

2026/27

Municipal Budget



HALIFAX

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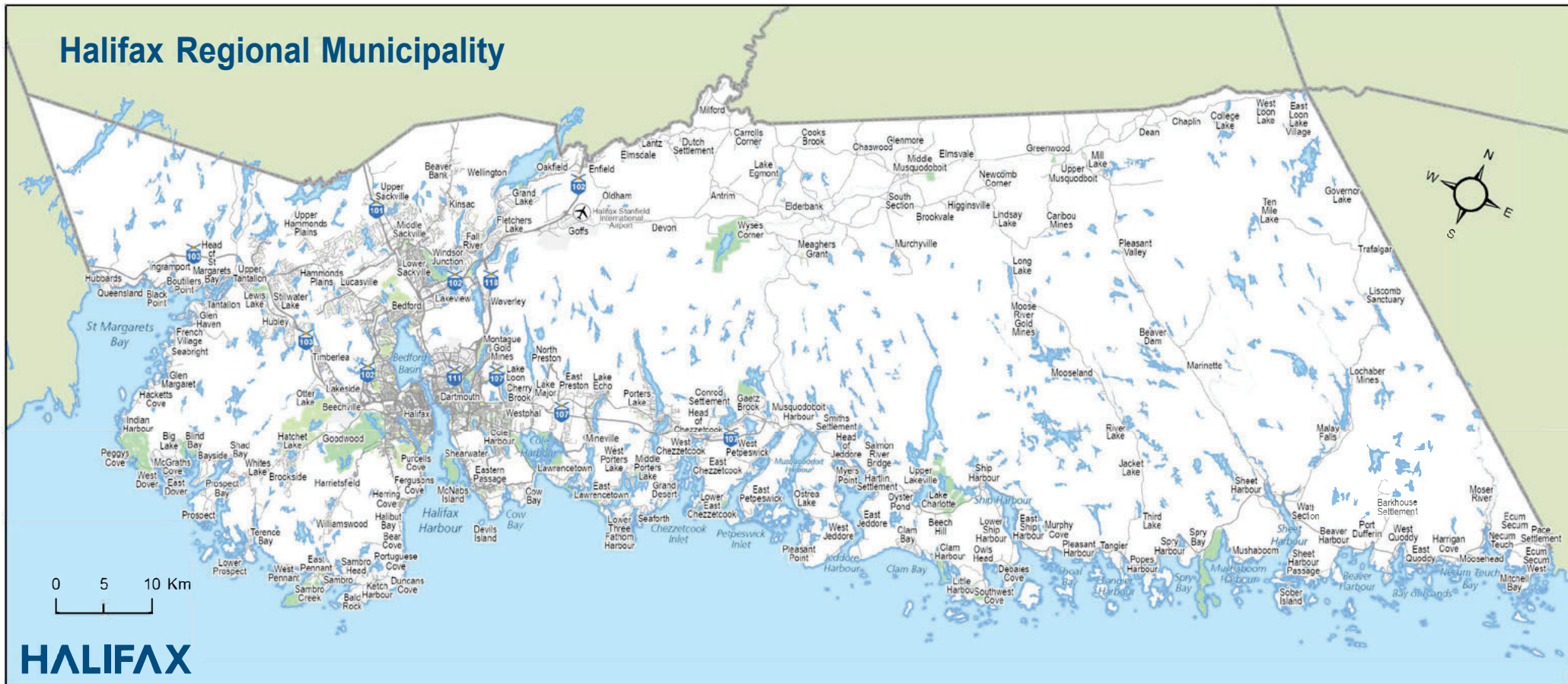
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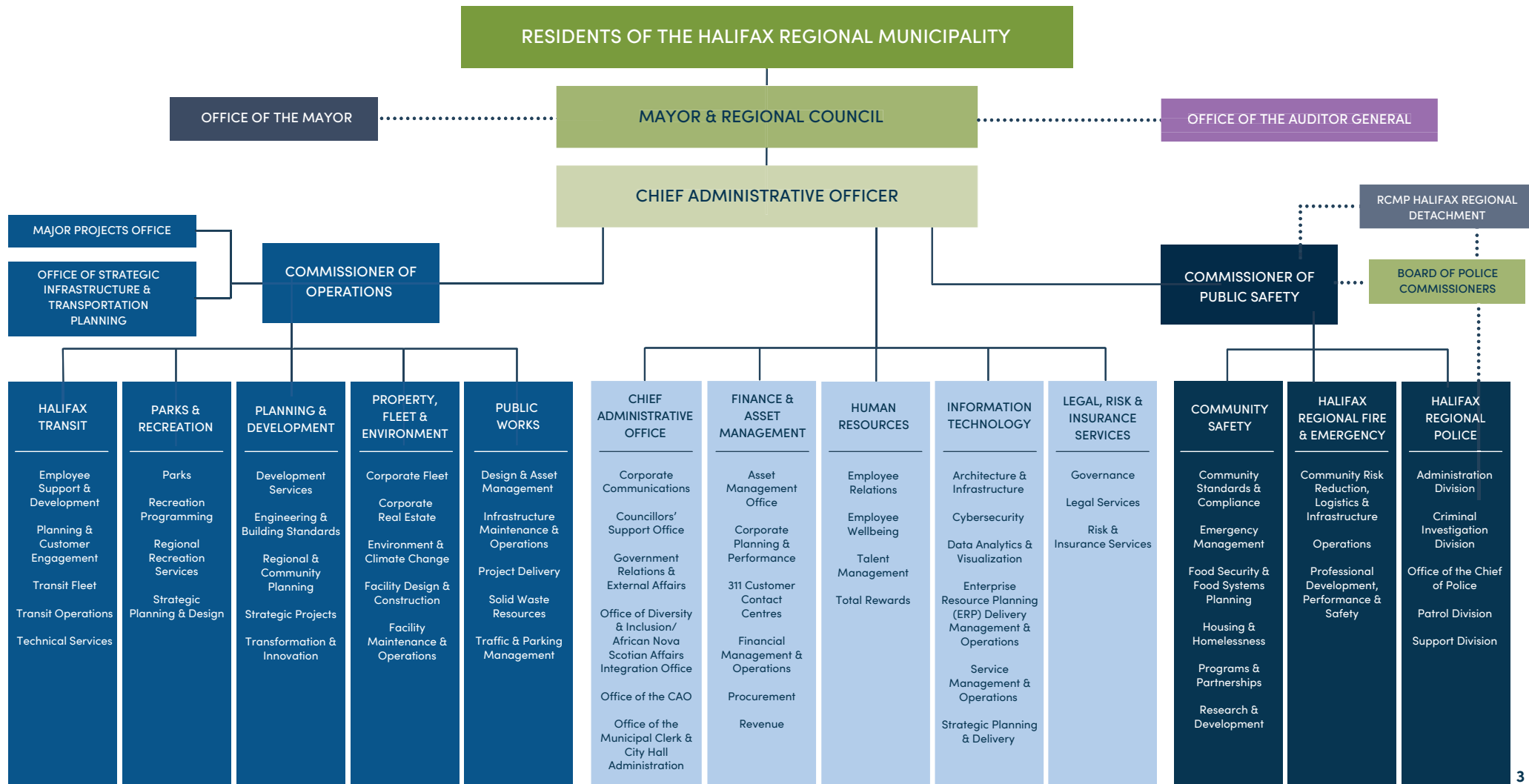
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Map of the Halifax region



HALIFAX REGIONAL MUNICIPALITY



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY AND 2026/27 BUDGET OVERVIEW

The Halifax region has seen unprecedented growth over the past several years. An increasing population, demand for municipal services and above average inflation has added a considerable amount of pressure on the municipality's budget. The municipality's approach to the 2026/27 Budget is to balance the demand and cost of services while remaining fiscally responsible.

There are two average tax bill metrics provided in the "2026/27 Budget at a Glance". The municipal average tax bill increase represents the municipal portion of the tax bill which is used to generate municipal revenue and fund municipal expenditures. These rates are set by Regional Council. The municipal average tax bill increase is quoted throughout the discussion and analysis. The second metric is the total average tax bill increase, which represents the total property tax bill increase including provincial and mandatory rates which are remitted directly by the municipality to other agencies.

During the 2026/27 Budget and Business Planning process, the municipality rationalized its expenditures and sought ways to mitigate the impact of inflation, maintain services and moved forward on the path to fiscal sustainability. Without this work, the required increase in tax revenues to cover increasing expenditures would have far exceeded 9.5 per cent. The increases reflect the challenges of growth and inflation on the resources required to carry out the priorities of Regional Council.

2026/27 Budget at a Glance

OPERATING BUDGET: **\$1.45B**

CAPITAL BUDGET: **\$316.7M**

MUNICIPAL AVERAGE TAX BILL
INCREASE: **9.5%**

TOTAL AVERAGE TAX BILL
INCREASE: **7.5%**

RESIDENTIAL TAX RATE INCREASE:
0.028 (FROM 0.770 TO 0.798)

APPROACH TO BUDGETING

The 2026/27 Budget was built using the strategic priorities in the *2026-2030 Strategic Priorities Plan*. At the beginning of each budget cycle, Finance & Asset Management staff meet with all individual business units to review their proposed plans for the upcoming fiscal year. Business units outline the services and service levels they intend to deliver, as well as the funds required to deliver on those plans. The total required funding is then consolidated and reviewed through a fiscally sustainable lens by Finance staff, who take the requested funding and balance it against a reasonable level of property taxes. As an outcome of that process, financial targets are issued to each business unit that will allow them to achieve their priorities.

Public Engagement

The municipality invites any member of the public to provide feedback to, or present at, any Budget Committee in advance of the committee meeting. For the 2026/27 budget, public participation debates were initiated, with nine dates available for members of the public to speak on the budget. The public was invited to participate prior to all budget meetings, both in person and virtually, including ahead of budget debates at the Board of Police Commissioners. This comprehensive approach provides ample opportunity for residents' input to assist in the development and ratification of the municipal budget.

FINANCIAL POLICIES

The following section outlines the legal and financial policies that guide the municipality's Finance staff as they build the annual budget.

Basis of Accounting

The municipality's financial information has been prepared to conform in all material respects to the accounting principles prescribed pursuant to Section 451 of the *Municipal Government Act Nova Scotia* (MGA) by the Nova Scotia Department of Municipal Affairs and Housing and adheres to their *Financial Reporting and Accounting Manual* (FRAM). It is intended for the use of members of Regional Council.

The operating budget sets out the expected net actual result of revenue and expenses of the municipality's Operating Fund. The extent that those revenues and expenses are included in the calculation of the municipality's estimate of required sums, as determined under Section 93 of the *Halifax Regional Municipality Charter*, provide the basis for the general tax rate. As per FRAM Section 3(1)(a)(iv)D, if the municipality's operating fund statement of operations results in a surplus, the surplus shall be transferred to the operating reserve.

Significant Accounting Policies

Revenue and expenses included in the determination of the general rate surplus are recorded on an accrual basis except as noted below:

- Interest expense is recorded on a cash basis;
- Debt principal repayments are deducted as an expense;
- Inter-fund transfers are included in the financial results of the Operating Fund;
- Transfers from the Operating Fund to purchase or construct tangible capital assets are deducted as an expense; and
- Amortization of tangible capital assets, changes in the value of the liability for employee sick leave and the liability for contaminated sites no longer in use are not included as expenses.

Reconciling Budgeting and Financial Reporting

There are important differences between how municipalities prepare their budgets and business plans and the requirements of how financial statements are prepared. The municipality's budget is prepared using the modified accrual accounting basis. This is done to meet the requirement outlined in section 93(8) of the *Halifax Regional Municipality Charter*:

The tax rates must be those that the Council deems sufficient to raise the amount required to defray the estimated requirements of the Municipality.

The intent of this section of the charter is that the municipality must prepare a balanced budget where funding outflows are matched with funding inflows. Funding inflows into the operating budget would be:

- property and deed transfer tax revenues;
- user fees, fines and fares; and
- transfers from financial reserves.

Whereas outflows from the budget would be the following items:

- expenditures (e.g. salaries, maintenance);
- capital budget funding from the operating budget; and
- debt repayments.

The annual financial statements are prepared on an accrual basis (as described above). The difference between the two would be the following:

- consolidation of related entities;
- debt principal repayments;
- transfers between funds (capital, operating and reserves); and
- depreciation of capital assets.

A reconciliation between these two approaches is provided in the notes to the annual financial statements.

DISCUSSION AND ANALYSIS

INTRODUCTION TO HALIFAX

The Halifax Regional Municipality (HRM) continues to serve as the dynamic economic center of Canada's East Coast. With a population of 517,115¹, the Halifax region is the largest and most diverse municipality within Nova Scotia. The municipality's landmass covers almost 5,500 sq km and nearly 50 per cent of Nova Scotia's population resides within the municipality. The Halifax region has both significant suburban and rural areas, with a concentrated urban mix. The region's unique blend of urban, suburban, and rural communities—spanning over 200 distinct areas—continues to attract new residents, making it one of Canada's fastest-growing municipalities.

ECONOMIC ENVIRONMENT: NATIONAL AND LOCAL

The Halifax Regional Municipality has the largest economic output in the Atlantic region. The municipality accounts for approximately 57 per cent of provincial gross-domestic product (GDP). It's real GDP growth outpaced both Canada and Nova Scotia, and accounted for 93 per cent of Nova Scotia's 2025 net real GDP growth². Below is some HRM specific economic data provided through the Halifax Partnership Economic Dashboard, as well as a bigger picture outlook.

Halifax's housing market remains tight. The average home price reached about \$595,000 in February 2026, slightly higher than both the previous month and the same time last year, and market conditions have shifted back toward a seller's market. Homes are also taking a bit longer to sell, with the median time on market rising to 31 days. In the rental market, average monthly rents increased 8 per cent in 2025 to about \$1,745, while the vacancy rate rose to 2.7 per cent. Smaller units saw the fastest rent growth, with studio rents increasing by 15 per cent.

Economic growth in Halifax remains relatively strong compared to the province and country. Real GDP grew by 2.3 per cent in 2025 and is expected to grow more moderately in the coming years, but the region still accounted for the vast majority of Nova Scotia's economic growth last year. Retail sales across the province increased year-over-year, with strong gains in categories like sporting goods and fuel, while health and personal care sales declined.

Labour market conditions remain stable, with unemployment at 5.3 per cent; still lower than both the provincial and national rates. Overall employment has grown modestly over the past year, driven largely by gains in health care and manufacturing, though some sectors such as public administration and transportation saw declines. Inflation in Halifax was 2.8 per cent in January 2026, slightly higher than the national rate. In commercial real estate, office vacancy remains elevated but relatively stable, while industrial vacancy has tightened and rents for industrial space have risen significantly.

Across Canada, the broader economic climate is becoming characterized by slower growth and increasing fiscal restraint. National GDP growth is expected to moderate to roughly 1–1.5 per cent in 2026 as consumer spending softens, business investment remains cautious, and population growth slows significantly due to reduced immigration targets. Slower population growth is expected to dampen demand for housing, goods,

¹ Source: Statistics Canada, Population estimates, July 1, by census division, 2021 boundaries

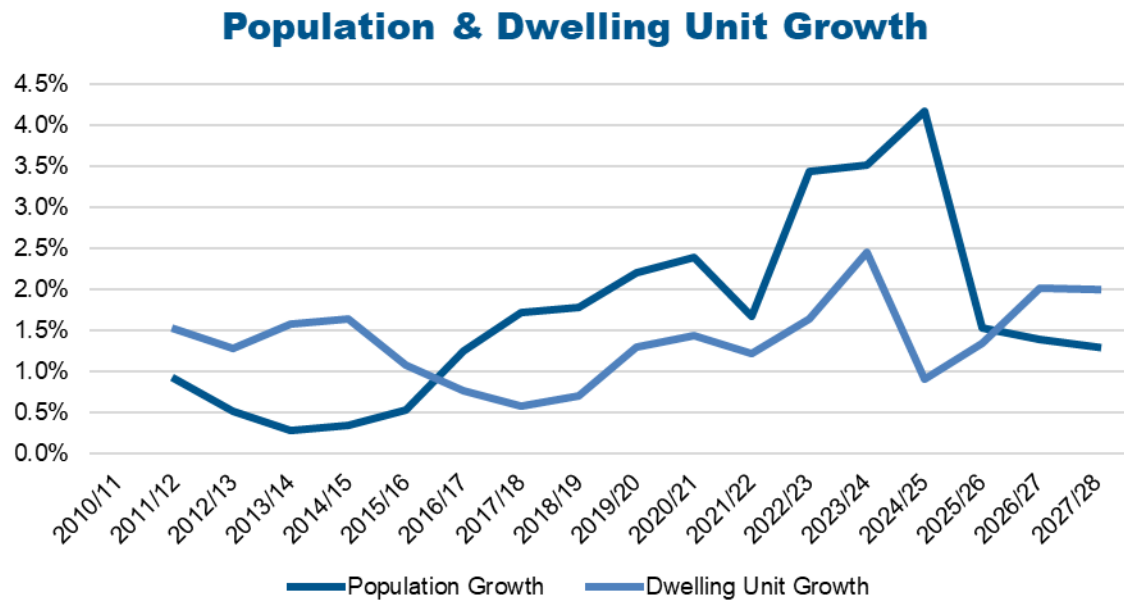
² Halifax Partnership | Halifax Economic Dashboard | February 2026

and services, contributing to a general economic slowdown and more modest expansion across many sectors.

At both the federal and provincial levels, governments are responding to this environment with tighter fiscal management. Many organizations and public institutions are beginning to implement belt-tightening measures, including operating cutbacks, hiring pauses, and staff reductions as they adjust to slower revenue growth and rising costs. In Nova Scotia specifically, the province is experiencing the same broader pressures affecting the Canadian economy; moderating growth, constrained public finances, and a more cautious outlook among businesses and governments as the economy transitions to a period of slower, more stable expansion.

The municipality is still facing significant challenges related to housing affordability and availability. Unprecedented population growth has led to a rising demand for housing that the current rate of residential construction still has not met, although this growth has slowed significantly more recently. On October 12, 2023, an agreement was reached between the Government of Canada and the municipality to deliver \$79.3 million in federal funding in support of housing initiatives that will be implemented by the end of 2026. As a result, significant changes have been implemented to allow for more densification in the urban core.³ This has led to the approval and commencement of initial stages of construction of a significant number of new high rises in Halifax and Dartmouth and a large increase to housing starts year-over-year. At some point in the near future the slowing population growth and accelerated dwelling unit growth will converge which should help to ease housing pressure. These trends as well as the more recent changes to population trending are depicted in Figure 1 below.

Figure 1 – Population and Dwelling Unit Counts, Actual and Forecast



Source: Population: Statistics Canada; Dwelling Units: Property Valuation Services Corporation Annual Assessment Reports;
Forecast: Internal HRM finance model

³ [Housing Accelerator Fund | Regional & Community Planning | Halifax](#)

OPERATING BUDGET

The operating budget includes expenditures that are required to run the municipality and provide essential services to residents. This includes compensation for staff and contractors, fuel, building maintenance, materials and debt charges – as well as a transfer from the operating budget to the capital budget. These costs are offset by revenues, including property taxes (residential and commercial), tax agreements, payments in lieu of taxes and a variety of fees and fines. Per the *Municipal Government Act Nova Scotia*, deficits are not permitted beyond one year.

In 2026/27, municipal expenditures will total \$1,211.7 million. The municipality has both accountability and revenue raising power for these expenditures. Major areas of cost increases include compensation increases and inflationary pressures across all expenditures. The municipality's population has grown significantly in recent years, as a result, costs to provide municipal services have also increased, including growth in the number of new staff positions (also known as full time equivalents or FTEs), compensation levels and capital asset repair.

Figure 2 below shows the summary of the municipal budget balance, from 2025/26 to 2026/27.

Figure 2 – Summary of Municipal Budget Balance, 2025/26 Compared to 2026/27 (in Millions)

Expenditures	2025/26 Budget	2026/27 Budget
Gross expenditures	\$ 1,333.6	\$ 1,445.9
Less: mandatory provincial costs	\$ (221.2)	\$ (234.2)
Municipal expenditures	\$ 1,112.4	\$ 1,211.7
Less: revenues	\$ (344.5)	\$ (360.8)
Net municipal expenditures	\$ 767.9	\$ 850.9
Less: general and transit tax levy	\$ (767.9)	\$ (850.9)

The municipality's largest area of expenditures is in compensation and related costs. These costs represent the staff that provide the services provided by the municipality. As the population grows, the demand for municipal services escalates. For instance, as demand for public transit grows, a larger fleet of buses is required for service expansion. Not only does this expansion incur significant capital expenditures for new buses, funded through the capital budget, but it also requires an increase to the operating budget to cover the salaries and related expenses of additional bus operators and support staff. Consequently, the municipality faces the dual challenge of financing immediate capital outlays and sustaining higher operational costs, underscoring the need for strategic budget management to ensure the long-term viability of expanded services.

Additional substantial expenses for the municipality encompass contractual service fees – for tasks outsourced beyond the municipal workforce – as well as expenditures on fuel. There are also transfers categorized as capital renewal, which are allocations from the operating budget to support capital investments. For a comprehensive breakdown of these costs, please refer to Figure 3 presented below.

Figure 3 – Budgeted Expenditures by Category from 2025/26 to 2026/27 (in Millions)

Category	Expense Budget (in \$M's)		
	2025/26 Budget	2026/27 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 566.2	\$ 595.1	5.1%
Office	18.2	18.4	1.1%
External Services	184.6	193.1	4.6%
Supplies	5.3	5.1	-4.1%
Materials	4.6	4.7	2.5%
Building Costs	23.9	24.0	0.7%
Equipment & Communications	12.7	12.9	1.7%
Vehicle Expense	43.8	43.6	-0.6%
Other Goods & Services	35.6	38.1	6.9%
Interdepartmental	0.1	(0.5)	-980.0%
Debt Service	43.5	44.5	2.3%
Other Fiscal	173.9	232.6	33.8%
Total Municipal Expenses	\$ 1,112.4	\$ 1,211.7	8.9%

The municipality provides services through its various business units. These expenditures are detailed below in Figure 4.

Figure 4 – Expenditures by Business Unit (in Millions)

Business Unit Expenditures	2025/26 Budget	% of Total Exp.	2026/27 Budget	% of Total Exp.
Public Safety:				
Community Safety	\$ 17.2	1.5%	\$ 18.3	1.5%
Halifax Regional Fire & Emergency	\$ 99.3	8.9%	\$ 102.4	8.5%
Halifax Regional Police	\$ 114.7	10.3%	\$ 115.6	9.5%
RCMP	\$ 40.1	3.6%	\$ 44.7	3.7%
Total	\$ 271.3	24.4%	\$ 281.0	23.2%
Operations:				
Halifax Transit	\$ 147.9	13.3%	\$ 158.9	13.1%
Property Fleet & Environment	\$ 65.7	5.9%	\$ 66.7	5.5%
Parks & Recreation	\$ 66.3	6.0%	\$ 71.6	5.9%
Planning & Development	\$ 29.4	2.6%	\$ 36.6	3.0%
Public Works	\$ 141.7	12.7%	\$ 145.1	12.0%
Major Projects Office	\$ 0.4	0.0%	\$ 0.5	0.0%
Strategic Infrastructure & Transportation Planning	\$ 1.6	0.1%	\$ 2.1	0.2%
Total	\$ 452.9	40.7%	\$ 481.4	39.7%
Corporate Service:				
CAO	\$ 23.8	2.1%	\$ 24.7	2.0%
Finance & Asset Management	\$ 22.8	2.0%	\$ 22.1	1.8%
Human Resources	\$ 11.8	1.1%	\$ 11.3	0.9%
Legal, Risk & Insurance Services	\$ 7.5	0.7%	\$ 8.0	0.7%
Information Technology	\$ 44.7	4.0%	\$ 47.1	3.9%
Total	\$ 110.7	10.0%	\$ 113.1	9.3%
Fiscal Services	\$ 240.6	21.6%	\$ 296.3	24.4%
Mayor's Office	\$ 1.0	0.1%	\$ 1.1	0.1%
Office of the Auditor General	\$ 1.3	0.1%	\$ 1.3	0.1%
Halifax Public Library	\$ 34.7	3.1%	\$ 37.5	3.1%
Total Municipal Expenditures	\$ 1,112.4	100%	\$ 1,211.7	100%

The municipality's full-time equivalent positions by business unit are detailed below in Figure 5.

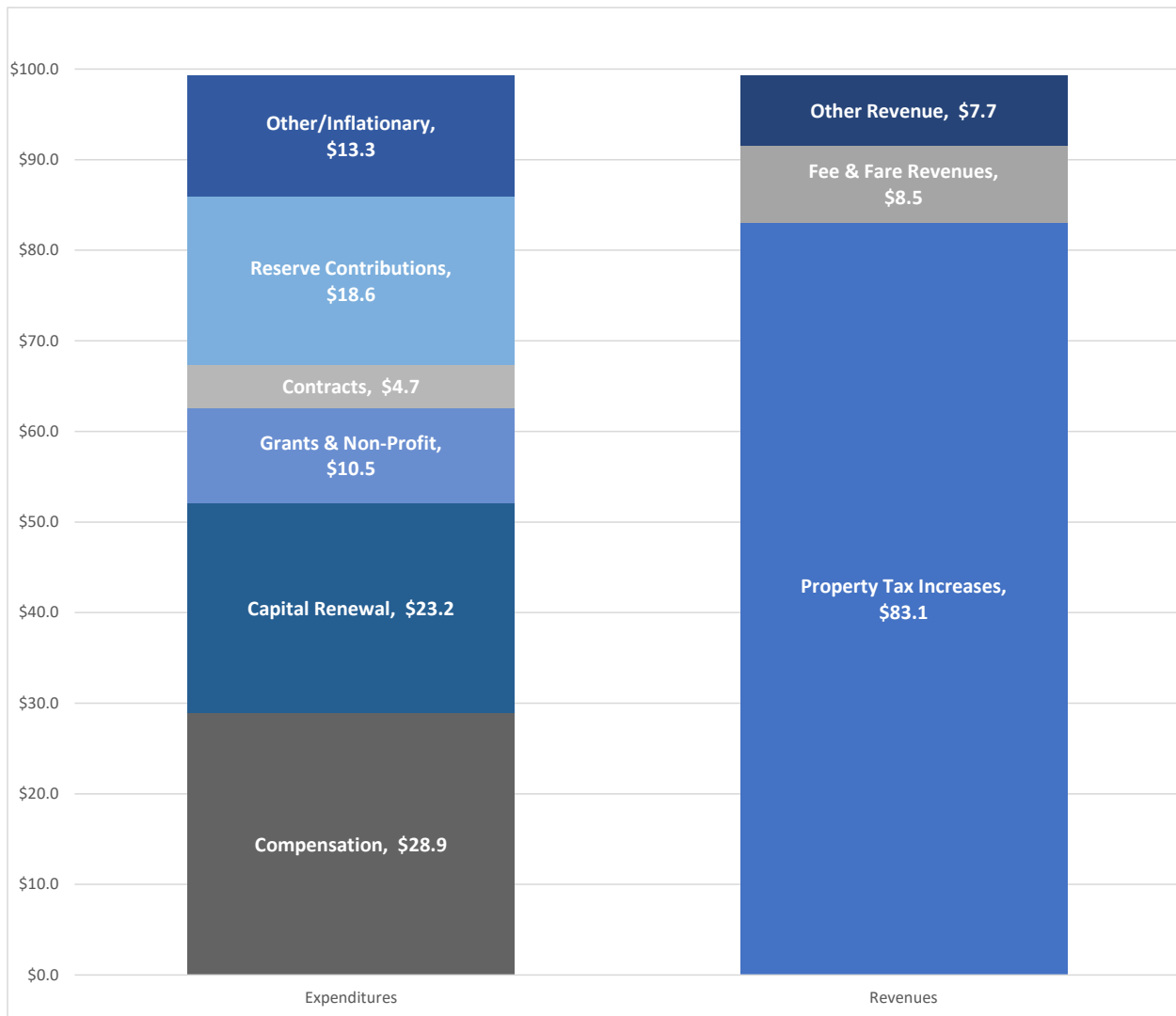
Figure 5 – Full Time Equivalent Positions by Business Unit

Business Unit FTEs	2025/26 Budget	2026/27 Budget	FTE Δ
Public Safety:			
Community Safety	149.8	150.4	0.6
Halifax Regional Fire & Emergency	652.7	661.7	9.0
Halifax Regional Police	783.4	786.4	3.0
Total	1,585.9	1,598.5	12.6
Operations:			
Halifax Transit	1,155.9	1,185.9	30.0
Property Fleet & Environment	237.0	233.0	(4.0)
Parks & Recreation	309.1	312.8	3.7
Planning & Development	255.0	250.0	(5.0)
Public Works	419.6	425.6	6.0
Major Projects Office	12.0	11.0	(1.0)
Strategic Infrastructure & Transportation Planning	10.0	14.0	4.0
Total	2,398.6	2,431.3	32.7
Corporate Service:			
CAO	81.0	120.7	39.7
Finance & Asset Management	239.2	229.6	(9.6)
Human Resources	92.0	91.0	(1.0)
Legal, Risk & Insurance Services	85.6	50.5	(35.1)
Information Technology	165.0	164.0	(1.0)
Total	662.8	655.8	(7.0)
Mayor's Office	6.0	7.0	1.0
Office of the Auditor General	9.6	9.6	-
Halifax Public Library	337.0	337.0	-
Total Municipal FTE's	4,999.9	5,039.2	39.3

BUDGET GROWTH

Incremental changes to the municipal budget are the result of operating pressures and additional resources needed to support initiatives directed by Regional Council, as well as to fund the Capital Plan. This budget increase is offset by an increase in revenue stemming from property taxation and other sources. Consequently, the average residential municipal tax bill will increase by 9.5 per cent – which combines a 5.6 per cent rise in average assessed property value with a 3.6 per cent increase in the municipal tax rate (the figures do not tie due to rounding). The incremental growth in revenues and expenses are detailed below in Figure 6.

Figure 6 – Incremental Municipal Revenues & Expenses (in millions)



PROPERTY TAXATION REVENUES

Canadian municipalities rely on property tax as their major source of revenue. Approximately 82 per cent of HRM's revenues come from residential, resource and commercial property taxes, tax agreements and payments in lieu of tax. Important municipal services – such as Halifax Regional Police, Halifax Regional Fire & Emergency, Parks & Recreation, Halifax Transit and Public Works – are primarily funded through the collection of a property tax rate of assessed property values, which includes residential, commercial and resource (land) property types.

There are two major components to the calculation of property tax: the assessed value of properties and the property tax rate. The value of the assessment base is established annually by an independent provincial agency, Property Value Services Corporation (PVSC), using established international standards of real property assessment. Nova Scotia's assessment represents market values from the previous year, although single-family homes are eligible to have their values capped at the Nova Scotia Consumer Price Index.

In the recent year, Halifax's housing market has leveled off, with prices stabilizing after a period of cooling due to tightened fiscal policies and a series of interest rate hikes designed to curb inflation. Since then, interest rates have begun to fall slowly. These measures have tempered the rate of price increases for the time being, but the long-term challenge of balancing housing supply with demand remains a critical issue. Halifax's housing market is now navigating a period of moderation, with affordability and housing availability emerging as key priorities for policymakers. However, the recent Bank of Canada decisions to lower interest rates again may begin stimulating renewed activity in the housing market and potentially lead to another period of rising prices. With inflation stabilized, the assessment cap on qualifying residential properties has been set at 2.6 per cent compared to an increase of 1.5 per cent in 2025/26. One significant trend which has continued to materialize is the conversion of commercial properties to residential to support housing construction. This has shifted a large portion of assessed property to residential which has significantly boosted this assessment class, while reducing commercial. Total assessment changes are outlined in Figure 1 below. By taxable residential category: vacant land increased 8.8 per cent which is down significantly after a two-year conversion trend from commercial to residential as developers prepared land for construction, single-family households went up 5.9 per cent, 2-3 unit building went up 12.6 per cent, and 4+ unit apartments went up 12.1 per cent which is caused by significant increase to the value of these buildings, as well as the fact most apartments do not qualify for the assessment cap.

Figure 7 – Residential and Commercial Taxable Assessment Value and Assessment Cap:

2022/23 to 2026/27 (in Billions)

(billions)	2022/23	2023/24	2024/25	2025/26	2026/27
Residential	\$ 46.8	\$ 52.8	\$ 57.3	\$ 62.0	\$ 66.8
Commercial	\$ 8.9	\$ 9.7	\$ 10.5	\$ 11.2	\$ 12.0
year-over-year change (%)					
Residential	9.6%	12.8%	8.5%	8.3%	7.7%
Commercial	0.6%	8.5%	8.2%	6.4%	7.2%
Historical Residential Property Assessment Cap					
Assessment Cap	5.4%	7.7%	3.2%	1.5%	2.6%

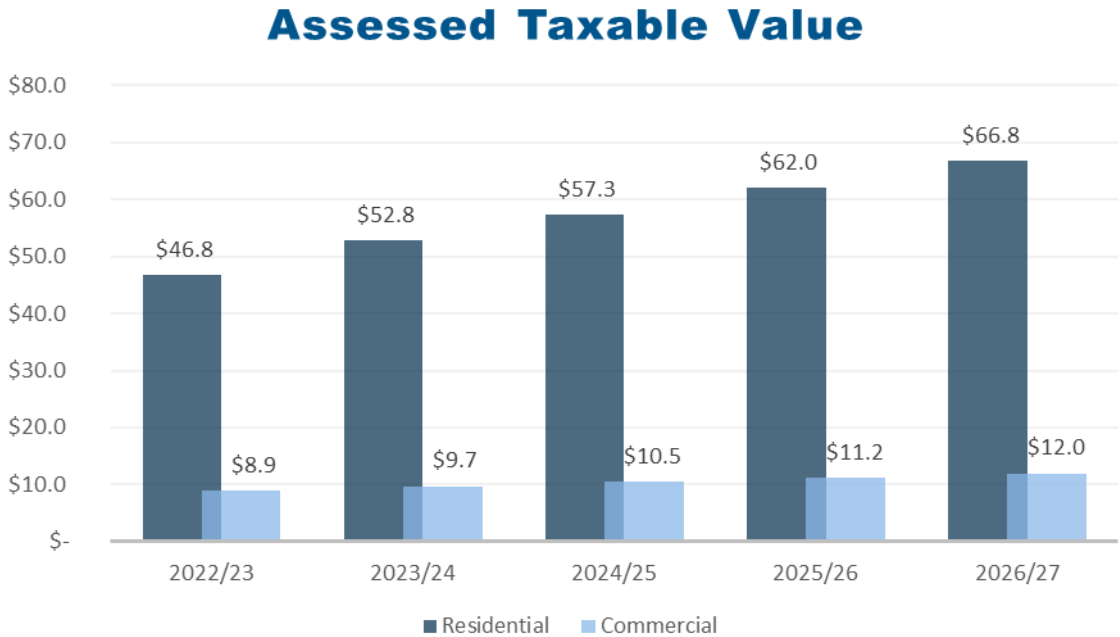
Source: Property Valuation Services Corporation

Commercial property values have continued a trend of strong growth. Retail shopping and office space, and industrial properties such as warehousing, as well as commercial vacant land have seen particularly high increases, leading to a total increase of 7.2 per cent – which is up slightly from the previous year of 6.4 per cent increase. The total taxable commercial assessment base increased by 7.6 per cent. Broken down by tax boundary, the:

- business park area increased by 9.1 per cent;
- community area (outside CDD⁴) increased by 9.2 per cent;
- downtown/community area increased by 7.2 per cent;
- industrial area increased by 10.7 per cent; and
- rural area increased by 4.7 per cent.

Figure 8 below details residential and commercial assessment taxable values from 2022/23 to 2026/27.

Figure 8 – Actual Assessment Growth, Official Assessment (Residential and Commercial)



PROPERTY TAXATION AND AVERAGE TAX BILL

The average tax bill increase is made up of a combination of the property assessment increase and property tax rate change. These two factors work in tandem to produce the average tax bill increase that is required to finance HRM’s expenditures based on the proposed annual budget. The property assessment is wholly controlled by PVSC, which is a provincial crown corporation. Once the assessment increase is known, the required property tax rates are calculated for residential, commercial, and resource properties (which may result in a rate increase or decrease) to provide the proposed tax bill increase. In prior years, due to historic growth in taxable assessments for residential properties and strong growth for commercial properties,

⁴ Commercial Development District

combined with lower average tax bill increases required to support the budget, the corresponding municipal tax rate on the average single-family household and commercial property required to finance the budget saw a decrease for a consistent period of time. Since 2023/24 this trend has ceased, with tax rates increasing each year since then. To meet the approved increase for the 2026/27 Budget, the residential and commercial base tax rates will change, as outlined in figures 9 - 13.

The average value of a single-family home in HRM has increased from \$338,500 to \$357,500 or 5.6 per cent (compared to an increase of 4.7 per cent in 2025), and the average single-family municipal residential tax bill will increase by 9.5 per cent or \$247 per year.

Figure 9 – Average Residential Single-Family Household Assessment, Tax Rate, and Municipal Tax Bill

	2025/26 Approved	2026/27 Proposed	% Change
Assessment	\$ 338,500	\$ 357,500	5.6%
Mun. Tax Rate	0.770	0.798	3.6%
Average Mun. Tax Bill	\$2,606	\$2,853	
Increase \$		\$247	
Increase %		9.5%	

The municipality has a variety of residential tax rates, including three residential general tax rates that vary by Urban, Suburban and Rural areas; a dedicated residential tax for Halifax Transit, the Local Transit tax, paid by those within one kilometre of a local route; and a Climate Action Tax to fund major climate change initiatives. These tax rates are set by the municipality. Specific tax rates are detailed below in Figure 10.

Figure 10 – Residential Municipal Tax Rates

Residential	2025/26 Approved	2026/27 Proposed	% Change
Urban General Rate	0.661	0.687	3.9%
Suburban General Rate	0.628	0.654	4.1%
Rural General Rate	0.628	0.654	4.1%
Local Transit Rate	0.092	0.095	3.3%
Strat. Inf. & Climate Fund	0.017	0.016	-5.9%

A new commercial taxation policy became effective on April 1, 2023, and has created changes to the way that commercial property taxes are calculated going forward. Geographical tax boundaries for commercial properties will change from the previous Urban, Suburban and Rural areas to one of five new tax areas, which are listed below in Figure 11. For each tax area, rates will vary by assessed value of the property within three tiers of assessment.

Figure 11 – Commercial Municipal Tax Rates

Commercial	2025/26			2026/27		
	\$0 - \$1M	\$1M - \$2M	\$2M+	\$0 - \$1M	\$1M - \$2M	\$2M+
Commercial Base Rate	2.888	2.888	2.888	2.950	2.950	2.950
Commercial Rural Rate	2.550	2.550	2.550	2.605	2.605	2.605
Strat. Inf. & Climate Fund	0.071	0.071	0.071	0.067	0.067	0.067
Business Park Tax Area	2.738	2.588	3.469	2.800	2.650	3.450
Community Area (Outside CDD)	2.738	2.588	2.898	2.800	2.650	2.950
Downtown/Community Tax Area	2.738	2.588	2.898	2.800	2.650	2.950
Industrial Park Tax Area	2.738	2.588	3.038	2.800	2.650	3.098
Rural Tax Area	2.550	2.550	2.550	2.605	2.605	2.605

The total average residential property tax bill contains many rate types which are listed on the bill and includes rates levied by the municipality as well as rates levied on behalf of the Province of Nova Scotia and Halifax Water. A description of each of these rates and some of the services they fund is provided later in the document, and the total average residential tax bill is illustrated below in Figure 12.

Figure 12 – Total Average Residential Single-Family Household Tax Bill

	2025/26 Approved	2026/27 Proposed	% Change
Assessment	\$ 338,500	\$ 357,500	5.6%
Urban General Rate	0.661	0.687	
Local Transit Rate	0.092	0.095	
Strat. Inf. & Climate Fund	0.017	0.016	
Municipal Tax	0.770	0.798	3.6%
Average Mun. Tax Bill	\$2,606	\$2,853	
Municipal Increase \$		\$247	
Municipal Increase %		9.5%	
Supplementary Education	0.015	0.015	0.0%
Mandatory Education	0.294	0.290	-1.4%
Property Valuation Serv.	0.011	0.010	-9.1%
Fire Protection	0.015	0.014	-6.7%
Stormwater ROW	0.010	0.008	-20.0%
Total Tax	0.345	0.337	-2.3%
Average Total Tax Bill	\$3,774	\$4,058	
Total Increase \$		\$284	
Total Increase %		7.5%	

Due to the implementation of Administrative Order 2022-003-ADM Respecting Commercial Property Taxation in Certain Areas of the Municipality, the average assessment increase to a commercial property must be broken down into the five commercial tax areas as well as across three rate tiers. This is provided in figure 13 below along with the various tiered taxation rates within each tax area that form the average tax bills for commercial properties. It is important to note that due to the wide range of assessments within

each tax area, and the tiered rate structure which increases the tax burden on higher valued properties, this average is not necessarily representative of most commercial properties.

Figure 13 – Total Average Commercial Tax Bill by Commercial Tax Area

Commercial	2025/26				2026/27				\$ Change	% Change
	\$0 - \$1M	\$1M - \$2M	\$2M+	Total	\$0 - \$1M	\$1M - \$2M	\$2M+	Total		
Business Park Tax Area	2.738	2.588	3.469	3.187	2.800	2.650	3.450	3.216		0.9%
Average Assessed Value	5,707,890	5,707,890	5,707,890	5,707,890	6,184,798	6,184,798	6,184,798	6,184,798		8.4%
Tax Bill	\$ 27,380	\$ 25,880	\$ 128,627	\$ 181,887	\$ 28,000	\$ 26,500	\$ 144,376	\$ 198,876	\$ 16,989	9.3%
Community Area (Outside CDD)	2.738	2.588	2.898	2.738	2.800	2.650	2.950	2.800		2.3%
Average Assessed Value	513,328	513,328	513,328	513,328	543,684	543,684	543,684	543,684		5.9%
Tax Bill	\$ 14,055	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 14,055	\$ 15,223	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 15,223	\$ 1,168	8.3%
Downtown/Community Tax Area	2.738	2.588	2.898	2.669	2.800	2.650	2.950	2.725		2.1%
Average Assessed Value	1,861,274	1,861,274	1,861,274	1,861,274	1,997,193	1,997,193	1,997,193	1,997,193		7.3%
Tax Bill	\$ 27,380	\$ 22,290	\$ -	\$ 49,670	\$ 28,000	\$ 26,426	\$ -	\$ 54,426	\$ 4,756	9.6%
Industrial Park Tax Area	2.738	2.588	3.038	2.779	2.800	2.650	3.098	2.863		3.0%
Average Assessed Value	2,899,239	2,899,239	2,899,239	2,899,239	3,175,559	3,175,559	3,175,559	3,175,559		9.5%
Tax Bill	\$ 27,380	\$ 25,880	\$ 27,319	\$ 80,579	\$ 28,000	\$ 26,500	\$ 36,419	\$ 90,919	\$ 10,340	12.8%
Rural Tax Area	2.550	2.550	2.550	2.550	2.605	2.605	2.605	2.605		2.2%
Average Assessed Value	536,583	536,583	536,583	536,583	578,155	578,155	578,155	578,155		7.7%
Tax Bill	\$ 13,683	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 13,683	\$ 15,061	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 15,061	\$ 1,378	10.1%

Municipal Tax Rates

Urban General Rate, Suburban General Rate, Rural General Rate

These rates provide funding for essential municipal services, including: policing, solid waste, recreation programs, planning and development, libraries, sports fields, playgrounds, municipal administration, fire suppression, street lighting, recreational and community facilities (including the municipality's share of capital and operating costs), sidewalks (including plowing), ferry services and the portion of Regional Express and other Halifax Transit express routes with park and ride facilities not covered within the Local Transit rate.

Strategic Infrastructure & Climate Fund

The Strategic Infrastructure & Climate Fund finances projects and programs supporting *HalifACT* outcomes, including climate mitigation and adaptation efforts and improved municipal resiliency with major projects ranging from electrification of buses to retrofitting existing municipal buildings.

Local Halifax Transit Rate

A local Halifax Transit rate is levied on all residential and resource properties within 1km walking distance of any HRM transit stop, at any point during the fiscal year. This includes conventional transit, community transit, park and rides, regional express, ferry terminals, and any other HRM transit stop.

Mandatory & Provincial Tax Rates

The 2026/27 Budget dedicates \$246 million for provincial services, such as education, supplemental education programming, and property assessment. The municipality does not provide these services, nor is the municipality accountable for how the money is spent. Rather, under the *Halifax Regional Municipality Charter*, all municipalities must levy taxes for these items and transfer the collected funds to the Halifax Regional Centre for Education (HRCE), Conseil scolaire acadien provincial (CSAP), and the province. There are also mandatory rates which are collected on behalf of Halifax Water and remitted to the utility in a similar manner as the province. Figure 15 below shows the share of Mandatory & Provincial Costs that the municipality will collect from the tax rate in 2026/27.

Supplementary Education Rate

The municipality provides supplementary funding to the Halifax HRCE, and the CSAP, the province-wide Acadian school board, for music, arts, and recreation programs within the Halifax region.

Fire Protection Rate

The Nova Scotia Regulatory and Appeals Board (NSRAB) requires the municipality to provide an annual contribution to fund the operations of the Halifax Water. This contribution is used to fund the hydrant costs incurred by Halifax Water and is set by a formula approved by the NSRAB. The hydrant charges are recovered via a special fire protection area rate that the municipality levies on all properties within 1,200 feet of a hydrant.

Storm Water Right-of-Way Rate

The municipality is responsible to pay an amount to Halifax Water for stormwater services based on the total area of impervious surface of municipal-owned roads. For the past five years, this storm water charge has been collected on the Halifax Water bill directly. As of April 1, 2023, the responsibility for collection of this rate has been transferred to the municipality, meaning it will no longer appear on a property owners water bill, but will now appear on the property tax bill instead.

Property Valuation Tax

The municipality shares some of the cost of the province's assessment system administered by PVSC.

Mandatory Provincial Education Tax

This mandatory education contribution is set by the Province of Nova Scotia at the value of the Provincial Education Rate times the Uniform Assessment.

Figures 14 and 15 below illustrate the proportion that each rate type makes up on the total residential property tax bill.

Figure 14 – Property Tax Bill Breakdown

HRM Urban Property Tax Bill Breakdown

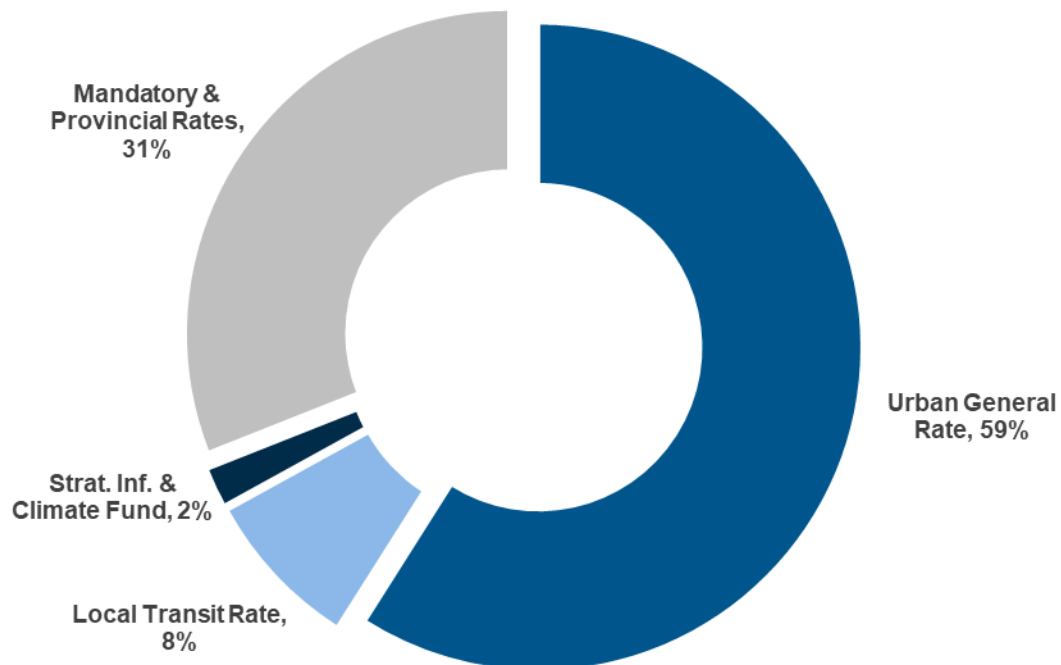
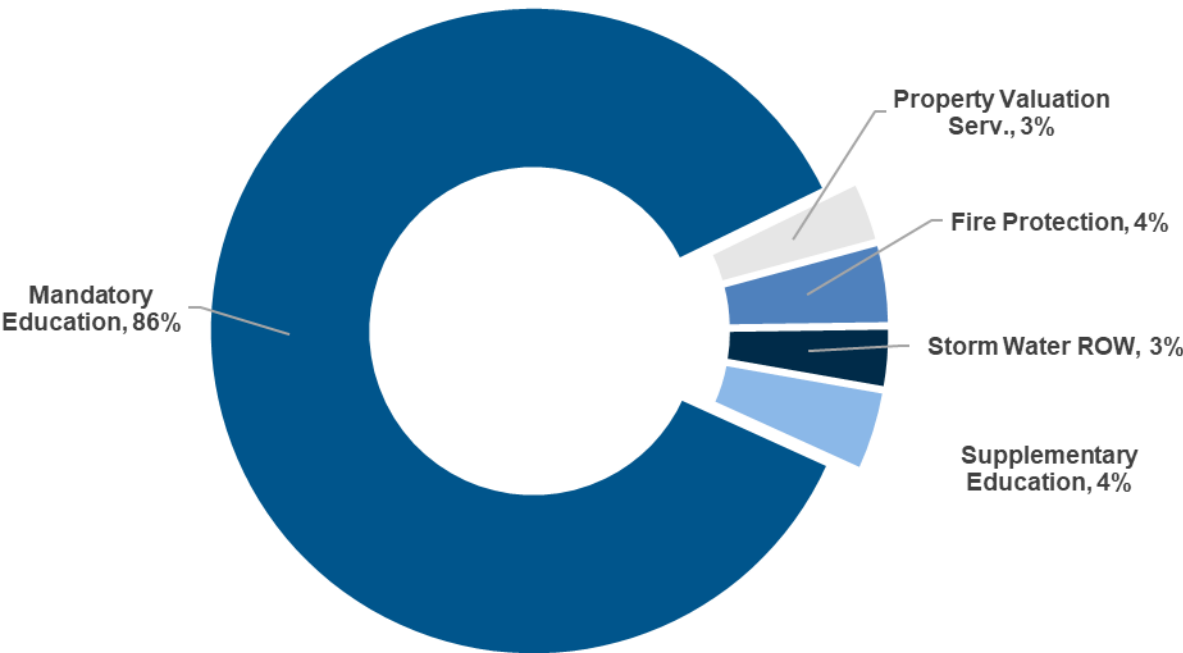


Figure 15 – Nova Scotia Provincial Mandatory Rates Breakdown

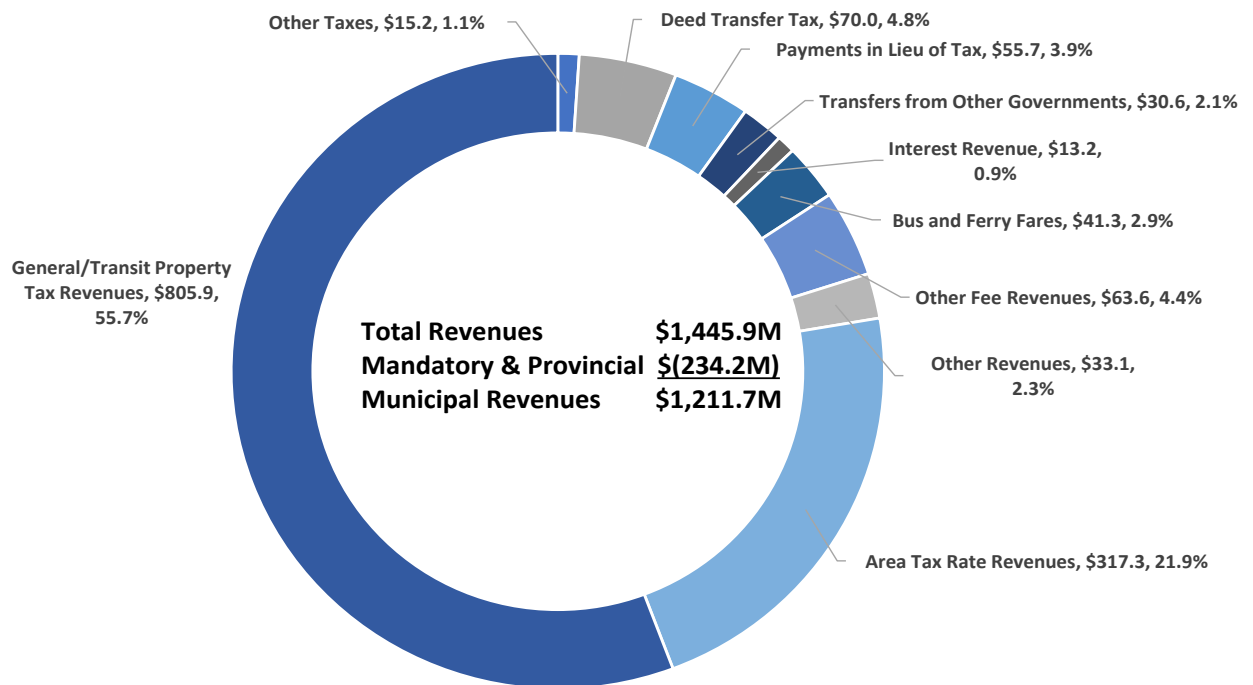
Mandatory & Provincial Rates Breakdown



OTHER REVENUES

Property taxes and payments in lieu of taxes form the most significant share of municipal revenues, as shown below in Figure 16. Deed Transfer Tax (a 1.5 per cent tax on the sale of properties) is the municipality's second largest source of revenues. Area Tax Rate Revenues, although a significant portion of revenues are used for specific purposes and not for municipal operations.

Figure 16 – Municipal Revenues by Type: 2026/27 (in Millions)



DEBT

Debt is a financial tool used to help fund long-term capital expenditures. Debt provides the municipality with financial flexibility by spreading the cost of projects over a longer period and providing more consistent, predictable payments. Debt is taken on in the form of debentures, provided to the municipality by the Nova Scotia Department of Finance and Treasury Board. The municipality does not issue its own debt, and since it is provided by the Nova Scotia Department of Finance and Treasury Board, there is no associated bond rating.

Debentures being by paid by the municipality have a scheduled lifespan of between 10 and 20 years. In 2026/27, the total property tax and SI supported principal and interest payments on outstanding debt will be approximately \$44.5 million. This represents about 3.9 per cent of total municipality taxation revenue. This ratio is well below the 15 per cent ceiling, as established by the Province of Nova Scotia for municipalities to ensure strong financial health. Figure 17 below shows the debt service costs and outstanding balance of tax-supported debt between 2021 to 2026. The appendix contains the full repayment schedule (principal and interest) of all outstanding municipality debt by debenture.

Types of Municipal Debt

The municipality classifies its debt into five main types, each distinguished by the source of repayment. For the purposes of these guidelines, capital leases are treated as debt. The five types of debt include:

1. Tax Supported (General Rated) Debt: This is municipal debt, funded by the general tax rate and used to fund capital projects across the municipality. This funds capital projects that are eligible for debenture that are not Strategic Initiatives (SI);
2. Strategic Initiative (SI) Debt: This is debt funded by the SI Reserve. Projects eligible for SI debt are those designated as Strategic Initiatives, for example, transformative projects that would require a substantial increase in general tax rates to fund using current revenues;
3. Local Improvement Charge Debt (LIC): Debt issued for capital projects that are funded by LIC charges. For example, a limited group of properties in a confined geographic area where earmarked revenue pays for local capital expenditures. The debt is serviced by LIC revenues;
4. HRWC Debt (Halifax Water): Funds borrowed on behalf of HRWC and repaid through the HRWC rate base; and
5. Repayable Debt: Debt borrowed on behalf of, and fully paid for by, outside organizations that either operate municipal assets or are community owned.

Debt Limits and Ceiling

Provincial Financial Condition Indicator (FCI) guidelines dictate that the annual principal and interest expense paid on all long-term debt as a percentage of total own source operating revenue (property tax, PILT, sales of services, other revenue from own sources, and grants in lieu) is considered low risk at less than 10 per cent, moderate risk between 10 per cent to 15 per cent, and high risk at greater than 15 per cent.

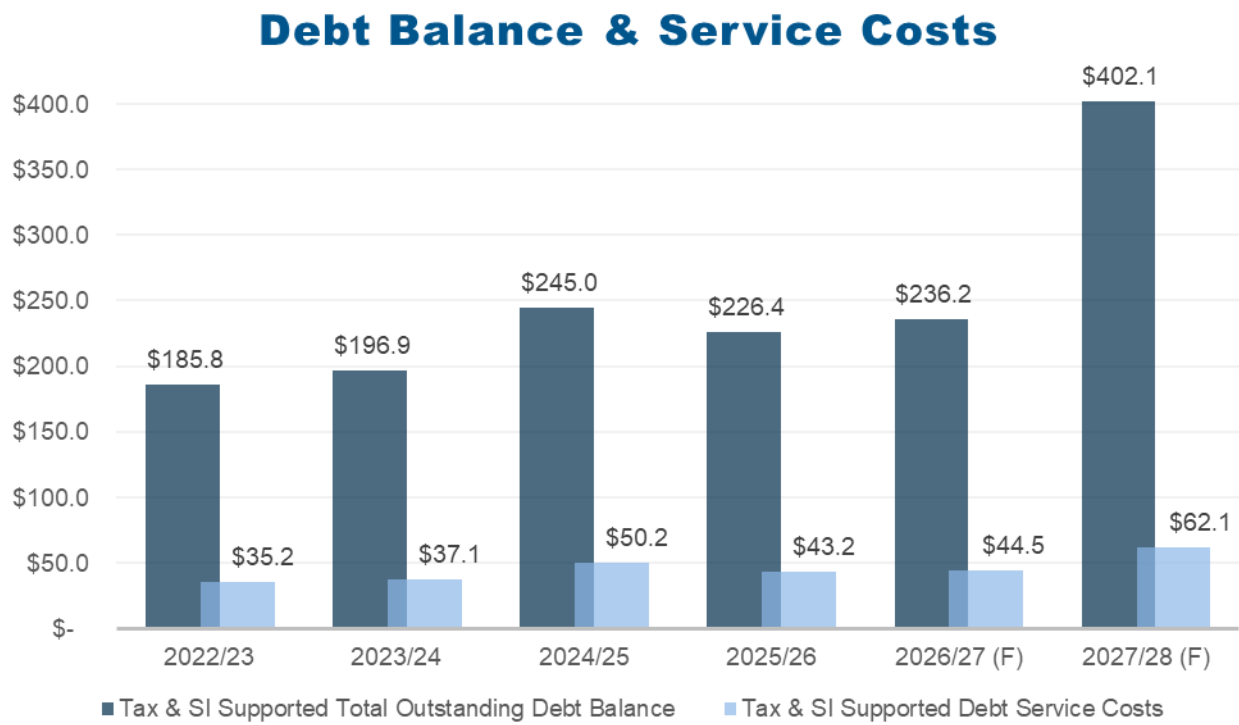
HRM sets the following guidelines:

1. Tax supported debt service ratio: the total combination of annual HRM tax supported debt and reserve funded debt service costs shall not exceed 12 per cent of annual HRM taxation revenue. Taxation revenue is the total combination of 'Taxation' and 'Taxation from other governments' as stated on the HRM Consolidated Statement of Operations and Accumulated Surplus as of March 31 of the stated fiscal year.
2. Upon the tax supported debt service ratio exceeding 11 per cent, where possible, annual debt principal costs of future debenture issuances must be less than or equal to the total amount of debt principal scheduled to be retired in that fiscal year, until such time as the ratio is reduced to at most 10 per cent.

Debt Guidelines and Principles

1. Debt will only be issued for capital assets with a useful life of at least 10 years and for those projects eligible to be debt funded in the capital budget. The duration of the debt must not exceed the useful life of the asset as defined by the Financial Reporting and Accounting Manual (FRAM).
2. The Department of Finance and Treasury Board carefully lays out what type of debt, borrowing options, maturities are to be set and manages market rates for NS municipalities. HRM is subject to the same criteria.
3. Municipal Debt is not purchased directly by international or institutional investors but by the Provincial Government to ensure liquidity and lower net borrowing rates. Municipal debentures are a form of provincial debt, which is owned by larger market entities including pension funds, institutional entities, and the Bank of Canada.
4. Municipal debt is provincially backed in capital markets. HRM's flexibility is through how much debt it can request through Temporary Borrowing Resolutions (TBRs) and what it can request/have approved.
5. HRM is authorized by the Province of Nova Scotia to issue debt through the Canadian Infrastructure Bank on qualifying capital projects.

Figure 17 – Outstanding Tax and SI Supported Debt and Service Costs (in Millions)



RESERVES

Reserves serve as financial safeguards, earmarked for upcoming expenses. They are categorized as either capital reserves, which are linked to the Capital Budget, or operating reserves, associated with the Operating Budget. Some reserves are mandated by law and carry specific usage constraints. The contributions to these reserves are sourced from operational funds or through the proceeds from asset liquidation, like the sale of surplus properties or business park lots.

Withdrawals from reserves must be authorized by Regional Council, through the budget process or by resolution via the Audit & Finance Standing Committee. Used properly, reserves support long-term planning and enhance financial sustainability by allowing unexpected or large expenditures to occur without significant impact to other services or tax rates.

The Financial Reserves Administrative Order (2014-015-ADM) outlines the Reserve Policy. Each reserve is supported by a business case outlining the reserve's objectives and the source and use of funds. Reserve balances are reported to Regional Council as part of quarterly financial reporting. The below Figure 18 shows a summary of forecasted reserves balances, from 2026/27 to 2029/30.

Figure 18 – Summary of Reserve Balances, 2026/27 to 2029/30 (in Millions)

Reserves	2026/27	2027/28	2028/29	2029/30
Risk reserves	\$ 22.2	\$ 25.9	\$ 29.8	\$ 33.7
Obligation reserves	\$ 147.6	\$ 167.6	\$ 206.0	\$ 221.8
Opportunity reserves	\$ 268.2	\$ 288.8	\$ 309.6	\$ 331.0
Total	\$ 437.9	\$ 482.3	\$ 545.4	\$ 586.6

Note: Figures may not add due to rounding

HALIFAX

COMMUNITY SAFETY

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

COMMUNITY SAFETY

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

To champion a community-focused, holistic approach to safety and well-being in Halifax Regional Municipality through the implementation of strategies to mitigate, prevent, respond and recover.

OVERVIEW

Community Safety strengthens the Halifax Regional Municipality's capacity to address the root causes of crime, social harms, violence and victimization while protecting vulnerable residents through proactive, outcomes-focused services. Critical to this work is increasing municipal understanding and awareness of the inequities and vulnerabilities in our communities and moving towards actions that create more welcoming, safe and complete communities for all. The business unit oversees the advancement of public safety, providing services to enhance community well-being and ensure that residents can live, work and thrive in a secure environment. The unit is also responsible for the formulation and administration of services and by-laws related to licensing and by-law enforcement.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Executive Director's Office	✓ Oversight and Administration of Community Safety Business Unit
Community Standards & Compliance	✓ Animal Services ✓ By-law Enforcement ✓ School Crossing Guard Program ✓ Licensing ✓ Park Patrols ✓ Housing and Homelessness Compliance Program
Emergency Management	✓ Amateur Radio Coordination ✓ Comfort Centre Management ✓ Emergency Management Office Operations ✓ Emergency Response Optimization ✓ Hazard, Risk and Vulnerability Assessment ✓ Joint Emergency Management Team Program ✓ Regional Search and Rescue Coordination ✓ Voluntary Vulnerable Persons Registry
Food Security & Food Systems Planning	✓ Community and Emergency Food Distribution Planning and Support ✓ Halifax Mobile Food Market ✓ JustFOOD Halifax Action Plan
Housing & Homelessness	✓ Advocacy Around Homelessness ✓ Outreach and Sheltering Operations ✓ Public Education Around Homelessness ✓ Research and Policy Development
Programs & Partnerships	✓ Collaborative Partnership Management ✓ Community Led Innovation ✓ Community Mobilization Coordination ✓ Community Safety Program Delivery ✓ Public Safety Coordination ✓ Youth Violence Prevention and Intervention
Research & Development	✓ Community Safety Training and Education ✓ Program and Policy Research, Development, and Evaluation

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		149.8
New Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
3 Supervisor School Crossing Guards (0.8 FTE to 1.0 FTE)	Maintain Current Service	0.6
Transferred Positions		
Net Transfer Positions		
Total Changes		0.6
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		150.4

Includes full, part-time, and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Research & Development	\$ (187,925)	\$ 379,500	\$ 382,800	\$ 588,000	\$ 208,500	54.9
Emergency Management	1,136,615	1,411,400	1,404,900	1,436,700	25,300	1.8
Housing & Homelessness	3,093,576	2,472,100	2,472,100	2,093,800	(378,300)	(15.3)
Programs & Partnerships	1,454,748	3,574,400	3,439,100	1,734,000	(1,840,400)	(51.5)
Food Security & Food Systems Planning	657,937	757,500	757,500	956,800	199,300	26.3
Community Standards & Compliance	6,134,484	6,800,800	6,528,900	7,048,000	247,200	3.6
Executive Director's Office	1,293,795	562,100	947,500	3,868,900	3,306,800	588.3
Net Total	\$ 13,583,231	\$ 15,957,800	\$ 15,932,800	\$ 17,726,200	\$ 1,768,400	11.1

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 9,516,195	\$ 10,272,600	\$ 10,168,300	\$ 10,736,800	\$ 464,200	4.5
Office	87,269	90,000	82,500	59,700	(30,300)	(33.7)
External Services	2,462,429	1,332,800	2,415,000	1,477,300	144,500	10.8
Supplies	151,721	51,700	265,500	101,700	50,000	96.7
Materials	46,387	1,200	11,200	51,200	50,000	4,166.7
Building Costs	117,915	401,000	222,800	51,000	(350,000)	(87.3)
Equipment & Communications	208,361	141,000	137,000	91,000	(50,000)	(35.5)
Vehicle Expense	2,416	5,800	11,300	10,800	5,000	86.2
Other Goods & Services	2,508,296	3,411,000	3,391,200	1,494,800	(1,916,200)	(56.2)
Interdepartmental	8,864	5,900	5,900	5,900	-	-
Other Fiscal	719,186	1,501,000	1,321,600	4,246,200	2,745,200	182.9
Total Expenditures	15,829,040	17,214,000	18,032,300	18,326,400	1,112,400	6.5

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Transfers from other Govts	\$ (92,835)	\$ -	\$ (390,700)	\$ -	\$ -	-
Fee Revenues	(357,494)	(375,000)	(407,000)	(380,000)	(5,000)	1.3
Other Revenue	(1,795,479)	(881,200)	(1,301,800)	(220,200)	661,000	(75.0)
Total Revenues	(2,245,809)	(1,256,200)	(2,099,500)	(600,200)	656,000	(52.2)
Net Total	\$ 13,583,231	\$ 15,957,800	\$ 15,932,800	\$ 17,726,200	\$ 1,768,400	11.1

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 15,957,800
Service Enhancements	
Maintain existing Service Levels in Research & Development	198,300
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Inflationary pressures in office expenses and other goods & services	16,200
AIM Team Strategy	1,500,000
Mobile Food Market	184,200
Neighbour Mediation Program	100,000
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	464,200
SPCA Contract Increase	90,000
Other/Transfers	
IT Services - Eastlink WAN/Internet Services	(1,700)
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact "Green" Reductions	(40,000)
Reduce funding for Stabilization Centre (due to inability to operationalize service)	(392,800)
Reduce unutilized funding to establish a drop-in centre for individuals experiencing homelessness	(350,000)
Total Changes	\$ 1,768,400
2026/27 Budget	\$ 17,726,200

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Executive Director's Office ¹	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected ²	2026 Planned
Public Safety Strategy Milestones Achieved (per cent of total)	30%	74%	80%	100%
¹ Data reported for the calendar year. ² Data projected as of December 17, 2025. Analysis: - The Public Safety Strategy (PSS) frames the municipality's strategic, prevention-centred approach to developing and growing the community safety ecosystem, specifically, through the implementation of actions in three areas. The PSS leads a coordinated approach to preventing crime, criminalization and victimization; strengthens and fosters partnerships with branches of government, social agencies, educational institutions, business associations and community groups; builds evidence, knowledge and capacity for coordinated and holistic approaches to the root causes of crime, criminalization and victimization. - The current Strategy covers the fiscal period 2023-2026 and is structured around a series of strategic milestones, with measurable progress tracked and reported annually to ensure effective implementation.				
Emergency Management ¹	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected ²	2026 Planned
Number of registrants hfxALERT	38,000	39,993	47,050	70,000
Number of registrants Voluntary Vulnerable Persons Registry (VVPR)	-	295	335	375
Number of Emergency Alerts/hfxALERT	-	54	45	50
Number of VVPR alerts issued during Emergency Alerts	-	-	9	15
Humanitarian Response Volunteers				
Ground Search and Rescue (GSAR)	-	308	310	330
Amateur Radio		166	151	154
Joint Emergency Management (JEM)		205	245	270
Total Volunteers		679	706	754
¹ Data reported for the calendar year. ² Data projected as of December 17, 2025. Analysis:				

- **Number of Volunteers.** Over the past year Volunteer participation in the Joint Emergency Management (JEM), the municipality's emergency response program, increased by **22.5%**. This growth reflects coordinated communications and community-based outreach led by Emergency Management and JEM teams.
In 2025, JEM teams were activated three times, supporting comfort centres and water distribution over four months, contributing more than 2,000 volunteer hours.
- **hfxALERT and Voluntary Vulnerable Persons Registry (VVPR)**
The municipality uses hfxALERT as its primary system for sending urgent and non-urgent emergency notifications to residents. The Voluntary Vulnerable Person Registry (VVPR) enables the municipality to directly support residents who may require additional assistance during emergencies.
Tracking registrations for hfxALERT and VVPR helps measure the reach and effectiveness of emergency communications and indicates how well-prepared communities are to receive critical information during emergencies.
Recent results show that registrations increased most significantly during real emergency events, rather than through promotional campaigns. For example, emergency preparedness activities resulted in approximately 30 new registrations, while Susie's Lake Wildfire led to an increase of about 1,000 registrations. This suggests that real-world use of emergency alerts is more effective at encouraging residents to sign up, and that event-based outreach may improve future registration rates.
- **Ground Search and Rescue GSAR**
The municipality relies on Ground Search and Rescue (GSAR) teams, which are on call 24 hours a day, 365 days a year. Their primary role is to support police agencies in searches for lost or missing persons in both urban and wilderness environments. Their secondary role is to assist during civil emergencies such as hurricanes, wildfires, floods, and drought. In 2025, GSAR teams helped distribute 876,137 litres of water to drought affected communities. GSAR teams aim to maintain steady membership levels that match their operational capacity. While personal and work-related demands can affect volunteer availability, teams place a strong emphasis on ongoing training and exercises to ensure a high level of readiness.
- **Amateur Radio**
As volunteer emergency services providers, the Dartmouth and Halifax Amateur Radio Clubs support HRM by maintaining radio communications infrastructure and providing technical expertise. Their members contribute hundreds of volunteer hours each year to ensure that equipment is ready for use during emergencies.
HRM is also supported by 24 trained Amateur Radio operators who form the Halifax Auxiliary Telecommunications Service (HATS). This group provides skilled telecommunications operators to support or replace normal communication systems when those systems are damaged or overloaded during an emergency. HATS volunteers operate and test HRM's backup radio systems, promote public education on emergency preparedness, and maintain 24/7 readiness. In 2025, they contributed more than 4,200 volunteer hours.
- **Joint Emergency Management (JEM)**
Over the past year, volunteer participation in the Joint Emergency Management (JEM) program - the municipality's community-based emergency response network - increased by

22.5%. This growth reflects coordinated communication efforts and strong community outreach led by Emergency Management and JEM teams.

In 2025, JEM teams were activated three times, supporting comfort centres and water distribution over a four-month period, contributing more than 2,000 volunteer hours. In addition to activation support, JEM volunteers also contributed hundreds more hours to training and community outreach activities focused on emergency preparedness.

Housing & Homelessness ¹	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected ²
Encampment service calls	784	1,146 ³	1,039
Number of people experiencing homelessness	-	-	1,150 ⁴

¹ Data reported for the calendar year.

² Data projected as of December 1, 2025.

³ As of 2024, 311 Customer Service Centres statistics include customer emails.

⁴ The most accurate count currently available estimates that approximately 1,150 people are experiencing homelessness in the Halifax Regional Municipality (data is from Affordable Housing Association of Nova Scotia's 2025 Point In Time count). A more meaningful performance measure for our work, however, is the number of individuals living rough whom our team successfully connects with shelter, indoor housing options, or temporary accommodations.

Analysis:

- **Encampment service calls.**

Next to the presence of encampments themselves, the most common concern about the presence of people sheltering in a community space is the garbage and waste that is generated. Calls to address waste or garbage in the community are registered through the 311 Customer Service Centre and tracked. While the number of calls largely depend on the number of homeless at any time and therefore outside of the municipality's control, staff can mitigate the volume of calls through working with encampment residents, regular inspections of sites, and increased provision of garbage cans or commercial garbage bins.

As the Housing & Homelessness service area and services are developed, other performance measures under consideration include:

- **Number of people sheltered and housed.**

The municipality's ultimate goal is that every Halifax Regional Municipality resident has a safe, supportive, and sustainable home, and that all homes are purposely constructed for long-term human habitation, built to safety codes and standards, and in a suitable location based on municipal planning strategies. One of the primary roles of outreach staff is to connect people experiencing homelessness to sheltering and housing. By tracking the number of people who can be housed that are supported by navigators, we can measure the effectiveness of transitioning people from homelessness to being housed. It is essential to note that the achievement of this performance measure is primarily impacted by the availability of affordable, deeply affordable, and supported housing.

- **Provision of supplies and supports.**

People experiencing homelessness often lack the resources to shelter outside safely. They need access to washrooms, power, and running water. While a primary goal of the navigator program is connecting people to housing, the other is supporting people while they are forced to sleep rough. By tracking the volume of supplies and supports provided each year, we can measure, to some extent, a key outcome of the work.

- **Number and usage of designated locations.**

The municipality will monitor the number of people sleeping rough in the community and usage trends could be an important measure of activity in the community and of the effectiveness of designated locations. In 2025, the municipality de-designated three encampment sites: Geary Street, Cogswell, and Lower Flinn Park. While many individuals residing at these locations were supported in accessing appropriate housing and indoor shelter options, others relocated to remaining designated encampments or to alternative locations. Precise relocation outcomes are not available at this time.

Programs & Partnerships ¹	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Actual ²	2026 Planned
Safe Cities & Safe Public Spaces Program				
Community Safety Assessments (CSA's)	4	1	4	3
Number of Sessions	34	16	78	59
Number of Participants				
Gender-Based Violence (GBV) Training	3	8	2	2
Number of Sessions	66	116	25	30
Number of Participants				
Led or supported progress on research.	5	6	2	1
Number of Projects				
Number of Participants				
Youth Violence Prevention & Intervention				
Child, Youth and Family Response Table				
Number of Sessions	-	5	10	11
Number of Participants	-	91	255	300
Crisis Assistance & Response (CARE) team				
Diversion from Emergency Services	-	-	66	400
Community Mobilization Teams				
Crisis Preparation: Meetings, Training and Workshops.				
Number of Sessions	24	28	35	40-
Number of Participants	241	214	1,532	1,700-
Community Collaborative Response Plan				
Healing Circles				

Number of Sessions	1	18	11	11
Number of Participants	-	244	209	125
Night of Caring				
Number of Sessions	2	3	8	5
Number of Participants	74	179	366	80
Trauma and Healing Workshops				
Number of Sessions	1	1	2	3
Number of Participants	-	-	90	115
Referrals for individual support	-	-	3	4

¹ Data reported for the calendar year.

² Data as of December 31, 2025.

Analysis:

- **Safe Cities & Safe Public Spaces Program.** This program has played a key role in contributing to the 2023-2026 Public Safety Strategy strategic priorities by providing expert advice to promote public safety across municipal programs and services, creating safer and more inclusive spaces. By tracking these actions, we can measure the scope and effectiveness of the networking and collaboration across business units and with external community organizations.
- **Youth Violence Prevention & Intervention.** The Youth Social Policy Strategist works with other youth-serving organizations to broaden the spectrum of responses to youth violence and intervention programs. This will provide a coordinated response to actions, programs, and support for youth in the municipality, directly connecting youth to resources. Programs & Partnerships can use this data to track the beginning stages of our Youth Safety Action Plan.
- **Crisis Assistance and Response (CARE) team.** Provides an innovative approach to public safety in the municipality by creating non-police alternative responses to distress related to substance use, mental health, or well-being. Community Safety collaborates with community organizations to dispatch skilled crisis workers and provide free confidential help.
- **Community Mobilization Teams.** An essential step in establishing an effective crisis response team is ensuring the community has the necessary capacity to support itself. By tracking these activities, Programs & Partnerships can determine if the training equips Community Mobilization Team members to be able to respond to and support the community during critical incidents. This shows that Programs & Partnerships is building community readiness and providing services to build stronger, more resilient residents.
- **Community Collaborative Response Plan.** The Community Crisis Response Program (CCRP) is a trauma-informed, culturally relevant, and community-driven pilot initiative launched to support residents across the municipality. CCRP addresses trauma as a root cause of violence and provides healing spaces for youth, families, and communities impacted by critical incidents.

Food Security & Food Systems Planning ¹	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Actual ²	2026 Planned
Mobile Food Market				7,000

Orders Placed Pounds of Food Distributed	1,469 124,072	3,830 178,400	6,026 263,096	300,000
Community Food Distribution Pounds of Food Distributed Number of Distribution Recipients	- -	- -	20,493 30	50,000 40
Urban Agriculture Number of New Community Plots Sites Number of Supported Community Gardens Number of Fruit and Nut Trees planted	- - -	5 - -	2 17 -	2 10 30
Emergency Food Planning Storm kits distributed Community partner agreements established	- -	- -	1,500 -	NA 20
Food Access and Literacy Community food programs delivered Assets added to HRM Food Asset Map	- -	30 -	30 -	40 100

¹ Data reported for the calendar year.

² Data as of December 2025.

Analysis

- **Mobile Food Market:**

Increase the year-over-year availability of fresh, locally sourced food in communities with limited access to healthy food. This will include expanding the number of markets and purchasing a new refrigerated Mobile Food Market truck.

- **Community Food Distribution:**

This new municipal program has already distributed significant amounts of food across the region. The use of the Truck brings more food into communities, distributes surplus food and reduces food waste, and reduces distribution burdens on community organizations. This program prioritizes small, grassroots organizations that often get missed in large deliveries or lack the resources/people power to secure surplus foods. As this program develops, the Truck will be increasingly maximized to efficiently distribute food. The Truck Coordinator will continue to develop relationships with community partners, increasing the municipality's network of community food actors.

- **Urban Agriculture:**

The Community Plots Pilot aims to increase access to growing space through the development of plots for community organizations and groups, increasing community access to growing spaces. In 2024, the Municipal Food Team advanced five new community plot sites, with the development of new beds for community use and site exploration at: (1) Spencer House, (2) Belmont Arms Oasis, (3) Avonhurst Gardens Oasis, (4) Atlantic Street, Pallet Shelter Community, and (5) Farrell Street Park. In 2025, the Municipal Food Team further advanced

community plot development at Farrell Street and began site engagement and visioning for the Amalamek Way Community Garden, in collaboration with the Mi'kmaw Native Friendship Centre. This work will continue through 2026.

In 2025, the Halifax Food Council advanced urban agriculture across the municipality. Key achievements include provision of direct support to 17 of 26 registered community gardens on municipal land across 11 districts, through water delivery, provision of infrastructure, educational programming, and the distribution of Community Garden Grants. In 2026, the Urban Agriculture Specialist will further advance this work.

- **Emergency Food Planning:**

- In 2025, kits containing shelf-stable food to 1500 residents. Local food products and other emergency resources were distributed through 4 different community partners, prioritizing newcomers and international students who are often less connected to local services. In providing these kits, the project increased community preparedness while supporting the regional economy through local product procurement. Learnings from this project were captured in a final report and jurisdictional scan, that will be available on justfoodhalifax.ca.
- The Emergency Food Partners Bids & Tenders work, done in partnership with Procurement, is being finalized by Corporate Communications and is anticipated to launch in early 2026. Community organizations will register for this municipal program so that they can be activated by Emergency Management Office during emergency events. This integration of community resources, expertise, and relationships increases the municipalities capacity to respond to emergency events, allowing for more coordinated yet flexible responses.

- **Food Access and Literacy:**

- JustFOOD Community Partners delivered community food literacy programs to Indigenous and African Nova Scotia community members. Programs encouraged skill-building, social connections, and cultural, healthy meal preparation, strengthening food access, and fostering supportive networks amounts communities.

Research & Development ¹	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected	2026 Planned
Community Safety Training Participants	330	285	450	400
Participants who agree that community safety training supports independent resolution of crises and conflict at work or volunteering	-	49%	84%	-
Research and Development Learning Partnerships	18	36	38	35
Satisfaction and confidence level with community safety trainings	-	89%	90%	-
¹ Data reported for the calendar year.				

Analysis:

- **Community Safety Training Participants.** In the past year, Community Safety partners have facilitated training in Nonviolent Crisis Intervention, Mental Health First Aid and Applied Suicide Intervention Skills Training. Measuring the number of municipal staff, partners, and volunteers trained in Community Safety education offerings is an indicator of the reach of training programs and their impact on building capacity for alternative (non-enforcement) approaches to safety. The reach of our training programs demonstrates the skills municipal employees, volunteers and community partners to have to de-escalate situations before an enforcement response is required. This approach is more effective and efficient in creating community safety and supporting employee and volunteer wellbeing.
- **Community Safety Training Impact.** Feedback generated from participants in Community Safety training can help measure progress toward building alternatives to enforcement. The percentage of participants who believe that the training has reduced their need to seek help when resolving crisis or conflict situations is a measure of the likelihood that community safety training will support staff, partners and volunteers in alternatives to enforcement and capacity to help individuals navigate toward services to support their needs.
- **Research and Development Learning Partnerships.** The Research & Development service area's key role is fostering the community safety ecosystem through capacity building and learning partnerships. Measuring the number of multi-week research, development and capacity building partnerships and collaborations with external partners such as academic institutions, non-profits, community organizations, and other levels of government is an indicator of the breadth and impact of the ecosystem in advancing shared community safety goals.

Community Standards & Compliance ¹	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected ²
Number of by-law service requests/complaints and inquiries ³	9,931	9,013	10,203
Number of by-law cases created	7,119	6,432	7,324
Number of Orders issued (curbside solid waste and dangerous and unsightly)	2,691	1,989	2,417
Number of summary offence tickets issued	274	218	351
Number of site visits	12,005	12,002	12,910
Number of licenses inspections ⁴	1,161	1,187	1,159
Number of licenses issued ⁵	5,519	5,969	5,198
Park and taxi stand patrols	684	1,571	3,739
Number of animals handled (animal control)	389	338	380
Housing & Homelessness calls for service	-	1,262	1,013
Housing & Homelessness designated encampment patrols performed ⁶	-	329	394

Number of children crossed at school crosswalks per day ⁷	-	~13,000	13,300
¹ Data reported for the calendar year. ² All figures presented are projected. 2025 projections are based on actual expenditures to November 1, 2025, with a calculated projection applied to estimate year-end 2025 results. ³ Service requests include requests from Animal Services, License Standards, and By-law Standards. ⁴ Includes inspections for taxis, sidewalk cafes, and food service vehicles. ⁵ Includes dogs, taxis, and transportation network companies, temporary signs, highway advertising signage, sidewalk cafes, vendors, and land-lease communities. ⁶ Includes designated encampments only. Patrols of undesignated encampments are recorded as park patrols. ⁷ In 2024, school crossing guards were transferred from Halifax Regional Police to Community Safety. Statistics are not available prior to 2024. The increase in children is due to additional crosswalks being added. Analysis: Service Requests/ Complaints and Inquiries are generated by the public and are fluid from year to year. There has been an increase in proactive patrols for parks and taxis along with calls for service for Housing & Homelessness. The increase in park patrols has resulted from a more formalized service level agreement with Parks & Recreation related to priority parks. Our service delivery model focusses on community safety and maintaining community standards by promoting safe healthy and livable communities.			

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
EP-01 Increase regional growth in strategic areas that are well-served by existing or planned services, utilities, and infrastructure.	
Equity-based Policy Framework <i>Service Area: Research & Development</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal EP-01; no Action alignment Capital investments have a profound impact on community safety and wellbeing. They influence where people can travel, gather, socialize, find jobs, and feel a sense of safety and belonging. This Framework and associated toolkit will help decision-makers prioritize capital investment planning based on evidence and community informed measures of equity. The goal is to provide a resource for a more equitable approach to decision making across the municipality and an approach to monitor impacts of investment on measures of equity.	31-Mar-27
SC-01 Improve municipal preparedness planning to mitigate the potential impacts of emergency situations and climate-related events.	
Community Mobilization Team <i>Service Area: Programs & Partnerships</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-01-A1 Support resident-led Community Mobilization Teams in accessing and navigating community resources by facilitating coordination to strengthen their capacity to prevent, prepare for, and respond to critical incidents. This will include conducting 10 monthly coordination meetings between the three Community Mobilization Teams and key community and municipal partners and holding a minimum of three training for volunteers.	31-Mar-27
Crisis Assistance and Response (CARE) team <i>Service Area: Programs & Partnerships</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-01-A1 Ensure CARE Team calls are documented and analyzed in partnership with 211 and Souls Harbour, and establish diversion pathways with HRP, RCMP, IES, the Provincial Crisis Line, and Victim Services to support appropriate routing of non-violent crisis calls to CARE.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Emergency Management Strategic Plan <i>Service Area: Emergency Management</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-01-A2 Emergency Management will implement its comprehensive strategic emergency management plan to guide the emergency management program and subsequent projects. This will outline the principles of the Emergency Management Assistance Program framework. The plan will be operationalized in the next two years.	31-Mar-28
Update and Replace Municipal Emergency Management Plan (2017) with Comprehensive Emergency Management Plan <i>Service Area: Emergency Management</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-01-A2 Update and replace Municipal Emergency Management Plan to provide the structure and operational direction for emergency management in the municipality. The plan would replace the Municipal Emergency Plan with updated and more detailed information for prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response and recovery.	31-Dec-26
Public Safety Strategy 2023-2026 <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-01-A5 The Public Safety Office commenced implementation of the current Public Safety Strategy in April 2023. The Strategy guides municipal business units in promoting safer communities through proactive, preventative and non-enforcement responses. All actions in the strategy are complete or in flight as it enters its final year of implementation. This year the Strategy implementation will focus on Indigenous Community Safety planning (1.3) implementing an Equity-based Policy Framework (Action 1.6); Drug Policy Working Group (Action 2.2); and Youth Community Safety (Action 2.5). At the end of each fiscal year, detailed Strategy outcomes are reported to Regional Council in the Public Safety Strategy Annual Report.	31-Mar-27
Public Safety Strategy Renewal 2027-2030 <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-01-A5 The Public Safety Strategy frames the municipality's strategic, prevention-centred approach to developing and growing the community safety ecosystem. The current Strategy is set for renewal, and development has commenced for a new Public Safety Strategy for Regional Council approval. The new Strategy will refine existing programs and initiatives to expand their focus toward Senior Safety, Preventing Violent Extremism and Gender Based Violence. The Strategy will be presented to Regional Council for approval by Jan 31, 2027.	31-Jan-27

Deliverable	Completion
Public Safety Strategy Program and Policy Research and Development <i>Service Area: Research & Development</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-01-A5 Advance and refine the Monitoring and Evaluation Framework for the Public Safety Strategy, including KPIs, dashboard development, geospatial indicators, and oversight of independent program evaluations and annual impact reports. Sustain and grow partnerships and collaborations to build capacity, knowledge and networks with internal and external groups including other branches of government, community sector and academic institutions.	31-Mar-27
Drought Resiliency Strategy <i>Service Area: Emergency Management</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-01-A6 Participate in Provincial working groups to develop a drought resiliency strategy for the municipality.	31-Mar-27
SC-02 Improve municipal emergency response and recovery efforts to keep residents safe, protect property, and restore essential services and infrastructure following an emergency event.	
Community Safety Training and Education <i>Service Area: Research & Development</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-02-A1 Promote community safety training offerings and capacity for municipal staff, community partners and volunteers, including Nonviolent Crisis Intervention, Mental Health First Aid, Safe Talk, Applied Suicide Intervention, Bystander Intervention and Preventing Violent Extremism.	31-Mar-27
Explore Expansion of Compliance Operations <i>Service Area: Community Standards & Compliance</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-02-A2 Explore expansion of Compliance Officers functions by examining other municipalities with the goal of improving response and being more inclusive to the municipality's growing needs.	31-Dec-27
Monitoring and Evaluation Framework for Programs and Services <i>Service Area: Research & Development</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-02-A2 Oversee the evaluation of new programs and services.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Senior Safety <i>Service Area: Research & Development</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-02-A2 Embed findings from the Senior Safety Research and Engagement Report into implementable actions in the renewed Public Safety Strategy.	31-Mar-27
Youth Violence Prevention and Intervention Strategic Plan <i>Service Area: Programs & Partnerships</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-02-A2 Programs & Partnerships will work with Research & Development to develop a Youth Safety Action Plan that will be embedded into the renewed Public Safety Strategy.	31-Dec-26
SC-03 Improve the well-being of community members at risk of or experiencing homelessness by enhancing supports and resources	
Weekly Monitoring of Non-Designated Encampment Sites <i>Service Area: Housing & Homelessness</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-03-A1 Conduct weekly on-site check-ins at all known non-designated encampment locations to assess conditions, identify emerging risks, and ensure timely sharing information with relevant departments. Performance will be measured by the total number of check-ins completed each week, with results tracked and reported through a standardized weekly monitoring log.	31-Mar-27
Annual Indoor Transition Support for Individuals Experiencing Homelessness <i>Service Area: Housing & Homelessness</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-03-A2 Assist at least 100 individuals per year in transitioning indoors by coordinating referrals, providing navigation support, and documenting outcomes across shelter and housing programs. Progress will be tracked through the total number of individuals who secure indoor accommodations with our direct involvement.	31-Mar-27
SC-04 Plan and invest in social infrastructure and opportunities for connection to increase residents' well-being and sense of belonging in their communities.	
Promoting Healing from Trauma <i>Service Area: Programs & Partnerships</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A7 Implement the Collaborative Community Response Plan (CCRP) with diverse grassroots community organizations by hosting healing events (e.g., healing circles, Nights of Caring) to provide trauma-informed, culturally relevant support for communities impacted by violence.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Safe City and Safe Public Spaces Program <i>Service Area: Programs & Partnerships</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-04-13 The Safe Cities and Safe Public Spaces program aims to respond to and prevent sexual violence against women and girls in public spaces through collaborative and locally owned changes to policies, programs, and built environments. The program plays a key role in actioning the Public Safety Office's equitable, intersectional, and community-based approach to public safety. The program will carry out a minimum of one on-site safety assessment quarterly and develop strategies and plans in collaboration with partners and communities.	31-Mar-27
SC-07 Invest in the enhancement, protection, and expansion of natural assets, green spaces and urban agriculture to support community and ecological health and resilient ecosystem services.	
Develop a Formal Community Food Distribution Program <i>Service Area: Food Security & Food Systems Planning</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-07-A6 Develop and pilot the JustFOOD Community Food Distribution Program using the community food truck to support dignified access to food in underserved communities and reduce food waste. This deliverable includes partnering with community food organizations and suppliers to increase access to food supply and coordinating distribution activities during the pilot period. It also includes collecting data on community interest, program impact, and participant feedback. Completion of this deliverable will produce a formal Community Food Distribution Program model.	31-Mar-27
Develop and Launch Halifax Regional Municipality Food Asset Map <i>Service Area: Food Security & Food Systems Planning</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-07-A6 Formally establish the Halifax Regional Municipality Food Asset Map, a mapping application intended to enable the identification, refinement, and sharing of information about food resources in the Halifax Region. This deliverable includes open-source food resource data that will support researchers, policymakers, service providers, planners, advocates, and community members. The impacts of this deliverable include better identification of gaps, vulnerabilities, and assets in the food system and will help inform other municipal planning efforts.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Establish a Community Fruit and Nut Tree Program <i>Service Area: Food Security & Food Systems Planning</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-07-A6 Develop and launch a community Fruit and Nut Tree Program that supports residents and garden groups in planting, caring for, and harvesting fruit and nut trees in public spaces. This deliverable includes creating a formal process for procuring and installing trees in partnership with Urban Forestry and Parks & Recreation and piloting the program through community-led site selection and planning. Program design and pilot setup will be complete by June 1, 2026, with tree planting finished by December 31, 2026. Success will be measured through the number of pilot sites, trees planted, workshops delivered, and community participation.	31-Mar-27
Establish JustFOOD Community Garden Grants Program <i>Service Area: Food Security & Food Systems Planning</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-07-A6 Formally establish the municipally led JustFOOD Community Garden Grants Program, building on the 2025 pilot. This deliverable includes finalizing program guidelines, opening the annual intake, supporting applicants, coordinating evaluations, and distributing funds to community gardens on municipal land. The program will reduce barriers to participation and support garden development, maintenance, and community learning. Outcomes will be tracked through final reports to assess program impact.	31-Mar-27
RA-04 Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency, and cost effectiveness, while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.	
Develop an Emergency Coordination Centre Operations Guide <i>Service Area: Emergency Management</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action alignment Describe how the Municipal Emergency Coordination Centre (ECC) is structured and how it functions during an emergency. After the structure and role are approved, update the ECC concept of operations (ECC ConOps), which will explain how the ECC centre is activated and how it will operate.	31-Mar-27

Summary of Net Expenditures - Community Safety

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
C426 AIM Mobile Outreach	-	-	-	2,988,000	2,988,000	-
C600 Ex Dir Comm Safety	1,180,163	562,100	947,500	780,900	218,800	38.9
C422 CS Admin Prog Mgmt	113,633	-	-	100,000	100,000	-
** Community Safety Admin	1,293,795	562,100	947,500	3,868,900	3,306,800	588.3
C419 Public Safety Grant	(292,824)	-	-	-	-	-
C416 Public Safety Research	104,900	379,500	382,800	588,000	208,500	54.9
** Public Safety Research	(187,925)	379,500	382,800	588,000	208,500	54.9
C423 Homelessness Projects	257,102	-	-	-	-	-
C415 Homelessness Support	2,836,474	2,472,100	2,472,100	2,093,800	(378,300)	(15.3)
** Homelessness Support	3,093,576	2,472,100	2,472,100	2,093,800	(378,300)	(15.3)
C424 Community Response	-	2,203,000	2,031,500	98,200	(2,104,800)	(95.5)
C411 Public Safety Advisor	1,397,970	853,200	1,217,800	1,550,400	697,200	81.7
C417 HRM Safe Cities	16,731	259,700	93,700	40,000	(219,700)	(84.6)
C418 Comm Mobilization	40,047	258,500	96,100	45,400	(213,100)	(82.4)
** Progs & Partnerships	1,454,748	3,574,400	3,439,100	1,734,000	(1,840,400)	(51.5)
S421 Contracted Remedies	(0)	-	-	-	-	-
S420 By-Law Standards	2,281,986	2,748,900	2,422,500	2,900,800	151,900	5.5
S410 By-Law Services Adm	714,393	707,500	774,100	766,000	58,500	8.3
S330 Taxi & Limousine	133,186	58,300	47,700	27,900	(30,400)	(52.1)
S320 Animal control	-	-	-	-	-	-
D004 Building Administration	304,820	308,700	292,200	320,100	11,400	3.7
** Compliance	3,434,384	3,823,400	3,536,500	4,014,800	191,400	5.0
C421 Food Security	657,937	757,500	757,500	956,800	199,300	26.3
C801 Emergency Measures	1,136,615	1,411,400	1,404,900	1,436,700	25,300	1.8
P445 Marine	92,710	98,600	98,600	98,600	-	-
P460 Sch. Crossing Guard	2,607,389	2,878,800	2,893,800	2,934,600	55,800	1.9
*** Net Total	13,583,231	15,957,800	15,932,800	17,726,200	1,768,400	11.1

Summary of Expenditures Details - Community Safety

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	7,729,238	8,682,500	8,042,500	9,050,700	368,200	4.2
6002 Salaries - Overtime	65,020	46,200	96,200	46,200	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(130,103)	-	(129,900)	-	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	44,140	25,000	40,000	25,000	-	-
6099 Other Allowances	-	17,000	17,000	17,000	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	1,251,472	1,465,600	1,443,100	1,650,700	185,100	12.6
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(681,800)	-	(681,800)	-	-
6152 Retirement Incentives	29,846	38,200	37,100	45,000	6,800	17.8
6154 Workers' Compensation	236,894	310,300	294,800	312,100	1,800	0.6
6156 Clothing Allowance	34,143	36,000	36,000	36,000	-	-
6158 WCB Recov Earnings	(5,919)	-	-	-	-	-
6170 ext Fund Positions	-	-	-	-	-	-
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	192,689	333,600	291,500	235,900	(97,700)	(29.3)
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	68,777	-	-	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	9,516,195	10,272,600	10,168,300	10,736,800	464,200	4.5
6201 Telephone/Cable	17,830	22,500	14,000	21,800	(700)	(3.1)
6202 Courier/Postage	32,529	2,000	35,000	2,000	-	-
6203 Office Furn/Equip	9,015	8,500	8,500	8,500	-	-
6205 Printing & Reprod	135	6,400	6,400	16,300	9,900	154.7
6207 Office Supplies	24,251	15,600	18,600	6,100	(9,500)	(60.9)
6299 Other Office Expenses	3,510	35,000	-	5,000	(30,000)	(85.7)
* Office	87,269	90,000	82,500	59,700	(30,300)	(33.7)
6301 Professional Fees	1,240	42,000	42,000	10,000	(32,000)	(76.2)
6302 Legal Fees	-	700	700	700	-	-
6303 Consulting Fees	35,572	266,500	362,700	13,000	(253,500)	(95.1)
6308 Snow Removal	55,664	-	-	-	-	-
6310 Outside Personnel	682	-	-	-	-	-
6311 Security	62,221	-	-	-	-	-
6312 Refuse Collection	388,497	-	436,000	150,000	150,000	-
6399 Contract Services	1,918,553	1,023,600	1,573,600	1,303,600	280,000	27.4
* External Services	2,462,429	1,332,800	2,415,000	1,477,300	144,500	10.8

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	18,050	30,500	30,500	30,500	-	-
6402 Med & First Aid Supp	45	-	-	-	-	-
6403 Patrol Equip Supplies	26	-	-	-	-	-
6406 Bridge Tolls	4,104	1,000	1,000	1,000	-	-
6407 Clean/Sani Supplies	2,015	1,500	1,500	1,500	-	-
6409 Personal Protect Equ	4,811	11,000	12,000	11,000	-	-
6499 Other Supplies	122,669	7,700	220,500	57,700	50,000	649.4
* Supplies	151,721	51,700	265,500	101,700	50,000	96.7
6504 Hardware	23	-	-	-	-	-
6516 Topsoil	-	1,200	1,200	1,200	-	-
6517 Paint	163	-	-	-	-	-
6599 Other Materials	46,202	-	10,000	50,000	50,000	-
* Materials	46,387	1,200	11,200	51,200	50,000	4,166.7
6602 Electrical	8,263	-	500	-	-	-
6603 Grnds & Landscaping	1,558	-	-	-	-	-
6605 Municipal Taxes	32,447	-	-	-	-	-
6607 Electricity	3,123	1,000	1,000	1,000	-	-
6608 Water	31,965	-	159,600	-	-	-
6610 Building - Exterior	9,047	-	-	-	-	-
6611 Building - Interior	3,806	-	-	-	-	-
6612 Safety Systems	2,657	-	-	-	-	-
6614 Envir Assess/Cleanup	15,002	400,000	61,700	50,000	(350,000)	(87.5)
6617 Pest Management	6,231	-	-	-	-	-
6699 Other Building Cost	3,815	-	-	-	-	-
* Building Costs	117,915	401,000	222,800	51,000	(350,000)	(87.3)
6701 Equipment Purchase	73,353	120,000	120,000	70,000	(50,000)	(41.7)
6702 Small Tools	830	-	-	-	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	3,429	-	-	-	-	-
6704 Equipment Rental	-	200	200	200	-	-
6705 Equip - R&M	2,857	1,800	1,800	1,800	-	-
6706 Computer R&M	-	4,000	-	4,000	-	-
6707 Plumbing & Heating	107,835	-	-	-	-	-
6708 Mechanical Equipment	10,539	-	-	-	-	-
6711 Communication System	9,517	15,000	15,000	15,000	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	208,361	141,000	137,000	91,000	(50,000)	(35.5)
6802 Vehicle R&M	702	2,500	8,000	7,500	5,000	200.0
6804 Vehicle Fuel - Gas	-	300	300	300	-	-
6805 Tires and Tubes	333	-	-	-	-	-
6806 Vehicle Rentals	356	1,000	1,000	1,000	-	-
6899 Other Vehicle Expense	1,025	2,000	2,000	2,000	-	-
* Vehicle Expense	2,416	5,800	11,300	10,800	5,000	86.2
6901 Membership Dues	6,314	8,000	8,000	12,000	4,000	50.0
6902 Conferences/Workshop	5,688	16,700	9,700	20,700	4,000	24.0
6903 Travel - Local	36,433	56,000	41,000	48,500	(7,500)	(13.4)
6904 Travel - Out of Town	38,182	17,400	17,400	14,200	(3,200)	(18.4)
6905 Training & Education	53,998	107,500	73,000	132,500	25,000	23.3
6906 Licenses & Agreements	33,429	-	-	-	-	-
6909 Cost of Sales	1,269	-	-	-	-	-
6911 Facilities Rental	16,069	29,500	29,500	6,500	(23,000)	(78.0)
6912 Advertising/Promotio	10,854	101,500	44,500	85,500	(16,000)	(15.8)
6913 Awards	865	1,200	1,200	1,200	-	-
6914 Recruiting	195	-	-	-	-	-
6916 Public Education	11,657	-	-	6,000	6,000	-
6917 Books and Periodicals	266	4,100	4,100	4,400	300	7.3
6918 Meals/Catering	38,732	49,100	49,100	15,100	(34,000)	(69.2)
6919 Special Projects	1,547,128	2,991,500	2,684,700	945,300	(2,046,200)	(68.4)
6929 Procurement Card Clg	20	-	-	-	-	-
6933 Community Events	6,838	5,000	5,000	5,000	-	-
6938 Rewarding Excellence	2,079	3,500	4,000	3,700	200	5.7
6940 Fencing	29,214	-	-	-	-	-
6999 Other Goods/Services	669,068	20,000	420,000	194,200	174,200	871.0
* Other Goods & Services	2,508,296	3,411,000	3,391,200	1,494,800	(1,916,200)	(56.2)
7009 Internal Trfr Other	1,689	1,300	1,300	1,300	-	-
7011 Int Trf Record Check	-	-	-	-	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	7,176	4,600	4,600	4,600	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
* Interdepartmental	8,864	5,900	5,900	5,900	-	-
8001 Transf Outside Agenc	134,321	831,000	682,900	3,426,200	2,595,200	312.3
8004 Grants	584,865	770,000	822,000	820,000	50,000	6.5
8030 Tfr Fr Resvs to Oper	-	(100,000)	(183,300)	-	100,000	(100.0)
* Other Fiscal	719,186	1,501,000	1,321,600	4,246,200	2,745,200	182.9
** Total	15,829,040	17,214,000	18,032,300	18,326,400	1,112,400	6.5

Summary of Revenues Details - Community Safety

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4703 Cond.Grant NS(Other)	(92,835)	-	(52,200)	-	-	-
4704 Conditnl Grnts Other	-	-	(158,800)	-	-	-
4750 Other Grants	-	-	(179,700)	-	-	-
* Transfers from other Gov'ts	(92,835)	-	(390,700)	-	-	-
4907 Taxi Licenses	(112,925)	(140,000)	(175,000)	(140,000)	-	-
4908 Animal Licenses	(128,242)	(140,000)	(108,000)	(140,000)	-	-
4916 Vending Licenses	(36,162)	(25,000)	(24,000)	(25,000)	-	-
4950 Other Lic. & Permits	(80,165)	(70,000)	(100,000)	(75,000)	(5,000)	7.1
* Fee Revenues	(357,494)	(375,000)	(407,000)	(380,000)	(5,000)	1.3
5508 Recov External Parti	(1,795,479)	(881,200)	(1,301,800)	(220,200)	661,000	(75.0)
* Other Revenue	(1,795,479)	(881,200)	(1,301,800)	(220,200)	661,000	(75.0)
** Total	(2,245,809)	(1,256,200)	(2,099,500)	(600,200)	656,000	(52.2)
*** Net Total	13,583,231	15,957,800	15,932,800	17,726,200	1,768,400	11.1

HALIFAX

**HALIFAX REGIONAL FIRE AND
EMERGENCY**

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

HALIFAX REGIONAL FIRE & EMERGENCY

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

Our members are dedicated to enhancing and preserving quality of life, property and environment through education, leadership, partnerships and effective response to emergencies to ensure the citizens of Halifax Regional Municipality live in safe, inclusive and welcoming communities.

OVERVIEW

Halifax Regional Fire & Emergency (HRFE) advances Council and Administrative priorities by leading community safety initiatives, supporting holistic community planning and growth and delivering service excellence through innovation and best practices. HRFE delivers a full range of services, including fire prevention and education, fire suppression and technical rescue, hazardous materials response, emergency medical first response, community risk reduction and incident management. Serving more than 500,000 residents across 5,577 km², HRFE operates 51 strategically located fire stations staffed by over 500 career and 550 volunteer firefighters and officers, ensuring safety, innovation and community resilience.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Office of the Fire Chief	✓ Oversight and Administration of the Halifax Regional Fire & Emergency Business Unit ✓ Event Organization ✓ HRFE Social Media Management ✓ Local Assistant to the Fire Marshal ✓ Public Enquires Response
Community Risk Reduction, Logistics & Infrastructure	✓ Fire and Life Safety Education ✓ Fire Inspections and Code Enforcement ✓ Fire Investigations and Technical Review ✓ HRFE Infrastructure Maintenance, Design and Redevelopment ✓ Medical Training, Research and Continuous Quality Improvement ✓ Protective Equipment, Asset Management and Emergency Support ✓ Wildland Urban Interface (WUI) Program
Operations	✓ Emergency Medical First Response ✓ Fire Safety Maintenance Inspection Program (FSMI) ✓ Firefighting & Emergency Services ✓ Hazardous Materials Response ✓ Heavy Urban Search and Rescue (HUSAR) ✓ Home Fire Safety and Smoke Alarm Assistance ✓ Public Events and Fire Station Tours ✓ Technical Rescue ✓ Volunteer Firefighter Recruitment and Retention ✓ Water and Ice Rescue
Professional Development, Performance & Safety	✓ Emergency Communications and Technology ✓ Firefighter and Family Assistance Programming ✓ Occupational Health and Safety ✓ Professional Development and Training ✓ Workplace Culture / Diversity, Equity & Inclusion

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		652.7
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
HUSAR Program Manager	Maintain Current Service	1.0
Volunteer Outreach and Recruitment Assistant	Service Enhancement	1.0
Fire Urban Specialist	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Manager Fire Inspection Services	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Deputy Chief	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Career Firefighter	Budget Committee Direction	10.0
Transferred Positions		
Net Transfer Positions		-
Total Changes		9.0
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		661.7

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Office Of The Fire Chief	\$ 1,838,679	\$ 1,878,800	\$ 1,904,500	\$ 1,847,600	\$ (31,200)	(1.7)
Prof. Development, Performance & Safety	7,571,199	7,408,300	7,044,700	6,428,200	(980,100)	(13.2)
Operations	79,886,986	81,107,900	83,220,400	85,392,300	4,284,400	5.3
Comm. Risk Reduction, Logistics & Infrastructure	6,627,108	7,794,400	8,541,900	7,669,100	(125,300)	(1.6)
Net Total	\$ 95,923,973	\$ 98,189,400	\$ 100,711,500	\$ 101,337,200	\$ 3,147,800	3.2

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 91,853,753	\$ 93,856,500	\$ 95,412,800	\$ 97,050,700	\$ 3,194,200	3.4
Office	341,509	304,100	495,700	255,700	(48,400)	(15.9)
External Services	762,944	497,400	692,900	587,400	90,000	18.1
Supplies	1,257,278	1,298,700	1,904,700	998,700	(300,000)	(23.1)
Materials	8,400	-	13,700	-	-	-
Building Costs	777,635	453,600	471,400	453,600	-	-
Equipment & Communications	1,222,255	1,036,900	2,116,100	1,148,900	112,000	10.8
Vehicle Expense	5,726	-	12,900	-	-	-
Other Goods & Services	1,455,109	1,795,900	2,266,900	1,895,900	100,000	5.6
Interdepartmental	22,555	-	11,600	-	-	-
Other Fiscal	12,514	15,000	15,000	15,000	-	-
Total Expenditures	97,719,680	99,258,100	103,413,700	102,405,900	3,147,800	3.2

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Fee Revenues	\$ (21,146)	\$ (21,100)	\$ (21,100)	\$ (21,100)	\$ -	-
Other Revenue	(1,774,561)	(1,047,600)	(2,681,100)	(1,047,600)	-	-
Total Revenues	(1,795,707)	(1,068,700)	(2,702,200)	(1,068,700)	-	-
Net Total	\$ 95,923,973	\$ 98,189,400	\$ 100,711,500	\$ 101,337,200	\$ 3,147,800	3.2

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 98,189,400
Service Enhancements	
Volunteer Outreach and Recruitment Assistant	53,400
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Inflationary pressures on equipment/other	19,000
Funding for IT equipment (tablets, tablet mounts and Starlink)	93,000
Training requirements for skill maintenance of incumbents	100,000
Psychological support services for staff, career and volunteer firefighters	40,000
Legal fees in relation to labour arbitrations	50,000
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	3,405,400
Other/Transfers	
IT Services - Eastlink WAN/Internet Services	(48,400)
Reversal of one-time funding of uniforms and PPE for new FFs in 2025/26	(300,000)
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact "Green" Reductions	(311,600)
Hire 10 career firefighters to be staffed at station 11	215,000
FTE Reduction - Vacant Position	(168,000)
Total Changes	\$ 3,147,800
2026/27 Budget	\$ 101,337,200

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Operations	2022 Actual	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected
Community Risk Assessments and Advanced Home Assessments				
Community Risk Assessments Catalogued ¹	N/A	0	28	8
Advanced Home Assessments Catalogued ¹	22	139	145	97
Effective Firefighting Force (EFF) and Response Times				
% of incidents with Effective Firefighting Force target met	59.8% ²	61% ²	54.5%	67.8% ³
% of Urban incidents with first unit arriving within target response time				
Medical	70.3% ²	71.5% ²	70.4%	73.9% ³
Fire	78.2% ²	77.8% ²	75.2%	84.3% ³
% of Rural incidents with first unit arriving within target response time				
Medical				
Career on duty	86.3% ²	90.2% ²	85.3%	85.2% ³
Volunteer time	74.1% ²	75.2% ²	77.5%	76.4% ³
Fire				
Career on duty	81.0% ²	81.5%	93.5%	84.1% ³
Volunteer time	73.5% ²	79.8% ²	72.6%	81.3% ³

¹ Assessments catalogued since launching the new Wildfire Mitigation Program

² The figures for 2022 and 2023 have been revised to reflect updates from new reporting technology

³ 2025 Projected values based on information available as of December 31, 2025.

Analysis:

- Community Risk Assessments and Advanced Home Assessments**

Staff were required to shift focus from Community Risk Assessments and Home Assessments to develop the Structural Protection Unit training, an advanced leadership course and a basic wildfire training curriculum. Efforts also supported a Maritimes Wildfire Resilient Housing and Landscaping Workshop and a Vegetation Mitigation pickup program.

- Effective Firefighting Force (EFF) and Response Times**

Station alerting (Phase 1) was implemented early in 2025. Initial results indicate improvements in turnout times. A full analysis of the impact on response times will be possible in 2026 when sufficient data has been gathered.

Additional council investments in the fire service which have focused on response times include:

- In 2023, additional career staff were added to Fire Station # 8 in Bedford and Fire Station # 9 in Sackville to place a Tactical Support Unit and an Aerial into service.

- In 2024, additional staff were added to Fire Station #38 in Middle Musquodoboit, operating with career firefighters on duty around the clock, working alongside volunteers.
- In 2025, additional staff were added to Fire Station #65 in Upper Tantallon, operating with career firefighters on duty around the clock, working alongside volunteers. In 2026, upon completion of station renovations, these firefighters will be moved to Fire Station # 50 in Hammonds Plains.
- In Summer/Fall of 2026, Fire Station #1 in Bedford will open, with 24/7 career staffing and volunteer firefighters.
- In Q4 of 2026/27, additional career staffing at Station 11 from two to four firefighters (additional ten positions) will improve resident and firefighter safety by allowing that crew to act immediately in structure fire emergencies, without the need to wait for additional firefighters.

Other factors that may degrade response time performance include traffic congestion and residential development occurring farther away from existing fire stations.

Community Risk Reduction, Logistics & Infrastructure	2022 Actual	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Actual
Fire Safety Inspections				
Deficiency Inspections	N/A	331	238	371
FSMI Inspections	N/A	385	478	1,008
Level 1 Inspections	N/A	1,530	1,298	1,291
Customer Service Requests				
Public Education	N/A	190	190	182
Inspection	N/A	476	355	363
General	N/A	611	762	805
Fire Related Fatalities				
Fatalities ¹	5 ³	2	2	5
Civilian Fatalities (per 100,000 population)	1.04	0.40	0.40	0.97

¹ Fatality data source: Nova Scotia Medical Examiner's Service.

² Includes one fatality not associated with a structure fire (injuries from an oxygen concentrator that caught fire)

³ Value for 2025 is based on projected population provided by the municipality (513,816) and will be updated once Statistics Canada population estimate data is available.

Analysis:

- Fire Safety Maintenance Inspections (FSMI) are performed by both Operational Crews and new inspection staff. Inspection staff are normally focused on Level 1 inspections. In 2026 we anticipate an increase in both.

2025 Detailed Inspection Results

Type of Inspection	Number of Occupancies	Inspection Interval (years)	Inspections Required per year	Failed Inspections	Completed Cases	% Completed Case to Target
Assembly	2,377	3	792	425	329	42%

Daycare, Medical and Treatment	23	3	7	2	2	29%
Residential	5,331	5	1066	200	259	24%
Business and Personal Services	3,062	5	612	174	180	29%
Mercantile	1,881	5	376	342	252	67%
Industrial F1	62	2	31	0	1	3%
Industrial F2	1,401	3	467	30	23	5%
Industrial F3	877	3	292	30	30	10%
TOTAL	15,014	-	3,643	1,203	1,076	30%⁶

⁶ Percent completed cases to target is up from last year, from 25% in 2024 to 30% in 2025. At current rate, % completed case to target is expected to increase to at least 33% in 2026.

Five new inspectors were added in 2025, under a reduced qualification hiring program due to extensive difficulties in hiring pre-qualified inspectors. These inspectors are in an accelerated training program, and it is expected that they will have more capacity in the year ahead.

Professional Development, Performance & Safety	2022/23 Actual	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected
Career Firefighter Recruits Trained	40	44	39	15
Volunteer Firefighter Recruits Trained	68	73	71	86
New Volunteer Firefighters Recruited ¹	90	111	106	125

¹ This performance measure was introduced in 2022/23 to reflect the number of new volunteers recruited who were eligible for firefighter training.

Analysis:

- In addition to the Volunteer Firefighter Recruit Training programs, volunteer firefighters participated in 50,748 hours of training, meetings and station commitments and contributed 28,828 hours of time responding to emergencies. Success recruiting and retaining volunteer firefighters is critical to achieving our mission and supporting our composite response model.

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
SC-02 Improve municipal emergency response and recovery efforts to keep residents safe, protect property, and restore essential services and infrastructure following an emergency event.	
Year 3 of the Heavy Urban Search and Rescue / Public Safety Canada Grant Agreement – Operations and Equipment <i>Service Area: Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-02; no Action alignment Complete the final year of the current three-year Public Safety Canada HUSAR grant agreement and hire a Program Manager. The Program Manager will be responsible for finalizing a new agreement and acquiring essential resources for the HUSAR program, such as PPE for team members, medical equipment and equipment to support a basecamp. This program is federally funded with a 25% contribution rate from the municipality.	31-Mar-27
Staff and Operationalize the New HRFE Station 1 (West Bedford) <i>Service Area: Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-02; no Action alignment Staff and equip fire apparatus at the new HRFE Station 1 (West Bedford) location. This station will provide 24/7 career firefighting service alongside volunteer firefighters.	30-Sep-26
Fire Training Structure <i>Service Area: Professional Development, Performance & Safety</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-02; no Action alignment Oversee the design, construction and commissioning of a three-storey structural fire training prop at the existing training grounds. This includes working with Property, Fleet & Environment to manage the design/build tender, ensuring NFPA compliance and ensuring the installation of fire props, smoke simulation systems and safety controls to enhance firefighter training capabilities.	31-Mar-27
Station Alerting Phase II <i>Service Area: Professional Development, Performance & Safety</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-02; no Action alignment Station Alerting Project Phase II will implement enhanced alerting features including zoned lighting, additional speakers and displays, optimized tone configurations and a radio backup interface to ensure resilient, reliable emergency notifications. This initiative supports HRFE's commitment to faster, more reliable emergency response and improved firefighter safety through technology-driven innovation.	31-Mar-27
RA-02 Monitor, maintain, and replace municipal assets to establish and ensure service levels.	

Deliverable	Completion
Open the New HRFE Headquarters and Station 1 Facility <i>Service Area: Community Risk Reduction, Logistics & Infrastructure</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-02; no Action alignment Work closely with Property, Fleet and Development to complete the construction phase of this building and then relocate HRFE's current Headquarters, Fire Prevention and Logistics divisions to the new building.	31-Mar-27
Relocate Station 28 to the Eastern Shore Lifestyle Centre (ESLC) <i>Service Area: Community Risk Reduction, Logistics & Infrastructure</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-02; no Action alignment Continue to work with Property, Fleet and Environment on the ESLC to close out the construction phase and relocate the current station to the new facility.	31-Mar-27
OP-02 Strengthen the attraction and retention of people with the skills and behaviours needed to deliver municipal services.	
New Volunteer Outreach and Recruitment Assistant <i>Service Area: Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: OP-02-A3 Add a Volunteer Outreach and Recruitment Assistant to strengthen volunteer engagement and recruitment. HRFE will develop and post the job description, complete hiring and onboard the new position.	31-Dec-26
OP-03 Increase employee access to learning and development opportunities.	
Resiliency Training <i>Service Area: Professional Development, Performance & Safety</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal OP-03; no Action alignment Partner with the Tema Foundation (Trauma Resource and Education for Emergency Services) to provide mental health and resiliency training for career and volunteer firefighters.	31-Mar-27

Summary of Net Expenditures - Halifax Regional Fire & Emergency						
	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
F121 Succession Planning	47,898	92,000	68,000	92,000	-	-
F122 Fire Chief's Office	955,666	930,700	1,044,800	899,700	(31,000)	(3.3)
F123 Strat & Safety Init.	-	-	-	-	-	-
F124 Admin Support Serv	833,984	856,100	791,700	855,900	(200)	(0.0)
F126 HRFE Research Dev	1,132	-	-	-	-	-
** Office Of The Fire Chief	1,838,679	1,878,800	1,904,500	1,847,600	(31,200)	(1.7)
F120 Prof. Dev. & Train.	4,766,181	3,705,600	4,212,500	3,724,200	18,600	0.5
F140 Performance & Safety	1,120,323	2,081,400	1,043,700	987,100	(1,094,300)	(52.6)
F165 Firefighter & FAP	350,202	287,200	307,400	327,400	40,200	14.0
F180 Sfty, comp, Hlth Wel	277,422	303,600	338,700	306,900	3,300	1.1
F190 Technology and Innovation	1,057,072	1,030,500	1,142,400	1,082,600	52,100	5.1
F791 Rural Fire Debt Payments	-	-	-	-	-	-
** Prof. Devt., Performance & Safe	7,571,199	7,408,300	7,044,700	6,428,200	(980,100)	(13.2)
F110 Operations	75,197,834	75,836,400	77,646,900	79,936,300	4,099,900	5.4
F115 HU Search & Rescue	-	-	(12,300)	23,500	23,500	-
F116 Spec Ops	332,574	515,000	562,200	615,000	100,000	19.4
F724 Enfield Fire Dept.	25,000	25,000	25,000	25,000	-	-
F727 Milford Fire Department	2,400	2,400	2,400	2,400	-	-
F793 Volunteer Coordination	4,329,179	4,729,100	4,996,200	4,790,100	61,000	1.3
** Operations	79,886,986	81,107,900	83,220,400	85,392,300	4,284,400	5.3
F125 CRR, LOG & INFRA	185,016	219,300	399,000	425,600	206,300	94.1
F130 Fire Prevention	2,418,804	3,863,100	3,145,700	3,655,700	(207,400)	(5.4)
F135 Fire Buildings	525,458	324,200	489,300	324,200	-	-
F160 Logistics & Equipment	3,497,831	3,387,800	4,507,900	3,263,600	(124,200)	(3.7)
** Comm. Risk Red., Logist & Infra	6,627,108	7,794,400	8,541,900	7,669,100	(125,300)	(1.6)
*** Net Total	95,923,973	98,189,400	100,711,500	101,337,200	3,147,800	3.2

Summary of Expenditures Details - Halifax Regional Fire & Emergency						
	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	65,752,568	70,923,000	67,758,900	73,569,000	2,646,000	3.7
6002 Salaries - Overtime	6,116,471	6,022,500	7,189,200	6,022,500	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(325,078)	-	(122,400)	-	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	249,139	-	154,100	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	13,762,451	13,799,100	13,465,700	14,452,900	653,800	4.7
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(4,126,000)	-	(4,126,000)	-	-
6150 Honorariums	3,783,000	4,339,300	4,339,300	4,339,300	-	-
6151 Vehicle Allowance	10,549	-	11,700	-	-	-
6152 Retirement Incentives	535,469	662,500	556,500	686,800	24,300	3.7
6154 Workers' Compensation	1,688,977	1,930,100	1,530,100	1,987,900	57,800	3.0
6155 Overtime Meals	-	-	300	-	-	-
6156 Clothing Allowance	104,200	96,000	111,700	96,000	-	-
6157 stipends	364,149	210,000	456,900	210,000	-	-
6158 WCB Recov Earnings	(5,100)	-	-	-	-	-
6190 Compensation OCC trf	(70,000)	-	-	-	-	-
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	(44,676)	-	(34,200)	(187,700)	(187,700)	-
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	(67,845)	-	-	-	-	-
9210 HR CATS OT Wage/Ben	(523)	-	(5,000)	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	91,853,753	93,856,500	95,412,800	97,050,700	3,194,200	3.4
6201 Telephone/Cable	108,720	123,600	131,800	75,200	(48,400)	(39.2)
6202 Courier/Postage	15,304	4,000	15,300	4,000	-	-
6203 Office Furn/Equip	88,687	71,600	75,000	71,600	-	-
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	38,858	62,900	78,100	62,900	-	-
6205 Printing & Reprod	696	10,000	10,000	10,000	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	88,947	32,000	185,500	32,000	-	-
6299 Other Office Expenses	298	-	-	-	-	-
* Office	341,509	304,100	495,700	255,700	(48,400)	(15.9)
6301 Professional Fees	207,133	220,000	223,100	310,000	90,000	40.9
6302 Legal Fees	14,942	-	100,000	-	-	-
6303 Consulting Fees	97,520	-	9,500	-	-	-
6304 Janitorial Services	9,902	10,000	10,000	10,000	-	-
6308 Snow Removal	332,490	223,900	222,300	223,900	-	-

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6311 Security	15,761	28,000	23,500	28,000	-	-
6312 Refuse Collection	7,519	6,000	6,000	6,000	-	-
6399 Contract Services	77,679	9,500	98,500	9,500	-	-
* External Services	762,944	497,400	692,900	587,400	90,000	18.1
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	516,904	662,000	665,000	662,000	-	-
6402 Med & First Aid Supp	128,156	60,000	77,500	60,000	-	-
6404 Rec Prog Supplies	129,015	100,000	125,200	100,000	-	-
6405 Photo Supp & Equip	172	2,500	2,500	2,500	-	-
6407 Clean/Sani Supplies	127,326	102,000	140,000	102,000	-	-
6409 Personal Protect Equ	112,348	369,700	606,000	69,700	(300,000)	(81.1)
6499 Other Supplies	243,357	2,500	288,500	2,500	-	-
* Supplies	1,257,278	1,298,700	1,904,700	998,700	(300,000)	(23.1)
6502 Chemicals	129	-	100	-	-	-
6504 Hardware	1,954	-	-	-	-	-
6507 Propane	1,679	-	1,600	-	-	-
6511 Salt	3,655	-	300	-	-	-
6512 Sand	225	-	-	-	-	-
6517 Paint	758	-	-	-	-	-
6599 Other Materials	-	-	11,700	-	-	-
* Materials	8,400	-	13,700	-	-	-
6602 Electrical	34,645	-	300	-	-	-
6607 Electricity	20,929	9,000	12,000	9,000	-	-
6608 Water	42,233	26,500	55,500	26,500	-	-
6610 Building - Exterior	-	-	3,500	-	-	-
6611 Building - Interior	13,568	-	-	-	-	-
6612 Safety Systems	327	-	2,000	-	-	-
6616 Natural Gas-Buildings	13,086	8,000	8,000	8,000	-	-
6617 Pest Management	391	-	-	-	-	-
6699 Other Building Cost	652,456	410,100	390,100	410,100	-	-
* Building Costs	777,635	453,600	471,400	453,600	-	-
6701 Equipment Purchase	578,482	463,500	1,032,000	575,500	112,000	24.2
6702 Small Tools	87,047	35,000	61,100	35,000	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	12,652	26,500	27,800	26,500	-	-
6704 Equipment Rental	1,394	-	1,200	-	-	-
6705 Equip - R&M	384,526	391,000	798,100	391,000	-	-
6707 Plumbing & Heating	42,300	-	60,000	-	-	-
6708 Mechanical Equipment	20,110	-	15,000	-	-	-
6711 Communication System	95,745	120,900	120,900	120,900	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	1,222,255	1,036,900	2,116,100	1,148,900	112,000	10.8
6802 Vehicle R&M	2,355	-	6,600	-	-	-
6803 Vehicle Fuel - Diesel	1,209	-	1,000	-	-	-
6804 Vehicle Fuel - Gas	875	-	200	-	-	-
6806 Vehicle Rentals	370	-	-	-	-	-
6809 Electricity-Vehicles	-	-	300	-	-	-
6811 Shop Supplies	-	-	4,800	-	-	-
6899 Other Vehicle Expense	917	-	-	-	-	-
* Vehicle Expense	5,726	-	12,900	-	-	-
6901 Membership Dues	38,337	12,500	13,600	12,500	-	-
6902 Conferences/Workshop	16,515	-	7,100	-	-	-
6903 Travel - Local	23,248	21,000	25,400	21,000	-	-
6904 Travel - Out of Town	103,413	32,000	109,200	32,000	-	-
6905 Training & Education	376,290	984,000	1,141,000	1,084,000	100,000	10.2
6906 Licenses & Agreements	28,733	27,400	28,600	27,400	-	-
6907 Commission Fees	-	-	200	-	-	-
6908 Medical Examinations	6,587	60,000	60,700	60,000	-	-
6911 Facilities Rental	63,626	68,000	123,800	68,000	-	-
6912 Advertising/Promotio	29,636	30,000	34,100	30,000	-	-
6913 Awards	68,075	50,000	53,000	50,000	-	-
6914 Recruiting	330,170	169,000	174,300	169,000	-	-
6916 Public Education	36,560	65,000	76,500	65,000	-	-
6917 Books and Periodicals	16,375	25,000	91,000	25,000	-	-
6918 Meals/Catering	73,793	56,000	89,900	56,000	-	-
6919 Special Projects	36,926	-	-	-	-	-
6929 Procurement Card Clg	474	-	-	-	-	-
6933 Community Events	11,254	20,000	20,700	20,000	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6936 Staff Relations	148	-	-	-	-	-
6938 Rewarding Excellence	8,515	6,000	24,100	6,000	-	-
6943 Health and Wellness	107,172	105,000	100,000	105,000	-	-
6999 Other Goods/Services	79,263	65,000	93,700	65,000	-	-
* Other Goods & Services	1,455,109	1,795,900	2,266,900	1,895,900	100,000	5.6
7009 Internal Trfr Other	6,811	-	8,400	-	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	15,744	-	3,200	-	-	-
* Interdepartmental	22,555	-	11,600	-	-	-
8003 Insurance Pol/Prem	12,514	15,000	15,000	15,000	-	-
* Other Fiscal	12,514	15,000	15,000	15,000	-	-
** Total	97,719,680	99,258,100	103,413,700	102,405,900	3,147,800	3.2

Summary of Revenues Details - Halifax Regional Fire & Emergency

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
5102 Facilities Rentals	(21,146)	(21,100)	(21,100)	(21,100)	-	-
* Fee Revenues	(21,146)	(21,100)	(21,100)	(21,100)	-	-
5508 Recov External Parti	(1,767,560)	(1,039,900)	(2,673,400)	(1,039,900)	-	-
5600 Miscellaneous Revenue	(7,001)	(7,700)	(7,700)	(7,700)	-	-
* Other Revenue	(1,774,561)	(1,047,600)	(2,681,100)	(1,047,600)	-	-
** Total	(1,795,707)	(1,068,700)	(2,702,200)	(1,068,700)	-	-
*** Net Total	95,923,973	98,189,400	100,711,500	101,337,200	3,147,800	3.2

HALIFAX

HALIFAX REGIONAL POLICE AND RCMP

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

HALIFAX REGIONAL POLICE / RCMP HALIFAX REGIONAL DETACHMENT

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

OVERVIEW

Policing services in the municipality is delivered under an integrated service model where Halifax Regional Police (HRP) and the Halifax Regional Detachment of the Royal Canadian Mounted Police (RCMP HRD) employees work together in a number of integrated units. Both HRP and RCMP HRD utilize a COMSTAT intelligence-led policing model to focus and prioritize policing objectives related to people, places, patterns and problems.

HRP and RCMP HRD are Partners in Policing with a model that facilitates mutual assistance and a coordinated response providing for a professional police service for the municipality.

HRP is responsible for policing Halifax, Dartmouth, Bedford and all communities extending from Bedford to Sambro Loop. The remaining areas of the municipality are policed by RCMP HRD.

The Halifax Board of Police Commissioners provides civilian governance and oversight for HRP on behalf of Regional Council. The Board also functions as a Police Advisory Board to RCMP HRD as it performs contractual policing services within the municipality. RCMP services are provided through the 2012 Nova Scotia Provincial Police Service Agreement (PPSA), which sees most policing costs shared between the Province of Nova Scotia and Canada, each paying 70% and 30%, respectively through an “all-inclusive” per-officer cost multiplied by the number of officers assigned to each municipality. The per-officer cost includes but is not limited to salary, benefits, overtime, office space, vehicles, equipment, civilian support staff, etc.

HALIFAX REGIONAL POLICE

MISSION

Working together to keep our communities safe.

HRP OVERVIEW

HRP advances Council Priorities by delivering effective policing that protects public safety, builds community trust and improves quality of life for residents and visitors. HRP strengthens community safety by preventing crime, responding promptly to calls for service and conducting specialized investigations that address complex criminal matters. The organization engages stakeholders, communicates strategically and drives diversity and inclusion initiatives to promote equitable and responsive policing.

HRP provides strategic leadership, upholds professional standards and aligns its services with the municipality's goals. HRP enhances service delivery by applying innovation, research and strong administrative support to operate efficiently and transparently. This approach enables HRP to meet community needs, demonstrate accountability and advance Regional Council's vision for a safe, inclusive and resilient municipality.

HRP SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Chief's Office	✓ Oversight and Administration of the Halifax Regional Police Business Unit ✓ Audit, Policy and Research ✓ Background and Security Clearance Unit ✓ Diversity and Inclusion ✓ Professional Standards Investigative Unit ✓ Public Relations and Corporate Communications ✓ Sergeant Major
Administration Division	✓ Human Resources ✓ Property and Evidence ✓ Quartermaster

Service Area	Services Offered
	✓ Training
Criminal Investigation Division	✓ General Investigation Section (Integrated) ✓ Investigative Support Operations – Forensic Identification Section ✓ Special Enforcement Section (Integrated) ✓ Special Investigative Section (Integrated) ✓ Special Victims Section (Integrated)
Patrol Division	✓ Community Response Officers ✓ Liquor Enforcement Unit ✓ Patrol ✓ Quick Response Unit ✓ School Resource Officers
Support Division	✓ Aviation Security Unit ✓ Community Relations and Crime Prevention ✓ Court Section (Integrated) ✓ CPIC Transcription (Integrated) ✓ Emergency Planning ✓ Emergency Response Team ✓ Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy ✓ Integrated Emergency Services ✓ K-9 Unit ✓ Mental Health Mobile Crisis Team ✓ Mounted Unit ✓ Ports Unit ✓ Prisoner Care Facility ✓ Public Safety Unit ✓ Records Section (Integrated) ✓ Traffic Unit ✓ Traffic Support Section (Integrated) ✓ Victim Services

RCMP HALIFAX REGIONAL DETACHMENT

MISSION

To preserve the peace, uphold the law and provide quality service in partnership with our communities.

RCMP HRD OVERVIEW

RCMP HRD advances Council Priorities by delivering frontline policing, investigative support and essential administrative services. RCMP HRD protects public safety, responds to community needs and conducts complex investigations to support Council's vision for a safe, inclusive and resilient municipality.

RCMP HRD provides strategic leadership in delivering accountable, coordinated services that align with Council's strategic goals and strengthen trust within the community.

RCMP HRD SERVICES

As the provincial police service for Nova Scotia, the RCMP maintains a range of specialized units within the province that provide support to frontline policing and technical expertise for the most serious and complex crimes. Many of these units are aligned with national policy centres to ensure they remain current on emerging national and international trends and to receive ongoing training and guidance in response to the evolving nature of crime.

RCMP HRD operates as part of the broader RCMP in Nova Scotia ("H" Division) and benefits from important administrative and technical support services (e.g. Information Technology) from them. In addition, "H" Division supports RCMP HRD with specialized operational support services resources (e.g. Emergency Response Team, RCMP Air Services, Underwater Recovery Team, etc.) when needed. RCMP HRD regular member and public service employee resources are broadly organized along the following areas:

Service Area	Services Offered
Command Team	✓ Officer in Charge (Chief Superintendent) ✓ Superintendent ✓ Inspectors ✓ Staff Sergeant Major
Urban Patrol Areas Tantallon, Lower Sackville and Cole Harbour	✓ General Duty (Uniformed) Frontline Line Response and Investigations ✓ 24/7 "Watch" System
Rural Patrol Areas Sheet Harbour, Musquodoboit Harbour, North Central and North Preston	✓ Traditional "Detachment-Style" Teams

Service Area	Services Offered
Specialized Investigations	✓ “Plain Clothes” Investigations through Criminal Investigation Division (Integrated)
Community Policing	✓ Community Action Response Team (CART)
Teams	✓ Street Crime Enforcement Team ✓ Intimate Partner Violence Team ✓ Traffic Services
Integrated Support Units	✓ Court ✓ Records ✓ Police Service Dog Unit

HRP – FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		783.4
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Inspector, Divisional Commander Criminal Investigations	Vacant Position/Position Removed	(1.0)
Manager, Integrated Emergency Services (IES)	Maintain Current Service	1.0
Emergency Response Communicators, IES	Service Enhancement	8.0
Support Positions	Budget Committee Direction	(2.0)
Intercept Monitor (Temporary)	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Transferred Positions		
Transfer to CAO	FOIPOP Coordinators transferred from Halifax Regional Police	(2.0)
Total Changes		3.0
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		786.4

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

HRP – SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Chiefs Office	\$ 3,873,063	\$ 4,589,300	\$ 4,175,200	\$ 4,515,500	\$ (73,800)	(1.6)
Support Division	34,362,425	29,159,000	32,524,700	30,026,100	867,100	3.0
Operations Division	61,247,661	67,507,400	63,300,600	67,640,800	133,400	0.2
Net Total	\$ 99,483,149	\$ 101,255,700	\$ 100,000,500	\$ 102,182,400	\$ 926,700	0.9

HRP – SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 104,561,759	\$ 104,930,500	\$ 102,737,200	\$ 106,384,900	\$ 1,454,400	1.4
Office	612,603	625,400	721,100	385,900	(239,500)	(38.3)
External Services	3,074,724	3,534,400	3,459,600	3,848,600	314,200	8.9
Supplies	873,180	1,190,700	1,246,200	1,176,400	(14,300)	(1.2)
Building Costs	108,618	47,300	247,300	47,300	-	-
Equipment & Communications	1,481,693	2,094,100	1,522,100	1,505,000	(589,100)	(28.1)
Vehicle Expense	63,944	4,000	4,000	4,000	-	-
Other Goods & Services	2,715,443	2,919,900	2,599,900	2,729,200	(190,700)	(6.5)
Interdepartmental	(613,853)	(685,300)	(531,700)	(555,700)	129,600	(18.9)
Other Fiscal	49,024	54,100	54,100	54,100	-	-
Total Expenditures	112,927,135	114,715,100	112,059,800	115,579,700	864,600	0.8

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Transfers from other Govts	\$ (3,829,250)	\$ (3,800,000)	\$ (3,814,300)	\$ (3,800,000)	\$ -	-
Fee Revenues	(448,091)	(550,000)	(507,900)	(550,000)	-	-
Other Revenue	(9,166,646)	(9,109,400)	(7,737,100)	(9,047,300)	62,100	(0.7)
Total Revenues	(13,443,987)	(13,459,400)	(12,059,300)	(13,397,300)	62,100	(0.5)
Net Total	\$ 99,483,149	\$ 101,255,700	\$ 100,000,500	\$ 102,182,400	\$ 926,700	0.9

HRP – OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 101,255,700
Service Enhancements	
Emergency Response Communicators	392,900
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Commissionaires of Nova Scotia contract	421,300
Biological Casework Analysis Agreement	121,300
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	1,880,100
Revenue Changes	
Constable Secondments	537,400
Miscellaneous Cost Recoveries	(225,300)
Other/Transfers	
IT Services - Software/Maint./Lic./Hardware/Peripherals	(409,500)
IT Services - DEMS Equipment/Software approved in 2025/26	(441,700)
IT Services - Eastlink WAN/Internet Services	(38,200)
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact "Green" Reductions	(261,600)
HRP Vacancies	(600,000)
Non-Compensation Savings	(450,000)
Total Changes	\$ 926,700
2026/27 Budget	\$ 102,182,400

RCMP HRD – SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
RCMP	\$ 38,399,954	\$ 40,127,800	\$ 42,116,300	\$ 44,730,000	\$ 4,602,200	11.5
Net Total	\$ 38,399,954	\$ 40,127,800	\$ 42,116,300	\$ 44,730,000	\$ 4,602,200	11.5

RCMP HRD – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 40,127,800
Contractual Increases	
2025/26 Service enhancement full year cost (14 positions)	1,818,700
2025/26 Contract increase (transferred from Fiscal)	2,783,500
Total Changes	\$ 4,602,200
2026/27 Budget	\$ 44,730,000

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Integrated Police Statistics (HRP and RCMP HRD) ¹	2023 Actual		2024 Actual	
	HRM	Canada	HRM	Canada
Population size in determining measures	491,437	40,083,484	503,037	41,288,599
Reported number of Violent Criminal Code incidents per 100,000 population	1,466.48	1,441.79	1,358.25	1433.46
Reported number of Criminal Code incidents (non-traffic) per 100,000 population	5,664.69	5,884.00	6,019.68	5,672.34
Violent Crime Severity Index	97.26	100.92	93.58	99.87
Non-violent Crime Severity Index	61.78	74.00	66.73	69.76
Total Crime Severity Index	71.48	81.20	73.95	77.89
Weighted violent clearance rate ²	50.27	54.01	50.04	53.65
Weighted total clearance rate ²	31.41	34.85	30.31	35.54

¹ Data for all measures, unless otherwise specified, are from Statistics Canada.

² Weighted clearance rate refers to the number of criminal incidents solved by the police in the year divided by the number of criminal incidents reported in the year.

Analysis:

- In 2024, the overall *Crime Severity Index* (CSI) for the municipality increased by 3%. It remains lower than the national CSI, which decreased 4% in 2024. This is only the second decrease of the national CSI in a decade; the previous decrease coincided with the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020. The top violations contributing to the increase seen in the municipality were shoplifting \$5,000 or under, child pornography (possessing or accessing), murder second degree, theft \$5,000 or under and human trafficking.
- In 2024, the *Violent Crime Severity Index* (VCSI) for the municipality decreased by 3.78%, remaining below the national VCSI, which decreased by 1% from 2023. The top violations contributing to the decrease seen in the municipality were trafficking in persons, extortion, robbery, sexual interference and assault – level 2 – weapon/ bodily harm.

HRP	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Actual
Number of police officers hired	37	12	30

Number of traffic Summary Offence Tickets issued ¹	8,172	9,310	8,691
Total Calls for Service ²	323,810	295,932	298,472
Dispatched Calls for Service	104,004	112,945	121,368
Proactive Calls ³	21,962	25,192	25,165
Online Reported Calls	5,965	6,601	6,625
Per cent of 911 calls answered in 20 seconds ⁴	99.96	99.94	99.92
Average call answer time for non-emergency calls (seconds) ⁵	50	53	63.24

¹ A traffic Summary Offence Ticket is a formal notice for violations such as speeding, cell phone use, no insurance etc. under the Motor Vehicle Act.

² IES is an HRP function which receives and processes all 911 and non-emergency calls for service from the public which require one or more of the following emergency services: HRP, RCMP HRD, Halifax Regional Fire and Emergency (HRFE) and EHS. IES is also responsible for dispatching resources for HRP, RCMP HRD and HRFE. This figure represents the total number of 911 and non-emergency calls for service answered by IES.

³ Proactive calls for service include foot patrols, traffic stops and proactive assignments (e.g., checking on an individual subject to bail conditions, or high visibility patrol in an area recently subject to high levels of crime.)

⁴ Data source HRP/ Integrated Emergency Services (IES) data.

⁵ Data source HRP/ IES data.

Analysis:

- In 2025, HRP hired 30 police officers.
 - Of the officers hired, 22 were cadets who graduated as part of the Police Science Program (PSP), a 38-week full time training program which prepares recruits for employment at HRP.
 - The other eight officers were hired as Experienced Police Officers (EPOs). In order to apply to join HRP as an EPO, an applicant must meet the definition of an experienced police officer, as outlined in HRP policy.
- In 2024, HRP hired 12 police officers, all of whom were EPOs.
 - While 2024 did not see a PSP class graduate, the 2025 PSP class began in the fall of 2024 and was the start of HRP's priority to run consecutive PSP classes.
- In 2025, HRP issued 8,691 traffic Summary Offence Tickets (SOTs). That represents a decrease of 691 SOTs when compared with 2024.
- There were 298,472 total calls for service in 2025, that represents an increase of 2,540 calls when compared with 2024.
- There were 8,423 additional dispatched calls for service in 2025 when compared with 2024.

- Proactive calls decreased by 27 in 2025 when compared with 2024.
- The number of reports filed online increased by 24 in 2025 when compared with 2024.
- The per cent of 911 calls answered in 20 seconds continues to exceed 99.9%.
- The average call answer time for non-emergency calls has increased by 10.24 seconds in 2025 when compared with 2024.

RCMP HRD	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Actual
Number of police officers hired	4 ¹	6 ²	14
Number of traffic summary offence tickets issued	3,823	5,094	5,847
Total Calls for Service ³	50,420	60,125	63,001
Dispatched Calls for Service ⁴	39,522	40,698	40,250
Proactive Calls ⁵	10,898	19,427	22,751
On-line Reported Calls	850	1,235	927

¹ In 2023, RCMP HRD were approved 4 FTEs. These were for General Duty (Watch) members.

² In 2024, RCMP HRD were approved for 6 FTEs, including four General Duty Watch members and two Intimate Partner Violence (IPV) investigators.

³ Total Calls for Service are taken from the Versadex Records Management System (RMS).

⁴ Dispatched Calls for Service are those generated from the public calls to the dispatch centre.

⁵ Proactive calls for service include foot patrols, traffic stops and proactive assignments (e.g., checking on an individual subject to bail conditions, or high visibility patrol in an area recently subject to high levels of crime).

Analysis:

- In 2025, RCMP HRD were approved for 14 FTEs. This included six FTEs for a Community Satellite Office in Beechville-Lakeside-Timberlea, six FTEs for a Community Satellite office in Fall River, one FTE for Traffic Services in Musquodoboit Harbour and one FTE for a Community Policing Officer for Sheet Harbour. To date, 11 of those positions have been named and are in regular RCMP staffing process.
- Calls for Service in RCMP HRD jurisdiction continue to rise. On average in the past five years calls for service have been over 55,000.

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
SC-01 Improve municipal preparedness planning to mitigate the potential impacts of emergency situations and climate-related events.	
Strengthening Partner Collaboration <i>Service Area: Halifax Regional Police</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-01-A1</i> Continue to strengthen relationships with partners and collaborate on important projects and initiatives including Community Safety's Crisis Assistance and Response Team program, the rollout of surveys from the Halifax Board of Police Commissioners and participate in the drafting and implementation of the Halifax Transit Safety Program Plan and the Road Safety Strategy.	31-Mar-27
Deliver Strong Core Operations <i>Service Area: RCMP Halifax Regional Detachment</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-01-A1</i> Deliver strong core operations by curating an Annual Stakeholder Update as a key platform to deepen the awareness of RCMP HRD's capabilities and to ensure RCMP HRD clearly understands the needs and expectations of key stakeholders. Additionally, RCMP HRD will continue to engage with the municipality's Commissioner of Public Safety and the CAO to provide timely sharing of significant information related to public safety as well as enhanced awareness of incidents and events that are deemed to be high-risk within RCMP HRD jurisdiction. The intersectionality of crime trends and public safety is key to informing an effective and efficient response strategy.	31-Mar-27
Strategic Plan Development <i>Service Area: Halifax Regional Police</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-01-A5</i> Begin work to develop the next HRP strategic plan in collaboration with the Halifax Board of Police Commissioners and partner agencies.	31-Mar-27
SC-02 Improve municipal emergency response and recovery efforts to keep residents safe, protect property and restore essential services and infrastructure following an emergency event.	

Establish Community Policing Offices to Better Serve Halifax Regional Municipality Residents <i>Service Area: RCMP Halifax Regional Detachment</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-02-A1</i> Complete processes underway to establish community satellite offices in Beechville-Lakeside-Timberlea and Fall River. RCMP HRD will work with RCMP Property Management and Property Fleet & Environment, Leasing and Tenant Services to identify potential future opportunities for long-term physical sites.	31-Mar-27
Dedicated Intimate Partner Violence Unit <i>Service Area: RCMP Halifax Regional Detachment</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-02-A2</i> Through the Intimate Partner Violence (IPV) Unit, adapt the service delivery model in line with best practices to ensure consistent, trauma-informed investigations and prosecutions and to strengthen policing capacity while deepening partnerships with community supports to improve outcomes for victims and accountability for offenders.	31-Mar-27
Race-based Data Collection Framework – Year 2 <i>Service Area: Halifax Regional Police</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-02-A4</i> In partnership with RCMP HRD, HRP will continue work to progress the design, development and implementation of a race-based data collection framework. This is a complex and long-term initiative which will incorporate a collaborative and evidence-informed approach to community engagement, training, policy development and data analysis and reporting.	31-Mar-27
Support Reconciliation with African Nova Scotian Communities in the Municipality <i>Service Area: RCMP Halifax Regional Detachment</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-02-A4</i> Continue to support reconciliation with African Nova Scotian communities. RCMP HRD will continue to work with HRP on the race-based data collection project and will progress towards important community consultation work to envision what the data collection project will look like.	31-Mar-27
Integrated Criminal Investigation Division Review <i>Service Area: Halifax Regional Police</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-02-A4</i> Conduct a review of the integrated Criminal Investigation Division and create an action plan based on its recommendations, including identifying additional staffing resources that may be required.	31-Mar-27
Conduct a Review of the Integrated Criminal Investigation Division <i>Service Area: RCMP Halifax Regional Detachment</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-02-A4</i>	31-Mar-27

Work with HRP and municipal staff to conduct a detailed managerial review of the Integrated Criminal Investigation Division in 2026 to improve services to address complex criminal investigations for the residents of the municipality.	
SC-03 Improve the well-being of community members at risk of or experiencing homelessness by enhancing supports and resources.	
Support the Municipality's Response to Homelessness <i>Service Area: RCMP Halifax Regional Detachment</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-03-A2</i> Continue to work with the municipality to support the municipality's homelessness strategy and the municipality's homelessness working group for outreach within the unhoused community. RCMP HRD will continue to work with the Lower Sackville Tiny Home community and is proudly working with its proprietors to maintain a close and supportive relationship in joint service.	31-Mar-27
RA-04 Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency and cost effectiveness, while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.	
Digital Evidence Management System <i>Service Area: Halifax Regional Police</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04; no Action alignment</i> In partnership with Information Technology, HRP will procure and implement the Digital Evidence Management System (DEMS) body-worn cameras and in-car cameras. A new team dedicated to DEMS management and maintenance will be implemented.	31-Dec-26
OP-02 Strengthen the attraction and retention of people with the skills and behaviours needed to deliver municipal services.	
Employee Engagement <i>Service Area: Halifax Regional Police</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-02-A3</i> The Employee Engagement Working Group and its three sub-committees will continue to identify and progress a variety of initiatives. This work is being guided by feedback received through municipal and HRP surveys and ongoing feedback from HRP members. The group aims to progress at least one new initiative during the 2026/27 fiscal year.	31-Mar-27
Employee Recognition <i>Service Area: Halifax Regional Police</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-02-A3</i> Continue work to improve its internal recognition program process, the HRP Recognition Board, including looking at new ways to celebrate the accomplishments of its members. In addition, the Recognition Board will explore external recognition opportunities for members as they arise.	31-Mar-27

Consecutive Police Science Program Recruitment – Year 3 (2026/27) <i>Service Area: Halifax Regional Police</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-02-A4</i> Process applications for the 2027 Police Science Program (PSP). The PSP is the main avenue for HRP to hire police officers. Cadets will graduate from the 2026 PSP in July 2027.	31-Mar-27
Communications Plan to Support Recruitment <i>Service Area: Halifax Regional Police</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-02-A4</i> Develop and implement a multi-year communications plan that will support year-round recruitment to reach a robust candidate pool reflective of Halifax Regional Municipality residents.	31-Mar-27
OP-04 Foster a safety-first culture where employees' mental, emotional and physical well-being are protected.	
Physically and Mentally Healthy Workforce – Year 2 (2026/27) <i>Service Area: Halifax Regional Police</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-04-A1</i> Complete implementation of the Early Intervention (EI) Program. Part of this work will involve activating a communications plan to increase awareness about EI within the organization. In addition, work will continue to explore potential new initiatives to benefit the physical and mental wellness of members.	31-Mar-27
Health and Wellness Unit Advancement <i>Service Area: Halifax Regional Police</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal OP-04; no Action alignment</i> Develop an overarching Health and Wellness Framework and create a Health and Wellness Unit which will bring together all wellness programs and initiatives.	31-Mar-27

Summary of Net Expenditures - Halifax Regional Police

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
P120 Corporate Affairs	554,996	675,000	616,000	681,400	6,400	0.9
** Corporate Affairs Division	554,996	675,000	616,000	681,400	6,400	0.9
P110 Professional Stds	1,594,632	1,634,400	1,482,000	1,647,900	13,500	0.8
P125 Audit & Policy	329,713	617,300	432,300	667,700	50,400	8.2
** Executive Office	1,924,345	2,251,700	1,914,300	2,315,600	63,900	2.8
P105 Chief's Office	1,393,722	1,662,600	1,644,900	1,518,500	(144,100)	(8.7)
*** Chief's Office	3,873,063	4,589,300	4,175,200	4,515,500	(73,800)	(1.6)
P311 STIU	475,185	-	-	-	-	-
* IT & Security	475,185	-	-	-	-	-
P130 Facilities & Prop.	58,506	134,500	134,500	134,500	-	-
P210 EAP	151,410	336,800	336,800	328,600	(8,200)	(2.4)
P220 Human Resources	(342,600)	(200,600)	(255,500)	(110,000)	90,600	(45.2)
P225 Training	2,166,014	2,186,400	3,050,700	2,920,500	734,100	33.6
P255 Exhibits & Property	956,857	1,741,600	1,344,700	1,475,700	(265,900)	(15.3)
P505 Police Science Training	22,958	396,600	163,400	78,500	(318,100)	(80.2)
* Administration	3,013,145	4,595,300	4,774,600	4,827,800	232,500	5.1
P230 Finance	21,885	28,000	28,000	28,000	-	-
P250 Fleet Maintenance	95,622	50,900	50,900	50,900	-	-
* Fleet/Finance	117,507	78,900	78,900	78,900	-	-
** Administration Division	3,605,837	4,674,200	4,853,500	4,906,700	232,500	5.0
P235 Extra Duty	136,787	(131,000)	737,500	251,400	382,400	(291.9)
P317 CATS Clearing Account	5,956,393	-	-	-	-	-
P365 Collision Reconst	316,078	294,900	329,800	299,400	4,500	1.5
P370 Prisoner Care	1,256,144	906,300	1,429,200	935,500	29,200	3.2
P410 Shared Support	814,623	753,600	809,400	779,100	25,500	3.4
P430 Victim Service	298,067	507,600	507,600	538,400	30,800	6.1
P435 Canine	1,156,176	1,023,900	1,249,700	1,073,400	49,500	4.8
P440 ERT	2,895,140	2,394,000	3,126,900	2,400,800	6,800	0.3
P450 Public Safety Unit	30,054	36,700	137,200	36,700	-	-
P455 Bike Patrol	14,488	16,000	16,000	16,000	-	-
P465 Mounted	155,660	164,700	165,400	167,600	2,900	1.8
P470 Port's Policing	151,094	132,200	144,500	138,500	6,300	4.8
P480 CR/CP	1,224,168	1,304,800	1,361,100	1,303,000	(1,800)	(0.1)
P481 Youth Advocate Program	1,040,934	-	-	-	-	-
P485 Traffic	1,122,387	1,465,000	1,599,100	1,491,500	26,500	1.8
P486 Mental Health Crisis	299,132	253,000	314,000	266,800	13,800	5.5
P488 Aviation Security	(236,682)	(276,300)	(49,800)	(210,300)	66,000	(23.9)
* Support	16,630,644	8,845,400	11,877,600	9,487,800	642,400	7.3
A450 Integrated Emerg Srv	8,273,455	8,615,700	8,881,900	9,239,900	624,200	7.2
A551 Emergency Planning	87,546	129,600	131,400	125,900	(3,700)	(2.9)
N711 Dispatch Centre	88,662	105,700	105,700	105,700	-	-
N721 HRP	320,269	281,800	281,800	281,800	-	-
N731 Core Fire & EMO	1,060	3,000	3,000	3,000	-	-
N732 Rural Fire	680,892	676,300	676,300	676,300	-	-
P240 Traffic Support	623,264	708,600	612,500	717,800	9,200	1.3
P245 Court Officers	1,709,262	1,781,900	2,106,100	1,778,200	(3,700)	(0.2)
P265 Records	378,408	476,900	525,100	485,900	9,000	1.9
P489 Ground Search/Rescue	4,064	-	-	-	-	-
S120 FOIPOP Coordinator	96,141	166,100	29,900	-	(166,100)	(100.0)
* Information Management	12,263,023	12,945,600	13,353,700	13,414,500	468,900	3.6
** Support Division	28,893,668	21,791,000	25,231,300	22,902,300	1,111,300	5.1
P205 Support Division	1,862,920	2,693,800	2,439,900	2,217,100	(476,700)	(17.7)
*** Deputy Chief Support	34,362,425	29,159,000	32,524,700	30,026,100	867,100	3.0
P312 Technical Unit	1,202,725	1,285,300	1,127,100	920,900	(364,400)	(28.4)
P313 VICLAS	2,078	-	-	-	-	-
P314 Digital Forensics	720,046	557,200	641,700	836,000	278,800	50.0
P315 Inves. Call BackUnit	152,262	257,000	231,800	149,100	(107,900)	(42.0)
P316 CID	(2,191,952)	(2,043,600)	(2,224,700)	(2,285,600)	(242,000)	11.8
P320 Polygraph	103,166	156,900	132,900	159,700	2,800	1.8
P321 Cyber Crime	12,970	146,300	29,000	6,100	(140,200)	(95.8)
P325 Forensic Ident.	2,902,544	2,756,600	3,023,700	2,911,900	155,300	5.6
P330 Financial Crime	1,489,426	1,351,300	1,440,500	1,378,800	27,500	2.0
P335 Drugs	1,677,485	1,592,600	1,749,500	1,717,900	125,300	7.9

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
P340 Criminal Intel Unit	1,392,854	1,560,300	1,497,200	1,589,200	28,900	1.9
P345 Human Trafficking/MP	1,118,951	911,900	926,000	931,500	19,600	2.1
P346 ICE	427,963	562,400	690,700	592,500	30,100	5.4
P347 SAIT	1,768,882	1,594,500	1,754,700	1,655,800	61,300	3.8
P360 GIS	2,723,392	2,917,300	2,881,900	2,964,500	47,200	1.6
P375 Homicide	2,305,443	2,300,500	2,263,700	2,307,600	7,100	0.3
P376 Cold Case	(20,830)	237,200	266,000	301,800	64,600	27.2
P377 HEAT	507,301	436,500	331,100	301,900	(134,600)	(30.8)
P380 Crime Analysis	1,025,451	1,118,000	1,246,100	1,231,800	113,800	10.2
P381 Human Source Unit	184,851	174,300	181,600	164,700	(9,600)	(5.5)
P382 Intercept Monitors	116	10,000	600	10,000	-	-
** Criminal Investigations Divis	17,505,121	17,882,500	18,191,100	17,846,100	(36,400)	(0.2)
P415 Central	15,614,689	16,553,900	15,989,900	16,856,900	303,000	1.8
P475 QRU - Central Patrol	1,076,547	1,036,900	1,185,500	1,049,900	13,000	1.3
* Operations Central	16,691,236	17,590,800	17,175,400	17,906,800	316,000	1.8
P420 West	12,028,201	14,567,400	14,335,900	14,113,400	(454,000)	(3.1)
P495 QRU - West Patrol	262,045	711,600	258,900	716,500	4,900	0.7
* Operations West	12,290,246	15,279,000	14,594,800	14,829,900	(449,100)	(2.9)
P425 East	13,806,778	14,297,600	12,254,700	14,347,900	50,300	0.4
P490 QRU - East Patrol	263,134	711,200	292,800	705,400	(5,800)	(0.8)
* Operations East	14,069,912	15,008,800	12,547,500	15,053,300	44,500	0.3
** Patrol Operations	43,051,394	47,878,600	44,317,700	47,790,000	(88,600)	(0.2)
P405 Deputy Operations	691,146	1,746,300	791,800	2,004,700	258,400	14.8
*** Operations Division	61,247,661	67,507,400	63,300,600	67,640,800	133,400	0.2
**** HRM Police	99,483,149	101,255,700	100,000,500	102,182,400	926,700	0.9
***** Net Total	99,483,149	101,255,700	100,000,500	102,182,400	926,700	0.9

Summary of Expenditures Details - Halifax Regional Police

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	71,745,244	79,479,600	69,678,900	79,889,100	409,500	0.5
6002 Salaries - Overtime	8,146,919	2,889,200	8,225,700	2,964,200	75,000	2.6
6003 Wages - Regular	-	132,400	-	132,400	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(119,630)	-	(127,000)	-	-	-
6050 Court Time	2,246,078	1,647,800	2,575,100	1,686,200	38,400	2.3
6051 Shift Agreements	76,165	-	-	-	-	-
6052 Shift Differentials	230,132	403,700	403,700	403,700	-	-
6053 Extra Duty	1,751,601	1,988,400	1,988,400	1,988,400	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	30,538	-	-	-	-	-
6099 Other Allowances	2,083	-	-	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	15,997,187	16,850,500	15,969,000	17,145,400	294,900	1.8
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(2,215,000)	-	(2,815,000)	(600,000)	27.1
6152 Retirement Incentives	733,671	936,500	747,800	919,900	(16,600)	(1.8)
6153 Severance	1,328	-	-	-	-	-
6154 Workers' Compensation	2,474,522	2,401,500	2,935,700	3,841,300	1,439,800	60.0
6156 Clothing Allowance	364,967	462,500	462,500	462,500	-	-
6157 stipends	2,000	-	-	-	-	-
6158 WCB Recov Earnings	(156,861)	-	-	-	-	-
6164 On the Job injuries	142,794	179,400	103,400	179,400	-	-
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	895,452	(226,000)	(226,000)	(412,600)	(186,600)	82.6
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	(2,428)	-	-	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	104,561,759	104,930,500	102,737,200	106,384,900	1,454,400	1.4
6201 Telephone/Cable	125,073	177,700	176,900	148,800	(28,900)	(16.3)
6202 Courier/Postage	44,944	49,000	49,000	49,000	-	-
6203 Office Furn/Equip	91,730	80,800	180,800	80,800	-	-
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	246,575	199,500	199,500	10,000	(189,500)	(95.0)
6205 Printing & Reprod	805	2,500	-	2,500	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	103,475	115,900	114,900	94,800	(21,100)	(18.2)
* Office	612,603	625,400	721,100	385,900	(239,500)	(38.3)
6302 Legal Fees	232,039	160,400	400,000	160,400	-	-
6303 Consulting Fees	493	-	-	-	-	-
6304 Janitorial Services	122,532	139,700	139,700	139,700	-	-
6311 Security	140,210	42,900	127,900	42,900	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6312 Refuse Collection	26,230	15,000	15,000	15,000	-	-
6315 Outside Policing	250,871	553,400	275,000	400,000	(153,400)	(27.7)
6399 Contract Services	2,302,349	2,623,000	2,502,000	3,090,600	467,600	17.8
* External Services	3,074,724	3,534,400	3,459,600	3,848,600	314,200	8.9
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	221,432	438,800	438,800	438,800	-	-
6402 Med & First Aid Supp	540	-	-	-	-	-
6403 Patrol Equip Supplies	577,142	688,300	728,000	674,000	(14,300)	(2.1)
6404 Rec Prog Supplies	1,271	-	-	-	-	-
6405 Photo Supp & Equip	19,264	35,000	35,000	35,000	-	-
6406 Bridge Tolls	146	-	-	-	-	-
6407 Clean/Sani Supplies	9,672	8,700	8,700	8,700	-	-
6409 Personal Protect Equ	32,058	15,000	30,800	15,000	-	-
6499 Other Supplies	11,655	4,900	4,900	4,900	-	-
* Supplies	873,180	1,190,700	1,246,200	1,176,400	(14,300)	(1.2)
6603 Grnds & Landscaping	46	-	-	-	-	-
6605 Municipal Taxes	1,748	-	-	-	-	-
6607 Electricity	2,367	-	-	-	-	-
6608 Water	849	-	-	-	-	-
6611 Building - Interior	4,286	-	-	-	-	-
6616 Natural Gas-Buildings	12,250	-	-	-	-	-
6617 Pest Management	78	-	-	-	-	-
6699 Other Building Cost	86,994	47,300	247,300	47,300	-	-
* Building Costs	108,618	47,300	247,300	47,300	-	-
6701 Equipment Purchase	231,547	834,200	257,200	387,600	(446,600)	(53.5)
6702 Small Tools	648	-	-	-	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	51,357	8,000	8,000	8,000	-	-
6704 Equipment Rental	-	1,800	1,800	1,800	-	-
6705 Equip - R&M	57,063	93,500	138,500	93,500	-	-
6706 Computer R&M	42	8,700	8,700	8,700	-	-
6707 Plumbing & Heating	503	-	-	-	-	-
6708 Mechanical Equipment	9,298	4,100	4,100	4,100	-	-
6711 Communication System	941,474	885,100	845,100	742,600	(142,500)	(16.1)
6731 Airtime	189,761	258,700	258,700	258,700	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	1,481,693	2,094,100	1,522,100	1,505,000	(589,100)	(28.1)
6802 Vehicle R&M	1,570	-	-	-	-	-
6803 Vehicle Fuel - Diesel	-	3,000	3,000	3,000	-	-
6804 Vehicle Fuel - Gas	8,101	1,000	1,000	1,000	-	-
6806 Vehicle Rentals	45,935	-	-	-	-	-
6809 Electricity-Vehicles	7,066	-	-	-	-	-
6899 Other Vehicle Expense	1,272	-	-	-	-	-
* Vehicle Expense	63,944	4,000	4,000	4,000	-	-
6901 Membership Dues	21,352	23,200	23,200	23,200	-	-
6902 Conferences/Workshop	30,406	25,000	25,000	25,000	-	-
6903 Travel - Local	3,946	6,900	6,400	6,900	-	-
6904 Travel - Out of Town	372,366	380,200	303,200	380,200	-	-
6905 Training & Education	425,828	492,800	492,800	512,800	20,000	4.1
6906 Licenses & Agreements	78,630	84,800	84,800	84,800	-	-
6909 Cost of Sales	264	-	-	-	-	-
6910 Signage	1,597	-	-	-	-	-
6911 Facilities Rental	1,538,492	1,810,700	1,568,500	1,600,000	(210,700)	(11.6)
6912 Advertising/Promotio	42,130	43,100	43,100	43,100	-	-
6914 Recruiting	59,038	-	-	-	-	-
6917 Books and Periodicals	16,761	9,900	9,600	9,900	-	-
6918 Meals/Catering	45,368	26,000	26,000	26,000	-	-
6919 Special Projects	-	2,000	2,000	2,000	-	-
6933 Community Events	210	-	-	-	-	-
6938 Rewarding Excellence	18,417	15,300	15,300	15,300	-	-
6999 Other Goods/Services	60,639	-	-	-	-	-
* Other Goods & Services	2,715,443	2,919,900	2,599,900	2,729,200	(190,700)	(6.5)
7009 Internal Trfr Other	(87,324)	(500)	(500)	(500)	-	-
7011 Int Trf Record Check	-	(3,300)	(3,300)	(3,300)	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	9,025	-	-	-	-	-
7013 Int Trf Extra Duty	(535,555)	(681,500)	(527,900)	(551,900)	129,600	(19.0)
* Interdepartmental	(613,853)	(685,300)	(531,700)	(555,700)	129,600	(18.9)
8003 Insurance Pol/Prem	49,024	54,100	54,100	54,100	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
* Other Fiscal	49,024	54,100	54,100	54,100	-	-
** Total	112,927,135	114,715,100	112,059,800	115,579,700	864,600	0.8

Summary of Revenues Details - Halifax Regional Police

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4703 Cond. Grant NS(Other)	(3,829,250)	(3,800,000)	(3,814,300)	(3,800,000)	-	-
* Transfers from other Gov'ts	(3,829,250)	(3,800,000)	(3,814,300)	(3,800,000)	-	-
5250 Sales of Svcs-Other	(448,031)	(550,000)	(507,900)	(550,000)	-	-
5256 SOT Revenue	(60)	-	-	-	-	-
* Fee Revenues	(448,091)	(550,000)	(507,900)	(550,000)	-	-
5508 Recov External Parti	(7,668,628)	(7,190,600)	(6,532,100)	(7,378,500)	(187,900)	2.6
5600 Miscellaneous Revenue	(1,498,018)	(1,918,800)	(1,205,000)	(1,668,800)	250,000	(13.0)
* Other Revenue	(9,166,646)	(9,109,400)	(7,737,100)	(9,047,300)	62,100	(0.7)
** Total	(13,443,987)	(13,459,400)	(12,059,300)	(13,397,300)	62,100	(0.5)
**** Net Total	99,483,149	101,255,700	100,000,500	102,182,400	926,700	0.9

HALIFAX

PARKS AND RECREATION

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

PARKS & RECREATION

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

Parks & Recreation works to create a Halifax where everyone has access to meaningful recreation experiences that foster healthy lifestyles, vibrant communities and sustainable environment. We make a difference.

OVERVIEW

Parks & Recreation supports Council and Administrative Priorities by providing accessible and inclusive programs, services and facilities that promote physical, mental and social well-being across the municipality. Through the maintenance and enhancement of parks, trails, playgrounds, sports fields and green spaces, the Parks division fosters community connection and leisure opportunities. Recreation Programming delivers a broad range of structured and unstructured activities, including aquatic and dryland services, youth-at-risk initiatives and inclusion programs. Strategic Planning & Design contributes through policy development, capital planning, parkland acquisition and cultural initiatives such as the Poet Laureate program and arts grants. Regional Recreation Services strengthens community engagement through facility scheduling, civic event delivery, event grants and coordination and recreation software management, ensuring responsive and empowered service delivery; it also manages relationships with community partners who deliver services on behalf of the municipality.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Executive Director's Office	✓ Oversight and Administration of Parks & Recreation Business Unit
Parks	✓ Asset Control and Service Delivery ✓ Cemetery Management ✓ Geographic Information System (GIS) Services for Parks ✓ Horticulture Management ✓ Operations and Maintenance of Outdoor Recreation Assets ✓ Park Management ✓ Playground Maintenance ✓ Trail Maintenance
Recreation Programming	✓ Inclusion and Accessibility Programming ✓ Neighbourhood and Volunteer Services ✓ Recreation Program Delivery ✓ Youth and Senior Development Programs
Regional Recreation Services	✓ Civic Events ✓ Community Partnerships ✓ Facility Scheduling ✓ Recreation Software Management ✓ School Community Partnerships
Strategic Planning & Design	✓ Capital Projects for Outdoor Recreation Assets ✓ Capital Projects for Public Art, Cultural Assets and Collections ✓ Culture Planning and Strategies ✓ Geographic Information System (GIS) Services ✓ Indoor Recreation Facility Planning ✓ Park Planning ✓ Parkland Acquisitions and Disposals ✓ Recreation Strategies

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		309.1
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Gardener	Maintain Current Service	1.0
Gardener	Maintain Current Service	1.0
Seasonal Gardener	Maintain Current Service	0.6
Seasonal Gardener	Maintain Current Service	0.1
Cultural Developer, Collections	Service Enhancement	1.0
Transferred Positions		
Net Transfer Positions		
Total Changes		3.7
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		312.8

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	Budget	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections		Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Strategic Planning and Design	\$ 3,337,892	\$ 3,922,100	\$ 3,775,300	\$ 4,255,900	\$ 333,800	8.9
Parks & Recreation Administra	455,362	473,400	543,100	571,500	98,100	20.7
Parks	18,682,745	18,989,500	19,574,600	19,415,100	425,600	2.2
Recreation Programming	11,769,305	15,850,495	14,433,900	15,716,700	(133,795)	(0.8)
Regional Recreation	12,065,196	9,412,805	13,757,200	11,575,800	2,162,995	23.0
Net Total	\$ 46,310,501	\$ 48,648,300	\$ 52,084,099	\$ 51,535,000	\$ 2,886,700	5.9

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 33,495,839	\$ 39,029,895	\$ 38,611,799	\$ 39,951,100	\$ 921,205	2.4
Office	456,860	508,700	503,600	499,200	(9,500)	(1.9)
External Services	8,549,335	8,014,400	10,411,100	8,830,000	815,600	10.2
Supplies	723,884	647,200	747,750	693,600	46,400	7.2
Materials	643,193	587,800	664,300	653,900	66,100	11.2
Building Costs	3,184,819	2,857,600	3,164,400	2,899,600	42,000	1.5
Equipment & Communications	1,162,181	778,300	1,317,500	825,300	47,000	6.0
Vehicle Expense	269,253	216,300	274,800	228,300	12,000	5.5
Other Goods & Services	5,764,550	4,145,800	5,903,200	6,734,900	2,589,100	62.5
Interdepartmental	(143,629)	(42,600)	(4,950)	(22,100)	20,500	(48.1)
Other Fiscal	14,193,739	9,537,205	13,237,500	10,313,200	775,995	8.1
Total Expenditures	68,300,024	66,280,600	74,830,999	71,607,000	5,326,400	8.0

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Fee Revenues	\$ (14,449,779)	\$ (13,935,000)	\$ (16,432,200)	\$ (16,080,300)	\$ (2,145,300)	15.4
Other Revenue	(7,539,743)	(3,697,300)	(6,314,700)	(3,991,700)	(294,400)	8.0
Total Revenues	(21,989,523)	(17,632,300)	(22,746,900)	(20,072,000)	(2,439,700)	13.8
Net Total	\$ 46,310,501	\$ 48,648,300	\$ 52,084,099	\$ 51,535,000	\$ 2,886,700	5.9

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 48,648,300
Service Enhancements	
Parks Security / Port a potties / Rural Beach Program	205,000
Museum Strategy Cultural Developer Collections and contribution Agreement	135,000
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Inflationary pressures grass mowing, vegetation management, etc.	440,000
Other Inflationary pressures	235,000
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	860,200
Lockview all-weather field and field monitoring	145,000
Revenue Changes	
Fee Revenue increase	(951,500)
Other Revenue increase	(207,400)
Other/Transfers	
Youth Advocate Program non-compensation costs	189,000
Various subsidies and Discover Halifax adjustment	833,000
Affordable Access Program increase and Multi District Facility Expansion	1,400,000
IT Services - Eastlink WAN/Internet Services	(19,000)
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact "Green" Reductions	(95,000)
Low Service Impact Reductions in response to flat tax motion	(66,800)
In-Camera Budget Adjustment	185,000
Reduce Discover Halifax contribution by 5%	(70,000)
Reduce Discovery Centre contribution	(10,000)
Reduce Lake District Recreation Association (LDRA) contribution agreement by 10%	(10,000)
Increase Ice Rental Revenues	(210,800)
Reduce consulting	(100,000)
Total Changes	\$ 2,886,700
2026/27 Budget	\$ 51,535,000

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Parks	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Grass service calls	402	73 ¹	62	100
Playgrounds inspected to service level standards (six per year)	99%	96%	99%	96%
Park litter service calls	374	308	252	275

Hours of play on bookable assets	65,335	69,657	75,527	78,500
Parks operating and maintenance cost per capita ²	-	-	\$40.29 ²	-

- ¹ Further improvement in the reporting methodology have allowed Parks & Recreation to separate out grass service calls that require action versus service calls that do not or are occurring outside of municipal property.
- ² New performance measure, calculated as the Approved operating budget FY25/26 divided by 513,816 population. Value for 2025 is based on projected population provided by Halifax Regional Municipality and will be updated once Statistics Canada population estimate data is available.

Analysis:

- Grass service calls.** Grass service requests saw a further decrease in 2025. In 2024, Parks changed the reporting method for this type of service call because of new capabilities and improvements to reporting. Parks can better determine service requests that are outside service standard and require contractor resolution. There are other factors contributing to the grass cutting performance such as better alignment of the contracts including living wage, very dry weather conditions for much of the mowing season this past summer, and availability of equipment and parts. A large portion of the grass contracts were also in their final year and contractors were increasingly familiar with their inventories and nuances of service delivery in their districts. Although there were 62 missed or late cuts, there is a total of 40,088 individual cuts scheduled across the entire municipal inventory creating a 99.86% performance completion rating. All 62 late cuts were rectified within 24 hours. As multiple contracts will be tendered in 2026-27, a slight increase in service calls may occur as new contractors become familiar with their assigned inventories, operational requirements and service standards.
- Playgrounds inspected to service level standards.** In 2020, Parks leveraged the municipal CityWorks application to ensure that playground inspections were completed within the established service standards of six inspections per year. With a consistent full complement of staff for the past number of seasons, a 99% inspection service level is projected.
- Park litter service calls.** Service calls for litter are down 56 service requests from 2025 and down 122 since 2024. This is due to the increase in park staff, the development of additional routes, and increased focus on weekend staffing to cover special events and tournaments. Parks are anticipating continued increase in usage with the population growth, we therefore expect an increase in service requests of approximately 10%. With over 105,000 expected individual litter can empties in peak season, Park Litter Service Calls represents a 99.76% performance completion rating.
- Hours of play on bookable assets.** Parks saw an increase in its bookable assets across the board. Ball diamonds, all-weather fields, sport fields, and sport courts all had an increase in booked time. This is partly due to the increase in population, and partly because there were minimal rainouts or cancellations in 2025.
- Parks operating and maintenance cost per capita.** The average cost of operating and maintenance cost per capita of 64 municipalities across Canada is \$67.73 as per 2024 Canadian City Parks Report. HRM park maintenance cost per capita is one of the lowest in the country at \$40.29.

Recreation Programming	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Number of direct programs delivered ¹	8,280	8,700	7,137	8,600
Number of unique registrations ¹	70,132	67,000	62,772	70,000
Number of youths enrolled in leadership training (Calendar year)	2,439	2,332	2,358 ²	2,400
Number of participants at Emera Oval (winter)	116,000	120,000	130,000	120,000
Number of participants at Emera Oval (summer)	51,000	55,000	55,000	55,000
Recreation programs at full capacity (per cent)	-	-	76%	80%
Discounts (calendar year)				
Value of discounted programs/services (Calendar year)	\$1,041,700	\$1,215, 732	\$1,425,730	\$1,500,000
Number of registered clients who used discount	1,752	2,034	2,241	2,300

¹ The transition to the Xplor Recreation software in April 2025 introduced changes on how program registrations are recorded and impacted program availability at the start of the fiscal year. Due to the transition, spring programming was reduced to allow staff time to adapt to the new system and ensure a stable transition. Additionally, the functionality of Xplor has altered how services are reported. Under the previous system, certain drop-in programs were configured as seasonal registered programs to accommodate demand and advance registration requirements. Xplor now supports true drop-in functionality, which means participation in these programs is no longer reflected in registered program counts going forward.

² Stats have been updated to reflect calendar year reporting due to the limitations in the historical data that was retained for Legend (previous software).

Analysis:

- The Recreation Programming division has responded to changes in population, demand, and recreation trends by adjusting and modifying services and program offerings.
- **Inclusion.** The demographics of our population are quickly changing, and recreation service delivery must adapt accordingly. In 2025, the municipality provided inclusion services at no cost to 232 children with varying disabilities or behavioural challenges. This number has increased from 211 children receiving inclusion support in the summer of 2024.
- **Program registration.** Online registrations now account for over 92% of program registrations on the opening day of registration.
- **Affordable Access Program (AAP).** The Affordable Access Program allows qualified residents to apply for municipally subsidized programs (property tax, recreation, and transit). This intake process allows residents to apply once and have their application considered for multiple programs. On April 1, 2025, the Affordable Access program added a third category at a 25%

discount. The AAP now provides 100% discount, 50% discount and 25% discount to address the different levels of financial needs within the municipality.

Strategic Planning & Design	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned ³
Parks Capital				
Per cent of parks outdoor recreation capital projects tendered	92%	90%	95%	90%
Per cent of parks outdoor recreation capital projects completed	63%	70%	93%	80%
Number of recreation capital projects completed	65	64	67 ¹	56 ²
Culture & Community Programs ³				
Total operating funding requested	\$902,998	\$1,301,320	\$1,100,000	\$1,301,320
Operating funding awarded	\$510,000	\$609,950	\$635,000	\$635,000
Total project funding requested	\$512,863	\$527,859	\$615,000	\$750,000
Project funding awarded	\$175,000	\$200,050	\$175,000	\$175,000
Total annual funding envelope	\$685,000	\$810,000	\$810,000	\$810,000
Number of non-profit organizations receiving Arts & Culture grants	41	45	48	50
Culture Grants per Capita	\$1.36	\$1.61	\$1.58 ⁴	\$1.58

¹ Number of recreation projects complete as of 31 March 2026.

² This value reflects the submitted budget and may be adjusted following final budget approval.

³ Planned values are dependent on Council direction regarding grant funding

⁴ Culture Grants per Capita, calculated as the Total annual funding envelope \$810,000 divided by 513,816 population. Value for 2025 is based on projected population provided by Halifax Regional Municipality and will be updated once Statistics Canada population estimate data is available.

Analysis:

- **Per cent of parks outdoor recreation capital projects completed.** Successful completion of parks capital projects is dependent on a range of issues, including but not limited to, consultant and contractor capacity, equipment delivery, signed funding agreements, land tenure, permitting, seasonal conditions, as well community involvement; all these items can impact timing of projects and may require some to be completed over multiple years.
- **Grants to Professional Arts Organizations.** The information listed in the 'Culture & Community Program Performance Measures' table provides a summary of funding requests received through the annual application intake to the Professional Arts Grants Program. The purpose of the

program is to provide sustainable core operating funding to professional arts organizations in the municipality as well as an annual intake for professional arts projects. Each year, and through a peer jury review process, the total funding envelope is distributed between the two funding streams (operating and project) and is based on organizational needs. Applications are increasing annually and the ratio of need between operating and project-based funding streams continues to prioritize operating funding, leaving less capacity for funding projects. In 2025/26, project-based applications over-subscribed by \$432,490 and operating by \$581,209, and the funding envelope for combined project and operating based applications was \$810,000. On average this envelope meets about 33% of the overall need indicated by applications.

Regional Recreation Services	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Regional Special Events Grants	\$414,575	\$442,500	\$557,100	\$640,000
Marketing Levy Special Events Reserve (MLSER) (Balance as of April 1 each year)	\$1,993,453	\$3,040,000	\$3,000,000	\$3,000,000
Number of annual (Signature) and Non-Annual Event Grants ¹	19	23	23	23
Value of Annual (Signature) and Non-Annual Event Grants	\$913,500	\$1,638,500	\$1,512,400	\$4,613,000 ¹

¹ The significant increase is due to SailGP 2026, Canoe '26 World Juniors, half of the National Pride Games, U Sports, a potential Rugby Canada event, and a higher number of Signature, Emerging and Distinguished events than usual.

Analysis:

- Halifax Regional Municipality-operated civic events.** In 2025/26 Regional Recreation Services continued the direct delivery of civic events and culturally significant programs, hosting 54 events across the municipality. Grants were provided for community celebrations, established community events, and cultural showcases and events. Event grants were issued from the Marketing Levy Special Events Reserve. The calendar of civic/large scale events included Canada Day, Bedford Days, Natal Day, Clam Harbour Beach Sandcastle Competition, Hopscotch Arts Festival, Halifax Tree Lighting, Halifax Explosion Memorial Ceremony, Dartmouth Tree Lighting, Menorah Lighting, and New Year's Eve Celebration with Emancipation Day and Acadian Day added to the event calendar in recent years. Cultural groups such as the African Nova Scotian Music Association, the Jamaican Cultural Association and the Conseil Communautaire du Grand Havre returned very positive feedback on our commitment to celebrating multiple cultures across the HRM. Their communities reported a sense of pride as the production value of their annual festival has been elevated significantly by the Dartmouth Summer Series.
- Signature Events Sustainability Fund.** The primary objective, as outlined in the Administrative Order 2014-020-GOV Respecting Marketing Levy Special Event Reserve (Administrative Order), is the promotion of the municipality as a tourist destination. More broadly, Signature Events boost the local economy, celebrate community and culture, and position the municipality as a premier destination for tourism and events. For the first time, Signature Events were eligible to apply for consultant funding to develop sustainability plans. Seven of the 10 Signature events applied,

securing a combined a total of \$235,000 dedicated to the future success of HRM's local favourite festivals. This funding provides organizations with new resources to improve the long-term success of their organizations. To date, four organizers have completed their sustainability plans, and three others have begun the process. All seven are reporting positive feedback. Two events have already confirmed that these plans enabled them to re-envision their festivals' revenue stream.

- **Major event hosting.** Staff were part of five National/International major event bids this year. Four of five were confirmed, representing an 80% success rate. This is considered a very high success rate in the world of major event bids. Staff continue to finalize the Major Event Framework. The consultation process has taught both Discover Halifax and HRM, multiple strategies to ensure we focus on assets, alignment and authenticity to improve the ecosystem we create for our events industry. On the delivery side, the Canadian Curling Trials are set to surpass the Halifax sales record in the Scotiabank Arena for curling events. Although the building capacity is not as large as other cities, it will also be a top five sales record for curling major events in Canada. Early predictions on economic impact from 2025 events should exceed 2024 numbers. This should increase the yield from the marketing levy and increase opportunities to support major events into the future.
- **Recreation technology.** The operation and configuration of recreation management software enable transactions for a variety of recreation services including recreation programming, facility rentals, memberships, punch passes and drop-in services. The business unit successfully transitioned to the new software, Xplor Recreation, on April 1, 2025, and the legacy recreation software was decommissioned. Since the implementation of Xplor software, 45,000 active online client accounts have been created. Advancements continue as the business unit fulfills software reporting requirements and implements the full capabilities and benefits of this new solution.

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
EP-02 Expedite the delivery of housing supply and support the development of complete communities with a mix of housing options and convenient access to goods, services, and facilities.	
Outdoor Recreation Facilities Standards Project (Greenbook) / The Municipal Park Design Guidelines <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A7 A uniform set of design and construction standards for outdoor recreation facilities such as courts and various playing field types is being developed for use by for staff, consultants, contractors, and developers in the planning, designing of parks. Significant work has been done in 2025/26 and will continue in 2026/27.	31-Mar-27
Parks and Outdoor Recreation Facilities Plan <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A7 The Parks and Outdoor Recreation Facilities Plan is to be the replacement of the parks and outdoor recreation parts of the Community Facilities Master Plan 2. It will broadly consider the provision, types, and needs for existing and new parks and outline how they should be planned with outdoor facilities, outlining best practices, standards, and benchmarks. A scoping report that is to be prepared in early 2026/27 for Regional Council will outline how the Parks and Outdoor Recreation Facilities Plan is to be developed and subsequently undertaken and finalized in 2027/28.	30-Jun-27
Recreation Centre Needs Analysis <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A7 This project will establish the foundational guidelines for planning new recreation centres. It will define a standard prototype for recreation centres and provide benchmark-based criteria to determine when and where new facilities should be developed. The analysis will include catchment area identification and socio-economic mapping to ensure equitable access and informed decision-making. This work is an early phase of the forthcoming Indoor Recreation Facilities Plan, which will replace the indoor recreation components of the current Community Facilities Master Plan 2.	1-Sep-26

Deliverable	Completion
Subdivision Tracking <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A7 As subdivision development occurs within the municipality, parkland is dedicated to the municipality but not typically developed with outdoor recreation facilities such as playgrounds and courts. The Subdivision Tracking project is underway and will be assessing when parkland is intended to be dedicated and the potential needs and priorities for parkland development.	31-Mar-27
EP-04 Ensure residents and businesses can contribute to and benefit from the municipality's growing economy.	
Implementation of the Integrated Tourism Master Plan 2030 - Year 2 <i>Service Area: Regional Recreation Services</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-04-A3 Support the implementation of the Integrated Tourism Master Plan 2030.	31-Mar-27
Implementation of the Event Framework <i>Service Area: Regional Recreation Services</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-04-A4 Support the implementation of the Event Framework. Year 1 implementation, in partnership with Discover Halifax and Events East.	31-Mar-27
Implementation of Event Strategy <i>Service Area: Regional Recreation Services</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-04-A4 Support the implementation of the Event Strategy. This will include creating an Event Advisory Group, a redesign of the Special Event Task Force, the creation of the first Annual Event Gathering and updating the Marketing Levy By-Law.	31-Mar-27
Wanderers Block Report and Operations <i>Service Area: Regional Recreation Services</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-04-A7 Continue to work with event partners to improve efficiency within the Wanderers stadium operation and the future planning of the Wanderers Block.	31-Mar-27
SC-04 Plan and invest in social infrastructure and opportunities for connection to increase residents' well-being and sense of belonging in their communities.	

Deliverable	Completion
Community Neighbourhood and Volunteer Services Evaluation and Analysis <i>Service Area: Recreation Programming</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A1 Complete an evaluation and analysis for community development throughout the municipality (community, neighbourhood and volunteer services) to align with the Rural Recreation Strategy and other municipal strategies.	31-Mar-27
Culture and Community Programs <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A2 Implement culture and community programs, including Adult Poet Laureate Program Continuation; Youth Poet Laureate Program Continuation; Professional Arts grants; and Permanent and Temporary Public Art Programming.	31-Mar-27
Cogswell Art and Storytelling Program <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A2 In 2025, the Cogswell Public Art program, Interchange was launched. In 26/27, the next phase of Cogswell Storytelling Interpretive Design Strategy, prioritizing Mi'kmaw and African Nova Scotian stories will deliver the design and content for interpretive elements within the Cogswell District through inclusive collaboration and site-specific opportunities.	31-Mar-28
Fog Lane Park Plan <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A2 Fog Lane Park is a recently acquired parkland dedication park that is the reported site of an African-Nova Scotian homestead. A park plan that considers this cultural history and the needs of a newly developed subdivision of houses is to be developed.	31-Mar-27
Peace and Friendship Park Plan <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-04-A2 The municipality is updating the design of Peace and Friendship Park stemming from Regional Council's adoption of the recommendations of the Commemoration of Edward Cornwallis and the Recognition and Commemoration of Indigenous History. A park plan is underway and will be completed following updates to the municipality's existing heritage conservation district plan to the area within which the park is located.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Point Pleasant Park Interpretive Plan <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-04-A2 A subsequent part of the Point Pleasant Park Comprehensive Plan (2008) was the development of an Interpretive Plan of Mi'kmaq heritage within the park, which was undertaken but not completed. This project to review, update, and complete the Interpretive Plan has been scoped in 2025/26 and is intended to be undertaken in 2026/27.	31-Mar-27
Professional Arts Venues Plan <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A2 The Arts Venue Study was completed in 2024/25. Scoping for the next phase, The Arts Venue Plan will occur in 26/27. This deliverable provides a comprehensive assessment of existing cultural facilities across HRM, identifies gaps in cultural facilities, and outlines strategic recommendations for investment in current and future spaces. It establishes a roadmap for informed decisions on major capital projects and long-term cultural infrastructure planning.	31-Mar-27
Regional Museum Strategy Implementation <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A2 In October 2025, Regional Council approved the Phase 2 Regional Museum Strategy. Scoping for Museum Strategy Implementation plan will occur in 26/27.	31-Mar-27
Youth Services Plan – Version 3 <i>Service Area: Recreation Programming</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A3 Create youth services plan – version 3. This will inform the delivery of youth services in Halifax Regional Municipality. Youth will be consulted to inform phase three of the plan.	31-Mar-27
Senior Recreation Services Plan <i>Service Area: Recreation Programming</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A4 Implement the Seniors Recreation Services Plan offering to ensure enhanced opportunities for the seniors (60+) of the municipality.	31-Mar-27
Implementation of the Halifax Common Master Plan <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A6 The municipality will continue to implement actions from Halifax Common Master Plan. This is a multi-year project with regular updates to Regional Council.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Dartmouth Common Park Plan Review – Initial Scoping <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-04; no Action alignment This project will include an initial review of the Dartmouth Common Master Plan (2010) to consider if a new park plan is warranted relative to factors such as the prospective establishment of a downtown Dartmouth heritage conservation district and changing circumstances from development in the area.	31-Mar-27

SC-05 Improve equitable access to municipal programs, services, indoor and outdoor spaces, and events for all residents.	
Affordable Access Program at Multi-District Facilities <i>Service Area: Regional Recreation Services</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-05-A1 Implement the Affordable Access Program by configuring subsidies within Xplor Recreation Software for all Multi-District Facilities. Provide ongoing training and support to ensure consistent program management at each site. Monitor and report quarterly on client participation and total subsidy value. Conduct a comprehensive assessment of program expansion across Multi-District Facilities, evaluating effectiveness in meeting strategic goals.	31-Mar-27
Inclusion Support Services Analysis and Evaluation <i>Service Area: Recreation Programming</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-05-A1 Complete the analysis and evaluation of the Recreation Inclusion Program.	31-Mar-27
Enhance Parks Presence in Rural Areas <i>Service Area: Parks</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-05-A3 Pilot the creation of rural satellite depots for staff use and equipment storage as identified in the Rural Lens for Recreation Service Delivery to enhance maintenance of parks and trail maintenance.	31-Mar-27
Outdoor Recreation Evaluation and Analysis <i>Service Area: Recreation Programming</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-05-A3 Create an evaluation and analysis for outdoor recreation throughout the municipality to align with the Rural Recreation Strategy and other municipal strategies.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Review Community-Led Rural Recreation Service Delivery <i>Service Area: Parks</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-05-A3 Evaluate the use of community-led park maintenance delivery in rural areas.	31-Mar-27
Rural Recreation Strategy <i>Service Area: Recreation Programming</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-05-A3 Implement year 3 action items in the Rural Recreation Strategy.	31-Mar-27
Graves-Oakley Park Plan <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-05-A4 Graves-Oakley is regional sports park in the Spryfield area that also serves a local community. It contains ball diamonds and sport fields, local playground areas, a large gravel parking lot, a rugby clubhouse with washrooms, and an undeveloped forested area. An initial scoping has been undertaken in 2025/26, which will be followed by the development of a park plan in 2026/27 to guide future improvements.	31-Mar-27
Implementation of the Playing Field Strategy <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-05-A4 This project will track and report on the status of the short term (1 to 3 years) strategic actions from the Playing Field Strategy which was approved in April 2023.	31-Mar-27
Training and Competition Aquatic Centre Study <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-05; no Action alignment The Training and Competition Aquatic Centre Study is underway and is to broadly identify the municipality's needs for new recreation pools and the options for the development of a regional training and competition pool with a 50-metre pool, that has arisen as an emerging need based on aged aquatic facilities at Centennial Pool and Dalhousie University. Updates are also to be provided of the actions from the municipality's Aquatic Strategy.	30-Apr-26
Review and Development of Recreation Allocation Policies <i>Service Area: Regional Recreation Services</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-05, no Action alignment Review the municipality's approach to the allocation of recreation assets including review and analysis of the current Ice Allocation Policy; development of an outdoor playing field allocation policy, in line with the Playing Field Strategy; and development of an allocation policy for gymnasiums. The project will include engagement with partners such as Halifax Regional Centre for Education (HRCE) and user groups.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Options for the Future Use of Halifax Memorial Library <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-05; no Action alignment The development of a park plan is a multi-year project was identified in past staff reports and business plans. Initial work has commenced and will continue through 2026/27.	31-Mar-27
Park Planning for I-1 Lands and Other Nearby West Bedford Parks <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-05; no Action alignment The municipality recently acquired a property (I-1 Lands) in a new area of West Bedford to serve as a large park with several outdoor recreation facilities and the possibility of an indoor institutional use. A preliminary park concept plan was developed, the plan enabled the design and construction of a recently completed pump track as an initial facility. The Park Planning for I-1 Lands and other nearby West Bedford Parks project is to consider the prospective development of the I-1 Lands and assess whether other parkland that was obtained as parkland dedications is needed.	31-Mar-27
Off-Leash Dog Area Program Update <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-05; no Action alignment The municipality's Off-leash Dog Area Program Update will include a scoping report in 2025/26 for Regional Council and a subsequent review and update of the existing program, including reviews of the municipality's approach to off-leash areas, updates to the administrative order as needed, and the establishment of a new workplan for the development of future off-leash areas.	31-Mar-27
SC-07 Invest in the enhancement, protection, and expansion of natural assets, green spaces and urban agriculture to support community and ecological health and resilient ecosystem services.	
HalifACT: Parks & Recreation Support <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-07-A2 Deliver on HalifACT deliverables through Parks & Recreation operational work year over year, and through future strategic acquisitions and plans. Current activities include Parks Naturalization, supporting Community Gardens engagement, stewardship of parks, and efforts to support Halifax Green Network Plan.	31-Mar-28

Deliverable	Completion
Blue Mountain-Birch Cove Lakes Regional Park <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-07-A3 The municipality has an ongoing multi-year project with partners to consider the realization of large regional wilderness park and a potential National Urban Park under a Parks Canada program. This is multi-year program, with an update report that may be expected in 2026/27.	31-Mar-27
Shaw Wilderness Park Management / Park Plan <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-07-A4 There has been a longstanding intention to develop a management / park plan for Shaw Wilderness Park in conjunction with the Nature Conservancy of Canada. This has temporarily been postponed on occasions as the municipality successfully acquired additional lands for the park and has most recently been partnering with the province to replace the Williams Lake Dam. The Shaw Wilderness Park Management / Park plan remains as a project for 2026/27.	31-Mar-27
Acquire and Develop Parkland <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-07; no Action alignment Acquire land to contribute to the municipality's parks, with a focus on Regional Wilderness Parks, as supported by planning and policy documents, and directions of Regional Council including direction to consider divesting other parkland.	31-Mar-27
Big Latter Pond Park Plan <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-07; no Action alignment The municipality anticipates acquiring lands from the province in 2025/26 that have had a longstanding use as municipal parkland. The parkland and its outdoor recreation facilities need assessment and improvements that are to be identified within a park plan.	31-Mar-27
Park Naturalization Operational Guidelines <i>Service Area: Parks</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-07; no Action alignment Develop operational guidelines for naturalization areas including planting, maintaining and monitoring of sites.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Penhorn Lake and Surrounding Parks Initial Review <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-07; no Action alignment With increased development occurring in the Penhorn Lake area, initial reviews of the changes in use, demands, and possible impacts upon Penhorn Lake and its surrounding parks are to be undertaken.	31-Mar-27
Provincial Land Transfers <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-07; no Action alignment There are several longstanding municipal parks that are on lands that are owned by the province. Some of these are now being considered for transfer to the municipality, with some parks expected to be divested and transferred in 2025/26 and others expected in 2026/27. Other municipal parks where there may continue to be a shared municipal-provincial interest are to be the subject of ongoing discussions.	31-Mar-27
Sandy Lake Regional Park <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Design</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-07; no Action alignment The municipality has an ongoing multi-year project to further plan for and develop Sandy Lake Regional Park. This is a multi-year project, with an update report to Regional Council that is expected in 2026/27.	30-Jun-26
RA-01 Preserve and strengthen the municipality's financial position to meet current and future needs and obligations.	
Recreation User Fee Review - Administrative Order 2019-010-ADM and Bylaw U-100 <i>Service Area: Regional Recreation Services</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-01; no Action alignment Conduct jurisdictional scans on fee structures and user fees in recreation service areas. Complete a comprehensive cost recovery analysis based on findings and develop a revised fee structure and tables. Prepare a report with recommendations to Halifax Regional Council.	31-Mar-28
RA-02 Monitor, maintain, and replace municipal assets to establish and ensure service levels.	
Lifecycle Review for Playing Fields <i>Service Area: Parks</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-02; no Action alignment Review municipal playing fields against lifecycle replacement standards of 15 years for all weather and 25-30 years for grass.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
RA-04 Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency, and cost effectiveness, while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.	
Tracking Parks & Recreation Strategic Plans <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action alignment Develop and maintain a systematic approach to monitor the progress and implementation of Parks & Recreation strategic plans including a formal reporting schedule.	31-Mar-27
Comprehensive Governance Review of Multi-District Facilities <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action alignment Review the governance of municipally owned Multi-District Facilities (MDFs) to ensure the current model effectively meets the evolving recreational needs of our growing and changing population and is modern, accountable, and adaptable.	31-Mar-27
Recreation Framework <i>Service Area: Recreation Programming</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action alignment Scope a Recreation Framework.	31-Mar-27
RA-06 Foster collaborative relationships with other levels of government and partners.	
Enhanced Compliance Oversight for HRM Partnership Agreements <i>Service Area: Regional Recreation Services</i> Action Plan Reference: RA-06-A2 Implement improved compliance monitoring procedures for HRM Partnership Agreements, including a standardized annual review, to ensure partners meet contractual obligations, performance standards, and reporting requirements.	31-Mar-27

MULTI-DISTRICT FACILITIES / VOLUNTEER BOARDS

2026/27 FINANCIAL SUMMARY

Facility	Previous Subsidy FY25/26	Budgeted Expenditures	Budgeted Revenues	Surplus / Deficit	Requested Subsidy FY26/27	Additional Net New Funds	Recommended Change to Subsidy FY26/27
Alderney Landing	\$731,750*	\$2,775,750	\$2,044,000	\$(731,750)	\$731,750	\$0	\$0
Canada Games Centre	\$0	\$6,787,919	\$6,824,351	\$36,432	\$0	\$0	\$0
Centennial Pool	\$292,000	\$843,900	\$546,000	\$(297,900)	\$297,900	\$5,900	\$0
Cole Harbour Place	\$782,662	\$4,782,809	\$4,024,626	\$(758,183)	\$758,183	\$(24,479)	\$(12,240)
Halifax Forum	\$186,581	\$5,076,640	\$4,825,403	\$(251,237)	\$251,237	\$64,656	\$12,240
St. Margaret's Centre	\$427,350	\$2,241,000	\$1,784,000	\$(457,000)	\$457,000	\$29,650	\$0
Zatzman Sportsplex	\$744,330	\$4,981,524	\$4,197,135	\$(784,389)	\$784,389	\$40,059	\$0
TOTALS	\$3,164,673	\$27,489,542	\$24,245,515	\$(3,244,027)	\$3,280,459	\$115,786	\$0

* Includes Geothermal subsidy

Funding of \$3,164,673 is available within Parks & Recreation 2026/27 budget envelope to provide requested subsidies at the same level as 2025/26. Additional funding required to match the net increase in overall subsidy being requested is not included in the current proposed Parks & Recreation budget.

SUBSIDY REQUEST

All Multi-District Facilities (MDF) have requested subsidy funding in 2026/27, except for Canada Games Centre. The total subsidy request is \$3,280,459 representing an increase of \$115,786 over the approved 2025/26 subsidy of \$3,164,673. Alderney Landing and Cole Harbour Place made budget adjustments to reduce or maintain prior year subsidy level.

The subsidies are typically provided to the MDF facilities in quarterly installments, so if revenue recovery exceeds expectations, some of the subsidy may not be required. Further, if revenue exceeds expenses resulting in a year end surplus, it would be transferred to the capital reserve and would reduce future facility recapitalization costs.

FUNDING IMPACT

The consistent message from all MDFs is that a lack of funding could mean that they may:

- Incur potential difficulties paying facility operations and maintenance costs;
- Face staff retention and recruitment challenges;
- Defer annual and preventative maintenance;
- Reduce building and staffing hours;
- Reduce programing and building operating hours;
- Delay purchasing operational equipment; and,
- Increase membership and program fees.

As noted, the MDF management agreements require that the facilities submit budgets and business plans pursuant to Regional Council direction. The following pages include the business plans prepared by each facility and outline their respective programs and services.

ALDERNEY LANDING FACILITY ASSOCIATION

MISSION

Alderney Landing is a vital culture and community gathering place that brings together the public with local artists, performers, farmers, and vendors.

FACILITY ASSETS AND SERVICES

For more information please visit: <https://alderneylanding.com>

Facility Assets and Services	Offered
Community Programs	✓
Inclusion & Access Programs	✓
Rental Spaces	✓
Theatre / Cultural Arts Programming	✓
Events & Festivals	✓
Farmers Market / Vendor Market	✓
Economic Development / Local Business Support	✓

TOP DELIVERABLES

1. Implement the tactics under our Strategic Plan for AL, Theatre, Market, Gallery, and Events, that demonstrates our commitment to diversity and inclusion.
2. Deliver an increase in large scale events, benefiting the residents of the region.
3. Build and maintain strong relationships with key partners that support Alderney's mandate in planning for necessary facility rejuvenation in conjunction with the municipality's Open Space Plan.

2026/27 OPERATING BUDGET

Expenditures	
Wages and event staff	\$983,000
Snow clearing and parking supplies	\$60,000
Art Gallery	\$10,500
Brand communication cultural programming	\$45,000
Tent install/dismantle, cleaning, storage	\$15,500
Bar & Catering	\$46,000
Events, Cultural programming	\$690,000
CPP EI WCB Health	\$107,000
Building maintenance	\$117,800
HRM Geothermal	\$40,000
Events supplies and equipment	\$136,750
Garbage removal, building service, and equipment	\$51,000
SOCAN, licenses, fees, ATM, security, linen	\$8,000
Utilities, power, telephones	\$124,000
Interest, bank, ATM, Prof fees, & dev	\$44,000
Property tax and amortization	\$45,000
Security Requirements	\$102,200
Extra Duty Policing	\$150,000
Total Expenditures	\$2,775,750
Revenues	
Cultural Events programming	\$830,000
Events Plaza Parking	\$365,000
Farmers and Cultural Market Vendors	\$414,000
Theatre level	\$319,000
Cultural Grants	\$65,000
Visual Arts & ATM	\$51,000
Total Revenues	\$2,044,000
HRM Subsidy Requested (incl. \$102,200 for facility security, \$40,000 internal HRM Geothermal, \$150,000 extra duty police officers)	\$731,750
Total	\$2,775,750
Net Surplus/Deficit	\$0

SUBSIDY REQUEST

Factors that have influenced the financial position of Alderney Landing requesting the same level of support as 2024 and 2025 include:

- The total subsidy request includes \$102,200 to provide security personnel for the ALFA managed areas of the Alderney Landing facility due to increasing liability and risk management issues resulting from the significant amount of transit and people at risk that frequent the facility.
- The total subsidy includes the internal municipality expense of \$40,000 Geothermal.
- Increasing facility operational expenses including utilities and building maintenance, due to aging equipment and infrastructure.
- Increase in wages due to legislated provincial minimum wage increases.
- Require \$150,00 in Extra Deputy Police Officers. Previously five to six incidents a day, extra Deputy hired resulted in 1 to 3 incidents per week.

The budget includes an increase in all revenue streams including theatre, market area operations, and events and programming to help reduce the requirement for additional municipal subsidy funding.

These circumstances have necessitated the request of a subsidy in 2026/27 of \$731,750.00, same as in 2025/26.

FUNDING IMPACT

Lack of funding for the facility could mean:

- Inability to offer full range of event and program offerings.
- Inability to meet payroll obligations; and
- Difficulty in covering facility operational costs.

CANADA GAMES CENTRE

MISSION

The Canada Games Centre (CGC) is committed to the promotion of healthy active living. The CGC provides opportunities and access for sport and recreation at all levels. Driven by passion, leadership, and teamwork, the CGC provides innovative programming and exceptional experiences.

FACILITY ASSETS AND SERVICES

For more information about services offered, please visit: <https://canadagamescentre.ca>

Facility Assets and Services	Offered
Community Programs	✓
Inclusion & Access Programs	✓
Fitness & Wellness Programs	✓
Aquatics Programs	✓
Rental Spaces	✓
Economic Development / Local Business Support	✓

TOP DELIVERABLES

1. Completion of changeroom renovations.
2. Improve space utilization to expand program availability.
3. Increased aquatic leadership/training courses.
4. Expand community outreach initiatives and opportunities.

2026/27 OPERATING BUDGET

Expenditures	
Wages & Benefits	\$3,594,898
Program Expenses	\$1,463,867
Housekeeping & Security (cleaning supplies)	\$89,200
Marketing (website, signage, print materials, promotions, merchandise)	\$137,862
Utilities (Electricity, water, natural gas)	\$852,296
Operations (Pool chemicals, Contracted Services, Maintenance)	\$412,996
Administration (Legal, IT, Banking, Stationary, Accounting, Postage)	\$236,800
Total Expenditures	\$6,787,919
Revenues	
Membership & Day Passes	\$4,708,000
Facility Rentals (Pool, Track, Fieldhouse, community rooms)	\$395,821
Recreation Programming (Aquatics, Recreation, Fitness)	\$1,337,284
Commercial Leasing (Lifemark, Subway and Canadian Sport Institute)	\$303,960
Miscellaneous Revenue (Grants, Parking, Food Services, Donations, Advertising)	\$79,286
Total Revenues	\$6,824,351
HRM Subsidy Requested	\$0
Total	\$6,824,351
Net Surplus/Deficit	\$36,432

SUBSIDY REQUEST

No subsidy requested.

FUNDING IMPACT

None.

CENTENNIAL POOL

MISSION

The Centennial Pool Association provides the community and amateur athletes with access to high-quality aquatic training in a safe, well-managed facility. As Nova Scotia's provincial aquatics training center, we offer inclusive programs that support athletic development, wellness, and community engagement.

FACILITY ASSETS AND SERVICES

For more information about services offered, please visit: <https://centennialpool.ca>

Facility Assets and Services	Offered
Community Programs	✓
Inclusion & Access Programs	✓
Fitness & Wellness Programs	✓
Aquatics Programs	✓
Rental Spaces	✓
Events & Festivals	✓

TOP DELIVERABLES

1. Marketing, Community Partnerships & Diversity

We will expand outreach by building local partnerships, promoting water safety, and increasing visibility. Our goal is to foster a welcoming, inclusive, and connected aquatic environment that motivates individuals to maintain healthy lifestyles.

2. Swim Programs

We will continue supporting amateur sport clubs across all aquatic disciplines while expanding adult swim lessons and school-based water safety programs such as Swim to Survive. We also intend to strengthen partnerships with non-profit and Indigenous organizations.

3. Multipurpose Room Programming

We will introduce new programs in our multipurpose room, including:

- Fitness and yoga classes
- Lifesaving Society certification courses

2026/27 OPERATING BUDGET

Expenditures	
Salaries & Benefits	\$448,900
Program expenses	\$11,000
Housekeeping & Security	\$94,000
Marketing and Events	\$15,000
Administration (Legal, IT, Banking, Stationary, Accounting, Postage)	\$20,000
Utilities	\$220,000
Operations (Pool Chemicals, Contracted Services, Maintenance)	\$35,000
Total Expenditures	\$843,900
Revenues	
Memberships & Day Passes	\$85,000
Other Facility Rentals	\$312,000
Programming	\$24,000
Misc Revenue (Grants, Parking, Food Services, Donations Advertising)	\$125,000
Total Revenues	\$546,000
HRM Subsidy Requested	\$297,900
Total	\$843,900
Net Surplus/Deficit	\$0

SUBSIDY REQUEST

Factors that have influenced the financial position of the Centennial Pool Association include:

- Rising utility costs, particularly electricity.
- Wage pressures tied to minimum wage increases and competitive staffing needs.
- Inflation affecting goods, services and maintenance.
- Requirements to maintain a safe, high-quality training environments.
- Contract renewals in 2026/27 that may increase costs.

FUNDING IMPACT

If adequate funding is not secured, the following impacts are likely:

- Challenges meeting payroll
- Ongoing staffing shortages and retention issues
- Reduced operational capacity
- Inability to maintain equipment and safety standards
- Reduced availability for community groups and sport organizations

COLE HARBOUR PLACE

MISSION

To fulfill the recreational, cultural, and wellness needs of the community, while creating a legacy for families and inspiring leaders of tomorrow. Cole Harbour Place (CHP) is the heart of the community, inspiring and enabling physical, mental, and social well-being.

FACILITY ASSETS AND SERVICES

For more information about services offered, please visit: <https://coleharbourplace.ca>

Facility Assets and Services	Offered
Community Programs	✓
Inclusion & Access Programs	✓
Fitness & Wellness Programs	✓
Aquatics Programs	✓
Arena / Ice Programs	✓
Rental Spaces	✓
Theatre / Cultural Arts Programming	✓
Events & Festivals	✓

TOP DELIVERABLES

1. Increase Membership Growth and Retention.

Focus on rebuilding membership levels following the mandatory transition to the new Xplor system, during which all memberships were administratively cancelled and had to be manually re-established. This required migration resulted in significant member loss and affected both membership numbers and reported revenue. Moving forward, targeted promotions and data-driven insights will be used to strengthen retention and attract new members as reporting stabilizes under the new platform.

2. Ensure a Safe Environment for all Staff and Customers.

Maintain and enhance safety standards throughout the facility by strengthening incident-prevention measures, improving staff training and emergency preparedness, and ensuring consistent enforcement of policies and procedures. This goal supports a secure, welcoming

environment where both staff and patrons can confidently participate in all programs and services.

3. Advance Capital Renewal in Collaboration with HRM.

Continue working in partnership with Halifax Regional Municipality to achieve critical capital improvements for the aging facility. Focus on projects that enhance accessibility, energy efficiency, sustainability, and user experience, ensuring CHP remains a safe, modern, and welcoming community hub for years to come.

2026/27 OPERATING BUDGET

Expenditures	
Salaries & Benefits	\$3,001,436
Program Expenses	\$32,850
Housekeeping & Security	\$230,489
Marketing and Events	\$300
Administration (Legal, IT, Banking, Stationary, Accounting, Postage)	\$301,684
Utilities	\$824,950
Operations (Pool Chemicals, Contracted Services, Maintenance)	\$391,100
Total Expenditures	\$4,782,809
Revenues	
Memberships and Day Passes	\$733,500
Arena Rentals	\$1,285,390
Other Facility Rentals	\$190,579
Programming	\$573,455
Leasing	\$638,324
Affordable Access	\$476,222
Misc Revenue (Grants, Parking, Food Services, Donations, Advertising)	\$127,156
Total Revenues	\$4,024,626
HRM Subsidy Requested	\$758,183
Total	\$4,782,809
Net Surplus/Deficit	\$0

SUBSIDY REQUEST

Factors that have influenced the financial position of CHP include:

1. **Loss of Rental Revenue.** A space that was previously leased by the province, which would generate \$214,025 in revenue annually, has been acquired by HRM Recreation. This revenue stream will no longer be available in the upcoming fiscal year.
2. **Rising Operating Costs.** Increasing utility and equipment costs have added pressure to the facility's operating budget.
3. **Aging Infrastructure.** The facility requires substantial capital investments to address aging infrastructure to ensure it remains in good repair, fully functional, and safe for all users.
4. **HRM Recreation.** HRM Recreation's presence in the same facility offering similar programming at lower cost directly may affect registration levels and associated revenues.
5. **Rising Minimum Wage.** Large increases in minimum wage rates have further escalated staffing expenses.

Cole Harbour Place is requesting a subsidy of \$758,183 for the 2026/2027 fiscal year, representing a decrease of \$24,479 from the previous year.

FUNDING IMPACT

If adequate funding is not secured, the following impacts are likely:

1. **Payroll Challenges.** Inability to meet payroll obligations, jeopardizing staffing and operations.
2. **Increased Costs to Users.** Significant increases in programming fees, limiting accessibility for community members.
3. **Deferred Maintenance.** Postponing essential annual maintenance, which could compromise safety and operational standards.
4. **Recruitment and Retention Issues.** Continued difficulties in attracting and retaining qualified staff.
5. **Operational Strains.** Challenges in covering operational and maintenance costs for the facility.
6. **Reduced Hours and Services.** Potential reductions in facility operating hours, programming, and customer service, negatively impacting the community.

HALIFAX FORUM

MISSION

The Halifax Forum Community Association (HFCA) is committed to providing an innovative and quality facility for a diverse cross-section of recreation, entertainment, arts, business, cultural, and community-based events. It provides facilities that are fun, safe, and versatile, which enables it to create opportunities for children, adults, and seniors through individual, group, and team activities. The Halifax Forum is a vital community partner for the residents of the municipality and is committed to being financially responsible and efficiently managed.

FACILITY ASSETS AND SERVICES

For more information about services offered, please visit: <https://halifaxforum.ca>

Facility Assets and Services	Offered
Community Programs	✓
Inclusion & Access Programs	✓
Arena / Ice Programs	✓
Rental Spaces	✓
Theatre / Cultural Arts Programming	✓
Events & Festivals	✓
Farmers Market / Vendor Market	✓

TOP DELIVERABLES

1. Our top priority is ensuring public safety and maintaining program service levels between now and the beginning of the redevelopment construction (projected to be the spring of 2027). This includes addressing any potential safety concerns related to the facility, including the impacts of the aging infrastructure, as well as ensuring a secure environment for both shelter residents and the public using the Forum complex.
2. Continue to strive to maintain the best financial performance possible given;
 - the strong likelihood of unplanned facility closures to the facility's aging infrastructure
 - the Multipurpose Center secondment as a shelter has been extended to the end of August 2026 and,

- the impact of the impending closure during redevelopment will have on facility rentals and financial performance.
3. Play a direct and active role in collaborating with Municipal staff and stakeholders as the redevelopment of the Halifax Forum moves from the building and design phase to the pre-construction phase.

2026/27 OPERATING BUDGET

Expenditures	
Salaries & Benefits	\$1,818,315
Service Expenses (Social Nights, Events)	\$2,007,356
Utilities	\$697,969
Administration (Legal, IT, Banking, Stationary, Accounting, Postage)	\$28,000
Operations (Contracted Services, Maintenance, Vehicle, Sanitary)	\$525,000
Total Expenditures	\$5,076,640
Revenues	
Social Nights (Bingo)	\$3,126,987
Parking	\$60,000
Arenas	\$1,168,416
Facility Rentals	\$350,000
Other Revenue (Concessions, Advertising, ATM)	\$120,000
Total Revenues	\$4,825,403
HRM Subsidy Requested	\$251,237
Total	\$5,076,640
Net Surplus/Deficit	\$0

SUBSIDY REQUEST

Factors that have influenced the financial position of the Halifax Forum include:

- Aging infrastructure and the MPC being converted to a homeless shelter
- Ice Rates have been increased but non-prime hours used will be reduced with the loss of both Men's and Women's Dalhousie varsity hockey teams, as they transition to the new Dalhousie arena.

FUNDING IMPACT

If adequate funding is not secured, the following impacts are likely:

- Unplanned facility closures, increased issues with Health and Safety, limiting access to non-profit groups in favour of for-profit

ST. MARGARET'S CENTRE

MISSION

St. Margaret's Centre is dedicated to the community. The Centre evolved from the grassroots of the community and will continue to evolve to serve. It is committed to providing quality programming at an affordable price in a great recreational setting to the community. The heart of St. Margaret's is in the Centre.

FACILITY ASSETS AND SERVICES

For more information about services offered, please visit: <http://www.stmargaretscentre.ca/>

Facility Assets and Services	Offered
Community Programs	✓
Inclusion & Access Programs	✓
Rental Spaces	✓
Theatre / Cultural Arts Programming	✓
Farmers Market / Vendor Market	✓
Economic Development / Local Business Support	✓

TOP DELIVERABLES

1. Quality ice and great gym experiences with a wide scope of programs offered.
2. Health and wellness fitness initiatives for family and individuals.
3. Development of new programs to fit the need of changing populations.
4. Increase in meeting room, multi-purpose room and gymnasium rental rates.

2026/27 OPERATING BUDGET

Expenditures	
Salaries and Benefits	\$1,274,436
Program expenses	\$29,000
Housekeeping and Security	\$31,000
Marketing and Events	\$4,600
Administration (Legal, IT, Banking, Stationary, Accounting, Postage)	\$49,164
Utilities	\$508,000
Operations (Pool Chemicals, Contracted Services, Maintenance)	\$344,800
Total Expenditures	\$2,241,000
Revenues	
Memberships and Day Passes	\$32,000
Arena Rentals	\$1,140,000
Other Facility Rentals	\$220,500
Programming	\$295,000
HRM Affordable Access Programs	\$30,000
Misc Revenue (Grants, Parking, Food Services, Donations, Advertising)	\$66,500
Total Revenues	\$1,784,000
HRM Subsidy Requested	\$457,000
Total	\$2,241,000
Net Surplus/Deficit	\$0

Notes to Operating Budget:

- 2% increase in Wages
- Increase in rates for Meeting Room, Multi-purpose room and gymnasium rentals

SUBSIDY REQUEST

Factors that are influencing the financial position of this facility include:

1. Increase in expenses.
2. Increase in electricity expenses due to market price increasing (NS Power).
3. Increase in furnace oil expenses due to the market price increasing.
4. Increase in building maintenance expenses due to an aging building; many areas of the older parts of the building's infrastructure date from 1988 to the early 1990's.
5. Increase in arena ice plant maintenance operating costs as the plant must meet rising standards and be following all provincial inspections.

6. Increase in wages due to provincial minimum wage increases. Also, attracting new staff and retaining staff is an important part of today's workplace success.
7. Increase in Camp Westwood day camp expenses due to rising prices of supplies for camp and needed changes to the camp programming to attract and keep the customer base.

Decrease in revenue:

1. Camp Westwood revenues were down considerably because St. Margaret's Centre was not included in HRM's Affordable Access Program (AAP), therefore many customers went to other venues where AAP access was offered.
2. In addition to some declining revenues, St. Margaret's Centre continues to prioritize maintaining reasonable pricing on programming as to maximize participation of the community wherever it can.

To maintain our services in an aging building we are asking for a higher subsidy than last year, but less than the subsidy we received in the 2023/24 year end.

FUNDING IMPACT

If adequate funding is not secured, the following impacts are likely:

1. Lack of funding could mean St. Margaret's Centre would not be able to offer quality programs at an affordable price to the community.
2. The Centre would be reactive and instead of undertaking timely preventative maintenance, only broken-down equipment would be repaired. This approach could lead to more emergency situations when major malfunctions or equipment failures occur.
3. Less day-to-day essential services to the customers that use the facility. Cleaning, maintenance, and building appearance will suffer.
4. Future projects in programming and facility updates, as well as accessibility, will be put on hold as St. Margaret's Centre will simply not have adequate funds.

ZATZMAN SPORTSPLEX

MISSION

Great communities have citizens who are healthy in body, mind, and spirit. The Zatzman Sportsplex provides sport, recreation, and social gathering opportunities supporting individuals, families, and groups to realize their full potential and contribute to the development of a prosperous, diverse, inclusive, and healthy community.

FACILITY ASSETS AND SERVICES

For more information about services offered, please visit: <https://zatzmansportsplex.com>

Facility Assets and Services	Offered
Community Programs	✓
Inclusion & Access Programs	✓
Fitness & Wellness Programs	✓
Aquatics Programs	✓
Arena / Ice Programs	✓
Rental Spaces	✓
Theatre / Cultural Arts Programming	✓
Events & Festivals	✓

TOP DELIVERABLES

1. Departmental reviews in Athletic, Aquatics and Operations to identify efficiencies to help mitigate rising costs to deliver services.
2. Implementation of key deliverables from the new 2026-2030 Strategic Plan
3. Foster strong alliance with HRM to deliver on the Affordable Access Program to ensure program success.

2026/27 OPERATING BUDGET

Expenditures	
Salaries and Benefits	\$3,334,845
Program expenses	\$130,607
Housekeeping and Security	\$293,980
Marketing and Events	\$58,050
Administration (Legal, IT, Banking, Stationary, Accounting, Postage)	\$87,150
Utilities	\$939,700
Operations (Pool Chemicals, Contracted Services, Maintenance)	\$137,192
Total Expenditures	\$4,981,524
Revenues	
Memberships and Day Passes	\$1,600,675
Arena Rentals	\$665,700
Other Facility Rentals	\$178,460
Programming	\$1,106,400
Leasing	\$11,400
HRM Affordable Access (programs and memberships)	\$195,000
Misc Revenue (Grants, Parking, Food Services, Donations, Advertising)	\$439,500
Total Revenues	\$4,197,135
HRM Subsidy Requested	\$784,389
Total	\$4,981,524
Net Surplus/Deficit	\$0

SUBSIDY REQUEST

Factors that have influenced the financial position of this facility include:

1. Pool and arena operational models are deficit-based but remain a necessary community service.
2. Increasing utility costs due to inflation.
3. Uncertainty of the Affordable Access Program implementation may result in additional wear and tear on infrastructure, increasing repair and maintenance expenses. Potential to deter regular paying members from continuing due to increased facility usage.

FUNDING IMPACT

If adequate funding is not secured, the following impacts are likely:

1. The facility would be unable to meet payroll obligations.
2. Eliminate all free community access programming including free track access.
3. Defer regular and preventive maintenance.
4. Larger increases in membership and program fees.

Summary of Net Expenditures - Parks & Recreation

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
W707 Culture & Community	1,258,648	1,464,600	1,349,800	1,594,500	129,900	8.9
C414 Stra Plan & Des Adm	243,814	324,600	270,500	310,400	(14,200)	(4.4)
W700 Policy & Planning	963,357	1,178,900	1,197,300	1,322,900	144,000	12.2
W954 Parks Capital Projects	872,073	954,000	957,700	1,028,100	74,100	7.8
**** Strategic Planning and Design	3,337,892	3,922,100	3,775,300	4,255,900	333,800	8.5
C410 Director's Office	455,362	473,400	543,100	571,500	98,100	20.7
C888 LCD NAIG P-R	-	-	-	-	-	-
**** Parks & Recreation Administra	455,362	473,400	543,100	571,500	98,100	20.7
R851 Horticulture East	759,317	992,200	1,013,900	971,800	(20,400)	(2.1)
W180 Trials & Open Spaces	789,993	1,237,500	1,141,700	1,049,000	(188,500)	(15.2)
W181 Parks East Admin	302,803	364,200	374,000	424,200	60,000	16.5
W182 Sportsfields East	1,400,469	1,769,500	1,891,100	1,885,500	116,000	6.6
W183 Playgrounds Central	744,022	766,000	1,017,000	875,500	109,500	14.3
W185 Sportsfields - Central	1,335,667	1,273,000	1,355,800	1,242,000	(31,000)	(2.4)
W187 Artificial Fields	511,421	456,000	599,700	601,000	145,000	31.8
W191 Cntrcts-Grass/Hort	3,296,162	3,516,900	3,462,000	3,794,700	277,800	7.9
*** Parks East	9,139,855	10,375,300	10,855,200	10,843,700	468,400	4.5
R831 Parks West Admin	442,219	355,000	530,300	488,600	133,600	37.6
R850 Horticulture West	1,588,989	2,092,750	1,603,100	1,272,500	(820,250)	(39.2)
R855 Cemeteries	(19,355)	(37,100)	(237,600)	(82,900)	(45,800)	123.5
R860 Major Parks	707,512	823,300	827,800	771,400	(51,900)	(6.3)
W184 Playgrounds West	816,095	829,600	928,900	821,400	(8,200)	(1.0)
W186 Sportsfields West	2,304,385	1,685,400	1,908,500	1,778,300	92,900	5.5
W193 Trails & Op. Sp Mtce	888,438	945,100	1,045,100	974,900	29,800	3.2
W194 PG Major Hort Assets	-	51,050	663,000	975,800	924,750	1,811.5
*** Parks West	6,728,282	6,745,100	7,269,100	7,000,000	254,900	3.8
W702 Parks Administration	(542,628)	(451,000)	(716,900)	(666,100)	(215,100)	47.7
W705 State of Good Repair	2,496,497	1,309,800	1,325,800	1,371,100	61,300	4.7
W706 Asset Ctrl & Svc Del	860,738	1,010,300	841,400	866,400	(143,900)	(14.2)
**** Parks	18,682,745	18,989,500	19,574,600	19,415,100	425,600	2.2
D850 Inclusion Services	583,247	797,400	593,500	653,300	(144,100)	(18.1)
D101 Rec. Prog. Admin.	381,025	1,732,900	1,897,500	1,812,200	79,300	4.6
D999 LCD Clearing Acc Rec	-	-	-	-	-	-
*** Recreation Services	964,272	2,530,300	2,491,000	2,465,500	(64,800)	(2.6)
D175 CWSCC PR AQ FC	655,996	847,200	564,400	698,900	(148,300)	(17.5)
D320 Bedford Outdoor Pool	28,596	(37,800)	79,100	(71,300)	(33,500)	88.6
D540 Beaches	512,386	470,000	666,300	557,700	87,700	18.7
D545 Halifax Commons Pool	334,465	390,495	476,400	386,000	(4,495)	(1.2)
D570 Needham Pool	303,340	284,600	236,900	280,700	(3,900)	(1.4)
D640 Colby Vill Otdr Pool	40,298	46,400	70,800	12,000	(34,400)	(74.1)
** Aquatics & Leisure	1,875,082	2,000,895	2,093,900	1,864,000	(136,895)	(6.8)
D180 Herring Cove Program	511	-	-	-	-	-
*** Aquatics,Leisure,Active Livin	1,875,592	2,000,895	2,093,900	1,864,000	(136,895)	(6.8)
CAFE SS Youth Worx Cafe	89,135	39,400	80,800	14,400	(25,000)	(63.5)
S210 Youth Worx Program	316,132	269,700	350,500	177,600	(92,100)	(34.1)
S231 LKD-947 Mitchell	-	-	-	-	-	-
S232 1300 Youth Worx Faci	1,011	2,500	2,500	2,500	-	-
S233 Youth Worx Operations	739,632	932,600	862,500	1,033,100	100,500	10.8
** Youth Worx Operation	1,145,909	1,244,200	1,296,300	1,227,600	(16,600)	(1.3)
D160 AEC Fleming & SMBC	296,929	188,750	274,650	540,750	352,000	186.5
C761 Youth Power House	280,936	353,100	296,500	363,100	10,000	2.8
C762 Youth Advocate Program	101	1,274,400	1,137,400	1,666,000	391,600	30.7
D755 AEC Shubie & Overnig	727,696	861,350	631,350	720,250	(141,100)	(16.4)
*** Youth Programming	2,451,572	3,921,800	3,636,200	4,517,700	595,900	15.2
C175 Hubbards Programming	18,662	32,900	12,700	32,900	-	-
D155 Chocolate Lk Program	220,394	430,700	177,100	438,500	7,800	1.8
D210 Lakeside Programming	596,893	479,400	624,700	476,600	(2,800)	(0.6)
D215 CWSCC Dryland	77,810	117,500	68,400	252,600	135,100	115.0
D580 St Andrews Programming	132,287	1,700	2,000	(12,200)	(13,900)	(817.7)
*** Mainland North & Western	1,046,046	1,062,200	884,900	1,188,400	126,200	11.9
D310 Gordon Snow Programm	252,259	239,800	234,100	240,200	400	0.2
D315 Acadia Programming	402,372	426,500	542,400	500,200	73,700	17.3
D325 Lebrun Programming	302,734	759,000	326,100	791,100	32,100	4.2

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
D330 Mid. Musq. Program	47,680	24,800	39,600	25,300	500	2.0
D350 Bdld/Hmdplns CommCtr	170,093	121,400	47,100	13,300	(108,100)	(89.0)
*** Bedford/Sackville/Fall River	1,175,139	1,571,500	1,189,300	1,570,100	(1,400)	(0.1)
D172 NPCC Programming	368,891	425,100	326,600	380,900	(44,200)	(10.4)
D410 Musq Harbour Prog/FC	364,080	465,900	422,700	332,700	(133,200)	(28.6)
D430 Sheet Hbr.Prog/FC	265,009	206,300	276,700	209,400	3,100	1.5
D620 Cherrybrk/LkEcho Pro	1,087	2,100	1,500	-	(2,100)	(100.0)
D630 Cole Hbr Programming	515,254	538,500	690,100	609,800	71,300	13.2
D810 Findlay Programming	210,511	874,500	185,800	863,700	(10,800)	(1.2)
D815 Dart North Com Ctr.	419,697	391,800	340,900	333,900	(57,900)	(14.8)
D825 Horizon Program	459,755	400,500	411,200	397,800	(2,700)	(0.7)
*** Cole Harbour/Dartmouth & East	2,604,284	3,304,700	2,655,500	3,128,200	(176,500)	(5.3)
C471 Emera Oval	528,756	870,500	508,600	566,800	(303,700)	(34.9)
D510 Needham Programming	560,556	507,600	537,700	502,800	(4,800)	(0.9)
D550 G. Dixon Programming	275,913	143,700	265,400	94,600	(49,100)	(34.2)
D555 Isleville Programming	(17,440)	(5,600)	(9,100)	(5,600)	-	-
D565 The Pavilion/HFX Com	10,577	(27,500)	(5,100)	(29,500)	(2,000)	7.3
D575 Larry O'Connell Prog	(12,647)	5,100	700	5,100	-	-
D590 Citadel Programming	228,526	121,700	218,100	111,800	(9,900)	(8.1)
*** Peninsula	1,574,241	1,615,500	1,516,300	1,246,000	(369,500)	(22.9)
ADMN SSS - Administration	34,512	171,600	171,200	208,200	36,600	21.3
ATHL SSS-Athletics	211,620	27,200	87,500	(69,400)	(96,600)	(355.1)
ICEX SSS - Ice	(443,778)	(472,100)	(477,000)	(502,700)	(30,600)	6.5
MEMB SSS - Memberships	(52,608)	(134,300)	(120,300)	(157,000)	(22,700)	16.9
POOL SSS - Pool	328,413	251,200	305,400	257,700	6,500	2.6
*** Sackville Sports Stadium	78,159	(156,400)	(33,200)	(263,200)	(106,800)	68.3
**** Recreation Programming	11,769,305	15,850,495	14,433,900	15,716,700	(133,795)	(0.8)
C413 Business Services	735,571	773,000	785,600	906,400	133,400	17.3
C705 Community Partnerships	5,578,862	5,288,475	6,721,900	5,333,670	45,195	0.9
C711 Discover Halifax	1,644,348	728,500	1,446,400	1,376,500	648,000	88.9
C721 Wanderers Grounds	-	-	1,451,000	185,000	185,000	-
C760 Events	2,764,548	1,758,000	1,849,600	1,893,800	135,800	7.7
C772 Events _Grants/MLSER	-	17,000	-	-	(17,000)	(100.0)
D710 Regional Rec ServAdm	413,363	209,900	590,000	1,519,600	1,309,700	624.0
D911 Sport & Scheduling	927,539	1,025,300	1,040,200	1,055,600	30,300	3.0
*** Operations	12,064,231	9,800,175	13,884,700	12,270,570	2,470,395	25.2
D970 LeBrun Arena	(297,664)	(281,200)	(283,000)	(298,200)	(17,000)	6.0
D980 Gray Arena	(31,458)	(18,900)	(69,000)	(17,500)	1,400	(7.4)
*** Arenas	(329,122)	(300,100)	(352,000)	(315,700)	(15,600)	5.2
C706 Greenfoot Energy Centre	48,534	(42,270)	101,600	(180,770)	(138,500)	327.7
C708 RBC Centre	216,542	(93,000)	74,900	(246,300)	(153,300)	164.8
C709 FOA Sub-leases	17,530	-	-	-	-	-
C910 LTMV Tax Account	-	-	-	-	-	-
*** Facilities	282,606	(135,270)	176,500	(427,070)	(291,800)	215.7
C290 Springfield Lake Rec	939	-	-	-	-	-
*** Area Services	939	-	-	-	-	-
C125 Beaver Bank Com. Ctr	46,543	48,000	48,000	48,000	-	-
*** Mun. Rec. Facil-General Rate	46,543	48,000	48,000	48,000	-	-
**** Regional Recreation	12,065,196	9,412,805	13,757,200	11,575,800	2,162,995	23.0
***** Net Total	46,310,501	48,648,300	52,084,099	51,535,000	2,886,700	5.9

Summary of Expenditures Details - Parks & Recreation

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	18,361,831	21,934,300	19,718,200	22,753,200	818,900	3.7
6002 Salaries - Overtime	848,231	675,600	680,800	675,600	-	-
6003 Wages - Regular	11,626,143	10,899,295	11,684,800	11,383,800	484,505	4.4
6004 Wages - Overtime	32,825	-	17,500	-	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(1,978,525)	-	(254,200)	-	-	-
6051 Shift Agreements	445	-	-	-	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	22,185	-	22,500	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	4,192,945	4,523,900	4,354,500	4,813,800	289,900	6.4
6101 Benefits - Wages	693,070	591,700	751,000	601,600	9,900	1.7

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(1,995,800)	-	(1,995,800)	-	-
6150 Honorariums	11,225	15,900	19,100	15,900	-	-
6152 Retirement Incentives	121,844	152,100	138,000	153,700	1,600	1.1
6154 Workers' Compensation	939,220	832,100	1,167,500	816,800	(15,300)	(1.8)
6155 Overtime Meals	1,106	500	500	500	-	-
6157 stipends	166,421	300,000	212,300	300,000	-	-
6158 WCB Recov Earnings	(386)	-	-	-	-	-
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	(635,045)	694,300	421,800	17,200	(677,100)	(97.5)
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	(332,294)	406,000	(139,400)	414,800	8,800	2.2
9210 HR CATS OT Wage/Ben	(575,402)	-	(183,100)	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	33,495,839	39,029,895	38,611,799	39,951,100	921,205	2.4
6201 Telephone/Cable	89,272	114,100	129,100	101,900	(12,200)	(10.7)
6202 Courier/Postage	28,638	56,400	39,700	56,200	(200)	(0.4)
6203 Office Furn/Equip	14,901	18,900	21,000	19,200	300	1.6
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	2,545	7,200	2,100	7,200	-	-
6205 Printing & Reprod	158	4,700	3,200	4,700	-	-
6206 Microfilms	-	-	100	-	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	170,334	151,500	162,600	154,300	2,800	1.8
6299 Other Office Expenses	151,012	155,900	145,800	155,700	(200)	(0.1)
* Office	456,860	508,700	503,600	499,200	(9,500)	(1.9)
6301 Professional Fees	12,391	800	7,500	100	(700)	(87.5)
6303 Consulting Fees	27,391	218,000	144,700	135,700	(82,300)	(37.8)
6304 Janitorial Services	42,769	134,000	86,000	134,000	-	-
6305 Property Appraisal	-	4,300	1,000	3,600	(700)	(16.3)
6308 Snow Removal	3,263	12,000	4,000	12,000	-	-
6309 Litigation Disburse	17	-	-	-	-	-
6311 Security	579,619	519,800	492,900	571,000	51,200	9.8
6312 Refuse Collection	139,700	91,600	148,400	91,600	-	-
6399 Contract Services	7,744,186	7,033,900	9,526,600	7,882,000	848,100	12.1
* External Services	8,549,335	8,014,400	10,411,100	8,830,000	815,600	10.2
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	104,140	109,200	98,900	109,200	-	-
6402 Med & First Aid Supp	12,595	15,800	20,950	15,750	(50)	(0.3)
6404 Rec Prog Supplies	357,125	314,200	368,700	353,700	39,500	12.6
6406 Bridge Tolls	5,994	200	-	200	-	-
6407 Clean/Sani Supplies	103,822	76,400	87,600	77,400	1,000	1.3
6409 Personal Protect Equ	111,686	120,100	150,500	126,000	5,900	4.9
6490 Supplies OCC Transfer	(10,000)	-	-	-	-	-
6499 Other Supplies	38,521	11,300	21,100	11,350	50	0.4
* Supplies	723,884	647,200	747,750	693,900	46,400	7.2
6501 Asphalt	658	2,000	2,000	1,500	(500)	(25.0)
6502 Chemicals	302	4,100	2,500	4,100	-	-
6503 Fertilizer	54,167	46,000	44,000	44,500	(1,500)	(3.3)
6504 Hardware	87,047	75,700	70,100	82,700	7,000	9.2
6505 Lubricants	1,948	300	3,300	300	-	-
6506 Lumber	69,632	80,400	64,500	80,400	-	-
6507 Propane	136	-	200	-	-	-
6508 Ready Mix Concrete	594	-	-	-	-	-
6511 Salt	7,345	1,800	4,500	1,800	-	-
6512 Sand	12,331	20,300	20,500	26,300	6,000	29.6
6513 Seeds & Plants	114,232	84,800	119,400	88,800	4,000	4.7
6514 Sodas	2,036	8,600	4,700	8,600	-	-
6515 Stone and Gravel	46,361	42,400	43,900	42,400	-	-
6516 Topsoil	109,211	97,800	75,000	97,800	-	-
6517 Paint	120,371	114,200	163,100	163,800	49,600	43.4
6518 Metal	-	-	400	-	-	-
6522 Greenhouse Materials	-	-	-	1,500	1,500	-
6599 Other Materials	16,823	9,400	46,200	9,400	-	-
* Materials	643,193	587,800	664,300	653,900	66,100	11.2
6602 Electrical	278,470	284,100	348,800	326,100	42,000	14.8
6603 Grnds & Landscaping	211	30,000	-	30,000	-	-
6605 Municipal Taxes	25,054	20,000	20,000	20,000	-	-
6606 Heating Fuel	7,960	18,000	-	18,000	-	-
6607 Electricity	1,888,767	1,676,600	1,910,600	1,676,600	-	-
6608 Water	182,107	171,700	169,000	171,700	-	-
6609 Elevator & Escalator	620	-	-	-	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6610 Building - Exterior	1,454	-	2,100	-	-	-
6611 Building - Interior	42,132	3,000	2,100	3,000	-	-
6612 Safety Systems	5,867	3,500	3,500	3,500	-	-
6615 Vandalism Clean-up	-	-	100	-	-	-
6617 Pest Management	27,942	102,400	7,200	102,400	-	-
6690 Building OCC Transfer	(42,700)	-	-	-	-	-
6699 Other Building Cost	766,937	548,300	701,000	548,300	-	-
* Building Costs	3,184,819	2,857,600	3,164,400	2,899,600	42,000	1.5
6701 Equipment Purchase	588,591	521,100	575,600	550,600	29,500	5.7
6702 Small Tools	66,719	59,400	63,900	59,400	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	1,902	-	300	-	-	-
6704 Equipment Rental	381,362	60,000	532,500	75,000	15,000	25.0
6705 Equip - R&M	31,579	24,200	33,200	26,700	2,500	10.3
6706 Computer R&M	155	-	-	-	-	-
6707 Plumbing & Heating	10,822	3,300	4,800	3,300	-	-
6708 Mechanical Equipment	460	1,000	-	1,000	-	-
6711 Communication System	130,591	109,300	107,200	109,300	-	-
6790 Equipment OCC Trsf	(50,000)	-	-	-	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	1,162,181	778,300	1,317,500	825,300	47,000	6.0
6802 Vehicle R&M	1,869	-	1,600	-	-	-
6803 Vehicle Fuel - Diesel	319	500	500	500	-	-
6804 Vehicle Fuel - Gas	296	3,300	1,700	3,300	-	-
6806 Vehicle Rentals	236,685	212,500	232,700	214,500	2,000	0.9
6807 Vehicle Leases	18,171	-	15,000	10,000	10,000	-
6810 Comm Vehicle R&M	7,045	-	-	-	-	-
6811 Shop Supplies	427	-	-	-	-	-
6899 Other Vehicle Expense	4,442	-	23,300	-	-	-
* Vehicle Expense	269,253	216,300	274,800	228,300	12,000	5.5
6901 Membership Dues	16,382	48,000	34,500	39,900	(8,100)	(16.9)
6902 Conferences/Workshop	9,938	14,100	13,700	16,200	2,100	14.9
6903 Travel - Local	174,939	155,100	197,600	173,300	18,200	11.7
6904 Travel - Out of Town	26,367	19,100	24,500	24,600	5,500	28.8
6905 Training & Education	64,445	87,500	115,400	108,700	21,200	24.2
6906 Licenses & Agreements	11,766	32,900	6,900	32,900	-	-
6908 Medical Examinations	175	3,900	2,800	3,900	-	-
6909 Cost of Sales	133,750	481,300	1,567,000	2,881,300	2,400,000	498.6
6910 Signage	14,632	126,700	116,700	126,700	-	-
6911 Facilities Rental	162,515	246,600	228,800	234,600	(12,000)	(4.9)
6912 Advertising/Promotio	26,882	77,900	43,100	80,300	2,400	3.1
6913 Awards	107,497	56,400	53,800	56,400	-	-
6914 Recruiting	611	1,600	2,000	1,600	-	-
6915 Research Data Acquis	16	-	100	-	-	-
6916 Public Education	-	3,500	1,000	-	(3,500)	(100.0)
6917 Books and Periodicals	2,732	1,600	5,300	3,700	2,100	131.3
6918 Meals/Catering	12,794	7,400	15,500	12,000	4,600	62.2
6919 Special Projects	1,761,298	701,700	718,700	904,400	202,700	28.9
6928 Committee Expenses	-	-	100	-	-	-
6932 Youth Pr Services	30,346	140,000	39,900	99,200	(40,800)	(29.1)
6933 Community Events	1,050,655	1,062,600	992,900	1,041,400	(21,200)	(2.0)
6938 Rewarding Excellence	5,608	19,700	10,300	19,700	-	-
6940 Fencing	1,603,337	280,400	266,400	280,400	-	-
6941 Playground Equipment	37,806	53,400	89,300	62,300	8,900	16.7
6942 Management Fees	510,321	489,900	1,326,300	489,900	-	-
6943 Health and Wellness	1,742	2,000	2,000	2,000	-	-
6954 Cash over/under	56	-	400	-	-	-
6990 Gds & Svcs OCC Trsf	(20,000)	-	-	-	-	-
6999 Other Goods/Services	17,940	32,500	28,200	39,500	7,000	21.5
* Other Goods & Services	5,764,550	4,145,800	5,903,200	6,734,900	2,589,100	62.5
7009 Internal Trfr Other	(244,206)	(157,900)	(127,400)	(152,900)	5,000	(3.2)
7011 Int Trf Record Check	-	3,000	3,000	3,000	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	18,396	24,900	32,050	21,400	(3,500)	(14.1)
7013 Int Trf Extra Duty	63,181	87,400	87,400	87,400	-	-
7015 Int Trf Facility Rent	19,000	-	-	19,000	19,000	-
9900 Rev/Exp.Vehicle Rent	-	0	0	0	-	-
* Interdepartmental	(143,629)	(42,600)	(4,950)	(22,100)	20,500	(48.1)

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
8001 Transf Outside Agenc	12,540,942	7,428,375	9,505,700	6,771,270	(657,105)	(8.8)
8004 Grants	2,700,925	4,187,100	5,935,100	8,038,200	3,851,100	92.0
8022 Transf to/fr Trust	(176,287)	-	(135,000)	-	-	-
8030 Tfr Fr Resvs to Oper	(1,448,540)	(2,595,000)	(2,645,000)	(5,013,000)	(2,418,000)	93.2
8031 Tfr To Resvs Fr Oper	576,700	516,730	576,700	516,730	-	-
* Other Fiscal	14,193,739	9,537,205	13,237,500	10,313,200	775,995	8.1
** Total	68,300,024	66,280,600	74,830,999	71,607,000	5,326,400	8.0

Summary of Revenues Details - Parks & Recreation

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
5102 Facilities Rentals	(1,181,382)	(993,900)	(1,298,500)	(1,202,200)	(208,300)	21.0
5107 Rental Ball Fields	(298,088)	(300,000)	(350,000)	(345,000)	(45,000)	15.0
5108 Rental Sportsfields	(252,439)	(250,000)	(220,000)	(250,000)	-	-
5109 Rental Parks	(20,517)	(22,800)	(26,000)	(23,500)	(700)	3.1
5110 Rental Sports Courts	(18,245)	(20,800)	(37,000)	(30,000)	(9,200)	44.2
5111 RTAL Weather Fields	(503,363)	(510,000)	(540,000)	(510,000)	-	-
5150 Other Rental Revenue	(360)	-	(7,500)	-	-	-
5151 Lease Revenue	(637,969)	(523,500)	(533,700)	(516,900)	6,600	(1.3)
5204 Administration Fees	(100,000)	(213,200)	(100,000)	(100,000)	113,200	(53.1)
5209 Comm. Events Rev.	(352,442)	(464,500)	(364,500)	(350,500)	114,000	(24.5)
5210 Sport & Fitness Rev.	(1,291,792)	(1,197,500)	(1,181,600)	(1,284,300)	(86,800)	7.2
5212 Leisure Skills Rev.	(107,231)	(125,500)	(110,800)	(125,500)	-	-
5213 Play. & Camp Rev.	(1,115,466)	(1,133,000)	(1,931,300)	(2,146,200)	(1,013,200)	89.4
5215 Aquat.Rev.-Instuct.	(1,287,506)	(1,194,400)	(1,354,300)	(1,418,400)	(224,000)	18.8
5216 Aquat.Rev.-Recreat.	(123,796)	(228,300)	(138,600)	(229,300)	(1,000)	0.4
5219 Ice Rentals	(5,386,280)	(5,182,200)	(5,439,400)	(5,481,200)	(299,000)	5.8
5225 Tipping Fees-Waste R	(126)	-	-	-	-	-
5228 Membership Revenue	(887,325)	(767,800)	(811,400)	(868,200)	(100,400)	13.1
5235 Contract Serv Rev	-	-	(931,900)	(107,300)	(107,300)	-
5239 Cultural Programs	(325,014)	(293,700)	(348,200)	(432,400)	(138,700)	47.2
5250 Sales of Svcs-Other	(433,956)	(439,600)	(403,800)	(381,700)	57,900	(13.2)
5404 Canteen Revenue	(50,914)	(29,800)	(130,000)	(123,900)	(94,100)	315.8
5450 Other Sales Revenue	(75,567)	(44,500)	(173,700)	(153,800)	(109,300)	245.6
* Fee Revenues	(14,449,779)	(13,935,000)	(16,432,200)	(16,080,300)	(2,145,300)	15.4
5503 Advertising Revenue	(282,234)	(346,700)	(350,200)	(352,700)	(6,000)	1.7
5508 Recov External Parti	(7,149,228)	(3,278,700)	(5,843,800)	(3,535,000)	(256,300)	7.8
5600 Miscellaneous Revenue	(108,281)	(71,900)	(120,700)	(104,000)	(32,100)	44.6
* Other Revenue	(7,539,743)	(3,697,300)	(6,314,700)	(3,991,700)	(294,400)	8.0
** Total	(21,989,523)	(17,632,300)	(22,746,900)	(20,072,000)	(2,439,700)	13.8
***** Net Total	46,310,501	48,648,300	52,084,099	51,535,000	2,886,700	5.9

HALIFAX

PLANNING AND DEVELOPMENT

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

PLANNING & DEVELOPMENT

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

Planning & Development is leading Halifax Regional Municipality's transformation, ensuring our region is resilient and a preferred destination for people, investment and new ideas. We are taking action aligned with these priorities and are committed to delivering results that are valued by Regional Council and the community by improving and streamlining our legislation, processes, supporting tools and technologies.

OVERVIEW

Planning & Development advances Regional Council's priorities through service delivery designed to build a healthy, vibrant and sustainable municipality. The business unit oversees regional and community planning, urban design, heritage planning, land development, development-related compliance and regulation, infrastructure and growth analysis and building standards. Through efficient, accurate and coordinated service delivery, the team fosters strong relationships with residents, the development industry, partner departments and Regional Council.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Executive Director's Office	✓ Oversight and Administration of Planning & Development Business Unit ✓ Customer Inquiry Management ✓ Permit Management ✓ Strategic Planning and Growth
Development Services	✓ Customer Inquiry Management ✓ Land Use and Development Permitting ✓ Land Use and Engineering Compliance

Service Area	Services Offered
	✓ Planning Application ✓ Subdivision Application Processing and Approvals
Engineering & Building Standards	✓ Development Engineering Policy ✓ Customer Inquiry Management ✓ Engineering and Building Permitting ✓ Planning Application Support ✓ Standards for Residential Occupancies Compliance ✓ Subdivision Approvals and Takeover
Regional & Community Planning	✓ Affordable Housing Programs ✓ Community Planning ✓ Customer Inquiry Management ✓ Environmental, Social and Economic Planning ✓ Regional Planning
Strategic Projects	✓ Civic Addressing, Asset and Commemorative Naming ✓ Comprehensive Area Planning ✓ Culture and Heritage ✓ Customer Inquiry Management ✓ Planning Information Systems
Transformation & Innovation	✓ Strategic and Transformation Management ✓ Business Continuity Planning ✓ Customer Inquiry Management ✓ Planning & Development Records Management ✓ Service Delivery and Data Management ✓ Staff and Client Engagement

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		255.0
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Transferred Positions		
Transfer to Public Works	Streetscaping Program transferred from P&D	(4.0)
Transfer to SITP	Streetscaping Program transferred from P&D	(1.0)
Total Changes		(5.0)
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		250.0

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Strategic Projects	\$ 2,436,000	\$ 3,511,900	\$ 3,243,500	\$ 3,184,200	\$ (327,700)	(9.3)
Regional & Community Planning	2,826,229	4,185,600	3,253,400	3,748,900	(436,700)	(10.4)
Planning & Development Administration	1,485,561	1,951,600	1,793,500	1,497,400	(454,200)	(23.3)
Engineering & Building Standards	(10,005,036)	(6,988,100)	(5,693,500)	(7,633,900)	(645,800)	9.2
Development Services	3,737,852	4,993,700	4,501,000	5,353,700	360,000	7.2
Net Total	\$ 480,605	\$ 7,654,700	\$ 7,097,900	\$ 6,150,300	\$ (1,504,400)	(19.7)

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 19,972,734	\$ 24,485,700	\$ 22,747,900	\$ 25,523,100	\$ 1,037,400	4.2
Office	113,371	101,700	88,600	94,200	(7,500)	(7.4)
External Services	826,225	2,063,200	3,143,400	3,584,900	1,521,700	73.8
Supplies	21,915	18,500	20,100	18,500	-	-
Materials	122	-	300	-	-	-
Building Costs	1,081	16,000	3,200	6,000	(10,000)	(62.5)
Equipment & Communications	9,201	8,600	8,800	8,900	300	3.5
Vehicle Expense	3,683	102,700	17,200	6,500	(96,200)	(93.7)
Other Goods & Services	342,960	557,700	807,100	502,200	(55,500)	(10.0)
Interdepartmental	28,338	1,572,600	427,900	447,900	(1,124,700)	(71.5)
Other Fiscal	1,359,096	497,900	3,671,300	6,397,900	5,900,000	1,185.0
Total Expenditures	22,678,726	29,424,600	30,935,800	36,590,100	7,165,500	24.4

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Transfers from other Gov'ts	\$ (3,300,856)	\$ (5,079,900)	\$ (8,642,600)	\$ (13,253,700)	\$ (8,173,800)	160.9
Fee Revenues	(18,747,108)	(16,535,000)	(15,047,500)	(17,031,100)	(496,100)	3.0
Other Revenue	(150,157)	(155,000)	(147,800)	(155,000)	-	-
Total Revenues	(22,198,121)	(21,769,900)	(23,837,900)	(30,439,800)	(8,669,900)	39.8
Net Total	\$ 480,605	\$ 7,654,700	\$ 7,097,900	\$ 6,150,300	\$ (1,504,400)	(19.7)

* Budgets have been restated due to changes in organizational structure.

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 7,654,700
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	1,037,400
Revenue Changes	
Increase in Fee revenues	(496,100)
Other/Transfers	
Decrease in leased vehicles (increase use of fleet vehicles)	(96,200)
Decrease in Heritage Grants	(450,000)
Decrease in AHGP Grant	(200,000)
Decrease/Reduction to Travel/Conferences and other reductions	(50,500)
Transfer of Heritage Grants to Fiscal	(200,000)
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact "Green" Reductions	(49,000)
Low Service Impact Reductions in response to flat tax motion	(1,000,000)
Total Changes	\$ (1,504,400)
2026/27 Budget	\$ 6,150,300

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Executive Director's Office	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected
Population, Housing and Construction Value Statistics			
<i>Population size (source Stats Can)</i>	491,437	503,037	513,816 ¹
Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation (CMHC) housing starts (units) ²	4,657	4,691	6,438
CMHC completions (units) ³	2,954	3,179	3,349
Approved residential units from permits issued	6,292	6,029	6,235
Total construction value of building permits issued (billions)	\$1.74B	\$2.06B	\$2.04B
Total construction value of building permits issued by plan area (millions)			
Regional Centre	\$687M	\$736M	\$796M
Suburban	\$625M	\$914M	\$655M
Rural	\$429M	\$400M	\$582M
Permit Applications Statistics ⁴			
Residential Building Permits ⁵			
Application Volume	2,026	2,191	2,555
Permits Issued	1,669	1,845	2,208
Average Days to Issue Permit	26	21	27
Mixed Use & Commercial Building Permits ⁵			
Application Volume	589	603	662
Permits Issued	434	477	553
Average Days to Issue Permit	38	34	37
Construction Permits ⁶			
Application Volume	2,654	2,537	2,540
Permits Issued	2,380	2,270	2,270
Average Days to Issue Permit	10	34	12
Engineering Permits ⁷			
Application Volume	1,398	2,537	1,955
Permits Issued	1,118	2,270	1,577
Average Days to Issue Permit	23	9	21
Development Only Permits ⁸			
Application Volume	434	1,010	982
Permits Issued	290	762	746
Average Days to Issue Permit	20	20	26

TOTAL			
Application Volume	7,101	7,941	8,694
Permits Issued	5,891	6,656	7,355
Permit Housing Statistics			
New Residential Buildings – High Density	52	43	62
Submitted Permits	18	24	26
Issued Permits	106	87	110
Average Time to Issue			
New Residential Building – Low Density	859	999	1152
Submitted Permits	734	893	999
Issued Permits	26	20	26
Average Time to Issue			
Per cent of Total Issued Units by Structure Type			
Dwelling – Backyard Suite		1%	2%
Dwelling – Multiple Units		40%	49%
Dwelling – Semi-Detached	-	2%	2%
Dwelling – Single Detached		11%	12%
Dwelling – Townhouse		7%	12%
Mixed Use – Residential & Other Use(s)		39%	23%
Planning Applications Statistics			
Rezoning, Land Use By-law Amendment and Development Agreement			
Application Volume	94	62	70
Volume Completed	38	41	48
Average Days to Complete	325	309	444
Site Plan Approval			
Application Volume	10	1	8
Volume Completed	7	5	4
Average Days to Complete	178	204	66
Subdivision			
Application Volume	522	455	458
Volume Completed	413	377	351
Average Days to Complete	141	138	153
Telecommunication Tower			
Application Volume	1	1	5
Volume Completed	1	1	3
Average Days to Complete	148	32	25
Variance			
Application Volume	58	49	57
Volume Completed	44	37	48
Average Days to Complete	89	83	100

TOTAL			
Application Volume	704	568	598
Volume Completed	509	461	454
¹ Value for 2025 is based on projected population provided by the municipality (513,816). ² Data source: CMHC, Housing Market Information Portal, Historical Starts by Dwelling Type starts to date (5,623). Added the 5-year average (2020-2024) start rate for missing November & December 2025. ³ Data source: CMHC, Housing Market Information Portal, Historical Completions by Dwelling Type completions to date (2640), Added the 5-year average (2020-2024) completion rate for missing November and December 2025. ⁴ All information is a snapshot as of the calendar year end. ⁵ Structures that can be occupied or used for storage including for new construction, additions and renovations. ⁶ Construction Permits: Permit types that involve construction, but are not for buildings (e.g., decks, demolitions, fences, signs, solar panels, swimming pools). Permits for mobile homes also fall under this category. ⁷ Engineering Permits: Permits related to construction that require activity in or changes to the municipal right-of-way (streets, sidewalks) as well as blasting. ⁸ Development Only Permits: Permits that verify land use, however, do not approve construction. Analysis: - Planning & Development shows a stronger housing pipeline with projected housing starts up 37% and completions continuing to rise, while approved residential units rebound close to 2023 levels. Construction value remains near record highs but planning application completion times for complex files such as development agreements and variances are lengthening, signaling capacity challenges despite overall growth. - Processing times no longer improve uniformly across all permit types and indicate targeted efficiency work is needed in the high-volume categories. <i>Approved residential units from permits issued</i> are projected at ~6,235 in 2025 (+3.4% vs. 2024 and nearly back to 2023 volumes) and total permits issued across all categories are projected to reach ~7,355 (+10.5% year-over-year), signaling broad-based volume growth.			
Development Services	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected
Development Services Completed Permit Reviews	14,449	17,419	18,551
Per cent of Permit Reviews Completed within Two Days	79%	76%	66%
Per cent of Permit Reviews Completed within Six Days	93%	92%	81%
Customer Inquiry Volume	8,874	11,516	11,426
Customer Inquiry Average Resolution Time ¹	5	5	5.5

Land Use Compliance Files Initiated	72	372	398
Zoning Confirmation Letter Requests	643	1331	1,142
¹ Average resolution time is measured in calendar days. Resolution is defined as closed and the inquiry or issue is resolved. Analysis: Development Services continues to manage high review volumes with strong completion rates, but efficiency metrics show slight declines in speed, while customer inquiries and compliance activities remain elevated. Projected 2025 figures suggest ongoing workload growth and a need for targeted process improvements to maintain service levels.			
Engineering & Building Standards	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected
Engineering & Building Standards Completed Permit Reviews	13,259	15,039	16,499
Per cent of Permit Reviews Completed within Two Days	62%	67%	58%
Per cent of Permit Reviews Completed within Six Days	85%	89%	82%
Customer Inquiry Volume	5,252	5,657	6,112
Customer Inquiry Average Resolution Time ¹	24	14	21
Number of minimum standards inquiries (By-law M-200) ²	1,075	1,190	1,208
Number of Building Inspections	28,551	34,442	38,344
Engineering Compliance Files Initiated	77	186	205
¹ Average resolution time is measured in calendar days. Resolution is defined as closed and the inquiry or issue is resolved. ² Minimum standards inquiries are a subset of overall inquiries volume. Analysis: Engineering & Building Standards continues to experience rising permit review volumes, inspections and customer inquiries, while efficiency metrics show slight declines in turnaround speed. Projected 2025 figures indicate growing operational demand and the need for sustained process improvements to maintain service quality.			
Regional & Community Planning	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected

Additional Regulatory Capacity Added (units) ¹	0	200,000	0
Per cent of Permits Near Transit Routes ²	56.35%	56.51%	55.20%
Per cent of Permits Near Proposed Rapid Transit Routes ³	25.47%	26.51%	24.27%
Number of Affordable Units Funded ⁴			
New units	9	94	191
Units repaired	122	160	29
Investment into Affordable Housing ⁴	\$1.4M	\$5.2M	\$5.3M
¹ Regulatory capacity means the estimated number of residential units that are enabled through zoning. These are units that can proceed as-of-right through the construction permit process, upon application by a landowner. Regulatory capacity does not include residential units that Regional Council may consider through a future (discretionary) planning process, such as a Development Agreement, Rezoning or Plan Amendment. This measurement reflects the change to zoning framework in the given year. It does not reflect prior capacity within the entire zoning framework ² Residential and commercial, within 500m of transit routes. ³ Residential and commercial, within 800m of proposed Bus Rapid Transit routes and ferry, including the Bedford Ferry Terminal. ⁴ New units/ rooms and total maintenance/repairs to existing units supported through the Affordable Housing Grant Program. Analysis: • 2024 was a pivotal year for increases to regulatory capacity. Work continues on additional capacity building through policy and regulation changes, which will be realized in future years. • 2025 brings focus on affordable housing, with an increase in new affordable units built, less repair work and comparable funding to 2024.			
Strategic Projects	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected
Civic Addressing and Heritage Completed Permit Reviews	6,145	7,397	8,038
Percent of Reviews Completed within Two Days	91%	94%	96%
Percent of Reviews Completed within Six Days	98%	99%	99%
Customer Inquiry Volume	463	381	378
Customer Inquiry Average Resolution Time ¹	12	7	13
Total Civic Numbers Assigned	2,112	1,780	1,960

¹ Average resolution time is measured in calendar days. Resolution is defined as closed and inquiry/issue resolved.

Analysis:

- Strategic Projects consistently improved turnaround times, with over 96% of reviews completed within two days and nearly 99% within six days in 2025, while maintaining high volumes of civic and heritage reviews.
- Customer inquiry volumes continue to decline, average resolution time improved in 2024 but is expected to lengthen in 2025, and total civic numbers assigned are projected to rebound versus 2024, while still below the 2023 level.

Transformation & Innovation	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected
Customer and System Support Statistics			
Permit and Planning Applications Supported Through the Permitting, Planning, Licensing and Compliance System (PPL&C)	10,616	11,694	14,986
Email Support Touchpoints with Customers ¹	1,871	3,494	3,247
Individual Onboarding Completed	145	215	192
Records and Information Management Statistics			
Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy (FOIPOP) Requests Fulfilled	-	127	120
Minimum Staff Time Used per FOIPOP Fulfillment (hours)	-	2.5	1.8
Property Status Inquiries Completed	-	574	379
Permit Website Engagement Statistics ²			
Permit Website Total Main Page Views	68,132	68,949	78,621
Permit Website Total Unique Users Visting Main Page	31,925	28,092	27,403

¹ Support touchpoints are calculated based on the initial touchpoint.

² Permit main page: <https://www.halifax.ca/home-property/building-development-permits>

Analysis:

- Transformation & Innovation shows steady growth in system-supported transactions and customer touchpoints, alongside increased onboarding needs and consistent engagement metrics, reflecting ongoing adaptation and efficiency improvements.
- Turnover and internal staff movement continues to create a strong need for staff onboarding training.

- Transformation & Innovation continues to engage with industry regularly, holds internal and external support and change sessions and offers external training sessions with new and existing customers as requested.
- Permit website views stay stable around 70K/ year and unique users slightly decline, suggesting a mature user base and focus on maintaining accessibility rather than expanding reach.
- Transformation & Innovation continues to lead large and small scale process and business improvements creating efficiencies and transparency for customers and an overall improved customer and staff experience.

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
EP-01 Increase regional growth in strategic areas that are well-served by existing or planned services, utilities and infrastructure.	
Regional Plan Review Phase 5 <i>Service Area: Regional & Community Planning</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-01-A2</i> Develop and test potential growth scenarios, working from the assumption that Halifax Regional Municipality will grow to be a region supporting one million people. The scenarios will help us to evaluate how to direct housing, jobs and community infrastructure in a fiscally sustainable way that will support our goals for affordable, healthy, connected, and inclusive communities. The Strategic Growth and Infrastructure Priorities Plan is a key input to this process and will provide a framework for long-term settlement planning and fiscal management.	31-Mar-29
African Nova Scotian Community Action Planning Program <i>Service Area: Regional & Community Planning</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal EP-01; no Action assignment</i> Establish and implement community action plans in the African Nova Scotian communities of Beechville, Upper Hammonds Plains and Lucasville in collaboration with community leaders and the Road to Economic Prosperity team.	31-Mar-29

Deliverable	Completion
Community action plans are a process for residents of African Nova Scotian communities to identify strengths and opportunities, create a vision for their community's future and develop an action plan to achieve it.	
Capital Cost Contribution Studies <i>Service Area: Engineering & Building Standards</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal EP-01; no Action assignment</i> Establish and adopt Capital Cost Contribution Studies in respect of new and oversized infrastructure in Sandy Lake and Highway 102 Corridor Special Planning Areas.	31-Mar-27
EP-02 Expedite the delivery of housing supply and support the development of complete communities with a mix of housing options and convenient access to goods, services and facilities.	
Suburban Secondary Planning Framework <i>Service Area: Regional & Community Planning</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A1</i> Delivery and approval of the Suburban Secondary Planning framework and supporting Land Use By-laws.	15-Dec-28
Rural Secondary Planning Framework <i>Service Area: Regional & Community Planning</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A1</i> Delivery and approval of the Rural Secondary Planning framework and supporting Land Use By-laws.	26-Dec-31
Centre Plan Update <i>Service Area: Regional & Community Planning</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A1</i> Review and update of the Centre Plan Secondary Plan and Land Use By-law.	31-Mar-27
Comprehensive Neighbourhood Planning <i>Service Area: Strategic Projects</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A2</i> Proactively plan for the development of new complete communities and business parks in response to increased population growth and advance comprehensive neighbourhood planning projects to enable the development of new housing units supported by new roads, pathways, parks, commercial services and community facilities. In the 2026/27 fiscal comprehensive neighbourhood planning projects will be completed on Young Street Lands and the Bedford Common. Planning and identification of early deliverables will also be completed for the Provincial Special Planning Areas of Sandy Lake, Highway 102, Morris Lake (pending Minister direction) and Westphal (pending Minister direction).	31-Mar-34

Deliverable	Completion
Community Infrastructure Master Plans <i>Service Area: Engineering & Building Standards</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A2</i> Develop Community Infrastructure Master Plans as part of the comprehensive neighbourhood planning projects for Young Street Lands and the Bedford Common. Contribute to the planning and identification of early deliverables for the Provincial Special Planning Areas of Sandy Lake, Highway 102, Morris Lake (pending Minister direction) and Westphal (pending Minister direction).	31-Mar-27
Downtown Dartmouth Waterfront Revitalization <i>Service Area: Strategic Projects</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A2</i> Create a conceptual development plan and accompanying implementation plan for the Dartmouth Waterfront. These plans and accompanying recommendations will establish a framework for the planning, design and implementation of park and public space features, urban design, mobility connections, a multi-functional emergency access route, climate change adaptation measures and new development.	31-Mar-27
Mill Cove Land Use Planning <i>Service Area: Strategic Projects</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A2</i> A study is currently underway, and a consultants' report will be delivered to support a staff recommendation to Regional Council for initiation of comprehensive planning for the Mill Cove Area in winter 2027. This project will help inform suburban planning to support the fast ferry terminal and library and will support population growth in the area, directly supporting housing and development.	31-Mar-27
Affordable Housing Strategy <i>Service Area: Regional & Community Planning</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A6</i> Develop an Affordable Housing Strategy. The development of an Affordable Housing Strategy is a requirement of the municipality's Housing Accelerator Fund agreement with the Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation that must be delivered by October 2026. The Affordable Housing Strategy is intended to clarify the municipality's role in affordable housing, assess current housing-related efforts and create a framework to guide housing action with a focus on areas where the municipal government can partner or lead initiatives. This plan will set out direction, actions and resource allocation to achieve objectives related to housing.	12-Oct-26
Housing Accelerator Fund <i>Service Area: Regional & Community Planning</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A8</i> Implement the Housing Accelerator Fund (HAF) Action Plan. These actions encourage more housing choices in neighbourhoods across the municipality; create faster	12-Oct-26

Deliverable	Completion
approval processes; and help turn unused spaces into homes. The municipality's HAF Action Plan aims to help create 2,600 net new housing units, part of the municipality's total target of 15,467 new housing units over three years, between 2023 and 2026 The municipality entered into a \$79.3 million agreement with Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation (CMHC) to develop and implement a HAF Action Plan by 2026. Approved by Regional Council in 2023, the municipality's HAF Action Plan contains 11 actions which must be completed by October 2026.	
Trusted Partner Program <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A8</i> Establish a Trusted Partner Program through the delivery of a by-law to Regional Council.	31-Dec-27
Development Charges By-laws <i>Service Area: Engineering & Building Standards</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal EP-02; no Action assignment</i> Implement updated Development Charges by-law to support local and community infrastructure in strategic growth areas, consistent with existing methodology. Subject to Provincial approval, amend the Dartmouth Cove Development Charges by-law to reflect increased density and establish a new by-law for Spring Garden West.	31-Mar-27
EP-03 Maintain and improve municipal infrastructure resilience to mitigate and adapt to the impacts of climate change.	
Coastal and Freshwater Flood Risk Management <i>Service Area: Engineering & Building Standards</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-03-A3</i> Continue to enhance understanding of flood prone areas through modelling and mapping flood risks under current and future climate conditions and advancing policies, programs, and education. Previously conducted flood studies (Sackville Rivers and Shubenacadie watersheds) will continue to be evaluated for necessary updates and advancement of flood mitigation policies and programs. A new flood modelling study will be completed for the Musquodoboit River watershed. Municipal wide policy considerations, such as, incorporating floodplains and coastal setbacks will be amended in collaboration with planning staff.	31-Mar-30
Stormwater Policy Implementation <i>Service Area: Engineering & Building Standards</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal EP-03; no Action assignment</i> Collaborate closely with Halifax Water to advance action items in the Integrated Stormwater Management Policy Framework. A Stormwater Management Strategy and Policy will be developed. The Strategy and Policy will provide a structured approach to policy changes, such as updates to the grade alteration by-law and stormwater management administrative	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
order, and development of green infrastructure standards for inclusion in the Municipal Design Guidelines. Policy implementation includes advising Public Works on incorporating green infrastructure for enhanced stormwater management into capital projects.	
SC-04 Plan and invest in social infrastructure and opportunities for connection to increase residents' well-being and sense of belonging in their communities.	
Heritage Evaluation Criteria Review <i>Service Area: Strategic Projects</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A2</i> Continue reviewing the municipality's heritage evaluation criteria to ensure municipal heritage registrations are more inclusive of underrepresented groups and to expand focus on the municipality's cultural heritage (Culture and Heritage Priorities Plan Action Item 2.1).	31-Mar-27
Culture and Heritage Priorities Plan – Track and Report <i>Service Area: Strategic Projects</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A2</i> Track and report on the Culture and Heritage Priorities Plan actions. Actions are focused on investment, program development, service delivery and ongoing community engagement. Tracking has begun and reporting will continue every second year. The next report will be in 2027/28.	31-Mar-28
Downtown Dartmouth Heritage Conservation District <i>Service Area: Strategic Projects</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-04-A2</i> Staff will complete community consultation, prepare the draft Heritage Conservation District Plan and By-law, present to Heritage Advisory Committee and Regional Council and move to adoption if approved.	31-Mar-27
Brunswick Street District Heritage Conversation District <i>Service Area: Strategic Projects</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-04-A2</i> Undertake and complete a background study for the Brunswick Street District Conservation District (North of Cogswell Street).	31-Mar-27
Creighton Street Heritage Conservation District <i>Service Area: Strategic Projects</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-04-A2</i> Initiate the scoping of the Creighton Street Heritage Conservation District.	31-Mar-27
Heritage Grant Program Review <i>Service Area: Strategic Projects</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A2</i>	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Conduct a policy review of the municipality's Heritage Grant Program. This action item refers to Action 4.9 of the Culture and Heritage Priorities Plan, which recommends that the municipality conduct a review of municipal grant programs with the goal of enhancing access to opportunity, efficiency, accountability and inclusivity.	
Review of Administrative Order 46, Respecting HRM Asset Naming Policies <i>Service Area: Strategic Projects</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A2</i> Initiate a review of Administrative Order 46, Respecting HRM Asset Naming Policies, which will implement Action 3.2 of the HRM Culture and Heritage Priorities Plan and address various motions of Council. The review will result in recommendations for an updated and improved policy framework for municipal asset naming. The framework will promote increased reflection of Mi'kmaq, Acadian and African Nova Scotian history and culture in the municipality and address risks relating to commemorating individuals.	31-Mar-28
SC-06 Invest to enable community efforts to reduce carbon emissions by 75% (of 2016 levels) by 2030 and net-zero by 2050.	
Net-Zero New Construction <i>Service Area: Engineering & Building Standards</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-06-A1</i> The municipality will continue to work with the Province of Nova Scotia and other external stakeholders on the need for new construction standards reinforcing net-zero emissions to achieve Regional Council's commitment to a target of net-zero municipal operations by 2030 and to help the Province achieve its target toward net-zero emissions over four years.	31-Mar-30
SC-07 Invest in the enhancement, protection and expansion of natural assets, green spaces and urban agriculture to support community and ecological health and resilient ecosystem services.	
Green Network Plan <i>Service Area: Regional & Community Planning</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-07-A2</i> Implement all Halifax Green Network Plan (Green Network Plan) Actions. The Green Network Plan identifies 32 objectives and 79 actions that are required to establish its vision of an interconnected open space system for the entire municipality (the "Green Network"). Specifically, the Plan provides land management and community design direction to maintain ecologically and culturally important land and aquatic systems, promote the sustainable use of natural resources and economically important open spaces and identify, define and plan land suited for parks and corridors.	31-Dec-29

Deliverable	Completion
RA-04 Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency and cost effectiveness, while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.	
Processes and Systems Review and Improvements <i>Service Area: Transformation & Innovation</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action assignment</i> Continue to analyze areas for enhancement of existing and required business process, the Permitting, Planning, Licensing and Compliance system processes, in conjunction with staff function changes. This includes prioritizing requests for change under a lens of service excellence and in alignment with Regional Council priorities.	31-Mar-27
Enhanced Open Data Sets, Public Dashboards and Access to Planning & Development Information <i>Service Area: Transformation & Innovation</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action assignment</i> Continue to increase Planning & Development transparency through enhanced Open Data presence by adding additional data sets and improve existing sets with added data, enhancing the public dashboard and reviewing other opportunities/ tools for transparency.	31-Mar-27
Service Excellence Framework Design and Implementation <i>Service Area: Transformation & Innovation</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action assignment</i> The planning, creation and implementation of a comprehensive Planning & Development Service Excellence Framework.	31-Mar-28
RA-06 Foster collaborative relationships with other levels of government and partners.	
Short Term Rentals Education and Enforcement Pilot <i>Service Area: Development Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-06; no Action assignment</i> Develop a proactive enforcement program for short-term rentals with emphasis on enforcement through education and resource materials to inform the public of municipal land use zoning, permitting and registration requirements.	31-Mar-27

Summary of Net Expenditures - Planning & Development

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
C530 Planned Growth	965,885	1,052,800	935,500	1,252,800	200,000	19.0
D007 Strategic Projects Admin	181,480	205,200	245,200	276,000	70,800	34.5
C340 Heritage & Info Services	1,288,636	2,253,900	2,062,800	1,655,400	(598,500)	(26.6)
** Strategic Projects	2,436,000	3,511,900	3,243,500	3,184,200	(327,700)	(9.3)
C002 Urban Design	1,210,896	1,679,700	1,390,000	1,588,400	(91,300)	(5.4)
C320 Policy & Strtgc Plan	1,349,155	2,227,900	1,644,600	1,946,000	(281,900)	(12.7)
C350 Housing Accelerator Fund	(0)	900	-	-	(900)	(100.0)
D005 Reg. Planning Admin	266,178	277,100	218,800	214,500	(62,600)	(22.6)
** Regional & Community Planning	2,826,229	4,185,600	3,253,400	3,748,900	(436,700)	(10.4)
D001 Director P&D	572,376	689,200	569,100	600,600	(88,600)	(12.9)
D002 PD Business Services	913,185	1,262,400	1,224,400	896,800	(365,600)	(29.0)
* P & D - Administration	1,485,561	1,951,600	1,793,500	1,497,400	(454,200)	(23.3)
** Planning & Development Admin	1,485,561	1,951,600	1,793,500	1,497,400	(454,200)	(23.3)
C430 Building Standards	(9,749,630)	(8,556,600)	(5,597,500)	(9,019,800)	(463,200)	5.4
C450 Development Engineering	(720,874)	733,900	(410,800)	1,082,800	348,900	47.5
D006 Infra Planning Admin	465,468	834,600	314,800	303,100	(531,500)	(63.7)
** Engineering & Building Standard	(10,005,036)	(6,988,100)	(5,693,500)	(7,633,900)	(645,800)	9.2
C310 Urban & Rural Applic	1,276,803	1,343,400	1,246,200	1,355,800	12,400	0.9
C420 Land Dev & Subdv	991,619	2,196,100	1,793,900	2,573,500	377,400	17.2
C520 Applications Processing	1,222,215	1,161,100	1,167,200	1,170,700	9,600	0.8
D003 Current Plan. Admin	247,215	293,100	293,700	253,700	(39,400)	(13.4)
** Development Services	3,737,852	4,993,700	4,501,000	5,353,700	360,000	7.2
*** Net Total	480,605	7,654,700	7,097,900	6,150,300	(1,504,400)	(20)

Summary of Expenditures Details - Planning & Development

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	16,048,592	20,330,300	17,543,000	21,071,300	741,000	3.6
6002 Salaries - Overtime	17,166	10,600	35,500	10,600	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(199,143)	-	(207,900)	-	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	34,498	-	22,900	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	3,455,471	4,283,200	3,735,600	4,697,500	414,300	9.7
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(1,894,300)	-	(1,894,300)	-	-
6150 Honorariums	314	-	-	-	-	-
6151 Vehicle Allowance	566	-	100	-	-	-
6152 Retirement Incentives	93,279	131,400	112,300	143,000	11,600	8.8
6154 Workers' Compensation	471,637	723,400	644,000	715,500	(7,900)	(1.1)
6155 Overtime Meals	74	-	-	-	-	-
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	50,915	901,100	862,400	779,500	(121,600)	(13.5)
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	(693)	-	-	-	-	-
9210 HR CATS OT Wage/Ben	57	-	-	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	19,972,734	24,485,700	22,747,900	25,523,100	1,037,400	4.2
6201 Telephone/Cable	30,002	31,500	34,500	26,500	(5,000)	(15.9)
6202 Courier/Postage	16,337	5,200	8,200	5,200	-	-
6203 Office Furn/Equip	1,643	14,800	6,000	14,800	-	-
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	19,154	25,500	11,700	23,000	(2,500)	(9.8)
6205 Printing & Reprod	-	1,200	1,500	1,200	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	45,800	23,500	26,700	23,500	-	-
6299 Other Office Expenses	435	-	-	-	-	-
* Office	113,371	101,700	88,600	94,200	(7,500)	(7.4)
6301 Professional Fees	29,862	43,000	31,800	38,000	(5,000)	(11.6)
6302 Legal Fees	206	1,500	9,200	500	(1,000)	(66.7)
6303 Consulting Fees	694,976	2,016,700	2,058,400	1,404,400	(612,300)	(30.4)
6306 Property Survey	1,272	-	-	-	-	-
6311 Security	435	-	-	-	-	-
6314 Prosecution Services	1,415	-	1,000	-	-	-
6399 Contract Services	98,060	2,000	1,043,000	2,142,000	2,140,000	#####
* External Services	826,225	2,063,200	3,143,400	3,584,900	1,521,700	73.8
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	2,433	8,000	5,400	8,000	-	-
6402 Med & First Aid Supp	172	-	-	-	-	-
6406 Bridge Tolls	7,045	-	-	-	-	-
6407 Clean/Sani Supplies	197	-	-	-	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6409 Personal Protect Equ	9,289	9,300	10,600	9,300	-	-
6499 Other Supplies	2,779	1,200	4,100	1,200	-	-
* Supplies	21,915	18,500	20,100	18,500	-	-
6502 Chemicals	20	-	-	-	-	-
6505 Lubricants	-	-	100	-	-	-
6510 Road Oils	-	-	100	-	-	-
6511 Salt	-	-	100	-	-	-
6518 Metal	75	-	-	-	-	-
6599 Other Materials	28	-	-	-	-	-
* Materials	122	-	300	-	-	-
6602 Electrical	-	-	100	-	-	-
6608 Water	157	-	-	-	-	-
6611 Building - Interior	923	16,000	3,100	6,000	(10,000)	(62.5)
* Building Costs	1,081	16,000	3,200	6,000	(10,000)	(62.5)
6701 Equipment Purchase	2,728	-	100	-	-	-
6702 Small Tools	313	100	100	100	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	6,160	7,500	6,100	7,800	300	4.0
6705 Equip - R&M	-	1,000	2,500	1,000	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	9,201	8,600	8,800	8,900	300	3.5
6802 Vehicle R&M	196	6,000	1,000	6,000	-	-
6806 Vehicle Rentals	-	96,200	-	-	(96,200)	(100.0)
6807 Vehicle Leases	-	-	12,400	-	-	-
6899 Other Vehicle Expense	3,486	500	3,800	500	-	-
* Vehicle Expense	3,683	102,700	17,200	6,500	(96,200)	(93.7)
6901 Membership Dues	85,926	98,500	83,700	85,500	(13,000)	(13.2)
6902 Conferences/Workshop	59,661	16,300	54,300	24,300	8,000	49.1
6903 Travel - Local	3,372	16,800	10,400	11,000	(5,800)	(34.5)
6904 Travel - Out of Town	12,793	13,500	11,900	12,100	(1,400)	(10.4)
6905 Training & Education	81,836	118,000	74,300	93,200	(24,800)	(21.0)
6906 Licenses & Agreements	786	1,500	500	500	(1,000)	(66.7)
6910 Signage	21,882	30,000	70,900	30,000	-	-
6911 Facilities Rental	1,699	8,000	7,100	7,000	(1,000)	(12.5)
6912 Advertising/Promotio	22,117	28,100	20,400	26,100	(2,000)	(7.1)
6913 Awards	644	-	-	-	-	-
6914 Recruiting	964	2,000	1,600	2,000	-	-
6915 Research Data Acquis	41,266	110,000	70,000	110,000	-	-
6917 Books and Periodicals	2,746	1,500	3,900	1,500	-	-
6918 Meals/Catering	2,902	6,000	6,700	6,000	-	-
6919 Special Projects	1,409	103,000	384,500	85,500	(17,500)	(17.0)
6933 Community Events	-	-	3,000	3,000	3,000	-
6938 Rewarding Excellence	2,095	4,500	2,800	4,500	-	-
6943 Health and Wellness	194	-	-	-	-	-
6999 Other Goods/Services	667	-	1,100	-	-	-
* Other Goods & Services	342,960	557,700	807,100	502,200	(55,500)	(10.0)
7009 Internal Trfr Other	22,407	1,561,600	419,500	436,900	(1,124,700)	(72.0)
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	5,931	11,000	8,400	11,000	-	-
* Interdepartmental	28,338	1,572,600	427,900	447,900	(1,124,700)	(71.5)
8004 Grants	1,743,982	1,350,000	6,023,400	7,250,000	5,900,000	437.0
8030 Trfr Fr Resvs to Oper	(384,886)	(852,100)	(2,352,100)	(852,100)	-	-
* Other Fiscal	1,359,096	497,900	3,671,300	6,397,900	5,900,000	1,185.0
** Total	22,678,726	29,424,600	30,935,800	36,590,100	7,165,500	24.4

Summary of Revenues Details - Planning & Development

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4703 Cond.Grant NS(Other)	(594,335)	-	(631,200)	-	-	-
4704 Conditnl Grnts Other	(2,706,521)	(5,079,900)	(8,011,400)	(13,253,700)	(8,173,800)	160.9
* Transfers from other Gov'ts	(3,300,856)	(5,079,900)	(8,642,600)	(13,253,700)	(8,173,800)	160.9
4903 Building Permits	(13,923,476)	(13,300,000)	(10,300,000)	(13,699,000)	(399,000)	3.0
4904 Plumbing Permits	(238,956)	(150,000)	(176,000)	(154,500)	(4,500)	3.0
4905 St. Opening Permits	(792,185)	(450,000)	(733,200)	(463,500)	(13,500)	3.0
4906 Subdivision Applic.	(234,560)	(250,000)	(237,000)	(257,500)	(7,500)	3.0
4911 Zoning Fees	(243,950)	(120,000)	(193,600)	(123,600)	(3,600)	3.0

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4912 Signs & Encroachments	(1,551,013)	(750,000)	(1,560,000)	(772,500)	(22,500)	3.0
4914 Grade Alterations	(226,650)	(200,000)	(248,400)	(206,000)	(6,000)	3.0
4915 Minor Variance	(32,790)	(30,000)	(44,800)	(30,900)	(900)	3.0
4920 Development Permits	(1,029,274)	(750,000)	(1,000,300)	(772,500)	(22,500)	3.0
4950 Other Lic. & Permits	(274,226)	(275,000)	(242,200)	(283,300)	(8,300)	3.0
5250 Sales of Svcs-Other	(194,326)	(250,000)	(300,000)	(257,500)	(7,500)	3.0
5253 Subdiv Insp Fees	(5,701)	(10,000)	(12,000)	(10,300)	(300)	3.0
* Fee Revenues	(18,747,108)	(16,535,000)	(15,047,500)	(17,031,100)	(496,100)	3.0
5508 Recov External Parti	(150,157)	(155,000)	(147,800)	(155,000)	-	-
* Other Revenue	(150,157)	(155,000)	(147,800)	(155,000)	-	-
** Total	(22,198,121)	(21,769,900)	(23,837,900)	(30,439,800)	(8,669,900)	39.8
*** Net Total	480,605	7,654,700	7,097,900	6,150,300	(1,504,400)	(20)

HALIFAX

PROPERTY, FLEET AND ENVIRONMENT

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

PROPERTY, FLEET & ENVIRONMENT

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

Delivering sustainable management of fleet, buildings, land and ecosystems while taking meaningful action on climate change to support a healthy and resilient future for our residents.

OVERVIEW

Property, Fleet & Environment (PFE) advances Council and Administrative Priorities by managing municipal assets sustainably and driving climate action for a healthier, more resilient future. By focusing on efficiency, reliability and sustainability, the business unit strengthens organizational capacity, supports excellence in public service delivery, and contributes to the long-term well-being of residents. PFE divisions include: Corporate Fleet, Corporate Real Estate, Facility Design & Construction, Facility Maintenance & Operations and Environment & Climate Change.

PFE maintains and renews more than 1,600 vehicles and equipment assets, ensuring reliable and safe support for frontline and operational services. It acquires, develops and manages property to enable economic growth, community development and integrated mobility, while providing strategic advice on real estate matters. PFE leads the implementation of HalifACT, strengthens environmental stewardship and advances climate adaptation and emission reduction initiatives across the municipality in collaboration with community partners. The business unit also ensures the safety, cleanliness and functionality of more than 240 municipal facilities through preventative and lifecycle maintenance, while delivering major capital projects such as recreation centres, transit terminals and garages, fire stations, libraries and administrative buildings.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Executive Director's Office	✓ Oversight and Administration of Property, Fleet & Environment
Corporate Fleet	✓ Fleet Assets Acquisition and Disposal ✓ Fleet Maintenance and Repairs ✓ Fleet Planning and Optimization ✓ Fleet Regulatory Compliance
Corporate Real Estate	✓ Industrial Park Development ✓ Property Leasing and Tenant Services ✓ Real Estate Acquisition and Disposal
Environment & Climate Change	✓ Climate Resilience ✓ Enabling Climate Action ✓ Environmental Protection and Sustainability ✓ Net-Zero Emissions
Facility Design & Construction	✓ Facilities Energy Efficiency ✓ Facilities Growth Planning and Delivery ✓ Facility Asset Renewal and State of Good Repair
Facility Maintenance & Operations	✓ Aquatics and Recreation Facilities Maintenance ✓ Automated External Defibrillators (AEDs) Maintenance ✓ Facilities Contract Management ✓ Facilities Operations and Maintenance ✓ Security and Access Control

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		237.0
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Manager, Collective Impact	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Light Equipment Repair Person	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Jr. Environmental Professional	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Vacant Position	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Transferred Positions		
Net Transfer Positions		-
Total Changes		(4.0)
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		233.0

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Executive Director's Office	\$ 463,774	\$ 469,000	\$ 488,800	\$ 476,400	\$ 7,400	1.6
Corporate Fleet	16,602,165	19,748,500	18,943,300	20,039,400	290,900	1.5
Corporate Real Estate	6,736,058	7,180,300	7,416,700	7,403,700	223,400	3.1
Environment & Climate Change	3,723,867	4,665,600	4,237,800	3,979,700	(685,900)	(14.7)
Facility Design & Construction	1,602,835	2,178,000	2,243,300	2,178,900	900	-
Facility Maintenance & Operations	28,215,524	28,268,100	29,015,900	29,486,000	1,217,900	4.3
Net Total	\$ 57,344,223	\$ 62,509,500	\$ 62,345,800	\$ 63,564,100	\$ 1,054,600	1.7

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 20,503,078	\$ 24,015,600	\$ 23,599,900	\$ 24,210,800	\$ 195,200	0.8
Office	221,286	223,500	171,200	145,500	(78,000)	(34.9)
External Services	8,409,341	9,258,200	9,017,000	9,368,100	109,900	1.2
Supplies	301,710	316,400	300,800	292,100	(24,300)	(7.7)
Materials	391,480	398,600	401,100	385,900	(12,700)	(3.2)
Building Costs	11,493,847	11,937,300	11,745,700	12,238,700	301,400	2.5
Equipment & Communications	3,579,708	2,871,700	3,534,700	3,192,900	321,200	11.2
Vehicle Expense	9,360,425	10,554,100	10,231,700	10,757,300	203,200	1.9
Other Goods & Services	5,703,685	6,197,500	5,944,000	6,100,200	(97,300)	(1.6)
Interdepartmental	9,898	(123,900)	18,900	(22,800)	101,100	(81.6)
Other Fiscal	53,047	18,000	343,900	18,000	-	-
Total Expenditures	60,027,507	65,667,000	65,308,900	66,686,700	1,019,700	1.6

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Transfers from other Gov'ts	\$ (76,498)	\$ -	\$ (139,800)	\$ -	\$ -	-
Fee Revenues	(2,436,166)	(3,087,300)	(2,744,900)	(3,024,900)	62,400	(2.0)
Other Revenue	(170,620)	(70,200)	(78,400)	(97,700)	(27,500)	39.2
Total Revenues	(2,683,284)	(3,157,500)	(2,963,100)	(3,122,600)	34,900	(1.1)
Net Total	\$ 57,344,223	\$ 62,509,500	\$ 62,345,800	\$ 63,564,100	\$ 1,054,600	1.7

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 62,509,500
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Utility price increases	705,200
Increase in building maintenance and parts	252,100
Fleet expansion – increased fuel, repair and maintenance	433,800
BLT Community Centre - facility operating costs	411,000
Various accessibility upgrades - increased maintenance	110,500
New Generators (4) - increased maintenance	46,500
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	449,200
Contractual Increases for Janitorial, Snow Removal, Pest Control, Waste, etc.	347,400
Emergency Fleet lease	140,100
Revenue Changes	
Decreased revenue for Leases and Parking rentals	85,200
Other/Transfers	
IT Services - Eastlink WAN/Internet Services	(36,700)
Miscellaneous savings	(18,400)
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact "Green" Reductions	(600,700)
Low Service Impact Reductions in response to flat tax motion	(235,000)
Reduce security coverage outside of regular operating hours at City Hall	(15,000)
Painting service reduction	(20,000)
Defer additional maintenance	(12,800)
Vehicle Repairs and Maintenance	(325,000)
Commercial Vehicle Repairs and Maintenance	(199,000)
FTE reductions - Vacant Positions & Attrition	(151,300)
Reduce Advertising/promotion	(50,000)
Reduce Consulting	(187,500)
Environmental Assessments/Cleanup reduction	(75,000)
Total Changes	\$ 1,054,600
2026/27 Budget	\$ 63,564,100

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Corporate Fleet	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected
Number of planned maintenance work order hours ¹	15,296	13,269	18,972
Number of demand maintenance work order hours ¹	14,787	17,732	13,136
Service request rate: per cent of demand work order hours ¹	49%	43%	59%
Operating cost per vehicle km ¹	\$2.10	\$1.24	\$1.58
Total fuel consumed by vehicles (litres per 100 km) ¹	-	26.65	28.00
Average Age of Fleet (years)			
Municipal Fleet	-	8	8
Police Fleet	-	8	7
Fire Apparatus (Engines, Tankers, Quints, and Aerials)	-	16	14
Fire Supporting Fleet	-	12	12
Light Fleet Electric Vehicles (EV) (cumulative) ^{1, 2, 3}			
Total Number of Light Vehicles	592	600	606
EV Light Vehicles	51	62	64
ICE (Internal Combustion Engines) Vehicles	541	538	542
¹ Measures are for Municipal Fleet (excludes Emergency Fleet & Transit) ² 2025/26 data include vehicles received up to October 31, 2025 ³ Includes Plug-In Hybrid (PHEV) and Battery Electric Vehicle (BEV) Analysis: - A comprehensive review of the Preventative Maintenance Program allowed for implementation of improvements and revised processes. The data and reporting produced by Corporate Fleet now provides a more accurate representation of the hours utilized to complete vehicle preventative maintenance work (extend asset life) and demand work (break/fix). - Fleet recapitalization plays a key role in the reduction of downtime not only for the vehicle, but also for the user. Vehicle maintenance and operating costs of municipal fleet vehicles are influenced by several factors including usage, weather, cost of fuel, vehicle/equipment, age, and vocation.			

- The 2024/25 operating cost per kilometer is impacted by the volatile increase in the cost of parts, uncertainty of tariffs and fuel rates, and is expected to remain higher than previous years and continue to be challenged with global supply chain shortages. Current challenges associated with industry shortages of skilled tradespersons in automotive and truck repair are affecting both internal and external ability to provide specialized mechanical services within established service timelines.
- Aging equipment costs more to maintain, requires maintaining a large parts inventory or sourcing, is less usable, and produces higher emission levels.
- Corporate Fleet continues to make strides in actively moving towards providing a sustainable green fleet as it aligns with Regional Council's priority of decarbonizing transportation. The table above provides a breakdown of the acquired light fleet electric vehicles. The current estimated timeline for conversion of 95% of the light vehicle fleet is 2035.

Corporate Real Estate	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Property transactions (acquisitions and disposals)	\$10.7M	\$19.5M	\$70M	\$40M
Industrial Park sales (acres)	54	84	44	135
Industrial Park sales (gross revenue)	\$26M	\$40M	\$24M	\$47M

Analysis:

- The strong population growth and market for the municipality continues to put demand pressure on land supply and is increasing the land cost for capital projects. CRE is supporting several major projects including, but not limited to, the land acquisitions for the IMP and transportation corridors, Burnside Phase 13 expansion, and Cogswell land availability readiness.
- Property Transactions
 - Land transactions for 2025/26 were driven mainly by acquisitions for the Robie Street Transit Priority Corridor with over 50% of the properties purchased
 - Bayers Rd Property requirements completed - 29 of 29
 - Robie Street Property requirements status - 23 of 33 completed or under agreement
 - Transaction volumes for land to support transit and transportation projects is expected to continue in 2026/27 with \$30M planned.
 - Property reviews, nominal transactions in support of community initiatives, and affordable housing were allocated significant resources.
- Industrial Lands
 - The short-term demand for industrial land has been met with the launch of Burnside Phase 13-1, with \$70M of lots brought to market in fiscal 2024/25. Burnside Phase 13-3 will be tendered in early 2026.

- Going forward, the timely planning approvals will enable the buildout of Ragged Lake and Burnside Phase 13/14. Ragged Lake will be critical and necessary to allow Regional Council to meet or exceed its industrial land supply goal of up to 50-100 acres per year.
- The Planning & Development business unit, as a strategic partner, will lead the planning initiatives necessary to deliver the industrial supply for Regional Council. The industrial land program is one of the municipality's largest investments to the regional economy, and Gross Domestic Product is estimated at over \$2.5 billion annually for Burnside alone.
- Leasing and Tenant Services
 - Corporate Accommodations will successfully deliver new space for the consolidation of the Public Works business unit which is expected to be completed at end of fiscal 2026.
 - Leasing & Tenant Services is also delivering leased accommodation for its new commercial tenant on the 4th floor of Alderney Gate which will bring the office complex to full occupancy in early 2026.

Environment & Climate Change	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Total number of electric vehicle charging stations in the municipality for public use (cumulative)	168	209	214	224
Number of level 2 electric vehicle charging ports in the municipality for public use (cumulative)	154	182	186	194
Number of direct current fast chargers in the municipality for public use (cumulative)	14	27	28	30
Total corporate GHG emissions (tonnes)	100,953	103,572	101,000	89,000
Total GHG emissions associated with municipal buildings (tonnes) ¹	49,552	50,674	50,000	48,000
Capacity of net-metered solar installed (megawatts) (cumulative)	34.25	45.51	55	65
Number of net-zero and net-zero ready municipally owned buildings	4	4	5	8
Per cent of the municipality's light duty fleet that is fully electric (cumulative)	4.6%	7%	10.6%	15.7%
Greenhouse gas emissions (tonnes per capita) ²	10.72	10.07	9.70	9.40
Percentage of water (recreational) quality guideline exceedance ³	32%	11%	10%	N/A
Funding committed to Build Back Better projects	n/a	n/a	1,157,854	9,080,000
Number of community engagement sessions on climate action	19	34	40	35

Cumulative financing committed through Solar City Program	-	\$27M	\$28M	\$29M
¹ Includes solid waste. ² Projected to remain static in the short term as programs and policies are implemented. ³ The percentage of monitoring results that exceed Health Canada's water quality guidelines for recreational water usage for E. Coli or cyanobacteria levels on supervised beaches. Analysis: - Investments in solar energy continue to grow. As of year-end 2024, \$27 million in solar energy systems have been installed through the Solar City Program. These systems are expected to save property owners a total of \$1.9 million annually in utility costs and reduce annual greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions in the community by approximately 6,600 tonnes. The Solar City Program has enabled the installation of 9.80 megawatts (MW) of renewable energy in the municipality. - Public charging infrastructure continues to grow. Public charging infrastructure is now operational at 10 municipally owned facilities, resulting in 29 chargers for public use (7 Level 3 and 22 Level 2 chargers). Construction is underway at the Beechville-Lakeside-Timberlea Community Centre. In the next few months, construction at 40 Alderney and Point Pleasant Park will commence, with anticipated completion at end of the third Quarter. Design work and/or preliminary site investigation is ongoing at various sites that will fill the current gap in charging infrastructure. - Municipal building emissions will begin to decrease. NSPI's grid emissions intensity is expected to hold steady this year, then decline starting next year, aiming for an 80% renewables / 20% natural gas mix by 2030. The municipality's power purchase agreement, effective December 31, 2027, will further reduce the municipality's GHG emissions once it is operational. Between 2023/24 and 2024/25, HRM's electricity use rose ~3%, while fossil fuel use fell ~1%. Through the fuel-switching projects (started in 2021) completed recently or by early 2026, we anticipate another 1.5% fossil fuel reduction, offset by only a 0.5% electricity increase in 2026/27. - Corporate emissions have been decreasing over time. The slight increase in 2024-25 is due to higher-than-expected electrical emissions, a new solid waste facility coming online while the previous facility was coming offline, and an increase in heavy duty fleet diesel consumption. Decreased emissions are expected in the coming years through electric buses becoming operational in the transit fleet, deep energy retrofit projects are completed resulting in lower energy usage, more electric vehicles are incorporated into the fleet, and decreased electricity emissions through Nova Scotia Power's grid greening and the municipality's green power purchase agreements. - Community greenhouse gas emissions continue to decrease, even with a growing population. This is particularly evident in the per capita emissions. This decrease can be attributed to continued electrification through the installation of heat pumps, the use of electric vehicles, and decreasing grid emissions as Nova Scotia power brings additional renewable energy projects online.				
Facility Maintenance & Operations	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Number of planned maintenance work order requests	5,318	5,367	5,700	6,000

Number of demand maintenance work order requests	10,110	11,971	13,000	13,000
Cost of facility maintenance per square foot ¹	\$15.30	\$18.30	\$19.25	\$21.25
Utility cost per square foot (heating fuel / natural gas / electricity / water)	\$2.05	\$2.63	\$2.89	\$3.10
Total square footage of buildings maintained by FMO	3,007,952	2,989,210	3,002,000	3,005,000
Proportion of work orders that are preventative maintenance	35%	31%	31%	31.5%
Facility Utilities and Service Contract Costs				
Utilities	\$6.5M	\$5.6M	\$6.0M	\$6.5M
Contract Costs	\$7.1M	\$7.2M	\$7.5M	\$7.75M

¹ Costs are not inclusive of program support or amortization allocations.

Analysis:

- In addition to the services directly managed and funded by the budget, Facility Maintenance and Operations (FMO) provides services for other business units, including Halifax Transit, Library Services, and community-run facilities. For the community-run facilities, certain maintenance responsibilities fall under governing boards or external entities.
- The demand for maintenance services continues to grow. The volume of demand and planned maintenance work orders is projected to increase by approximately 23.3% compared to 2023/24. This demand is driven by aging infrastructure, as well as onboarding of newly constructed, more energy efficient facilities with advanced technology.
- Progress on the Cityworks Asset Registry will continue, with four (4) facilities scheduled for asset registration completion by the end of 2026. This initiative drives consistent and accurate storage of planned maintenance data in the Cityworks system.
- . While utility costs were decreased in 24/25 and 25/26, costs are projected to increase in 26/27 marking a return to 23/24 levels (\$6.5 million).
- The primary drivers of rising costs include aging infrastructure and contract service costs. Contract service costs are linked to the implementaion of a living wage policy under the Municipal Supplier Code of Conduct. Additional cost pressures come from rising supply expenses and insurance premiums.

Facility Design & Construction	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025 Projected	2026 Planned
Growth Projects delivered	\$25,200,000	\$20,679,372	\$46,633,746	\$31,964,000
Asset renewal Projects delivered	\$27,379,215	\$31,675,940	\$38,786,717	\$53,610,334
Deep Energy Retrofits (including Fuel Conversions)	3	12	11	12

Building condition assessments completed				
Updated ¹	8	8	40	40
New ²	2	0	3	0
Municipal Oil Usage (litres)	1,190,625	1,050,294	1,040,837	999,750

¹ Updated: Facilities which were assessed in prior years, being reassessed, and updated.

² New: Facilities being assessed for the first time.

Analysis:

Growth Projects (Capital Delivery)

Major construction activities and improvement projects in 2025/2026 included:

- Beechville Lakeside Timberlea Community Centre (BLT CC)
 - Complete replacement of the existing facility.
 - The new building will include a gymnasium, community space, universal washrooms and will be built to net-zero construction.
 - Construction is underway and will be completed in the spring of 2026.
- HRFE Headquarters and Station 1
 - Construction has begun and will complete in the fall of 2026.
 - The new building will be built to net-zero construction.
- Eastern Shore Lifestyle Centre (ESLC)
 - Construction has begun on the new facility which will include a new fire station, recreation centre and public library.
 - The new building will be built to net-zero construction.
 - Included in the Investing in Canada Infrastructure Program (ICIP)
- Various Accessibility Projects:
 - ESLC will be constructed to meet Rick Hansen Gold Certification.
 - Tender for switchback pathway at Sackville Sports Stadium

Asset Renewal Projects (Capital Delivery)

Major capital improvement and repair/replacement projects in 2025/2026 included:

- Cole Harbour Recreation Centre
 - Relocation of the Cole Harbour Recreation Centre into Cole Harbour Place to maintain the program offerings within the community after the former leased facility is shutdown.
 - This renovation will be completed in the fall/winter of 2025.
- East Dartmouth Community Centre Renovation
 - Renovation to convert green roof space to interior programing space to better serve community needs.
 - This work was completed in the fall of 2025.

- **Station 2 University Avenue Recap**
 - The municipality's oldest continuously operating fire station. Interior renovations will improve energy efficiency, improve operational activities and state of good repair for the facility.
 - Construction was completed in the spring of 2025.
- **Scotiabank Centre Ice Plant and Cooling System Replacement**
 - Replacement of mechanical systems in a 46-year-old facility that is an important entertainment and tourism venue.
 - \$12M project implemented energy-efficient mechanical systems with reduced water, energy, and labour demands and consistent, state-of-the-art ice production and A/C systems.
 - Included in the Investing in Canada Infrastructure Program (ICIP)
 - Construction was completed in the spring of 2025.
- **HRFE Facility Improvements**
 - Conversion of Station 38 (Middle Musquodoboit) to a career station. Completed in the summer of 2025
 - Exhaust extractor systems at multiple fire stations.
 - Conversion of Station 50(Upper Hammonds Plains) to a career station. Design to be completed in the fall of 2025, construction expected to be completed in the fall/winter of 2026.
 - Supply and installation of new fixed generators at Stations #4 and #6 to be completed in the winter of 2026/27.

HalifACT - Energy Efficiency Initiatives

The following work will be completed by FDC for the 2025/26 fiscal year:

- **Net-Zero Ready New Buildings**
 - Design for Eastern Shore Lifestyle Centre, Wright's Cove Transit Terminal.
 - Construction will be completed for Ragged Lake Transit Centre.
 - Study will be completed to optimize the design of heat pump systems in net-zero new construction projects.
- **Major Buildings Targeted for Deep Energy Retrofits.**
 - Energy Audits to be completed for Fire Stations including Station 9, Station 10, Station 11, Station 41, Station 50, Station 65, and the Sackville Heights Community Centre.
 - Construction will be completed for Station 7, Station 56, and Acadia Centre.
 - Work with Legal & Legislative Services and Procurement to adapt the Progressive Design Build (PDB) procurement process developed for new construction projects to engage design build teams for deep energy retrofits.
 - Establish a pre-qualified roster of five Progressive Design Build Deep Energy Retrofit (DER) teams.

- Issue two to three PDB DER requests for proposals (RFPs) to the pre-qualified roster of teams prior to the end of the 25/26 fiscal year.
- Oil Conversions
 - Design for Station 8, Station 14, and Richmond Family Court.
 - Construction will be completed for Lake Echo Community Centre, Upper Hammonds Plains Community Centre, Station 38, Carroll's Corner Community Centre, Scott Manor House, East Preston Community Centre, Eastern Shore Community Centre, and the Chocolate Lake Community Centre.
- Recommissioning
 - Canada Games Centre
 - RBC Centre
 - Greenfoot Energy Centre
 - Woodside Ferry Terminal

Facility Design and Construction continues to improve project delivery through the development of standardized project management plans and research of alternative contracting methods, to better align with industry direction.

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
EP-02 Expedite the delivery of housing supply and support the development of complete communities with a mix of housing options and convenient access to goods, services and facilities.	
Eastern Shore Lifestyle Centre <i>Service Area: Facility Design & Construction</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A4 A multi-year project consisting of a community centre, library, and fire station. Construction will commence in Q1 of 2025/26 with a phased approach, anticipating opening of the entire facility by Q4 2027/28.	31-Mar-28

Deliverable	Completion
Halifax Regional Police Facilities Replacement Study <i>Service Area: Facility Design & Construction</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A5 This is a multi-year program to replace the existing Halifax Regional Police (HRP) headquarters and divisional locations. In 2026/27, work will entail functional planning and site selection.	31-Jul-26
Halifax Regional Police Headquarters Facilities <i>Service Area: Facility Design & Construction</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A5 Complete the building massing and site evaluation study and present a recommendation for facility configuration and location to the Board of Police Commissioners and Regional Council.	31-Mar-27
Halifax North Public Library Phase 1 <i>Service Area: Facility Design & Construction</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A10 A multi-year project to fully renovate the Halifax North Public Library using a progressive design build methodology. The library will be redeveloped to accommodate growth, increased service usage, and demand for cultural and educational services. Public consultation and design to be completed by Spring 2027.	31-Mar-27
EP-03 Maintain and improve municipal infrastructure resilience to mitigate and adapt to the impacts of climate change.	
Critical Infrastructure Climate Change Vulnerability and Risk Assessment Phase 2 <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-03-A1 Complete Phase 2 of the Climate Change Vulnerability and Risk Assessment (CCVRA) by assessing vulnerability of municipal linear assets (bridges, roads, trails, multi-use paths). Initiate the assessment in 2026 and deliver a final vulnerability assessment report, including risk ratings and priority mitigation actions, by 2028.	31-Mar-28
Heat Action Plan <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-03-A1 Develop a Corporate Heat Action Plan that identifies risks to municipal operations and services, outlines response protocols, recommends facility adaptations, and includes an implementation roadmap.	31-Mar-28

Deliverable	Completion
Climate Adaptation Pathways Modelling <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-03-A2 Develop and validate a Climate Adaptation Model, quantifying projected climate impacts and assessing long-term costs and benefits of adaptation actions. Deliver a technical report and modeling tool.	31-Mar-27
Coastal Adaptation <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-03-A3 Develop a scope and process for identifying and prioritizing resilience measures for the municipality's coastline.	31-Mar-28
EP-04 Ensure residents and businesses can contribute to and benefit from the municipality's growing economy.	
Supply of Industrial Lands – Burnside Phase 14 <i>Service Area: Corporate Real Estate</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-04-A9 Work with Planning & Development to initiate background studies for the zoning and servicing of proposed Phase 14 Burnside for Industrial use as directed by Regional Council in 2015.	31-Mar-27
Aerotech Zoning <i>Service Area: Corporate Real Estate</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-04-A9 Prepare an application to amend zoning at Aerotech Business Park to permit a broader range of industrial uses.	31-Mar-27
Supply of Industrial Lands – Ragged Lake Secondary Planning <i>Service Area: Corporate Real Estate</i> Action Plan Reference: EP-04-A9 Corporate Real Estate will undertake necessary background reports (watershed impact, infrastructure study) on Ragged Lake expansion to support secondary planning considerations.	30-Jun-26

Deliverable	Completion
SC-01 Improve municipal preparedness planning to mitigate the potential impacts of emergency situations and climate-related events.	
Fire Safety Plans <i>Service Area: Facility Maintenance & Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-01-A5 Engage a consultant to review and update the Fire Safety Plans for five municipal facilities, ensuring compliance with current regulations and alignment with operational needs.	31-Mar-27
SC-05 Improve equitable access to municipal programs, services, indoor and outdoor spaces, and events for all residents.	
Halifax Forum Phase 1 <i>Service Area: Facility Design & Construction</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-05-A2 This is a multi-year project consisting of the redevelopment of the Halifax Forum Complex using a progressive design build methodology. The balance of Phase 1 will be the completion of the design, pending recommendations of the Heritage Advisory Committee and approval of the conceptual design by Regional Council.	31-Mar-27
SC-06 Invest to enable community efforts to reduce carbon emissions by 75% (of 2016 levels) by 2030 and net-zero by 2050.	
Administer the Solar City Program <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-06-A1 Deliver Year 10 of the Solar City Program by processing applications, supporting installations, and publishing a participation and performance summary for 2026/27.	31-Mar-27
Launch Community Retrofit Program <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-06-A1 Launch Year 1 of the Community Retrofit Program by enrolling eligible households, supporting retrofit installations, and producing a year-end participation and completion summary for 2026/27.	31-Mar-27
Resilience Retrofit Guidebook <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-06-A1 Develop and publish a Resilience Retrofit Guidebook that provides homeowners with climate-resilient retrofit measures, cost ranges, design considerations, and case studies tailored to local risks.	31-Dec-27

Deliverable	Completion
Install Public Electric Vehicle Chargers <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-06 -A2 Install and commission up to 10 new public EV chargers across the municipality.	31-Mar-27
Enabling Community Climate Action <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-06; no Action alignment Deliver community climate action initiatives by convening two HalifACT External Network meetings, delivering community climate workshops and programming, administering youth climate action funding and programs, and completing a review of programs with updated recommendations	31-Mar-28
Strategic Climate Partnerships <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-06; no Action alignment Lead strategic climate partnerships by co-leading quarterly CEO Climate Action Charter meetings, delivering the annual CEO Climate Action Summit, and establishing regular partner meetings to identify collaboration and leveraging opportunities.	31-Mar-28
SC-07 Invest in the enhancement, protection, and expansion of natural assets, green spaces and urban agriculture to support community and ecological health and resilient ecosystem services.	
Living Lakeshores <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-07-A1 Collaborate with Parks staff to deliver nature-based stabilization and restoration projects (Green Shores) at municipal lakefront parks. Complete installation at Kinsmen Beach (First Lake) and finalize shoreline design for Lake Echo, including site plans and implementation requirements.	31-Mar-27
Stormwater Management in Lakes <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-07-A5 Identify stormwater discharge locations at Penhorn Lake and Lake Banook posing stress to lake health and municipal programming (such as the municipal supervised beach program) and consider options to manage impacts, prioritizing nature-based solutions.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Invasive Species Management <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: SC-07-A9 Advance the implementation of the Integrated Pest Management Plan by delivering the second lake treatment for pest management at Little Albro Lake and launching the Hemlock Healers volunteer program to support treatment of Hemlock trees in municipal parks affected by invasive pests.	31-Mar-27
Natural Asset Inventory and Valuation <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-07; no Action alignment Update the 2021 Natural Asset Inventory to include 2025 assets. The updated inventory will include an ecosystem services valuation to inform resilience planning, asset management, green infrastructure, and parks planning in collaboration with Asset Management.	31-Mar-28
MB-02 Improve the reliability of public transit.	
Integrated Mobility Plan Land Acquisition-Young/Robie <i>Service Area: Corporate Real Estate</i> Action Plan Reference: MB-01-A2 Corporate Real Estate will advance the land acquisition work to support implementation of the Integrated Mobility Plan (IMP) transit corridors and initiatives for Young Street and Robie Street to support the IMP and HalifACT.	31-Mar-28
RA-02 Monitor, maintain, and replace municipal assets to establish and ensure service levels.	
Asbestos Surveys <i>Service Area: Facility Maintenance & Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-02; no Action alignment Conduct new asbestos surveys for five municipal facilities.	31-Mar-27
Radon Testing <i>Service Area: Facility Maintenance & Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-02; no Action alignment Complete radon testing for five municipal facilities.	31-Mar-27
Cityworks Work Orders and Asset Registry Phase 3 <i>Service Area: Facility Maintenance & Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-02; no Action alignment In Phase 3, the collection of asset data for several major facilities will be completed.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Improved Cost Analysis and Work Order Benchmarking <i>Service Area: Facility Maintenance & Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-02; no Action alignment Develop a centralized dashboard to provide real-time visibility into outsourcing expenses. This will include cost comparison between in-house and vendor work to identify savings opportunities and integration of workload analytics reflecting active work orders and staff utilization. The goal is to establish clear benchmarks for workload to support data-driven outsourcing decisions.	31-Mar-27
RA-03 Reach net-zero municipal operations by 2030.	
Increase Renewable Energy through Power Purchase Agreement and Exploring Emerging Technologies <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: RA-03-A1 Negotiate and execute renewable energy Purchase Power Agreements that increase the share of corporate electricity sourced from renewables beyond 50% and produce an emerging technologies report outlining additional renewable pathways for the municipality.	31-Mar-27
Net-Zero Energy – Deep Energy Retrofits <i>Service Area: Facility Design & Construction</i> Action Plan Reference: RA-03-A1 Deep energy retrofits is an ongoing program to meet the 2030 goal of net-zero municipal facilities. Two of the top 10 greenhouse gas emitting facilities in the portfolio will have progressive design build deep energy retrofit projects underway.	31-Mar-27
Net-Zero Energy – Recommissioning <i>Service Area: Facility Design & Construction</i> Action Plan Reference: RA-03-A1 Recommissioning is focused on optimizing building operations to save energy. Projects will be carried out at facilities with the highest identified emissions reduction through recommissioning measures.	31-Mar-27
Net-Zero Energy – Oil Conversion <i>Service Area: Facility Design & Construction</i> Action Plan Reference: RA-03-A1 The conversion of buildings using oil is part of the overall net-zero roadmap process. The Capital Plan will determine which projects progress for 2026/27.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Net-Zero Energy – New Construction <i>Service Area: Facility Design & Construction</i> Action Plan Reference: RA-03-A1 New construction projects will be built to net-zero standards. The Capital Plan will determine which projects progress for 2026/27.	31-Mar-27
Install Corporate Electric Vehicle Chargers for Fleet <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: RA-03-A2 Install and commission up to 80 electric fleet charging stations to further support the municipal EV fleet transition.	31-Mar-27
Transitioning Light Fleet to Electrification <i>Service Area: Corporate Fleet</i> Action Plan Reference: RA-03-A2 In partnership with Environment & Climate Change, refine the procurement and transition plan for light-duty electric vehicles to reflect current challenges with charging-infrastructure installation and site availability. Update timelines and implementation steps to ensure alignment with infrastructure readiness and operational requirements.	31-Mar-27
HalifACT Reporting – Emissions Inventory <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-03; no Action alignment Complete and publish the 2025 Community and Corporate GHG Emissions Inventory along with the 2025–2026 annual HalifACT progress report, including updating indicators and year-over-year analysis.	31-Mar-27
Internal Climate Governance and Mainstreaming <i>Service Area: Environment & Climate Change</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-03; no Action alignment Administer the HalifACT Governance Model by convening monthly working group meetings, delivering an annual cross-department strategy session, developing a formal process to integrate HalifACT actions into business planning, and offering Climate 101 and other training modules.	31-Mar-28

Deliverable	Completion
RA-04 Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency, and cost effectiveness, while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.	
Technology Roadmap <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action alignment Work with the IT Business Relationship Manager to progress the technology initiatives mapped out in the technology roadmap.	31-Mar-27
PFE Performance Excellence Strategy <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action alignment Performance Excellence and continuous improvement is a key focus for PFE. This is guided by the identification of risks and improvement opportunities, which are linked to the work of the business unit Employee Engagement committees and Performance Excellence Champion Committee. Results are reflected in regular tracking and communication of the benefits associated with continuous improvement activities.	31-Mar-28
Process Improvement Initiative – Corporate Safety Audit <i>Service Area: Facility Design & Construction</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action alignment Conduct an audit of Facility Design & Construction work practices as well as knowledge of corporate safety policies and programs. The audit will result in a report identifying areas for improvement and recommendations to increase awareness, provide training and modify standard operating procedures with the goal of accident and injury prevention and elevated awareness of safety. Recommendations will be implemented and a follow-up audit conducted in 2027/28 to assess improvement.	31-Mar-27
Vendor Onboarding Documentation Update <i>Service Area: Facility Maintenance & Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action alignment Update onboarding documentation for contracted vendors to clarify requirements, streamline processes, and ensure consistency across all service areas.	31-Mar-27
Contract Management – Standard Operating Procedures <i>Service Area: Facility Maintenance & Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action alignment Develop standard operating procedures for contract management functions.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
OP-01 Foster a workplace that is equitable, diverse, inclusive, and accessible.	
Diversity and Inclusion <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-01-A3</i> Partner with the PFE Diversity & Inclusion Advisor to consult on connections with communities, ensure opportunities to apply the EDIA lens are utilized in PFE work, and identify and complete training in various Diversity & Inclusion topics.	31-Mar-28

Summary of Net Expenditures - Property, Fleet & Equipment

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
D935 Enviro & Climate Chg	3,718,331	4,665,600	4,198,800	3,996,700	(668,900)	(14.3)
D930 Public Charging	5,536	-	39,000	(17,000)	(17,000)	-
** Environment & Climate Change	3,723,867	4,665,600	4,237,800	3,979,700	(685,900)	(14.7)
W100 Real Est & Mgt Admin	902,562	1,011,000	1,066,100	949,100	(61,900)	(6.1)
W202 Commercial Leasing	5,429,578	5,486,700	5,394,800	5,669,900	183,200	3.3
W400 Acquisitions & Disposals	276,918	486,100	646,600	493,400	7,300	1.5
W500 Business Parks	81,987	121,500	234,200	216,300	94,800	78.0
W955 Corporate Accommodations	45,013	75,000	75,000	75,000	-	-
** Corporate Real Estate	6,736,058	7,180,300	7,416,700	7,403,700	223,400	3.1
I101 Prop,Fleet&Env Admin	463,774	469,000	488,800	476,400	7,400	1.6
** Director's Office - PFE	463,774	469,000	488,800	476,400	7,400	1.6
W953 Facility Development	1,602,835	2,178,000	2,243,300	2,178,900	900	0.0
** Facility Design & Construction	1,602,835	2,178,000	2,243,300	2,178,900	900	0.0
W220 Clearing-Facilities	-	-	-	-	-	-
W959 Clearing - Capital	(806)	-	-	-	-	-
* Ops Admin	(806)	-	-	-	-	-
C770 LKD Bldgs/Operations	-	-	-	-	-	-
R102 Integrated Sec Manag	2,742,852	2,874,300	2,735,100	2,764,800	(109,500)	(3.8)
W135 LockedConstr Service	-	-	-	-	-	-
W160 Facilities Admin	2,162,528	2,320,600	1,932,600	1,829,200	(491,400)	(21.2)
W169 Transitional Properties	69,413	107,300	91,800	105,700	(1,600)	(1.5)
W200 Facility Operations	10,713,111	10,980,600	12,327,500	13,508,900	2,528,300	23.0
W211 LKDClean&TenantServ.	-	-	-	-	-	-
W212 LKDStructural&Arenas	-	-	-	-	-	-
W213 Mechanical & PM Serv	10,674,212	10,124,400	10,064,400	9,449,400	(675,000)	(6.7)
Z112 Stadium Operations	1,854,213	1,860,900	1,864,500	1,828,000	(32,900)	(1.8)
* Operations	28,216,330	28,268,100	29,015,900	29,486,000	1,217,900	4.3
** Municipal Facilities Mtce & Ope	28,215,524	28,268,100	29,015,900	29,486,000	1,217,900	4.3
R912 Fleet: Administration	1,036,612	1,042,500	1,075,600	1,055,200	12,700	1.2
* Fleet: Administration	1,036,612	1,042,500	1,075,600	1,055,200	12,700	1.2
R970 Fleet R&M:Municipal	7,456,145	9,033,500	8,435,800	9,464,000	430,500	4.8
* Fleet: Municipal Site	7,456,145	9,033,500	8,435,800	9,464,000	430,500	4.8
R981 Fleet R&M:Fire	5,666,134	6,641,700	6,524,300	6,311,700	(330,000)	(5.0)
R985 Fleet R&M:Police	2,443,274	3,030,800	2,907,600	3,208,500	177,700	5.9
* Fleet: Emergency	8,109,408	9,672,500	9,431,900	9,520,200	(152,300)	(1.6)
** Corporate Fleet	16,602,165	19,748,500	18,943,300	20,039,400	290,900	1.5
*** Net Total	57,344,223	62,509,500	62,345,800	63,564,100	1,054,600	1.7

Summary of Expenditures Details - Property, Fleet & Equipment

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	16,760,482	19,449,800	18,794,200	20,110,600	660,800	3.4
6002 Salaries - Overtime	937,791	682,500	828,300	664,600	(17,900)	(2.6)
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(1,179,308)	-	(546,900)	-	-	-
6051 Shift Agreements	44,601	85,700	86,300	91,400	5,700	6.7
6054 Vacation payout	32,650	-	37,200	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	3,832,498	4,050,600	4,140,200	4,316,700	266,100	6.6
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(1,211,300)	-	(1,262,300)	(51,000)	4.2
6150 Honorariums	-	-	200	-	-	-
6152 Retirement Incentives	115,967	150,200	137,200	154,700	4,500	3.0
6153 Severance	-	-	35,000	-	-	-
6154 Workers' Compensation	501,157	677,300	647,600	661,400	(15,900)	(2.3)
6155 Overtime Meals	(375)	2,500	2,700	2,500	-	-
6156 Clothing Allowance	9,150	16,200	16,200	15,900	(300)	(1.9)
6158 WCB Recov Earnings	(2,413)	-	(1,300)	-	-	-
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	(136,003)	454,400	(8,700)	(202,100)	(656,500)	(144.5)
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	(374,727)	(296,400)	(513,400)	(296,700)	(300)	0.1
9210 HR CATS OT Wage/Ben	(38,392)	(45,900)	(54,900)	(45,900)	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	20,503,078	24,015,600	23,599,900	24,210,800	195,200	0.8
6201 Telephone/Cable	70,723	76,100	72,200	38,100	(38,000)	(49.9)
6202 Courier/Postage	17,302	5,600	13,400	12,500	6,900	123.2
6203 Office Furn/Equip	8,577	19,100	33,800	19,000	(100)	(0.5)

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	83,870	88,000	18,000	43,000	(45,000)	(51.1)
6205 Printing & Reprod	135	200	-	200	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	40,498	34,300	33,600	32,500	(1,800)	(5.2)
6299 Other Office Expenses	181	200	200	200	-	-
* Office	221,286	223,500	171,200	145,500	(78,000)	(34.9)
6301 Professional Fees	181	-	-	-	-	-
6302 Legal Fees	12,438	10,000	11,600	5,000	(5,000)	(50.0)
6303 Consulting Fees	469,550	1,392,900	960,200	979,500	(413,400)	(29.7)
6304 Janitorial Services	3,410,389	3,560,100	3,601,000	3,993,100	433,000	12.2
6305 Property Appraisal	7,248	40,000	32,400	30,000	(10,000)	(25.0)
6306 Property Survey	8,652	25,000	82,400	20,000	(5,000)	(20.0)
6308 Snow Removal	1,032,769	891,500	947,800	1,119,000	227,500	25.5
6311 Security	1,910,125	1,828,600	1,709,400	1,666,000	(162,600)	(8.9)
6312 Refuse Collection	304,487	310,000	310,000	322,000	12,000	3.9
6390 Extnl Svcs OCC Trsf	(15,000)	-	-	-	-	-
6399 Contract Services	1,268,502	1,200,100	1,362,200	1,233,500	33,400	2.8
* External Services	8,409,341	9,258,200	9,017,000	9,368,100	109,900	1.2
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	44,031	59,900	62,100	52,400	(7,500)	(12.5)
6402 Med & First Aid Supp	15,581	7,300	11,300	9,200	1,900	26.0
6406 Bridge Tolls	10,109	10,400	-	-	(10,400)	(100.0)
6407 Clean/Sani Supplies	180,713	178,800	169,100	169,500	(9,300)	(5.2)
6409 Personal Protect Equ	50,862	59,000	57,300	60,500	1,500	2.5
6499 Other Supplies	414	1,000	1,000	500	(500)	(50.0)
* Supplies	301,710	316,400	300,800	292,100	(24,300)	(7.7)
6501 Asphalt	-	500	500	500	-	-
6502 Chemicals	45,846	41,500	57,400	52,400	10,900	26.3
6504 Hardware	5,188	13,600	6,600	6,000	(7,600)	(55.9)
6505 Lubricants	108,184	114,500	117,500	119,700	5,200	4.5
6506 Lumber	-	1,500	-	200	(1,300)	(86.7)
6507 Propane	204,017	158,600	180,400	158,400	(200)	(0.1)
6517 Paint	23,029	60,000	30,000	40,000	(20,000)	(33.3)
6518 Metal	166	-	-	-	-	-
6519 Welding Supplies	5,051	8,200	8,500	8,700	500	6.1
6599 Other Materials	-	200	200	-	(200)	(100.0)
* Materials	391,480	398,600	401,100	385,900	(12,700)	(3.2)
6602 Electrical	472,023	437,500	622,000	437,500	-	-
6603 Grnds & Landscaping	40,134	51,000	54,000	37,000	(14,000)	(27.5)
6605 Municipal Taxes	929,131	980,000	943,500	1,095,000	115,000	11.7
6606 Heating Fuel	883,672	1,210,000	1,110,000	1,210,000	-	-
6607 Electricity	3,902,548	4,408,300	4,043,700	4,522,400	114,100	2.6
6608 Water	713,885	670,000	670,000	670,000	-	-
6609 Elevator & Escalator	98,357	124,700	124,700	431,600	306,900	246.1
6610 Building - Exterior	911,482	790,000	775,000	577,000	(213,000)	(27.0)
6611 Building - Interior	1,033,925	876,000	891,000	783,200	(92,800)	(10.6)
6612 Safety Systems	733,303	808,500	808,500	808,500	-	-
6613 Overhead Doors	189,484	152,000	192,000	172,000	20,000	13.2
6614 Envir Assess/Cleanup	218,260	173,500	148,500	93,700	(79,800)	(46.0)
6616 Natural Gas-Buildings	1,332,467	1,192,300	1,292,300	1,337,300	145,000	12.2
6617 Pest Management	61,797	61,500	60,500	61,500	-	-
6690 Building OCC Transfer	(30,000)	-	-	-	-	-
6699 Other Building Cost	3,380	2,000	10,000	2,000	-	-
* Building Costs	11,493,847	11,937,300	11,745,700	12,238,700	301,400	2.5
6701 Equipment Purchase	61,862	60,500	61,000	58,000	(2,500)	(4.1)
6702 Small Tools	101,085	102,600	84,500	86,500	(16,100)	(15.7)
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	18,170	22,600	23,500	23,100	500	2.2
6704 Equipment Rental	1,019	5,500	10,500	5,500	-	-
6705 Equip - R&M	104,452	166,300	147,700	173,300	7,000	4.2
6707 Plumbing & Heating	1,489,820	906,000	1,204,000	1,096,500	190,500	21.0
6708 Mechanical Equipment	1,802,992	1,607,000	2,003,500	1,750,000	143,000	8.9
6711 Communication System	307	1,200	-	-	(1,200)	(100.0)
* Equipment & Communications	3,579,708	2,871,700	3,534,700	3,192,900	321,200	11.2
6802 Vehicle R&M	2,942,048	3,583,600	3,521,600	3,368,600	(215,000)	(6.0)
6803 Vehicle Fuel - Diesel	1,266,009	1,485,900	1,440,700	1,658,100	172,200	11.6
6804 Vehicle Fuel - Gas	2,100,490	2,423,300	2,279,600	3,022,900	599,600	24.7
6805 Tires and Tubes	455,620	520,000	625,000	530,000	10,000	1.9

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6806 Vehicle Rentals	-	1,000	-	-	(1,000)	(100.0)
6809 Electricity-Vehicles	-	-	-	-	-	-
6810 Comm Vehicle R&M	2,139,330	2,125,000	1,950,000	1,825,000	(300,000)	(14.1)
6811 Shop Supplies	50,249	60,000	57,000	57,000	(3,000)	(5.0)
6899 Other Vehicle Expense	406,678	355,300	357,800	295,700	(59,600)	(16.8)
* Vehicle Expense	9,360,425	10,554,100	10,231,700	10,757,300	203,200	1.9
6901 Membership Dues	23,419	29,600	28,800	29,600	-	-
6902 Conferences/Workshop	6,664	21,000	25,900	7,500	(13,500)	(64.3)
6903 Travel - Local	45,949	43,100	38,700	40,800	(2,300)	(5.3)
6904 Travel - Out of Town	66,939	77,000	55,400	32,700	(44,300)	(57.5)
6905 Training & Education	72,868	106,500	109,500	52,000	(54,500)	(51.2)
6906 Licenses & Agreements	230,502	224,300	265,700	245,000	20,700	9.2
6907 Commission Fees	-	-	100	-	-	-
6908 Medical Examinations	60	2,000	600	2,000	-	-
6910 Signage	50	4,000	5,000	4,000	-	-
6911 Facilities Rental	5,192,588	5,360,400	5,237,400	5,500,500	140,100	2.6
6912 Advertising/Promotio	88,688	105,900	61,500	55,900	(50,000)	(47.2)
6913 Awards	-	-	-	-	-	-
6914 Recruiting	16,004	2,900	3,900	3,000	100	3.4
6915 Research Data Acquis	3,000	-	7,000	-	-	-
6916 Public Education	31,593	30,000	30,000	15,000	(15,000)	(50.0)
6917 Books and Periodicals	2,396	2,900	1,300	2,900	-	-
6918 Meals/Catering	6,968	12,700	11,700	7,400	(5,300)	(41.7)
6919 Special Projects	38,500	7,500	2,200	-	(7,500)	(100.0)
6936 Staff Relations	10,413	16,900	16,900	13,300	(3,600)	(21.3)
6937 Corporate Training	-	2,500	1,500	-	(2,500)	(100.0)
6938 Rewarding Excellence	12,118	20,200	20,800	8,400	(11,800)	(58.4)
6940 Fencing	2,177	10,000	10,000	5,000	(5,000)	(50.0)
6942 Management Fees	468	117,600	8,000	74,700	(42,900)	(36.5)
6943 Health and Wellness	109	-	-	-	-	-
6990 Gds & Svcs OCC Trsf	(150,400)	-	-	-	-	-
6999 Other Goods/Services	2,610	500	2,100	500	-	-
* Other Goods & Services	5,703,685	6,197,500	5,944,000	6,100,200	(97,300)	(1.6)
7009 Internal Trfr Other	(16,408)	(130,100)	(15,200)	(29,000)	101,100	(77.7)
7010 IntTrfr Insur Funds	(23,190)	-	-	-	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	6,389	6,200	4,500	6,200	-	-
7013 Int Trf Extra Duty	85,888	-	29,600	-	-	-
7015 Int Trf FacilityRent	(19,000)	-	-	-	-	-
7099 Interdept Chargeback	(23,780)	-	-	-	-	-
* Interdepartmental	9,898	(123,900)	18,900	(22,800)	101,100	(81.6)
8003 Insurance Pol/Prem	25,181	18,000	18,000	18,000	-	-
8004 Grants	89,901	-	345,000	-	-	-
8030 Tfr Fr Resvs to Oper	(62,034)	-	(19,100)	-	-	-
* Other Fiscal	53,047	18,000	343,900	18,000	-	-
** Total	60,027,507	65,667,000	65,308,900	66,686,700	1,019,700	1.6

Summary of Revenues Details - Property, Fleet & Equipment

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4703 Cond. Grant NS(Other)	(10,268)	-	-	-	-	-
4750 Other Grants	(66,230)	-	(139,800)	-	-	-
* Transfers from other Gov'ts	(76,498)	-	(139,800)	-	-	-
5101 Parking Rentals	(150,116)	(185,100)	(185,100)	(330,000)	(144,900)	78.3
5102 Facilities Rentals	(1,581,353)	(1,875,000)	(1,875,000)	(1,825,000)	50,000	(2.7)
5150 Other Rental Revenue	(121,095)	-	(132,800)	-	-	-
5151 Lease Revenue	(578,983)	(557,000)	(475,000)	(476,900)	80,100	(14.4)
5250 Sales of Svcs-Other	(4,619)	(470,200)	(77,000)	(393,000)	77,200	(16.4)
* Fee Revenues	(2,436,166)	(3,087,300)	(2,744,900)	(3,024,900)	62,400	(2.0)
5508 Recov External Parti	(170,620)	(70,200)	(78,400)	(97,700)	(27,500)	39.2
* Other Revenue	(170,620)	(70,200)	(78,400)	(97,700)	(27,500)	39.2
** Total	(2,683,284)	(3,157,500)	(2,963,100)	(3,122,600)	34,900	(1.1)
*** Net Total	57,344,223	62,509,500	62,345,800	63,564,100	1,054,600	1.7

HALIFAX

PUBLIC WORKS

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

PUBLIC WORKS

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

We take pride in providing high-quality Public Works services to benefit our citizens. We make a difference.

OVERVIEW

Public Works (PW) advances Council Priorities by delivering essential municipal services that keep the municipality safe, accessible and inclusive. The business unit maintains and manages critical infrastructure and services that enable the community to function effectively and meet the needs of residents and visitors.

PW delivers capital projects efficiently through effective planning, engineering and project management. It oversees the design and long-term stewardship of transportation infrastructure and provides maintenance services that keep roads, sidewalks, bridges and active transportation corridors safe and functional. PW also ensures year-round operations such as snow and ice control, emergency event response, urban forestry and right-of-way asset management.

In addition, PW manages waste collection, processing, education and enforcement to encourage waste diversion and responsible disposal. It operates recycling, composting and landfill facilities for both residential and commercial sectors while promoting environmental stewardship and compliance with municipal by-laws. PW also supports safe and efficient mobility by managing traffic flow, signals, signage, pavement markings and curbside space, ensuring the transportation network meets the needs of all users.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Executive Director's Office	✓ Oversight and Administration of Public Works Business Unit
Design & Asset Management	✓ Asset Management ✓ Bridge Inspection Program ✓ Design Support for Public Works Municipal Business Units ✓ Guiderail Request Analysis ✓ Roads and Active Transportation Capital Projects ✓ Structural Asset Management ✓ Survey Support for Municipal Business Units
Infrastructure Maintenance & Operations	✓ Bridge Maintenance ✓ Emergency Response ✓ Infrastructure Assessment and Works Control ✓ Mobility Tactical Support ✓ Sidewalk Maintenance ✓ Street Maintenance ✓ Urban Forest Management ✓ Winter Operations
Project Delivery	✓ Construction Support and Inspection for Public Works Municipal Business Units ✓ Transportation Capital Project Delivery for Municipal Business Units
Solid Waste Resources	✓ Chlorofluorocarbon Gas (CFC) Removal ✓ Collection Services ✓ Composting Facility Operation ✓ Construction and Demolition Waste Management ✓ Education Services ✓ Enforcement Services ✓ Highway 101 Landfill Site Management ✓ Household Special Waste (HSW) ✓ Otter Lake Operation ✓ Recycling – Commercial Recycling Processing ✓ Rural Refuse Depot Operations
Traffic & Parking Management	✓ Active Transportation General Projects ✓ Equipment Management ✓ Off-Street Parking ✓ Parking Enforcement

Service Area	Services Offered
	✓ Parking Permit Management ✓ Parking Supply and Curbside Management ✓ Parking Ticket Management and Administration ✓ Pavement Markings ✓ Private Property Special Constable Management ✓ Right-of-way (ROW) Approvals / Permitting / Utility Inspection ✓ Road Safety ✓ Sign Manufacturing ✓ Special Events – Traffic Signs ✓ Street Light Installation and Maintenance ✓ Towing Management ✓ Traffic Count Program ✓ Traffic Management ✓ Traffic Signal Maintenance ✓ Traffic Signs Installation and Maintenance

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		419.6
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Project Management Construction Inspector	Service Enhancement	2.0
Team Lead - East Operations	Maintain Current Service	1.0
Program Manager, Road Safety	Budget Committee Direction	1.0
Project Manager, Road Safety	Budget Committee Direction	1.0
Compliance Officer	Budget Committee Direction	4.0
Supervisor, Traffic Enforcement	Budget Committee Direction	1.0
Administrative Assistant II	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Transferred Positions		
Transfer from Planning & Development	Streetscaping Program transferred to Public Works	4.0
Transfer from SITP	Transportation Demand Management transferred to Public Works	2.0
Transfer to SITP	Active Transportation transferred from Public Works	(7.0)
Transfer to Major Projects Office	Transfer of positions from Public Works for Windsor Street Exchange Project	(2.0)
Total Changes		6.0
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		425.6

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Design & Asset Management	\$ 5,236,829	\$ 5,440,800	\$ 5,576,500	\$ 5,867,600	\$ 426,800	7.8
Executive Director's Office	477,941	684,600	651,800	685,400	800	0.1
Infrastructure Maintenance & Project Delivery	63,641,653	67,814,600	69,691,100	71,060,000	3,245,400	4.8
Solid Waste Resources	3,091,052	4,022,200	3,542,300	3,841,800	(180,400)	(4.5)
Traffic & Parking Management	35,441,528	33,705,100	33,192,200	30,920,800	(2,784,300)	(8.3)
	3,917,959	5,887,300	4,306,170	4,059,900	(1,827,400)	(31.0)
Net Total	\$ 111,806,962	\$ 117,554,600	\$ 116,960,070	\$ 116,435,500	\$ (1,119,100)	(1.0)

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 35,041,104	\$ 39,203,400	\$ 37,932,000	\$ 39,309,300	\$ 105,900	0.3
Office	186,467	266,750	251,600	293,000	26,250	9.8
External Services	90,073,526	91,550,800	91,840,770	93,567,900	2,017,100	2.2
Supplies	683,714	483,150	609,765	485,600	2,450	0.5
Materials	3,339,611	3,279,000	3,278,985	3,289,000	10,000	0.3
Building Costs	3,458,761	3,958,300	3,953,800	3,958,300	-	-
Equipment & Communications	456,417	504,400	650,300	518,100	13,700	2.7
Vehicle Expense	87,781	27,000	99,500	57,000	30,000	111.1
Other Goods & Services	2,087,754	2,379,000	2,405,350	2,838,700	459,700	19.3
Interdepartmental	98,761	42,900	41,100	52,900	10,000	23.3
Other Fiscal	(1,270,181)	(31,500)	(31,500)	686,000	717,500	(2,277.8)
Total Expenditures	134,243,716	141,663,200	141,031,670	145,055,800	3,392,600	2.4

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Transfers from other Gov'ts	\$ (3,753,907)	\$ (4,542,000)	\$ (4,542,000)	\$ (4,371,500)	\$ 170,500	(3.8)
Fee Revenues	(16,475,044)	(16,240,600)	(16,382,800)	(18,062,600)	(1,822,000)	11.2
Other Revenue	(2,207,803)	(3,326,000)	(3,146,800)	(6,186,200)	(2,860,200)	86.0
Total Revenues	(22,436,754)	(24,108,600)	(24,071,600)	(28,620,300)	(4,511,700)	18.7
Net Total	\$ 111,806,962	\$ 117,554,600	\$ 116,960,070	\$ 116,435,500	\$ (1,119,100)	(1.0)

* Budgets have been restated due to changes in organizational structure.

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 117,554,600
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Increases in solid waste contracts (CPI and tonnage increases)	1,936,800
Inflationary increase in state of good repair costs	1,390,000
Inflationary increase in traffic control, primarily asphalt works	288,500
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	(33,600)
Increase to winter operations contracts	2,619,800
Increase to street light and traffic light maintenance contracts	257,500
Revenue Changes	
Increase to parking pay station revenue	(300,000)
New revenue for compost and ammonium sulphate sales	(150,000)
Net miscellaneous revenues	(13,000)
Net revenues related to the Extended Producer Responsibility Program (EPR)	(1,846,800)
Other/Transfers	
Burnside Compost Facility is decommissioned, no further operational costs	(100,000)
Net expenditures related to EPR including a transfer to reserves of \$720K	(2,455,500)
Net miscellaneous expenditures	99,200
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact "Green" Reductions	(25,000)
Increase parking fees at MetroPark	(150,000)
Street Parking - Add paid parking Saturdays (1st hour free)	(311,000)
Street Parking - Increase Parking Rates by 25%	(975,000)
Street Parking - Increase monthly commuter permit fees by \$20/month	(149,400)
Expedite delivery of Road Safety Program	140,000
Road Safety Communications Plan	250,000
Parking Enforcement Revenues net of Staffing Increase	(62,800)
Increased Tipping Fees - Recyclables & Organics	(310,000)
Cut tree re-planting program	(1,000,000)
FTE Reductions - Vacant Positions	(218,800)
Total Changes	\$ (1,119,100)
2026/27 Budget	\$ 116,435,500

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Design & Asset Management	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected	2026 Planned
Recapitalization Budget Spent vs. Kilometers Paved vs. Per Cent Good				

Annual kilometers paved	44.33	56.38	53.02	41.35
Per cent Good	-	55.9	54.5	51.8 ¹
Recapitalization investment (\$)	47.35M	58.95M	56.45M	51.49M

¹ Projected overall network condition.

Analysis:

- The *Annual kilometers paved* has decreased due to several factors including increased unit rates/ project costs, Integrated Mobility Plan (IMP) and Complete Street guiding principles and reduction in the preventative maintenance/ minor rehabilitation program. Complete Street elements including curb extensions, refuge medians, sidewalks, etc. are added to preventative maintenance/ minor rehabilitation projects which increase project costs and decreases the *Annual kilometers paved*.
- Pavement condition data is collected biennially using a multi-function data collection vehicle. As a result, no data was collected in 2025. The next data collection will occur in 2026/27. Regional Council approved a target Level of Service (LOS) of 60 per cent of the network in “Good” condition in January 2024, to be achieved by 2032. The next LOS update will be presented to Regional Council in 2026.

Project Delivery	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Capital Plan (\$) ¹	84.3M	158.7M	122.5M	100M
Per cent of Capital Plan Tendered	83%	79%	88%	95%

¹ This amount is the entire budgeted transportation Capital Plan.

Analysis:

- Design & Asset Management and Project Delivery have re-organized and grown the teams to continue delivering Council Priority projects. Overall, the percentage tendered remains high at greater than 85 per cent. From 2023 to 2025, the team restructured and had significant vacancies. Predictable multi-year capital plans and a fully staffed group will enable the team to meet or exceed a 95 per cent tendered target going forward.

Infrastructure Maintenance & Operations	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected	2026 Planned
Potholes (reported for the calendar year)				
Priority 1 ¹				
Identified	3,214	3,805	4,908 ²	5,500
Completed Within Standard	75%	71%	60%	80% ¹
Priority 2 ³				
Identified	3,719	3,791	5,272	6,050
Completed Within Standard	100%	100%	100%	100% ³
Total				
Identified	6,933	7,596	10,180	11,550 ⁴

Urban Forests (reported for the fiscal year)				
Trees planted	-	1,124	1,000	1,000
¹ Priority 1 pothole – 8 cm or greater in depth. ² As of November 2025. ³ Priority 2 pothole – less than 8 cm in depth. Analysis: Potholes. The majority of potholes are identified between January and June. The timing, volume and severity of potholes directly correlates to the freeze thaw cycle of winter. Crews focus on repairing potholes based on priority and road class. There are several factors that impact the ability to complete work from November to April. This includes staff moving positions for winter works operations, preparation and response to weather events and materials available. Asphalt plants close during the winter (December to April). During this time many repairs require recycled hot box asphalt or cold patch, which are both considered temporary and usually require rework in the spring. Potholes with signalized intersections also require additional traffic control. Priority 1 potholes are at higher risk of not being completed within standard compared to Priority 2. In 2025, the percentage of Priority 1 potholes completed within standard declined from 71% to 60% due to a 29% increase in the number of Priority 1 potholes identified, without a corresponding increase in resources to address them. As the overall condition of the Municipality's road network decreases, shown by the percentage of roads rated "good" decreasing, the need for operational reactive maintenance is increasing (i.e., increased need for pothole repairs). Urban Forests. The Urban Forest Management Plan (UFMP) was approved by Regional Council in March 2025 and recommends a planting target of a minimum of 1,000 net-new street and park trees per year for the next five years. Coupled with the street tree replacement program, the total replanting target is a minimum of 2,000 caliper trees per year, for the next five years. The capital portion of the tree planting budget which funds net-new trees was not funded by Regional Council for the 2025/26 fiscal year; the operating budget which funds replacement planting was funded. The UFMP planting target for the 2025/26 fiscal year was 2,000 trees, with only 1,000 trees projected, based on the available budget. For 2026/27, the UFMP target was 2,000 trees; however, the operational planting budget has not been funded while the capital portion has been funded, for planned planting of 1,000 trees.				
Solid Waste Resources ¹	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
HRM disposal rate (kg per capita)	459	360 ²	360 ²	N/A ³
Provincial average disposal rate (kg per capita)	491	441 ²	441 ²	N/A ³

- ¹ Population numbers to calculate municipal and provincial per capita disposal rates are provided by Divert Nova Scotia.
- ² Estimates.
- ³ 2026 data is N/A; these performance indicators are lagging indicators that are not forecasted but are reported after the reporting period closes.

Analysis:

- Rates are calculated by Divert Nova Scotia in conjunction with Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change (NSECC), using data submitted from all disposal sites across the province.
- Flash floods during the summer of 2023 significantly increased disposal tonnage across all sectors for the 2023/2024 reporting period.
- The decrease in *HRM disposal rate* for 2024/2025 reflects improved diversion practices and better management of construction and demolition debris. This disposal rate aligns with pre-flood trends. The 2024/25 figure is an estimate, to be validated in early 2026.
- The provincial disposal rate for 2024/25 is estimated at 441 kg per capita, consistent with the 2022/23 rate, and assumes a return to pre-flood levels.

Traffic & Parking Management	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected	2026 Planned
Accessible Parking				
Number of accessible parking tickets issued	3,474	4,716	3,425	5,500
Parking Services Outputs				
Tickets issued	152,151	163,659	132,000	175,000
Tiered parking fines	1,032	5,844	3,200	6,500
Road Safety Data				
Road safety data can be viewed in the annual Road Safety Report presented to the Transportation Standing Committee.				
Traffic Safety Measures				
Information on traffic safety measure implementation can be found on Halifax's Road Safety Dashboard .				
Analysis:				
• The decrease in parking violations addressed by staff in 2025 is anticipated to be a one-year occurrence due to staffing shortages. Staff are projecting that figures will return to historical norms in 2026 with a full staff complement.				

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
EP-02 Expedite the delivery of housing supply and support the development of complete communities with a mix of housing options and convenient access to goods, services and facilities.	
Household Special Waste Program Review <i>Service Area: Solid Waste Resources</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A3</i> Conduct a review of the Household Special Waste program and develop a plan to expand service delivery and improve operational efficiency.	31-Dec-26
Streetscaping <i>Service Area: Design & Asset Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal EP-02; no Action alignment</i> Deliver new and maintain existing streetscaped areas through integration with capital roadworks or as part of stand-alone place-making projects.	31-Mar-30
EP-05 Attract, retain and grow domestic and international business and talent.	
Parking Demand and Supply Study <i>Service Area: Traffic & Parking Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-05-A1</i> Undertake a comprehensive study to produce a report outlining the current parking situation in the core area of the municipality, including recommendations to accommodate anticipated growth and development. The information from this report will be used by the municipality, in partnership with the Business Improvement Districts, to inform policy decisions around parking supply and pricing.	31-Mar-27
SC-01 Improve municipal preparedness planning to mitigate the potential impacts of emergency situations and climate-related events.	

Deliverable	Completion
Halifax Regional Municipality Disaster Debris Management Plan <i>Service Area: Solid Waste Resources</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-01-A2</i> Engage internal and external partners towards the development of a municipal Disaster Debris Management Plan.	31-Dec-26
SC-06 Invest to enable community efforts to reduce carbon emissions by 75% (of 2016 levels) by 2030 and net-zero by 2050.	
Commercial and Multi-Unit Waste Room Design Guidelines <i>Service Area: Solid Waste Resources</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-06-A3</i> Complete and promote waste room design guidelines to reduce waste in the commercial and apartment sectors.	30-Sep-26
SC-07 Invest in the enhancement, protection and expansion of natural assets, green spaces and urban agriculture to support community and ecological health and resilient ecosystem services.	
Salt Management Plan <i>Service Area: Infrastructure, Maintenance & Operations</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-07-A1</i> Create a public-facing Salt Management Plan that reflects industry best practise as well as compliance with the federal Code of Practice for the Environmental Management of Road Salts.	30-Sep-26
Urban Forest Management Plan <i>Service Area: Infrastructure, Maintenance & Operations</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-07-A8</i> Implement the Urban Forest Management Plan to protect and grow the municipal urban tree canopy.	31-Mar-34
MB-01 Manage traffic congestion and improve the efficiency of the transportation network.	
Transportation Demand Management <i>Service Area: Traffic & Parking Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-01-A2</i> Integrate Transportation Demand Management practices into transportation and road safety programs and reporting.	31-Mar-27
Road Disruption Management Program (Phase 1) <i>Service Area: Traffic & Parking Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-01-A4</i>	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Establish a cross-department task force to identify inputs required to coordinate and manage short-term and long-term road disruptions. The program will identify and discuss strategies for implementation including but not limited to potential departmental reorganizations and software requirements to support the initiative.	
Adaptive Traffic Signal Control Implementation (Phase 1) <i>Service Area: Traffic & Parking Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-01-A4</i> Working with internal partners and Link Nova Scotia, complete the procurement plan and installation of adaptive traffic signal controls on two initial corridors to better manage traffic congestion and improve the overall efficiency of the transportation network.	31-Mar-27
Emergency Service Provider Design Engagement <i>Service Area: Design & Asset Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-01-A4</i> Review and update the engagement procedure with emergency services for municipally led capital roadworks projects.	31-Mar-27
Construction Impact Mitigation <i>Service Area: Project Delivery</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-01-A4</i> Review working policies and procedures to minimize the impacts of roadworks on traffic congestion.	31-Mar-27
MB-03 Improve access to sustainable transportation modes.	
All Ages and Abilities Regional Centre Bicycle Network <i>Service Area: Project Delivery</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-03-A3</i> Complete construction of the Regional Centre All Ages and Abilities Bike Network.	31-Mar-29
Active School Travel Program <i>Service Area: Traffic & Parking Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-03-A4</i> Building on the results of the 2025/2026 Active School Travel Baseline study, develop an initial Active School Travel Program.	31-Mar-27
MB-04 Improve safety of transportation modes.	
Road Safety Data Analysis Platform <i>Service Area: Traffic & Parking Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-04-A2</i> Working with IT Services, finalize procurement and implementation of a new road safety/ collision data analysis platform to support on-going efforts to improve road	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
safety on the municipality's roadways and move toward the goal of zero fatal and serious injury collisions by 2038.	
Road Safety Public Education and Communications Plan <i>Service Area: Traffic & Parking Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-04-A2</i> Working with Corporate Communications, develop and deliver an expanded public education and communications plan to enhance public knowledge and awareness of road safety issues and improve safety on the municipality's roadways in support of the goal of zero fatal and serious injury collisions by 2038.	31-Mar-27
MB-07 Develop and enhance the transportation network and infrastructure assets to meet defined service levels.	
Public Works Asset Management Program (Phase 1) <i>Service Area: Design & Asset Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-07-A1</i> Complete transportation/ Public Works asset identification and categorization across the Public Works portfolio.	31-Mar-27
Unaccepted Streets (Phase 2) <i>Service Area: Design & Asset Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-07-A1</i> Confirm boundaries of streets that are newly approved by Regional Council as part of the unaccepted streets review project.	31-Mar-27
RA-04 Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency and cost effectiveness, while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.	
Digital Records Management (Phase II) <i>Service Area: Project Delivery</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04; no Action alignment</i> Implement a new digital records management process.	31-Mar-27
Project Management Guidelines (Phase III) <i>Service Area: Project Delivery</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04; no Action alignment</i> Develop formal guidelines and policies for risk management, schedule management and quality management.	31-Mar-27

Summary of Net Expenditures - Public Works

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
R115 Transp Project Off.	1,029,961	1,367,400	961,000	1,012,300	(355,100)	(26.0)
R120 Construction Ser	1,765,292	2,294,600	2,152,000	2,348,100	53,500	2.3
R190 Project Planning TAM	295,799	360,200	429,300	481,400	121,200	33.6
***** Project Delivery	3,091,052	4,022,200	3,542,300	3,841,800	(180,400)	(4.5)
M671 VIK Spec Event Admin	-	-	-	-	-	-
R100 Directors Admin.	477,941	684,600	651,800	685,400	800	0.1
R101 LKD Serv. Deliv. & Qu	-	-	-	-	-	-
**** TPW Administration	477,941	684,600	651,800	685,400	800	0.1
***** Executive Director's Office	477,941	684,600	651,800	685,400	800	0.1
A315 Ticket Office	(7,242,146)	(6,859,500)	(7,324,100)	(8,588,000)	(1,728,500)	25.2
M555 Parkade	(1,789,426)	(1,775,000)	(1,775,000)	(1,950,000)	(175,000)	9.9
R954 Parking Management	542,289	602,700	562,400	604,000	1,300	0.2
**** Parking Services	(8,489,283)	(8,031,800)	(8,536,700)	(9,934,000)	(1,902,200)	23.7
R170 Transportation Serv.	1,601,647	1,880,000	1,676,800	2,263,000	383,000	20.4
R180 Active Transportation	1,021,684	1,272,800	639,900	742,800	(530,000)	(41.6)
**** Transportation Services	2,623,331	3,152,800	2,316,700	3,005,800	(147,000)	(4.7)
R112 Rights of Way Approval	508,724	703,700	584,770	677,400	(26,300)	(3.7)
**** Right of Way Services	508,724	703,700	584,770	677,400	(26,300)	(3.7)
R746 LockStreet Name Sign	-	-	-	-	-	-
R747 Traffic Signs	3,285,423	3,480,800	3,512,500	3,478,300	(2,500)	(0.1)
**** Sign Shop	3,285,423	3,480,800	3,512,500	3,478,300	(2,500)	(0.1)
R825 Streetlighting	3,820,187	4,232,900	4,210,500	4,352,200	119,300	2.8
R826 City Works Cap Clrg	-	-	-	-	-	-
R827 Traffic Lights	2,169,578	2,348,900	2,218,400	2,480,200	131,300	5.6
**** Traffic Signals & Streetligh	5,989,765	6,581,800	6,428,900	6,832,400	250,600	3.8
***** Traffic & Parking Management	3,917,959	5,887,300	4,306,170	4,059,900	(1,827,400)	(31.0)
W120 Operations Admin	461,982	(734,200)	(671,900)	(711,100)	23,100	(3.1)
W199 Fleet Maintenance	26,860	-	-	-	-	-
**** Municipal Operations Admin	488,841	(734,200)	(671,900)	(711,100)	23,100	(3.1)
R710 Ser Del & Asset Mgmt	2,092,439	2,367,000	2,357,600	2,405,700	38,700	1.6
**** Service Delivery & Asset Man	2,092,439	2,367,000	2,357,600	2,405,700	38,700	1.6
R845 Parks Urban Forestry	5,273,967	5,819,700	6,212,500	5,008,800	(810,900)	(13.9)
*** Urban Forestry	5,273,967	5,819,700	6,212,500	5,008,800	(810,900)	(13.9)
R723 Enhanced Maint Area	3,216,742	3,441,300	3,558,400	3,534,300	93,000	2.7
*** Enhanced Maintenance Area	3,216,742	3,441,300	3,558,400	3,534,300	93,000	2.7
R880 PB Contr. Streets	1,422	44,000	44,000	44,000	-	-
R881 PB Contr. Sidewalks	4,416,887	10,399,800	10,399,800	4,595,000	(5,804,800)	(55.8)
R882 Winter Program Costs	1,792,908	1,855,700	1,873,500	1,883,900	28,200	1.5
R883 In-House Streets	4,793,284	4,674,400	4,671,300	4,674,400	-	-
R884 In-Houses Sidewalk	539,904	446,100	448,200	446,100	-	-
R885 PB Contr. ST & SW	26,994,565	22,600,100	23,033,800	31,024,700	8,424,600	37.3
*** Operation Coordinator/Snow &	38,538,971	40,020,100	40,470,600	42,668,100	2,648,000	6.6
R715 Streets & Roads West	3,872,688	4,360,500	4,028,000	1,025,800	(3,334,700)	(76.5)
R716 Streets & Roads East	311,286	492,500	492,500	3,377,800	2,885,300	585.8
R718 Contracts-Asphalt E	1,072,676	1,233,700	1,233,700	1,746,300	512,600	41.5
R719 Contracts-Asphalt W	1,517,572	1,733,700	1,830,000	2,233,700	500,000	28.8
R720 Street Clean/Graffiti	847,873	1,175,900	1,193,500	1,328,900	153,000	13.0
R735 Street Mtce-East Rgn	1,387,227	2,595,100	2,618,600	2,563,900	(31,200)	(1.2)
R740 Concrete SW-Wst/Bedf	1,786,195	2,365,300	2,351,000	2,379,400	14,100	0.6
R741 Asph-Crb/Wlkwy-East	281,178	-	-	-	-	-
R742 Concrete Sdewlk East	428,071	-	-	-	-	-
R743 Asphlt Patching West	2,525,105	2,944,000	4,016,600	3,498,400	554,400	18.8
*** Streets & Roads	14,029,871	16,900,700	17,763,900	18,154,200	1,253,500	7.4
R766 Cityworks-Cr990002	821	-	-	-	-	-
**** Public Works Operations	61,060,372	66,181,800	68,005,400	69,365,400	3,183,600	4.8
***** Infrastructure Maintenance &	63,641,653	67,814,600	69,691,100	71,060,000	3,245,400	4.8
R110 Design Admin.	627,405	552,500	457,400	429,100	(123,400)	(22.3)
R111 Design	2,589,326	2,719,300	2,937,500	3,223,900	504,600	18.6
R130 Infrastr MgmtServ.	659,550	724,600	718,500	752,100	27,500	3.8
R140 Survey Services	1,360,548	1,444,400	1,463,100	1,462,500	18,100	1.3
***** Design & Asset Management	5,236,829	5,440,800	5,576,500	5,867,600	426,800	7.8
R311 MA Solid Waste Debt	-	-	-	-	-	-
R312 Lock Hlfx Transfer	-	-	-	-	-	-

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
R314 Sckv. Landfill Site	-	15,300	-	-	(15,300)	(100.0)
R315 Highway 101	501,487	395,000	410,300	425,300	30,300	7.7
**** Former Solid Waste System	501,487	410,300	410,300	425,300	15,000	3.7
R319 Community Monitoring	47,868	90,000	90,000	90,000	-	-
R321 Administration - WR	1,015,776	1,102,400	1,078,900	1,143,600	41,200	3.7
R601 See Cost Centre R321	-	-	-	-	-	-
*** Admin WR	1,063,644	1,192,400	1,168,900	1,233,600	41,200	3.5
R320 Otter Lake Operations	8,122,495	9,068,000	8,975,000	9,057,500	(10,500)	(0.1)
R326 Otter Lake WSF	-	-	-	-	-	-
R327 Otter Lake RDF	-	-	-	-	-	-
R329 Otter Lake FEP	4,191	7,000	-	-	(7,000)	(100.0)
*** Otter Lake	8,126,687	9,075,000	8,975,000	9,057,500	(17,500)	(0.2)
R322 Collection & RRFB	14,184,019	12,184,600	12,184,600	9,977,500	(2,207,100)	(18.1)
R323 Waste Res Sy Debt Ch	-	-	-	-	-	-
R324 Compost Fac. Burnside	524,745	100,000	100,000	-	(100,000)	(100.0)
R325 Halifax Organics	7,053,894	6,324,000	6,324,000	6,467,100	143,100	2.3
R328 Rural Depots	345,911	311,400	311,400	320,400	9,000	2.9
R330 Material Recov. Fac.	1,092,767	1,626,800	1,034,000	420,000	(1,206,800)	(74.2)
R332 Operating Reserve	-	-	-	-	-	-
R333 C & E Progrms HRM	249,498	284,000	284,000	282,800	(1,200)	(0.4)
R334 Household Haz. Waste	2,298,876	2,196,600	2,400,000	2,736,600	540,000	24.6
*** SW Other	25,749,710	23,027,400	22,638,000	20,204,400	(2,823,000)	(12.3)
**** Waste Resources	34,940,040	33,294,800	32,781,900	30,495,500	(2,799,300)	(8.4)
***** Solid Waste Resources	35,441,528	33,705,100	33,192,200	30,920,800	(2,784,300)	(8.3)
***** Net Total	111,806,962	117,554,600	116,960,070	116,435,500	(1,119,100)	(1.0)

Summary of Expenditures Details - Public Works

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	27,471,275	31,437,300	28,455,300	31,032,600	(404,700)	(1.3)
6002 Salaries - Overtime	1,988,972	1,565,900	2,279,600	1,565,900	-	-
6003 Wages - Regular	1,732	-	-	-	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(1,944,387)	-	(336,400)	-	-	-
6051 Shift Agreements	28,176	38,000	38,000	38,000	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	29,746	-	37,400	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	6,310,853	6,809,700	6,188,400	6,936,300	126,600	1.9
6101 Benefits - Wages	315	-	-	-	-	-
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(2,055,300)	-	(2,055,300)	-	-
6152 Retirement Incentives	181,323	236,900	234,100	225,900	(11,000)	(4.6)
6154 Workers' Compensation	886,888	1,170,900	1,159,400	1,093,500	(77,400)	(6.6)
6155 Overtime Meals	4,556	-	-	-	-	-
6157 stipends	-	-	2,800	-	-	-
6158 WCB Recov Earnings	(2,074)	-	-	-	-	-
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	(853,911)	-	(41,600)	472,400	472,400	-
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	482,678	-	-	-	-	-
9210 HR CATS OT Wage/Ben	454,961	-	(85,000)	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	35,041,104	39,203,400	37,932,000	39,309,300	105,900	0.3
6201 Telephone/Cable	60,079	49,500	45,800	44,500	(5,000)	(10.1)
6202 Courier/Postage	9,182	8,800	11,300	8,300	(500)	(5.7)
6203 Office Furn/Equip	8,044	31,350	30,100	28,900	(2,450)	(7.8)
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	25,226	35,300	33,600	31,800	(3,500)	(9.9)
6205 Printing & Reprod	26,483	61,500	60,200	81,500	20,000	32.5
6207 Office Supplies	57,351	61,300	64,000	79,000	17,700	28.9
6299 Other Office Expenses	103	19,000	6,600	19,000	-	-
* Office	186,467	266,750	251,600	293,000	26,250	9.8
6301 Professional Fees	25,557	22,000	22,000	22,000	-	-
6302 Legal Fees	-	5,000	15,000	5,000	-	-
6303 Consulting Fees	503,200	133,000	83,400	133,000	-	-
6308 Snow Removal	1,221,749	772,500	772,500	772,500	-	-
6309 Litigation Disburse	-	-	200	-	-	-
6310 Outside Personnel	699,255	750,000	730,000	775,000	25,000	3.3
6311 Security	6,774	70,000	71,100	70,000	-	-
6312 Refuse Collection	175,789	114,500	114,500	114,500	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6390 Extnl Svcs OCC Trsf	(163,000)	-	(217,800)	-	-	-
6399 Contract Services	87,604,201	89,683,800	90,249,870	91,675,900	1,992,100	2.2
* External Services	90,073,526	91,550,800	91,840,770	93,567,900	2,017,100	2.2
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	52,439	47,000	68,500	54,700	7,700	16.4
6402 Med & First Aid Supp	1,114	1,400	2,700	1,400	-	-
6403 Patrol Equip Supplies	200	-	200	-	-	-
6406 Bridge Tolls	36,342	-	-	-	-	-
6407 Clean/Sani Supplies	108,187	44,800	140,800	44,800	-	-
6409 Personal Protect Equ	293,209	198,650	190,865	193,600	(5,050)	(2.5)
6499 Other Supplies	192,223	191,300	206,700	191,100	(200)	(0.1)
* Supplies	683,714	483,150	609,765	485,600	2,450	0.5
6501 Asphalt	295,610	233,000	233,000	233,000	-	-
6502 Chemicals	18,063	78,500	82,900	78,500	-	-
6504 Hardware	163,764	150,500	149,300	150,500	-	-
6505 Lubricants	4,614	7,900	9,200	7,900	-	-
6506 Lumber	2,988	15,800	13,300	15,800	-	-
6507 Propane	421	2,200	1,200	2,200	-	-
6508 Ready Mix Concrete	80,659	167,000	166,500	167,000	-	-
6510 Road Oils	2,006	6,700	3,000	6,700	-	-
6511 Salt	2,436,297	2,183,300	2,183,300	2,183,300	-	-
6512 Sand	6,774	8,200	8,200	8,200	-	-
6513 Seeds & Plants	4,833	4,700	5,200	4,700	-	-
6514 Sods	269	3,100	3,100	3,100	-	-
6515 Stone and Gravel	40,014	51,500	51,500	51,500	-	-
6516 Topsoil	7,836	9,900	9,900	9,900	-	-
6517 Paint	209,955	212,700	213,185	222,700	10,000	4.7
6518 Metal	77,411	70,300	70,300	70,300	-	-
6519 Welding Supplies	395	3,700	3,700	3,700	-	-
6590 Materials OCC Trsf	(102,600)	-	-	-	-	-
6599 Other Materials	90,303	70,000	72,200	70,000	-	-
* Materials	3,339,611	3,279,000	3,278,985	3,289,000	10,000	0.3
6602 Electrical	393,223	667,900	667,900	667,900	-	-
6603 Grnds & Landscaping	-	15,300	15,300	15,300	-	-
6605 Municipal Taxes	4,191	7,000	7,000	7,000	-	-
6607 Electricity	3,048,511	3,237,800	3,237,800	3,237,800	-	-
6608 Water	4,464	15,000	15,400	15,000	-	-
6609 Elevator & Escalator	125	-	-	-	-	-
6610 Building - Exterior	-	-	100	-	-	-
6611 Building - Interior	325	300	300	300	-	-
6614 Envir Assess/Cleanup	-	5,000	-	5,000	-	-
6615 Vandalism Clean-up	-	10,000	10,000	10,000	-	-
6617 Pest Management	1,336	-	-	-	-	-
6699 Other Building Cost	6,587	-	-	-	-	-
* Building Costs	3,458,761	3,958,300	3,953,800	3,958,300	-	-
6701 Equipment Purchase	51,632	49,500	56,400	63,000	13,500	27.3
6702 Small Tools	76,382	113,400	123,400	112,400	(1,000)	(0.9)
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	11,890	26,600	59,050	22,800	(3,800)	(14.3)
6704 Equipment Rental	75,101	156,500	224,450	156,500	-	-
6705 Equip - R&M	101,620	35,400	63,000	40,400	5,000	14.1
6706 Computer R&M	-	500	500	500	-	-
6707 Plumbing & Heating	763	-	1,000	-	-	-
6708 Mechanical Equipment	272	-	-	-	-	-
6711 Communication System	138,757	122,500	122,500	122,500	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	456,417	504,400	650,300	518,100	13,700	2.7
6802 Vehicle R&M	13,047	6,000	17,400	6,000	-	-
6803 Vehicle Fuel - Diesel	3,215	-	-	-	-	-
6806 Vehicle Rentals	16,337	7,000	18,000	7,000	-	-
6807 Vehicle Leases	17,787	-	16,000	-	-	-
6810 Comm Vehicle R&M	8,457	-	500	-	-	-
6811 Shop Supplies	1,662	-	4,400	-	-	-
6899 Other Vehicle Expense	27,276	14,000	43,200	44,000	30,000	214.3
* Vehicle Expense	87,781	27,000	99,500	57,000	30,000	111.1
6901 Membership Dues	67,430	83,400	77,600	89,100	5,700	6.8
6902 Conferences/Workshop	28,585	41,200	49,000	43,000	1,800	4.4
6903 Travel - Local	281,862	307,700	306,500	312,800	5,100	1.7

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6904 Travel - Out of Town	54,492	68,900	63,100	58,500	(10,400)	(15.1)
6905 Training & Education	68,791	117,300	140,100	150,700	33,400	28.5
6906 Licenses & Agreements	451,032	414,200	455,200	460,900	46,700	11.3
6908 Medical Examinations	1,069	5,000	5,700	5,000	-	-
6909 Cost of Sales	419,006	400,000	400,000	400,000	-	-
6910 Signage	131,810	118,000	118,000	118,000	-	-
6911 Facilities Rental	-	300	600	300	-	-
6912 Advertising/Promotio	187,930	249,500	211,100	558,500	309,000	123.8
6914 Recruiting	2,810	4,500	8,500	4,500	-	-
6916 Public Education	65,710	82,800	82,800	178,800	96,000	115.9
6917 Books and Periodicals	5,900	7,600	8,950	6,600	(1,000)	(13.2)
6918 Meals/Catering	5,563	8,100	15,120	6,600	(1,500)	(18.5)
6919 Special Projects	7,169	191,500	184,600	166,500	(25,000)	(13.1)
6928 Committee Expenses	-	900	400	700	(200)	(22.2)
6929 Procurement Card Clg	10,130	200	200	200	-	-
6932 Youth Pr Services	36	-	-	-	-	-
6933 Community Events	20,189	20,000	20,000	20,000	-	-
6936 Staff Relations	2,426	2,000	1,800	2,000	-	-
6938 Rewarding Excellence	12,379	23,400	25,430	23,600	200	0.9
6940 Fencing	-	3,400	-	3,400	-	-
6942 Management Fees	234,562	200,000	200,000	200,000	-	-
6943 Health and Wellness	-	3,600	1,600	3,500	(100)	(2.8)
6999 Other Goods/Services	28,873	25,500	29,050	25,500	-	-
* Other Goods & Services	2,087,754	2,379,000	2,405,350	2,838,700	459,700	19.3
7009 Internal Trfr Other	84,850	77,900	78,700	87,900	10,000	12.8
7010 IntTrfr Insur Funds	-	(35,000)	(35,000)	(35,000)	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	13,910	-	1,300	-	-	-
7099 Interdept Chargeback	-	-	(3,900)	-	-	-
* Interdepartmental	98,761	42,900	41,100	52,900	10,000	23.3
8030 Tfr Fr Resvs to Oper	(1,270,181)	(31,500)	(31,500)	(34,000)	(2,500)	7.9
8031 Tfr To Resvs Fr Oper	-	-	-	720,000	720,000	-
* Other Fiscal	(1,270,181)	(31,500)	(31,500)	686,000	717,500	(2,277.8)
** Total	134,243,716	141,663,200	141,031,670	145,055,800	3,392,600	2.4

Summary of Revenues Details - Public Works

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4750 Other Grants	(3,753,907)	(4,542,000)	(4,542,000)	(4,371,500)	170,500	(3.8)
* Transfers from other Gov'ts	(3,753,907)	(4,542,000)	(4,542,000)	(4,371,500)	170,500	(3.8)
4901 Parking Station Rev	(4,811,138)	(4,700,000)	(5,000,000)	(6,161,600)	(1,461,600)	31.1
4902 Fines Fees	(815,749)	-	-	-	-	-
4905 St. Opening Permits	(295,386)	(235,000)	(255,000)	(235,000)	-	-
4912 Signs & Encroachments	(246,224)	(163,400)	(174,400)	(213,400)	(50,000)	30.6
4921 Parking Permit Rev	(821,063)	(950,000)	(950,000)	(1,099,400)	(149,400)	15.7
4922 Parking Ticket Rev	(3,716,681)	(4,600,000)	(4,600,000)	(5,030,900)	(430,900)	9.4
5101 Parking Rentals	(2,442,994)	(2,400,000)	(2,400,000)	(2,550,000)	(150,000)	6.3
5151 Lease Revenue	-	-	(240,000)	(720,000)	(720,000)	-
5204 Administration Fees	-	-	(25,000)	-	-	-
5225 Tipping Fees-Waste R	(1,899,572)	(1,877,000)	(1,877,000)	(2,052,300)	(175,300)	9.3
5256 SOT Revenue	(1,480)	-	-	-	-	-
5403 Sale-Other Recycle	(1,424,758)	(1,315,200)	(800,000)	-	1,315,200	(100.0)
5450 Other Sales Revenue	-	-	(61,400)	-	-	-
* Fee Revenues	(16,475,044)	(16,240,600)	(16,382,800)	(18,062,600)	(1,822,000)	11.2
5508 Recov External Parti	(998,310)	(2,283,000)	(2,303,800)	(5,721,000)	(3,438,000)	150.6
5600 Miscellaneous Revenue	(1,209,492)	(1,043,000)	(843,000)	(465,200)	577,800	(55.4)
* Other Revenue	(2,207,803)	(3,326,000)	(3,146,800)	(6,186,200)	(2,860,200)	86.0
** Total	(22,436,754)	(24,108,600)	(24,071,600)	(28,620,300)	(4,511,700)	18.7
***** Net Total	111,806,962	117,554,600	116,960,070	116,435,500	(1,119,100)	(1.0)

HALIFAX

MAJOR PROJECTS OFFICE

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MAJOR PROJECTS OFFICE

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

The Major Projects Office delivers complex, high-value infrastructure projects with centralized leadership and expert risk management. We are committed to executing transformative, multi-partner projects efficiently, effectively and with lasting impact.

OVERVIEW

The Major Projects Office leads the delivery of complex, high-value infrastructure projects, typically exceeding \$100 million. By providing centralized leadership, strategic alignment, and proactive risk management, the Office ensures efficient, transparent and accountable project execution that drives economic growth and enhances community well-being. The Office advances Regional Council's priorities and champions innovation, delivering transformative infrastructure that generates long-term economic, environmental and social benefits.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Executive Director's Office	✓ Oversight and Administration of the Major Projects Office
Burnside Transit Centre Eco-Rebuild	✓ Project Management and Delivery
Bus Rapid Transit	✓ Project Management and Delivery
Cogswell District Project	✓ Project Management and Delivery
Mill Cove Ferry Service Project	✓ Project Management and Delivery
Windsor Street Exchange Redevelopment Project	✓ Project Management and Delivery

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		12.0
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Project Director	Maintain Current Service	(2.0)
Project Manager	Maintain Current Service	(1.0)
Transferred Positions		
Transfer from Public Works	Transfer of positions to MPO for Windsor Street Exchange Project	2.0
Total Changes		(1.0)
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		11.0

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Major Projects Office	\$ 161,323	\$ 395,800	\$ 501,300	\$ 529,500	\$ 133,700	33.8
Net Total	\$ 161,323	\$ 395,800	\$ 501,300	\$ 529,500	\$ 133,700	33.8

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 62	\$ 293,300	\$ 449,300	\$ 509,400	\$ 216,100	73.7
Office	38,814	12,000	3,900	3,800	(8,200)	(68.3)
External Services	-	68,000	35,000	-	(68,000)	(100.0)
Supplies	-	-	400	1,200	1,200	-
Other Goods & Services	156,947	22,500	11,600	15,100	(7,400)	(32.9)
Total Expenditures	195,823	395,800	501,300	529,500	133,700	33.8

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Other Revenue	\$ (34,500)	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	-
Total Revenues	(34,500)	-	-	-	-	-
Net Total	\$ 161,323	\$ 395,800	\$ 501,300	\$ 529,500	\$ 133,700	33.8

* Budgets have been restated due to changes in organizational structure.

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 395,800
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Inflationary pressure in office expenses	24,000
Compensation adjustments	216,100
Other/Transfers	
External Consulting	(68,000)
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact "Green" Reductions	(22,000)
Low Service Impact Reductions in response to flat tax motion	(16,400)
Total Changes	\$ 133,700
2026/27 Budget	\$ 529,500

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
EP-02 Expedite the delivery of housing supply and support the development of complete communities with a mix of housing options and convenient access to goods, services and facilities.	
Mill Cove Library Project <i>Service Area: Mill Cove Ferry Service Project</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A9</i> Advance the Halifax Public Library within the Mill Cove Terminal, as directed by Regional Council, by progressing 30% design, value engineering and business case updates. Monitor and manage risks, budget, schedule and scope to support successful project outcomes.	31-Mar-27
Mill Cove Library Funding <i>Service Area: Mill Cove Ferry Service Project</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A9</i>	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Continue to manage the Phase 2 budget for the Mill Cove Library, ensuring financial milestones are monitored and reported to inform municipal leadership. Pursue and coordinate alternative funding sources for the library as required.	
MB-01 Manage traffic congestion and improve the efficiency of the transportation network.	
Windsor Street Exchange Redevelopment Project <i>Service Area: Windsor Street Exchange Redevelopment Project</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-01-A5</i> Advance the progressive design-build of the Windsor Street Exchange Redevelopment Project by continuing current phase construction, initiating future phases planning, developing Bus Rapid Transit integration options and coordinating with internal and external stakeholders.	31-Mar-27
Windsor Street Exchange Redevelopment Funding <i>Service Area: Windsor Street Exchange Redevelopment Project</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-01-A5</i> Secure and manage funding by confirming cost-sharing arrangements with key partners, applying for additional grants, ensuring compliance with funding requirements and monitoring milestones.	31-Mar-27
Mill Cove Ferry Service <i>Service Area: Mill Cove Ferry Service Project</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-01-A6</i> Advance 30% design, value engineering, and business case updates with stakeholders. Monitor and manage risks, budget, schedule and scope. Support Province-led land and water lot acquisition to prevent delays and progress ferry and infrastructure procurement. Conduct strategic risk assessments and mitigation with the Province to enable successful delivery.	31-Mar-27
Mill Cove Ferry Service Funding <i>Service Area: Mill Cove Ferry Service Project</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-01-A6</i> Continue to manage the Phase 2 budget including the Investing in Canada Infrastructure Program (ICIP) Provincial and Federal contributions. Pursue additional funding opportunities with Provincial and Federal programs. Continue to monitor and report on financial milestones.	31-Mar-27
MB-05 Public transit resources and service standards align and grow with the municipality.	
Advance Bus Rapid Transit Strategy <i>Service Area: Bus Rapid Transit</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-05-A2</i>	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Lead planning, design and cost estimation for Bus Rapid Transit (BRT) by presenting 30% design and cost updates to Regional Council, coordinating with stakeholders for network integration and aligning BRT planning with the Rapid Transit Strategy.	
Advance Bus Rapid Transit Funding <i>Service Area: Bus Rapid Transit</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-05-A2</i> Complete funding applications for Bus Rapid Transit infrastructure and submit to the Province. Continue to monitor their progress. Finalize conceptual designs and cost estimates, preparing supporting documentation for federal and provincial programs and engaging with funding partners to respond to feedback and secure approvals.	31-Mar-27
Bus Rapid Transit Stakeholder Engagement and Communications <i>Service Area: Bus Rapid Transit</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-05-A2</i> Implement or develop a stakeholder engagement and communications plan for Bus Rapid Transit (BRT) by conducting public consultations as well as internal and external stakeholder consultations on BRT routes and service design, communicating project milestones and addressing accessibility, equity and community impacts throughout engagement activities.	31-Mar-27
Transit and Active Transportation Networks Integration <i>Service Area: Bus Rapid Transit</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-05-A2</i> Ensure integration of Bus Rapid Transit (BRT) with active transportation networks by coordinating BRT station locations with sidewalks, bike lanes and multi-use pathways, updating design guidelines to meet accessibility and inclusiveness standards and confirming alignment with HalifACT sustainability targets and Integrated Mobility Plan Actions.	31-Mar-27
RA-03 Reach net-zero municipal operations by 2030.	
Burnside Centre Eco-Rebuild <i>Service Area: Burnside Transit Centre Eco-Rebuild</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-03-A3</i> Proceed with the Burnside Centre Eco-Rebuild project by finalizing the 30% design, commencing design activities and integrating HalifACT sustainability targets to support the transition to zero-emission buses and fleet expansion.	31-Mar-28
Burnside Centre Eco-Rebuild Funding <i>Service Area: Burnside Transit Centre Eco-Rebuild</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-03-A4</i> Secure and manage funding by confirming cost-sharing arrangements, pursuing additional grants and external funding, ensuring compliance with funding requirements and monitoring financial milestones to support project delivery.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Burnside Centre Eco-Rebuild Stakeholder Engagement <i>Service Area: Burnside Transit Centre Eco-Rebuild</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-03-A4</i> Lead stakeholder engagement for the Burnside Centre Eco-Rebuild project by securing timely input from internal and external stakeholders and community groups at key design and construction milestones to ensure operational requirements are met and project planning and design is successful.	31-Mar-27

Summary of Net Expenditures - Major Projects Office						
	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
I105 Cogswell Redev Cap S	160,680	2,500	2,500	-	(2,500)	(100.0)
E160 Major Projects Office	16	393,300	498,800	529,500	136,200	34.6
E161 Mill Cove Project Office	627	-	-	-	-	-
* Net Total	161,323	395,800	501,300	529,500	133,700	33.8
Summary of Expenses Details - Major Projects Office						
	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	680,463	250,000	408,900	445,800	195,800	78.3
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(13,765)	-	-	-	-	-
6099 Other Allowances	130,603	-	-	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	82,057	36,900	34,300	53,500	16,600	45.0
6152 Retirement Incentives	1,978	1,300	1,100	1,300	-	-
6154 Workers' Compensation	16,064	5,100	5,000	8,800	3,700	72.5
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	(897,337)	-	-	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	62	293,300	449,300	509,400	216,100	73.7
6201 Telephone/Cable	581	4,000	1,000	1,000	(3,000)	(75.0)
6202 Courier/Postage	29	-	200	-	-	-
6203 Office Furn/Equip	-	4,000	-	800	(3,200)	(80.0)
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	37,960	-	-	-	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	243	4,000	2,700	2,000	(2,000)	(50.0)
* Office	38,814	12,000	3,900	3,800	(8,200)	(68.3)
6399 Contract Services	-	68,000	35,000	-	(68,000)	(100.0)
* External Services	-	68,000	35,000	-	(68,000)	(100.0)
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	-	-	300	-	-	-
6402 Med & First Aid Supp	-	-	100	-	-	-
6409 Personal Protect Equ	-	-	-	1,200	1,200	-
* Supplies	-	-	400	1,200	1,200	-
6901 Membership Dues	-	2,000	3,300	5,500	3,500	175.0
6902 Conferences/Workshop	-	8,000	-	1,000	(7,000)	(87.5)
6903 Travel - Local	-	4,000	2,000	2,500	(1,500)	(37.5)
6905 Training & Education	1,960	2,500	2,500	2,300	(200)	(8.0)
6906 Licenses & Agreements	146,000	-	-	-	-	-
6912 Advertising/Promotio	-	2,000	1,200	500	(1,500)	(75.0)
6917 Books and Periodicals	-	-	100	-	-	-
6918 Meals/Catering	-	2,000	2,500	700	(1,300)	(65.0)
6938 Rewarding Excellence	-	2,000	-	2,600	600	30.0
6999 Other Goods/Services	8,987	-	-	-	-	-
* Other Goods & Services	156,947	22,500	11,600	15,100	(7,400)	(32.9)
7009 Internal Trfr Other	-	-	1,000	-	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	-	-	100	-	-	-
* Interdepartmental	-	-	1,100	-	-	-
** Total	195,823	395,800	501,300	529,500	133,700	33.8
Summary of Revenue Details - Major Projects Office						
	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
5508 Recov External Parti	(34,500)	-	-	-	-	-
* Other Revenue	(34,500)	-	-	-	-	-
** Total	(34,500)	-	-	-	-	-
* Net Total	161,323	395,800	501,300	529,500	133,700	33.8

HALIFAX

**STRATEGIC INFRASTRUCTURE
AND TRANSPORTATION
PLANNING**

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

STRATEGIC INFRASTRUCTURE & TRANSPORTATION PLANNING

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

The Office of Strategic Infrastructure & Transportation Planning drives collaborative, forward-thinking strategies to ensure the municipality's infrastructure and services are equipped to support sustainable growth.

OVERVIEW

The Office of Strategic Infrastructure & Transportation Planning ensures well-coordinated infrastructure planning that supports the municipality's long-term growth. Through collaboration across business units and with external partners, it identifies and advances critical projects that sustain and grow transportation, utilities and essential services to enable planned population growth and shape the mobility network.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Executive Director's Office	✓ Oversight and Administration of the Strategic Infrastructure & Transportation Planning Office
Transportation Planning Program	✓ Transportation Planning and Policy

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		10.0
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Planner 1	Vacant Position/Position Removed	(1.0)
Vacant Position	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Transferred Positions		
Transfer from Public Works	Active Transportation transferred to SITP	7.0
Transfer from Planning & Development	Streetscaping program transferred to SITP	1.0
Transfer to Public Works	Transportation Demand Management transferred from SITP	(2.0)
Total Changes		4.0
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		14.0

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Executive Director's Office	\$ 394,684	\$ 1,226,100	\$ 1,791,700	\$ 1,733,900	\$ 507,800	41.4
Transportation Planning Program	1,032,237	365,400	256,000	314,900	(50,500)	(13.8)
Net Total	\$ 1,426,920	\$ 1,591,500	\$ 2,047,700	\$ 2,048,800	\$ 457,300	28.7

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 1,298,408	\$ 1,046,500	\$ 1,764,100	\$ 1,703,800	\$ 657,300	62.8
Office	5,151	12,000	28,700	3,600	(8,400)	(70.0)
External Services	837,466	1,461,000	430,500	1,051,900	(409,100)	(28.0)
Building Costs	-	-	100	-	-	-
Equipment & Communications	326	-	1,000	-	-	-
Vehicle Expense	782	-	2,000	-	-	-
Other Goods & Services	73,549	77,000	81,000	119,500	42,500	55.2
Interdepartmental	7,714	(1,000,000)	(154,700)	(825,000)	175,000	(17.5)
Total Expenditures	2,223,396	1,596,500	2,152,700	2,053,800	457,300	28.6

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Transfers from other Govts	\$ (790,462)	\$ -	\$ (100,000)	\$ -	\$ -	-
Other Revenue	(6,013)	(5,000)	(5,000)	(5,000)	-	-
Total Revenues	(796,475)	(5,000)	(105,000)	(5,000)	-	-
Net Total	\$ 1,426,920	\$ 1,591,500	\$ 2,047,700	\$ 2,048,800	\$ 457,300	28.7

* Budgets have been restated due to changes in organizational structure.

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 1,591,500
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	150,400
Other/Transfers	
Net positions transferred from PW and P&D	599,900
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact "Green" Reductions	(200,000)
Low Service Impact Reductions in response to flat tax motion	(93,000)
Total Changes	\$ 457,300
2026/27 Budget	\$ 2,048,800

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Transportation Planning Program	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected	2026 Planned
Per cent of All Ages and Abilities Regional Centre Bicycle Network completed in the Regional Centre ¹	56% ²	60%	64%	71%
¹ Africville segment has not been considered as part of the performance measure. ² The majority of the bikeway network additions in 2023 were done tactically (i.e. using temporary materials and interim measures). Those segments are planned to be completed within the AAA target. The actual program total length is approximately 53km. However, counting the length of interim plus permanent projects for segments built in 2023 brings the total of the program to 60 km for the performance measures (double projects on certain segments). Analysis: All Ages and Abilities Regional Centre Bicycle Network: The percentage of the All Ages and Abilities Regional Centre Bicycle Network completed continues to increase, reflecting steady progress each year. Interim installations in 2023 accelerated network expansion, with permanent upgrades planned to further boost completion rates. Inclusion of major segments like Africville may impact future performance measure calculations.				

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
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Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
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SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

OP	Our People
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Deliverable		Completion
EP-01	Increase regional growth in strategic areas that are well-served by existing or planned services, utilities, and infrastructure.	
Strategic Growth and Infrastructure Priorities Plan <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-01-A1</i> Develop and begin the Strategic Growth and Infrastructure Priorities Plan by completing growth forecasting and scenario development, conducting an infrastructure needs assessment, identifying priority growth areas for infrastructure delivery and developing a financial investment and resource framework. Integrate these phases with long-term capital planning.		31-Mar-27
SC-01	Improve municipal preparedness planning to mitigate the potential impacts of emergency situations and climate-related events.	
Egress Route Action Planning <i>Service Area: Transportation Planning Program</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-01-04</i> Complete the region-wide subdivision egress study and present recommendations to Regional Council. Pending direction from Regional Council, carry out planning and design for recommended egress improvements.		31-Mar-27
MB-01	Manage traffic congestion and improve the efficiency of the transportation network.	
Regional Transportation Plan Initiatives <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-01-A1</i> Advance priority actions and short-term initiatives from the Regional Transportation Plan in collaboration with the Province and external partners. Coordinate planning and support integration with road disruption management, adaptive traffic signal control, and construction impact mitigation led by Public Works.		31-Mar-28
Transportation Data Strategy <i>Service Area: Transportation Planning Program</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-01-A3</i> Develop and implement a Transportation Data Strategy to organize data collection and management across the municipality and launch a transportation data collection program to improve transportation network monitoring.		31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Strategic Multi-Modal Corridors <i>Service Area: Transportation Planning Program</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-01-A7</i> Execute functional planning for major strategic multi-modal corridors and integrate the outcomes with recapitalization priorities through the capital budget process. Corridor plans scheduled for completion in 2026/27 include Herring Cove Road, Main Street (Dartmouth), Windmill Road, and Larry Uteck Boulevard. Complete a transportation study for the Hammonds Plains Road corridor that investigates existing/ projected traffic demands and identifies potential options to manage traffic congestion.	31-Mar-27
MB-03 Improve access to sustainable transportation modes.	
Active Transportation Priorities Plan Review <i>Service Area: Transportation Planning Program</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-03-A4</i> Complete a review of the Active Transportation Priorities Plan including community engagement to assess current infrastructure and programming, identify gaps, and update recommendations to align with evolving transportation needs and municipal priorities.	31-Mar-27
MB-06 Improve connectivity between and within communities.	
Active Transportation Priorities Plan Implementation <i>Service Area: Transportation Planning Program</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-06-A1</i> Continue implementing the Active Transportation Priorities Plan by completing functional plans for candidate cycling routes not identified as part of the Integrated Mobility Plan's All Ages and Abilities network, as well as for new sidewalks and multi-use pathways. This work includes starting new functional plans, completing ongoing plans, and seeking Regional Council approval for completed plans to enhance connectivity between communities.	31-Mar-28
MB-07 Develop and enhance the transportation network and infrastructure assets to meet defined service levels.	
Land Acquisition Strategy <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-07-A3</i> Develop and implement a Land Acquisition Strategy to support transportation and infrastructure projects by identifying and prioritizing required parcels for both short- and long-term needs. This includes coordinating acquisition activities with internal partners such as Corporate Real Estate, Finance & Asset Management and Planning & Development, outlining projected land requirements, resourcing, and funding needs, and engaging potential funding partners.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
RA-01 Preserve and strengthen the municipality's financial position to meet current and future needs and obligations.	
Operating and Capital Growth Framework <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-01-A1</i> Provide growth projections, infrastructure priorities and multi-year capital requirements to inform the fiscal framework and long-term financial planning.	31-Mar-28

Summary of Net Expenditures - Strategic Infrastructure & Transportation Planning						
	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
E170 Str Infra&Trans Plan	394,684	1,226,100	1,791,700	1,733,900	507,800	41.4
R951 StrategicTrans Plan	885,072	29,100	80,000	140,500	111,400	382.8
R953 TDM Programs	132,695	22,900	(29,000)	-	(22,900)	(100.0)
R956 IMP Studies	14,470	313,400	205,000	174,400	(139,000)	(44.4)
* Net Total	1,426,920	1,591,500	2,047,700	2,048,800	457,300	28.7

Summary of Expenditures Details - Strategic Infrastructure & Transportation Planning						
	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	1,087,139	971,300	1,438,500	1,620,700	649,400	66.9
6002 Salaries - Overtime	(451)	-	-	-	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(27,762)	-	-	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	203,729	170,000	293,700	334,500	164,500	96.8
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(129,600)	-	(9,600)	120,000	(92.6)
6152 Retirement Incentives	5,627	5,300	5,300	10,900	5,600	105.7
6154 Workers' Compensation	30,079	29,500	26,600	50,600	21,100	71.5
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	-	-	-	(303,300)	(303,300)	-
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	48	-	-	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	1,298,408	1,046,500	1,764,100	1,703,800	657,300	62.8
6201 Telephone/Cable	3,889	4,000	500	500	(3,500)	(87.5)
6202 Courier/Postage	135	-	-	100	100	-
6203 Office Furn/Equip	1,000	4,000	1,200	1,500	(2,500)	(62.5)
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	-	-	25,000	-	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	127	4,000	2,000	1,500	(2,500)	(62.5)
* Office	5,151	12,000	28,700	3,600	(8,400)	(70.0)
6301 Professional Fees	4,526	-	-	-	-	-
6303 Consulting Fees	832,939	1,450,000	430,000	1,049,400	(400,600)	(27.6)
6399 Contract Services	-	11,000	500	2,500	(8,500)	(77.3)
* External Services	837,466	1,461,000	430,500	1,051,900	(409,100)	(28.0)
6699 Other Building Cost	-	-	100	-	-	-
* Building Costs	-	-	100	-	-	-
6701 Equipment Purchase	326	-	1,000	-	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	326	-	1,000	-	-	-
6899 Other Vehicle Expense	782	-	2,000	-	-	-
* Vehicle Expense	782	-	2,000	-	-	-
6901 Membership Dues	8,575	2,000	25,000	15,000	13,000	650.0
6902 Conferences/Workshop	2,836	8,000	8,000	14,000	6,000	75.0
6903 Travel - Local	95	4,000	1,000	4,000	-	-
6904 Travel - Out of Town	6,034	7,000	7,000	19,000	12,000	171.4
6906 Licenses & Agreements	25,869	9,000	-	25,000	16,000	177.8
6911 Facilities Rental	417	500	500	1,000	500	100.0
6912 Advertising/Promotio	2,204	2,500	2,000	1,500	(1,000)	(40.0)
6918 Meals/Catering	753	2,000	2,500	2,000	-	-
6919 Special Projects	25,805	40,000	33,000	35,000	(5,000)	(12.5)
6933 Community Events	961	-	-	-	-	-
6938 Rewarding Excellence	-	2,000	2,000	2,000	-	-
6999 Other Goods/Services	-	-	-	1,000	1,000	-
* Other Goods & Services	73,549	77,000	81,000	119,500	42,500	55.2
7009 Internal Trfr Other	110	(1,000,000)	(155,000)	(825,000)	175,000	(17.5)
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	7,604	-	300	-	-	-
* Interdepartmental	7,714	(1,000,000)	(154,700)	(825,000)	175,000	(17.5)
** Total	2,223,396	1,596,500	2,152,700	2,053,800	457,300	28.6

Summary of Revenues Details - Strategic Infrastructure & Transportation Planning						
	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4703 Cond.Grant NS(Other)	(790,462)	-	(100,000)	-	-	-
* Transfers from other Gov'ts	(790,462)	-	(100,000)	-	-	-
5508 Recov External Parti	(6,013)	(5,000)	(5,000)	(5,000)	-	-
* Other Revenue	(6,013)	(5,000)	(5,000)	(5,000)	-	-
** Total	(796,475)	(5,000)	(105,000)	(5,000)	-	-
* Net Total	1,426,920	1,591,500	2,047,700	2,048,800	457,300	28.7

HALIFAX

HALIFAX TRANSIT

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

HALIFAX TRANSIT

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

Working together to provide a safe, reliable and sustainable transit system.

OVERVIEW

Halifax Transit advances Council Priorities by operating a transit network including 369 conventional buses, five ferries and 47 Access-A-Bus vehicles. With a workforce of over 1,000 employees, the business unit manages two transit maintenance and storage centres, three ferry terminals, 11 bus terminals and 14 Park & Ride lots, providing reliable transportation across the municipality.

Access-A-Bus Service delivers specialized, demand-based, door-to-door transit for individuals who cannot use conventional transit due to physical or cognitive disabilities and who are registered as eligible riders. This service complements the fixed-route system, serving locations within 1,000 metres of a conventional route. Operating 47 vehicles and travelling nearly 2 million kilometres annually, Access-A-Bus expands mobility options for residents with accessibility needs.

Conventional Bus Service offers an extensive network of routes across the service area, providing nearly 19 million passenger trips annually and travelling more than 21 million kilometres. Ferry Services operate two routes within Halifax Harbour, with terminals in Dartmouth (Alderney and Woodside) and Downtown Halifax providing 1.7 million passenger trips annually. Halifax Transit supports these ferry operations through dedicated repair and preventative maintenance services.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Executive Director's Office	✓ Oversight and Administration of Halifax Transit Business Unit

Service Area	Services Offered
Employee Support & Development	✓ Employee Support
Planning & Customer Engagement	✓ Bus Stop Improvements ✓ Capital and Long-term Service Planning ✓ Customer Support ✓ Sustainable Transportation Programs ✓ Transit Planning and Scheduling
Transit Fleet	✓ Bus Fleet Planning, Acquisition and Disposal ✓ Conventional Service Maintenance ✓ Paratransit Service Maintenance
Transit Operations	✓ Ferry Service ✓ Ferry Service Maintenance ✓ Operating Conventional Transit Routes ✓ Paratransit Service ✓ Transit Safety
Technical Services	✓ Technology Support

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		1,155.9
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
HVAC Technician (Contract Savings)	Service Enhancement	2.0
Mobile Service Supervisor (OT Savings)	Operational Cost of Capital	2.0
Industrial Electrician	Operational Cost of Capital	2.0
Conventional Operator	Budget Committee Direction	20.0
Mechanic	Budget Committee Direction	2.0
Hostler	Budget Committee Direction	1.0
Hostler/Repair Person	Budget Committee Direction	1.0
Transferred Positions		
Net Transfer Positions		
Total Changes		30.0
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		1,185.9

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	Budget	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections		Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Conventional Service	\$ 106,462,256	\$ 101,559,300	\$ 101,902,900	\$ 110,021,300	\$ 8,462,000	8.3
Transit Facilities	5,631,434	5,004,900	5,009,900	5,037,900	33,000	0.7
Fiscal Transit	(39,973,960)	(43,101,600)	(43,101,600)	(48,022,900)	(4,921,300)	11.4
Net Total	\$ 72,119,729	\$ 63,462,600	\$ 63,811,200	\$ 67,036,300	\$ 3,573,700	5.6

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	Budget	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections		Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 105,133,564	\$ 101,393,300	\$ 105,715,400	\$ 112,348,100	\$ 10,954,800	10.8
Office	1,341,517	1,407,800	1,407,800	1,329,800	(78,000)	(5.5)
External Services	4,978,133	4,708,800	4,708,800	5,106,900	398,100	8.5
Supplies	1,294,503	1,187,200	1,190,200	1,210,200	23,000	1.9
Materials	312,016	339,200	339,200	339,200	-	-
Building Costs	2,611,500	2,326,600	2,331,600	2,326,600	-	-
Equipment & Communications	1,372,709	1,248,900	1,248,900	1,244,900	(4,000)	(0.3)
Vehicle Expense	31,957,853	32,888,600	30,222,600	32,490,800	(397,800)	(1.2)
Other Goods & Services	1,332,460	2,164,200	2,173,100	2,204,200	40,000	1.8
Interdepartmental	532,759	143,400	143,400	143,400	-	-
Other Fiscal	452,696	50,000	50,000	114,000	64,000	128.0
Total Expenditures	151,319,710	147,858,000	149,531,000	158,858,100	11,000,100	7.4

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	Budget	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections		Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Area Rate Revenue	\$ (40,426,656)	\$ (43,551,600)	\$ (43,551,600)	\$ (48,536,900)	\$ (4,985,300)	11.4
Fee Revenues	(36,859,539)	(39,404,600)	(39,718,100)	(41,345,700)	(1,941,100)	4.9
Other Revenue	(1,913,785)	(1,439,200)	(2,450,100)	(1,939,200)	(500,000)	34.7
Total Revenues	(79,199,980)	(84,395,400)	(85,719,800)	(91,821,800)	(7,426,400)	8.8
Net Total	\$ 72,119,729	\$ 63,462,600	\$ 63,811,200	\$ 67,036,300	\$ 3,573,700	5.6

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 63,462,600
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Additional Ferry Cleanings	38,000
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	9,802,400
Refuse Collection increases	80,000
Rural Transit Grant contract increase	64,000
Software Licence increases	30,000
Uniform increases	25,000
Compulsory Ferry Training	30,000
Revenue Changes	
Local Transit Tax revenue changes	(4,985,300)
Ridership growth increase to fare revenue and miscellaneous Adjustments	(1,046,100)
Other/Transfers	
Operating Costs for 4 Additional Access-A-Buses	767,900
Fuel savings - 60 Ebuses in service and lower fuel prices	(1,417,600)
Ferry dry docking costs (funded via reserve for 2025/26)	720,000
IT Services - Eastlink WAN/Internet Services	(28,000)
Miscellaneous adjustments	43,000
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact "Green" Reductions	(859,700)
Enhance security at Scotia Square Terminal and Mumford Terminal	280,100
Accelerate the implementation of Halifax Transit's Core Service Plan	1,100,000
\$0.25 Fare increase	(865,600)
Cease Charter fee waivers	(129,400)
Discontinue printing of Riders Guides and Route Maps	(75,000)
Total Changes	\$ 3,573,700
2026/27 Budget	\$ 67,036,300

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Transit Operations	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Revenue Ridership (millions)	19.6	20.3	20.6	21.3
Analysis: After several years of regular growth following the COVID-19 pandemic and population boom in Halifax, ridership growth in 2025/26 has slowed significantly. This can be partly attributed to the fare increase that was implemented in September 2024, as well as shifting travel patterns due to				

major changes in the road network (i.e., opening of new highway connecting Burnside and Sackville, removal of bridge tolls), which have provided new options for trips.

- A 3.4% ridership increase is expected in the coming year, which is more in-line with growth experienced in past years.

Access-A-Bus Service	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Ridership	163,500	165,500	158,900	159,200
Total Cost (Expenses) per Revenue Vehicle Hour	\$85.20	\$101.96	\$100.76	\$107.13
Operating Expense per Passenger	\$50.28	\$60.29	\$60.25	\$63.96
Average Fare per Passenger	\$1.50	\$1.59	\$1.89	\$1.89
Revenue/ Cost Ratio	3.0%	2.6%	3.1%	3.0%
Customer Service (requests addressed within standard)	95%	81%	78%	90%
On-time performance for Access-A Bus	93%	94%	94%	90%
Grade of Service % of calls answered within 30 seconds	-	53.3%	53.5%	80%
Per cent of trips provided by Access-A-Bus annually of demand	73.9%	74.8%	73.7%	73.7%

Analysis:

- In 2025/26, Access-A-Bus is projected to experience a slight decrease in ridership, paired with increased revenue from the September 2024 fare increase, resulting in an improved financial position relative to 2024/25. With additional service provided in 2026/27 (two additional vehicles), ridership is expected to have a minor increase.

Conventional Transit Service	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Ridership	18,042,400	18,589,600	18,707,700	19,413,900
Number of Regular Service Passenger Trips per Capita in Service Area	53.3	51.4	48.9	48.0
Passengers per Service Hour	19.5	19.0	18.3	18.9
Revenue Vehicle Hour per Capita in-Service Area ¹	2.7	2.7	2.7	2.5
Total Cost (Expenses) per Revenue Vehicle Hour	\$122.33	\$132.95	\$125.52	\$132.44

Operating Expense per Passenger	\$6.26	\$7.01	\$6.85	\$6.99
Average Fare per Passenger	\$1.82	\$1.92	\$2.00	\$2.00
Revenue/ Cost Ratio	29%	27%	29%	29%
Requests Addressed within Standard	77%	67%	56%	90%
Mean Distance Between Failure (fleet reliability)	9,335	9,789	11,280	10,000
Planned Hours	923,117	980,294	1,020,554	1,025,285

¹ Based on population within the Urban Transit Service Boundary.

Analysis:

- As there were no significant service changes in 2025/26, conventional transit ridership only saw a moderate ridership increase. Some efficiencies in delivering/ scheduling the service were found, resulting in reduced operating costs per passenger. For conventional, fixed route transit service, revenue hours per capital is expected to decline in 2026/27 as the population grows at a faster rate than service increases. However, ridership is expected to rebound slightly from the September 2024 fare increase and see additional gains in 2026/27.
- The introduction of 60 new electric buses into the fleet has had a positive impact on fuel and maintenance costs, as well as the mean distance between failure metric, by allowing for the retirement of some older diesel buses that were costly to maintain. Service capacity and reliability in 2026/27 will be contingent on the purchase of new articulated buses to replace the existing fleet that are beyond their life span. Should the delivery of these vehicles be delayed, there is the potential for negative impacts on the mean distance between failures metric, as well as overall ridership.

Ferry Service	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Ridership	1,402,300	1,570,100	1,685,200	1,685,500
Passengers per Capita within Service Area ¹	4.1	4.3	4.4	4.2
Passengers per Service Hour	98.9	106.6	113.5	113.6
Cost to Operate a Ferry for Each In-service Hour	\$582.13	\$717.05	\$704.12	\$776.70
Operating Expense per Passenger	\$5.89	\$6.73	\$6.20	\$6.84
Average Fare per Passenger	\$1.81	\$1.78	\$1.68	\$1.68

Revenue/ Cost Ratio	31%	27%	27%	25%
Requests Addressed within Standard	89%	54%	70%	90%
Number of ferry trip cancellations (or per cent of total trips)	4.5%	1.0%	0.3%	1.0%

¹ Based on population within the Urban Transit Service Boundary.

Analysis:

- Ferry ridership is projected to increase by over 7% in 2025/26, which shows strong growth, and may represent a rebound after a challenging year with service losses in 2024/25. Operating costs for ferry are expected to increase in 2026/27 beyond typical inflationary pressures, as a result of required maintenance on several vessels that is expected to exceed typical annual costs. Where the additional vessel maintenance introduces higher risk of service loss, growth in ridership or revenue from passengers is not expected in 2026/27.

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
MB-02 Improve the reliability of public transit.	
Implementation of the Core Service Plan <i>Service Type: Conventional Transit Service</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-02-A1</i> Gradual implementation of the new Core Service Plan, introducing updated routes, schedules and service levels across the transit network to improve reliability, accessibility and overall service efficiency.	31-Mar-28
Ferry Operations Review Report <i>Service Type: Ferry Service</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-02-A3</i> Report to Regional Council with recommendations to improve efficiency and support future demand of the ferry service. Halifax Transit will receive an industry consultant's	30-Sep-26

Deliverable	Completion
review of ferry service best practices, vessel and infrastructure needs, operational policies and procedures and overall service design.	
On-Route Charging <i>Service Type: Conventional Transit Service</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal MB-02; no Action alignment</i> Installation of one to two on-route chargers at key transit terminals to support and extend the operational capacity of the electric bus fleet across the network.	31-Mar-28
Service Reliability Analysis Report <i>Service Type: Conventional Transit Service</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal MB-02; no Action alignment</i> Completion and delivery of the Service Reliability Analysis Report, summarizing the recent collection and analysis of service reliability data and highlighting challenges, barriers and opportunities for improvement.	30-Sep-26
MB-03 Improve access to sustainable transportation modes.	
Access-A-Bus Technology <i>Service Type: Access-A-Bus Service</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-03-A1</i> Introduce an online booking and automated notification system to drive continuous improvements in Access-A-Bus service and ensure consistent and reliable client communications.	30-Sep-26
Access-A-Bus Operations Review Report <i>Service Type: Access-A-Bus Service</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-03-A2</i> Report to Regional Council with recommendations to improve efficiency and support future demand of Access-A-Bus services. Halifax Transit will receive an industry consultant's review of Access-A-Bus best practices, vehicle needs, eligibility criteria, accessibility policies and procedures and overall service design.	31-Mar-27
MB-04 Improve safety of transportation modes.	
Halifax Transit Safety Program Plan <i>Service Type: Conventional Transit Service</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: MB-04-A1</i> Draft a plan for a Halifax Transit Safety Program for further consideration. Drafting the plan will involve defining the goals and objectives of the program and, pending budget and regulatory approval, the recruitment of additional resources for future development phases of the program.	31-Mar-27
MB-06 Improve connectivity between and within communities.	

Deliverable	Completion
Wrights Cove Terminal <i>Service Type: Conventional Transit Service</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal MB-06; no Action alignment</i> Construct the Wrights Cove Terminal in Burnside. The new terminal will enhance connectivity for travelers between Sackville, Dartmouth and Burnside, while also improving passenger comfort and boosting overall network efficiency.	30-Sep-26
RA-04 Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency and cost effectiveness, while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.	
Fare Management Project – Open Payment <i>Service Type: Conventional Transit Service</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action alignment</i> Introduce open payment (tap-to-pay) functionality to the existing electronic fare collection solution to further increase boarding efficiency and to improve fare payment options.	31-Mar-27

Summary of Net Expenditures - Halifax Transit Services

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
R624 HT Director's Office	1,732,442	1,928,500	1,928,500	2,278,900	350,400	18.2
R631 Revenue	(35,054,368)	(37,300,000)	(38,584,400)	(39,740,100)	(2,440,100)	6.5
R637 Planning & Custm Eng	3,190,515	3,657,000	3,657,000	3,787,600	130,600	3.6
** Halifax Transit Administratio	(30,131,411)	(31,714,500)	(32,998,900)	(33,673,600)	(1,959,100)	6.2
R640 Technical Services	2,314,275	2,712,700	2,721,700	2,739,700	27,000	1.0
** Halifax Transit - Technical Se	2,314,275	2,712,700	2,721,700	2,739,700	27,000	1.0
R932 BTC Facility Maintenance	504,091	527,700	605,700	657,700	130,000	24.6
R935 Bus Rebuild Program	-	-	-	-	-	-
R938 BTC Bus Maintenance	14,047,933	15,218,200	14,287,400	15,922,600	704,400	4.6
R962 RLTC Facility Maint	279,190	283,400	283,400	283,400	-	-
R963 RLTC Bus Maint	13,603,839	14,122,900	14,168,400	15,318,400	1,195,500	8.5
** Halifax Transit - Transit Flee	28,435,053	30,152,200	29,344,900	32,182,100	2,029,900	6.7
R656 Safety and Training	1,327,285	1,338,000	1,341,000	1,410,400	72,400	5.4
R658 Resource Sup & Dev	1,676,772	1,747,400	1,913,800	1,845,100	97,700	5.6
** Halifax Transit - Employee Sup	3,004,057	3,085,400	3,254,800	3,255,500	170,100	5.5
R635 BTC Operators	32,464,056	30,025,200	30,511,300	31,967,800	1,942,600	6.5
R636 Service Supervisors	5,076,473	5,147,900	5,504,600	5,720,500	572,600	11.1
R638 BTC & RLTC Bus Ops	16,790,071	18,141,000	14,344,600	16,618,655	(1,522,345)	(8.4)
R652 Access-A -Bus Operations	9,338,991	8,728,100	8,871,700	8,895,645	167,545	1.9
R657 Security	1,149,239	984,000	984,000	1,256,100	272,100	27.7
R661 Ferry Operations	7,366,618	7,092,000	7,297,100	8,071,400	979,400	13.8
R670 RLTC Operators	30,654,835	27,205,300	32,067,100	32,987,500	5,782,200	21.3
** Halifax Transit - Transit Oper	102,840,282	97,323,500	99,580,400	105,517,600	8,194,100	8.4
*** Conventional Service	106,462,256	101,559,300	101,902,900	110,021,300	8,462,000	8.3
M701 Fiscal Transit	(39,973,960)	(43,101,600)	(43,101,600)	(48,022,900)	(4,921,300)	11.4
R671 Halifax Tr. Debt Chg	-	-	-	-	-	-
*** Fiscal Transit	(39,973,960)	(43,101,600)	(43,101,600)	(48,022,900)	(4,921,300)	11.4
R680 Facilities - Ragged Lake	1,573,523	1,213,400	1,213,400	1,220,400	7,000	0.6
R681 Facilities - Burnside	1,446,059	1,503,400	1,508,400	1,511,400	8,000	0.5
R682 Facil-Ferry Terminal	1,074,471	768,400	768,400	788,400	20,000	2.6
R683 Facil-Other Property	1,537,380	1,519,700	1,519,700	1,517,700	(2,000)	(0.1)
*** Transit Facilities	5,631,434	5,004,900	5,009,900	5,037,900	33,000	0.7
**** Net Total	72,119,729	63,462,600	63,811,200	67,036,300	3,573,700	5.6

Summary of Expenditures Details - Halifax Transit Services

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	69,932,228	72,670,200	72,151,100	79,860,800	7,190,600	9.9
6002 Salaries - Overtime	11,262,771	7,088,300	10,345,100	6,957,300	(131,000)	(1.8)
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(220,371)	-	(5,132,800)	-	-	-
6051 Shift Agreements	125,594	160,000	160,000	160,000	-	-
6052 Shift Differentials	20,729	15,900	15,900	15,900	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	362,266	-	-	-	-	-
6099 Other Allowances	22,015	2,500	2,500	2,500	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	17,480,105	16,004,100	17,585,000	17,964,600	1,960,500	12.3
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(5,136,300)	-	(2,771,300)	2,365,000	(46.0)
6120 Comp OCC Budget Yr 1	-	587,900	587,900	1,071,300	483,400	82.2
6152 Retirement Incentives	562,412	711,800	711,800	753,300	41,500	5.8
6154 Workers' Compensation	5,601,477	6,157,100	6,157,100	5,931,800	(225,300)	(3.7)
6155 Overtime Meals	11,104	13,800	13,800	13,800	-	-
6156 Clothing Allowance	148,026	145,200	145,200	145,200	-	-
6158 WCB Recov Earnings	(61,986)	(18,300)	(18,300)	(18,300)	-	-
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	(243,233)	2,991,100	2,991,100	2,261,200	(729,900)	(24.4)
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	102,719	-	-	-	-	-
9210 HR CATS OT Wage/Ben	27,707	-	-	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	105,133,564	101,393,300	105,715,400	112,348,100	10,954,800	10.8
6201 Telephone/Cable	172,246	143,000	143,000	119,000	(24,000)	(16.8)
6202 Courier/Postage	80,974	50,300	50,300	70,300	20,000	39.8
6203 Office Furn/Equip	47,159	40,000	40,000	40,000	-	-
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	714,567	921,400	921,400	952,400	31,000	3.4
6205 Printing & Reprod	266,655	200,000	200,000	75,000	(125,000)	(62.5)
6207 Office Supplies	59,916	33,200	33,200	53,200	20,000	60.2

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6290 Office OCC Transfer	-	19,900	19,900	19,900	-	-
* Office	1,341,517	1,407,800	1,407,800	1,329,800	(78,000)	(5.5)
6301 Professional Fees	1,763	7,000	7,000	7,000	-	-
6302 Legal Fees	10,976	10,000	10,000	10,000	-	-
6304 Janitorial Services	1,511,172	1,522,400	1,522,400	1,560,400	38,000	2.5
6308 Snow Removal	749,112	748,000	748,000	748,000	-	-
6310 Outside Personnel	911,300	751,000	751,000	751,000	-	-
6311 Security	837,814	678,000	678,000	958,100	280,100	41.3
6312 Refuse Collection	237,358	86,400	86,400	166,400	80,000	92.6
6399 Contract Services	718,636	906,000	906,000	906,000	-	-
* External Services	4,978,133	4,708,800	4,708,800	5,106,900	398,100	8.5
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	683,380	846,100	849,100	876,100	30,000	3.5
6402 Med & First Aid Supp	45,765	19,000	19,000	19,000	-	-
6403 Patrol Equip Supplies	2,683	3,800	3,800	3,800	-	-
6406 Bridge Tolls	380,121	-	-	-	-	-
6407 Clean/Sani Supplies	98,587	115,000	115,000	108,000	(7,000)	(6.1)
6409 Personal Protect Equ	83,435	122,900	122,900	122,900	-	-
6490 Supplies OCC Transfer	-	58,800	58,800	58,800	-	-
6499 Other Supplies	533	21,600	21,600	21,600	-	-
* Supplies	1,294,503	1,187,200	1,190,200	1,210,200	23,000	1.9
6502 Chemicals	2,724	-	-	-	-	-
6504 Hardware	10,885	-	-	-	-	-
6505 Lubricants	291,806	338,500	338,500	338,500	-	-
6511 Salt	2,464	-	-	-	-	-
6518 Metal	192	-	-	-	-	-
6519 Welding Supplies	3,946	700	700	700	-	-
* Materials	312,016	339,200	339,200	339,200	-	-
6602 Electrical	4,127	-	-	-	-	-
6603 Grnds & Landscaping	3,872	40,200	40,200	40,200	-	-
6604 Bus Gates/Shlfr-R&M	8,138	35,000	35,000	35,000	-	-
6607 Electricity	999,987	833,000	833,000	833,000	-	-
6608 Water	153,334	89,200	89,200	89,200	-	-
6609 Elevator & Escalator	51,714	18,100	18,100	18,100	-	-
6610 Building - Exterior	200,008	176,000	176,000	176,000	-	-
6611 Building - Interior	348,941	348,000	348,000	348,000	-	-
6612 Safety Systems	134,695	116,500	116,500	116,500	-	-
6613 Overhead Doors	122,035	100,800	100,800	100,800	-	-
6614 Envir Assess/Cleanup	2,593	-	-	-	-	-
6616 Natural Gas-Buildings	539,198	558,800	558,800	558,800	-	-
6617 Pest Management	30,410	6,000	11,000	6,000	-	-
6699 Other Building Cost	12,447	5,000	5,000	5,000	-	-
* Building Costs	2,611,500	2,326,600	2,331,600	2,326,600	-	-
6701 Equipment Purchase	2,256	20,000	20,000	20,000	-	-
6702 Small Tools	108,531	99,000	99,000	99,000	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	46,956	44,000	44,000	44,000	-	-
6704 Equipment Rental	3,817	-	-	-	-	-
6705 Equip - R&M	561,062	576,500	576,500	576,500	-	-
6707 Plumbing & Heating	48,857	-	-	-	-	-
6708 Mechanical Equipment	358,963	255,000	255,000	255,000	-	-
6711 Communication System	67,600	70,000	70,000	66,000	(4,000)	(5.7)
6732 Mobile Data	174,667	184,400	184,400	184,400	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	1,372,709	1,248,900	1,248,900	1,244,900	(4,000)	(0.3)
6802 Vehicle R&M	8,223,481	10,124,000	10,224,000	10,238,800	114,800	1.1
6803 Vehicle Fuel - Diesel	17,056,826	18,396,400	14,600,000	16,848,155	(1,548,245)	(8.4)
6804 Vehicle Fuel - Gas	711,588	912,600	677,000	1,228,245	315,645	34.6
6805 Tires and Tubes	1,331,333	1,257,000	1,257,000	1,257,000	-	-
6806 Vehicle Rentals	8,522	10,000	10,000	10,000	-	-
6810 Comm Vehicle R&M	3,683,402	1,734,000	3,000,000	1,734,000	-	-
6811 Shop Supplies	51,493	55,000	55,000	55,000	-	-
6890 Vehicle OCC Transfer	-	269,600	269,600	269,600	-	-
6899 Other Vehicle Expense	891,208	130,000	130,000	850,000	720,000	553.8
* Vehicle Expense	31,957,853	32,888,600	30,222,600	32,490,800	(397,800)	(1.2)
6901 Membership Dues	34,984	35,500	35,500	35,500	-	-
6902 Conferences/Workshop	18,441	18,000	18,000	18,000	-	-
6903 Travel - Local	15,538	15,800	15,800	15,800	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6904 Travel - Out of Town	38,308	24,000	24,000	24,000	-	-
6905 Training & Education	65,284	228,500	228,500	258,500	30,000	13.1
6906 Licenses & Agreements	112,800	98,100	98,100	98,100	-	-
6907 Commission Fees	217,579	350,000	350,000	350,000	-	-
6908 Medical Examinations	86,585	91,500	91,500	91,500	-	-
6910 Signage	1,651	2,500	2,500	2,500	-	-
6911 Facilities Rental	249,446	263,500	263,500	273,500	10,000	3.8
6912 Advertising/Promotio	258,209	350,000	350,000	350,000	-	-
6913 Awards	4,311	15,000	15,000	15,000	-	-
6914 Recruiting	83,440	72,100	81,000	72,100	-	-
6918 Meals/Catering	2,320	1,100	1,100	1,100	-	-
6919 Special Projects	6,527	538,000	538,000	538,000	-	-
6936 Staff Relations	46,562	50,000	50,000	50,000	-	-
6938 Rewarding Excellence	5,214	5,000	5,000	5,000	-	-
6999 Other Goods/Services	85,258	5,600	5,600	5,600	-	-
* Other Goods & Services	1,332,460	2,164,200	2,173,100	2,204,200	40,000	1.8
7009 Internal Trfr Other	3,837	(139,100)	(139,100)	(139,100)	-	-
7010 IntTrfr Insur Funds	-	(100,000)	(100,000)	(100,000)	-	-
7011 Int Trf Record Check	-	4,500	4,500	4,500	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	142,878	-	-	-	-	-
7013 Int Trf Extra Duty	386,045	378,000	378,000	378,000	-	-
* Interdepartmental	532,759	143,400	143,400	143,400	-	-
8004 Grants	452,696	450,000	450,000	514,000	64,000	14.2
8030 Tfr Fr Resvs to Oper	-	(400,000)	(400,000)	(400,000)	-	-
* Other Fiscal	452,696	50,000	50,000	114,000	64,000	128.0
** Total	151,319,710	147,858,000	149,531,000	158,858,100	11,000,100	7.4

Summary of Revenues Details - Halifax Transit Services

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4204 Area Rate Loc Transi	(40,426,656)	(43,551,600)	(43,551,600)	(48,536,900)	(4,985,300)	11.4
* Area Rate Revenue	(40,426,656)	(43,551,600)	(43,551,600)	(48,536,900)	(4,985,300)	11.4
5102 Facilities Rentals	(43,383)	(54,400)	(54,400)	(54,400)	-	-
5201 Fare Revenue	(36,816,740)	(39,350,200)	(39,663,700)	(41,291,300)	(1,941,100)	4.9
5450 Other Sales Revenue	585	-	-	-	-	-
* Fee Revenues	(36,859,539)	(39,404,600)	(39,718,100)	(41,345,700)	(1,941,100)	4.9
5503 Advertising Revenue	(437,827)	(665,000)	(775,900)	(565,000)	100,000	(15.0)
5508 Recov External Parti	(629,794)	(414,200)	(454,200)	(414,200)	-	-
5600 Miscellaneous Revenue	(846,164)	(360,000)	(1,220,000)	(960,000)	(600,000)	166.7
* Other Revenue	(1,913,785)	(1,439,200)	(2,450,100)	(1,939,200)	(500,000)	34.7
** Total	(79,199,980)	(84,395,400)	(85,719,800)	(91,821,800)	(7,426,400)	8.8
**** Net Total	72,119,729	63,462,600	63,811,200	67,036,300	3,573,700	5.6

HALIFAX

CHIEF ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICE

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

CAO BUSINESS UNIT

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

To support Regional Council's priorities by leading the municipality with efficient, cost-effective and sustainable management that advances community well-being and ensures transparent, responsive governance for residents.

OVERVIEW

The Chief Administrative Office (CAO) provides strategic leadership to deliver high-quality public services and advance Regional Council's priorities. As legislated under the Halifax Regional Municipality Charter, the business unit supports and coordinates the work of Regional Council, Community Councils and Council-appointed Boards and Committees. It supports the Mayor and Council with legislative, administrative and strategic advice and ensures transparent governance, effective decision-making and responsive service delivery.

The business unit works to create an inclusive organizational culture that reflects the diverse Halifax Regional Municipality community by removing barriers and enabling full participation for all residents. It delivers strategic, integrated communications to maintain a positive municipal reputation and ensure clear, consistent messaging to residents and employees that builds understanding and support for key initiatives. In addition, it provides strategic guidance on priority initiatives through effective government relations, resident relations and administrative services, while ensuring transparent access to local government through the stewardship of public records, the management of access to information requests and the response to privacy breaches and complaints.

All Corporate Services business units report to the CAO: Finance & Asset Management, Human Resources, Information Technology and Legal, Risk & Insurance Services. The Commissioner of Operations (COO) and the Commissioner of Public Safety (CPS) also report to the CAO. The Office of the Commissioner of Operations oversees Halifax Transit, Parks & Recreation, Planning & Development, Property, Fleet & Environment, Public Works, Major Projects Office and Strategic Infrastructure & Transportation Planning, with a focus on improving strategic alignment, service delivery and operational efficiency. The Office of the Commissioner of Public Safety provides

administrative oversight and coordinates public safety services, enhancing integration and strategic planning across Halifax Regional Fire & Emergency, Halifax Regional Police and Community Safety.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Office of the CAO	✓ Oversight of all municipal Business Units ✓ CAO Corporate Governance ✓ CAO Issue Coordination ✓ City Hall Administration ✓ Executive Administrative Support for the CAO ✓ Report Centre Production and Approval
Office of the Commissioner of Operations	✓ Oversight of the Operations Business Units and Offices
Office of the Commissioner of Public Safety	✓ Police Transformation Project Management ✓ Oversight of the Public Safety Business Unit
Executive Director City Hall Administration and Municipal Clerk	✓ Access and Privacy ✓ Clerk's Office ✓ Council Support ✓ Municipal Archives – Corporate Information Management ✓ Municipal Elections ✓ Municipal Records Centre – Corporate Information Management
Corporate Communications	✓ Communications Strategy ✓ Crisis Communication ✓ Internal Communications ✓ Marketing and Graphic Design ✓ Print Services ✓ Public Affairs
Councillors' Support Office	✓ Councillor Administrative Support ✓ Councillor Communication Support ✓ Councillor-Citizen Relations Support ✓ Councillor Operational Support

Service Area	Services Offered
Diversity & Inclusion/ African Nova Scotian Affairs Integration Office	✓ Accessibility Services ✓ African Nova Scotian Integration ✓ Anti-Black Racism Action Planning ✓ Corporate Diversity Services ✓ Dismantling Hate and Racism Action Planning ✓ French Language Services ✓ Gender Equity Action Planning ✓ Immigrant Services ✓ Indigenous Community Engagement ✓ Local Immigration Partnership Implementation
Government Relations & External Affairs	✓ Corporate Policy Development, Coordination and Support ✓ Corporate Project Coordination and Management ✓ External Partnership Relations ✓ Government Relations

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		81.0
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Administrative Assistant III	Service Enhancement	1.0
Admin Coordinator - Funded by HIP	Service Enhancement	0.6
Chief of Staff	Vacant Position/Position Removed	(1.0)
Administrative Support/Intake Analyst	Service Enhancement	1.0
Transferred Positions		
Transfer from Legal, Risk & Insurance	Municipal Clerks Office Transferred to CAO	17.1
Transfer from Legal, Risk & Insurance	Access & Privacy Transferred to CAO	9.0
Transfer from Legal, Risk & Insurance	Information Management Transferred to CAO	9.0
Transfer from Legal, Risk & Insurance	Board Of Police Commissioners Transferred to CAO	1.0
Transfer from Halifax Regional Police	FOIPOP Coordinators Transferred from Halifax Regional Police	2.0
Total Changes		39.7
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		120.7

* *HIP: Halifax Immigration Partnership*

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	Budget	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections		Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Municipal Clerks	\$ 2,768,337	\$ 3,560,500	\$ 2,918,500	\$ 3,264,900	\$ (295,600)	(8.3)
Commissioner of Public Safety	370,693	918,900	818,300	923,700	4,800	0.5
Commissioner of Operations	590,339	514,400	547,200	477,200	(37,200)	(7.2)
Corporate Communications	4,176,233	3,990,900	4,341,400	4,083,000	92,100	2.3
Government Relations & Externa	3,406,630	3,874,900	3,734,500	3,849,200	(25,700)	(0.7)
CAO Office	937,992	1,075,900	1,223,500	1,120,100	44,200	4.1
Councillor Support	3,148,142	3,316,800	3,317,700	3,393,600	76,800	2.3
Diversity and Inclusion	1,965,910	2,306,200	2,127,900	2,712,100	405,900	17.6
Net Total	\$ 17,364,275	\$ 19,558,500	\$ 19,029,000	\$ 19,823,800	\$ 265,300	1.4

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	Budget	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections		Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 12,705,041	\$ 14,650,200	\$ 13,906,300	\$ 14,791,700	\$ 141,500	1.0
Office	1,447,842	964,600	1,396,700	933,400	(31,200)	(3.2)
External Services	593,836	517,600	445,400	318,900	(198,700)	(38.4)
Supplies	12,910	11,800	8,200	11,800	-	-
Materials	1,159	-	1,000	-	-	-
Building Costs	2,817	44,500	45,800	4,500	(40,000)	(89.9)
Equipment & Communications	8,406	18,000	37,000	44,500	26,500	147.2
Vehicle Expense	25,162	26,400	28,400	26,400	-	-
Other Goods & Services	619,844	881,400	944,600	948,100	66,700	7.6
Interdepartmental	(409,952)	(296,200)	(331,100)	(296,200)	-	-
Other Fiscal	6,764,504	7,010,300	7,010,600	7,870,100	859,800	12.3
Total Expenditures	21,771,570	23,828,600	23,492,900	24,653,200	824,600	3.5

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	Budget	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections		Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Area Rate Revenue	\$ (3,803,510)	\$ (3,820,200)	\$ (3,820,200)	\$ (4,497,600)	\$ (677,400)	17.7
Payments in Lieu of taxes	-	(174,600)	(174,600)	-	174,600	(100.0)
Transfers from other Govts	(2,297)	-	-	-	-	-
Other Revenue	(601,488)	(275,300)	(469,100)	(331,800)	(56,500)	20.5
Total Revenues	(4,407,295)	(4,270,100)	(4,463,900)	(4,829,400)	(559,300)	13.1
Net Total	\$ 17,364,275	\$ 19,558,500	\$ 19,029,000	\$ 19,823,800	\$ 265,300	1.4

* Budgets have been restated due to changes in organizational structure.

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 19,558,500
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Other inflationary and service pressures	(16,700)
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	831,500
Halifax Partnership 2% increase	44,900
ANS Road to Economic Prosperity agreement concluded	(365,000)
Revenue Changes	
Print services Revenue increases	(40,000)
Other/Transfers	
Vacancy Management	(600,000)
Eliminate budget for legal fees	(100,000)
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact "Green" Reductions	(24,500)
Low Service Impact Reductions in response to flat tax motion	(162,000)
Reduce contribution to Engage NS 2025 Quality of Life survey	(8,000)
Eliminate planned 2% increase in funding to Halifax Partnership in 2026/27	(44,900)
Approved ANS funding (for 3 years, starting in 2026/27)	750,000
Total Changes	\$ 265,300
2026/27 Budget	\$ 19,823,800

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Office of Diversity & Inclusion/ ANSAIO	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned ¹
Diversity & Inclusion training ²				
Number of participants	794	1078	800	N/A
Number of training sessions	59	60	60	N/A
¹ 2026/27 data is N/A; these performance indicators are lagging indicators that are not forecasted but are reported after the reporting period closes. ² Training sessions include: Corporate Diversity & Inclusion, Going from Support to Inclusion – Accessibility Training, Parlez vous francais – French training, Reaching out from an Afrocentric Place, Anti-Black Racism training, Indigenous Blanket Exercise and Gender Based Analysis+ Toolkit Training. Analysis: There is an increased demand for and participation in Anti-Black Racism training sessions.				
Office of the Municipal Clerk	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned ¹

Total number of Formal Freedom of Information (as per Legislated FOI Program) requests received	334	366	300 ²	N/A
Total number of Regular Freedom of Information requests processed	334	346	300	N/A
Per cent of Formal Freedom of Information Requests completed within legislated timelines ³	63.5%	47.4%	-	N/A

¹ 2026/27 data is N/A; these performance indicators are lagging indicators that are not forecasted but are reported after the reporting period closes.

² Projection is based on average number of requests received monthly as of November 30, 2025.

³ Legislated timeline is 30 days calendar days.

Analysis:

- The Access & Privacy office expects to process 300 applications in 2025/26, which includes a significant number of high-volume requests on matters of public interest. Resourcing challenges in the 2025/26 fiscal year have impacted ability to meet legislated timelines.

Requests have higher page counts of responsive records – more requests that are 100 pages or higher. Multiple requests are also received where the page count is over 1,000 pages (as high as 30,000 pages).

Corporate Communications	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Followers on primary social media accounts (X, Facebook Instagram, LinkedIn and YouTube)	172,813	190,000	207,000	217,000
Actively engaged users of online engagement platform Halifax tools (survey, forums, etc.)	9,902	28,000	25,000	28,000
Integrated communications plans ¹	176	357	365	365
Posts via Employee News	131	103	115	120
All staff emails, including Employee Bulletins	123	100	96	100
Public Service Announcements (PSAs), media releases and statements ²	717	716	720	720
Media inquiries	1,152	973	1,000	1,000
Units printed	3,180,000	3,655,081	3,200,000	3,500,000
Mail items processed				
Incoming mail	350,000	325,000	325,000	350,000
Outgoing mail	750,000	1,000,000	750,000	765,000

- ¹ New project management software was adopted in 2023/24, allowing for enhanced tracking of communications projects.
- ² All PSAs, media releases and statements are issued by Public Affairs in both English and French. The numbers listed above account for unique products in English (the figures double when including French versions).

Analysis:

- Ongoing enhancements to social media efforts, including expanded content creation through videography, continues to drive year-over-year growth in the number of followers – and, ultimately, ability to reach and engage with residents via primary social media platforms (i.e. Bluesky, Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, YouTube and X). In summer 2025, the municipality discontinued its use of X and adopted Bluesky. While Corporate Communications is not currently posting and engaging on the X platform, the associated followers are included in the overall count for continuity in year-over-year comparison of potential reach. Engage Halifax was launched in September 2025, as the municipality's online engagement platform, replacing Shape Your City Halifax. The number of engaged users of platform portal increases in years when there are a greater number of municipal projects requiring the use of the portal for public engagement.
- The number of integrated communications plans developed and executed each year is driven by the needs of business unit partners to advance priorities and associated initiatives. Starting in 2024/25, increased focus was placed on improving quality and relevancy of employee-facing communications. Adoption of a more strategic, targeted approach resulted in a reduction in frequency of Employee News posts and all-staff emails in 24/25. With the launch of the new employee intranet (the Lighthouse) in fall 2025 an increase in audience engagement with Employee News posts is anticipated moving forward due to enhanced employee accessibility and integration of content via the new SharePoint platform.
- The number of PSAs, media releases, statements and media inquiries has remained relatively stable. Fluctuations from year to year are impacted by demand from business unit partners to support communications efforts such as educational campaigns and promoting municipal initiatives and projects, as well as external factors such as weather events (e.g. winter storms), issues management (e.g. homelessness crisis) and emergencies.

The number of units printed is trending upward due to several factors, including growing demand from business unit partners for materials in multiple formats tailored to different audiences, an increase in notifications for residents related to municipal projects and requests for materials translated in different languages. In 2024/25 there was a spike in volume of units printed as well as outgoing mail, primarily due to the Residents Survey and Municipal Election. Efforts remain focussed on eliminating unnecessary printing. In addition to regularly identifying alternatives to print materials (e.g. digital communications), where possible, Corporate Communications supports HalifACT objectives by reducing waste (e.g. printing more impressions per sheet, using lower grade paper stock where possible, etc.) to reduce cost and overall paper consumption.

Government Relations & External Affairs	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned ¹
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Number of intergovernmental agreements signed and supported by GREA ²				
Signed	11	11	12	N/A
Total Funding	\$117.5M	\$41.8M	\$31.5M	N/A

¹ 2026/27 data is N/A; these performance indicators are lagging indicators that are not forecasted but are reported after the reporting period closes.

² This measure reflects agreements where GREA played a direct role in negotiation or support. It does not capture all intergovernmental agreements across the municipality. Funding amounts represent commitments at the time of signing; actual receipt may occur in a different fiscal year. Year-to-year variation is influenced by external factors such as program availability, eligibility criteria and timing of announcements from other levels of government.

Analysis:

Performance Measures related to intergovernmental agreements are dependent on factors such as announcements of new programs from other levels of government, discontinuation or expiry of existing programs, municipal eligibility for programs, etc. Therefore, external factors have a significant influence on year-to-year variation in numbers.

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
EP-04 Ensure residents and businesses can contribute to and benefit from the municipality's growing economy.	
African Nova Scotian Road to Economic Prosperity Action Plan <i>Service Area: Diversity & Inclusion/ African Nova Scotian Affairs Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-04-A1</i> Support the delivery of the municipal actions in the African Nova Scotian Road to Economic Prosperity Action Plan 2025-2030 to advance economic development and community priorities according to priorities to be established by the Road to Economic Prosperity Advisory Committee.	31-Mar-30

Deliverable	Completion
2022-2027 Inclusive Economic Strategy (Year 5) <i>Service Area: Government Relations & External Affairs</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-04-A5</i> Continue implementing and tracking the 2022-2027 Economic Strategy with the Halifax Partnership to attract, keep and grow talent, investment and jobs in Halifax.	31-Mar-27
Economic Strategy Renewal <i>Service Area: Government Relations & External Affairs</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-04-A6</i> Work with the Halifax Partnership to initiate the development of the next Economic Strategy and prepare a report for the Community Planning and Economic Development Standing Committee.	30-Jun-27
SC-04 Plan and invest in social infrastructure and opportunities for connection to increase residents' well-being and sense of belonging in their communities.	
Africville Visioning <i>Service Area: Diversity & Inclusion/ African Nova Scotian Affairs Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A7</i> Establish the Africville visioning process and action plan.	31-Mar-27
Diversity & Inclusion Framework <i>Service Area: Diversity & Inclusion/ African Nova Scotian Affairs Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A7</i> Transition the Diversity & Inclusion Framework to a 2027/28 Corporate Diversity & Inclusion Action Plan.	31-Mar-27
Anti-Black Racism / Dismantling Hate and Racism Strategy <i>Service Area: Diversity & Inclusion/ African Nova Scotian Affairs Office</i> <i>Action Plan References: SC-04-A7</i> Establish the Dismantling Hate and Racism Strategy as prescribed by the province.	31-Mar-27
Immigration Strategy Review and Immigration Action Plan <i>Service Area: Diversity & Inclusion/ African Nova Scotian Affairs Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A7</i> Conduct a review of the current Immigration Strategy to develop a 2027/28 Immigration Action Plan.	31-Mar-27
French Services Action Plan <i>Service Area: Diversity & Inclusion/ African Nova Scotian Affairs Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A7</i> Conduct a review of the current French Services Strategy to develop a 2027/28 French Services Action Plan.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Gender Equity Action Plan <i>Service Area: Diversity & Inclusion/ African Nova Scotian Affairs Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A7</i> Conduct a review of the current Gender Equity Strategy to develop a 2027/28 Gender Equity Action Plan.	31-Mar-27
Indigenous Services Action Plan <i>Service Area: Diversity & Inclusion/ African Nova Scotian Affairs Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A8</i> Develop a 2027/28 Indigenous Services Action Plan.	31-Mar-27
Accessibility Strategy 2025-2028 (Year 2) <i>Service Area: Diversity & Inclusion/ African Nova Scotian Affairs Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A9</i> Continue to work with business units and the community to implement and track Year 2 of the Accessibility Strategy 2025-2028.	31-Mar-27
Local Immigration Partnership <i>Service Area: Diversity & Inclusion/ African Nova Scotian Affairs Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A10</i> Through the Local Immigration Partnership, the municipality will bring together settlement agencies, community groups, employers and others to create a welcoming and inclusive community for newcomers. This will include: maintaining an inclusive partnership council that is broad based and representative of the community it represents; establishing ad-hoc working groups comprised of key partners and community representatives that will address community gaps and challenges to better support and address newcomer needs; supporting knowledge sharing and training by organizing training and activities for their local community partners; and, conducting research, as needed, to understand the newcomers' needs and the community's assets and gaps.	31-Mar-28
RA-01 Preserve and strengthen the municipality's financial position to meet current and future needs and obligations.	
Protocol and Sponsorship <i>Service Area: Government Relations & External Affairs</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-01; no Action alignment</i> Develop a framework and begin implementation of a coordinated Protocol and Sponsorship program for the organization.	31-Mar-27
RA-04 Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency and cost effectiveness, while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.	

Deliverable	Completion
Support for Key Policies and Strategies <i>Service Area: Corporate Communications</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04-A2</i> Support for advancing key policies and strategies including the Multilingual Policy, Social Media Policy, Accessibility Strategy and Anti-Black Racism Strategy.	31-Mar-27
Support for Major Projects <i>Service Area: Corporate Communications</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04-A2</i> Support for major projects including the Bus Rapid Transit, Cogswell District Project, Downtown Dartmouth Waterfront Revitalization, Housing Accelerator Fund, Mill Cove Project, Regional Plan, Suburban Plan and Windsor Street Redevelopment Project.	31-Mar-27
Governance Review – Phase 2 <i>Service Area: Office of the Executive Director City Hall Administration</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04; no Action alignment</i> Review of all Standing Committee Terms of Reference to reduce duplications and align with current municipal priorities. Develop a framework to review the Lived Experience Committees in terms of creation, reporting and support models. This work will also include a review of Terms of Reference for Lived Experience Committees to better define roles of Committee, staff liaison and business unit staff. Development of Committee Procedures Administrative Order.	31-Mar-27
Elections – Resourcing Study for Fully Alternative (Internet and Telephone) Voting Election <i>Service Area: Office of the Executive Director City Hall Administration</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04; no Action alignment</i> Develop a resourcing study contemplating alternative (internet and telephone) election voting for the Halifax Regional Municipality.	30-Sep-26
Elections – Update and Revise Policies for Incumbents and Candidates During Elections <i>Service Area: Office of the Executive Director City Hall Administration</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04; no Action alignment</i> Work in consultation with the Councillor Support Office and Finance to enhance and redevelop policies that clearly outline rules and expectations for the use of municipal assets and discretionary spending during municipal election campaigns.	31-Mar-27
Payment Portal Review <i>Service Area: Office of the Executive Director City Hall Administration</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action alignment</i> Review options for a payment portal for access to information requests with potential implementation based on that review.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
RA-05 Deliver meaningful and accessible public engagement and education on key municipal issues.	
Digital Communications Strategy <i>Service Area: Corporate Communications</i> <i>Action Plan References: RA-05-A2</i> Implement the Digital Communications Strategy to advance public engagement and education objectives.	31-Mar-27
OP-01 Foster a workplace that is equitable, diverse, inclusive and accessible.	
Corporate Diversity and Inclusion Training <i>Service Area: Diversity & Inclusion/ African Nova Scotian Affairs Office</i> <i>Action Plan References: OP-01-A1</i> Develop and provide corporate diversity and inclusion in person and online training including: Corporate Diversity & Inclusion (monthly), Going from Support to Inclusion – Accessibility Training (monthly), Parlez vous francais – French training (two times per year), Reaching out from an Afrocentric Place (monthly), Anti-Black Racism training (on request), Indigenous Blanket Exercise (on request) and Gender Based Analysis+ Toolkit Training (quarterly).	31-Mar-27

Summary of Net Expenditures - CAO

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
A121 Municipal Clerk	1,490,720	1,712,800	1,472,300	1,390,300	(322,500)	(18.8)
A722 Access & Privacy	549,186	841,700	677,200	1,021,500	179,800	21.4
A725 Information Management	728,431	1,006,000	769,000	853,100	(152,900)	(15.2)
A122 Info Resource Mgmt	-	-	-	-	-	-
*** Municipal Clerks	2,768,337	3,560,500	2,918,500	3,264,900	(295,600)	(8.3)
E140 Comm of Pub Safety	51,057	553,300	570,200	654,200	100,900	18.2
P135 Board Of Police C	319,636	365,600	248,100	269,500	(96,100)	(26.3)
*** Commissioner of Public Safety	370,693	918,900	818,300	923,700	4,800	0.5
E150 Comm'r of Operations	590,339	514,400	547,200	477,200	(37,200)	(7.2)
*** Commissioner of Operations	590,339	514,400	547,200	477,200	(37,200)	(7.2)
A621 Mrkt & Prom.-Hbr Sol	-	-	-	-	-	-
** Corporate Comms Locked Cost Ce	-	-	-	-	-	-
A124 Print Services	1,379,103	1,148,600	1,425,600	1,118,800	(29,800)	(2.6)
A620 Marketing	1,038,691	1,024,800	1,053,800	1,076,700	51,900	5.1
A622 Public Affairs	705,105	774,900	750,600	817,600	42,700	5.5
A623 Internal Communications	866,671	844,300	904,200	932,000	87,700	10.4
E112 Corp.Comm.Admin.	186,663	198,300	207,200	137,900	(60,400)	(30.5)
*** Corporate Communications	4,176,233	3,990,900	4,341,400	4,083,000	92,100	2.3
C510 Locked Bus Dist. Com	-	-	-	-	-	-
C511 Downtown Dartmouth BID	-	-	-	-	-	-
C512 Downtown Halifax BID	-	-	-	-	-	-
C513 Spring Garden Road BID	-	-	-	-	-	-
C514 Quinpool Road BID	-	-	-	-	-	-
C515 Spryfield & District BID	-	-	-	-	-	-
C516 Sackville Drive BID	-	-	-	-	-	-
C517 Dart Main St BID	-	-	-	-	-	-
C518 North End BID	-	-	-	-	-	-
C519 Porters Lake BID	-	-	-	-	-	-
** Business Improvement Districts	-	-	-	-	-	-
C771 BID's Contributions Fund	206,999	207,000	207,000	207,000	-	-
E121 Greater Hlfx Partner	2,129,622	2,243,500	2,243,500	2,243,500	-	-
E400 Intergovrn. Relation	1,070,008	1,424,400	1,284,000	1,398,700	(25,700)	(1.8)
*** Government Relations & Externa	3,406,630	3,874,900	3,734,500	3,849,200	(25,700)	(0.7)
C001 Locked DCAO Operations	-	-	-	-	-	-
C051 Lock Yr2000-Y2K Proj	-	-	-	-	-	-
C052 Lock Smart Comm Prog	-	-	-	-	-	-
C802 Lock Integrated Comm	-	-	-	-	-	-
** CAO Locked Cost Centers	-	-	-	-	-	-
E110 CAO Office	928,925	1,065,900	1,213,300	1,110,100	44,200	4.1
E113 City Hall Operations	9,067	10,000	10,200	10,000	-	-
*** CAO Office	937,992	1,075,900	1,223,500	1,120,100	44,200	4.1
E200 Councillor's Support	3,148,142	3,316,800	3,317,700	3,393,600	76,800	2.3
*** Councillor Support	3,148,142	3,316,800	3,317,700	3,393,600	76,800	2.3
E402 Fr/Loc Immig Partn	-	65,400	65,400	68,600	3,200	4.9
E401 Diversity-Inclusion	1,965,910	2,240,800	2,062,500	2,643,500	402,700	18.0
*** Diversity and Inclusion	1,965,910	2,306,200	2,127,900	2,712,100	405,900	17.6
**** Net Total	17,364,275	19,558,500	19,029,000	19,823,800	265,300	1.4

Summary of Expenditures Details - CAO

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	10,634,119	11,624,800	11,423,600	12,600,100	975,300	8.4
6002 Salaries - Overtime	46,292	28,000	120,900	32,000	4,000	14.3
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(377,460)	-	(270,400)	-	-	-
6050 Court Time	-	-	1,300	-	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	10,475	-	33,200	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	2,118,536	2,182,200	2,152,600	2,542,800	360,600	16.5
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(155,800)	-	(755,800)	(600,000)	385.1
6150 Honorariums	8,300	13,600	13,600	13,600	-	-
6152 Retirement Incentives	60,277	68,300	66,200	79,600	11,300	16.5
6154 Workers' Compensation	249,546	331,200	321,700	341,100	9,900	3.0
6155 Overtime Meals	180	-	500	400	400	-

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6170 ext Fund Positions	-	62,200	-	27,200	(35,000)	(56.3)
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	(45,388)	495,700	43,100	(89,300)	(585,000)	(118.0)
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	163	-	-	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	12,705,041	14,650,200	13,906,300	14,791,700	141,500	1.0
6201 Telephone/Cable	33,415	34,600	22,000	28,400	(6,200)	(17.9)
6202 Courier/Postage	902,366	619,800	862,900	619,000	(800)	(0.1)
6203 Office Furn/Equip	63,789	39,100	12,700	16,600	(22,500)	(57.5)
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	20,723	20,500	26,000	20,500	-	-
6205 Printing & Reprod	389,179	206,600	435,800	206,600	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	36,106	40,500	27,600	38,800	(1,700)	(4.2)
6299 Other Office Expenses	2,263	3,500	9,700	3,500	-	-
* Office	1,447,842	964,600	1,396,700	933,400	(31,200)	(3.2)
6301 Professional Fees	162	-	-	-	-	-
6302 Legal Fees	146,838	100,000	-	-	(100,000)	(100.0)
6303 Consulting Fees	101,690	27,000	43,000	27,000	-	-
6308 Snow Removal	-	-	200	-	-	-
6311 Security	6,806	-	7,000	-	-	-
6399 Contract Services	338,341	390,600	395,200	291,900	(98,700)	(25.3)
* External Services	593,836	517,600	445,400	318,900	(198,700)	(38.4)
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	287	300	300	300	-	-
6402 Med & First Aid Supp	6	-	-	-	-	-
6405 Photo Supp & Equip	8,908	7,500	7,500	7,500	-	-
6407 Clean/Sani Supplies	52	-	-	-	-	-
6409 Personal Protect Equ	-	-	400	-	-	-
6499 Other Supplies	3,656	4,000	-	4,000	-	-
* Supplies	12,910	11,800	8,200	11,800	-	-
6513 Seeds & Plants	-	-	1,000	-	-	-
6516 Topsoil	1,159	-	-	-	-	-
* Materials	1,159	-	1,000	-	-	-
6603 Grnds & Landscaping	1,077	-	-	-	-	-
6608 Water	33	-	-	-	-	-
6610 Building - Exterior	400	-	-	-	-	-
6611 Building - Interior	417	40,000	41,300	-	(40,000)	(100.0)
6699 Other Building Cost	890	4,500	4,500	4,500	-	-
* Building Costs	2,817	44,500	45,800	4,500	(40,000)	(89.9)
6701 Equipment Purchase	-	500	9,600	6,500	6,000	1,200.0
6702 Small Tools	-	-	200	-	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	591	1,500	100	1,500	-	-
6705 Equip - R&M	6,643	16,000	27,100	36,500	20,500	128.1
6711 Communication System	1,172	-	-	-	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	8,406	18,000	37,000	44,500	26,500	147.2
6899 Other Vehicle Expense	25,162	26,400	28,400	26,400	-	-
* Vehicle Expense	25,162	26,400	28,400	26,400	-	-
6901 Membership Dues	24,827	39,200	46,800	65,700	26,500	67.6
6902 Conferences/Workshop	72,033	75,700	47,500	76,200	500	0.7
6903 Travel - Local	45,425	68,200	58,600	68,300	100	0.1
6904 Travel - Out of Town	56,948	80,900	110,100	81,900	1,000	1.2
6905 Training & Education	25,978	52,500	39,600	52,500	-	-
6907 Commission Fees	-	-	100	-	-	-
6910 Signage	45	-	-	-	-	-
6911 Facilities Rental	7,105	7,800	6,800	7,300	(500)	(6.4)
6912 Advertising/Promotio	158,295	139,100	132,900	138,100	(1,000)	(0.7)
6913 Awards	1,120	1,200	2,400	1,200	-	-
6914 Recruiting	450	-	75,200	-	-	-
6915 Research Data Acquis	5,927	5,000	5,000	5,000	-	-
6916 Public Education	204	3,800	1,800	3,800	-	-
6917 Books and Periodicals	8,178	13,000	13,400	12,600	(400)	(3.1)
6918 Meals/Catering	46,446	32,000	38,800	33,000	1,000	3.1
6919 Special Projects	112,214	250,700	260,900	300,700	50,000	19.9
6920 Land Purchase	16	-	-	-	-	-
6928 Committee Expenses	300	3,000	3,000	3,000	-	-
6929 Procurement Card Clg	1,003	-	700	-	-	-
6933 Community Events	36,113	97,500	87,600	88,000	(9,500)	(9.7)
6936 Staff Relations	109	1,000	500	500	(500)	(50.0)
6938 Rewarding Excellence	9,243	10,300	8,600	9,800	(500)	(4.9)

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6999 Other Goods/Services	7,866	500	4,300	500	-	-
* Other Goods & Services	619,844	881,400	944,600	948,100	66,700	7.6
7009 Internal Trfr Other	(13,397)	(182,200)	(51,900)	(182,200)	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	(396,555)	(114,000)	(279,200)	(114,000)	-	-
* Interdepartmental	(409,952)	(296,200)	(331,100)	(296,200)	-	-
8001 Transf Outside Agenc	6,408,054	6,667,000	6,667,000	7,548,500	881,500	13.2
8004 Grants	356,451	307,000	307,300	307,000	-	-
9000 Prior Yr. Sur/Def	-	20,300	20,300	12,600	(7,700)	(37.9)
9001 Current Yr. Sur/Def	-	16,000	16,000	2,000	(14,000)	(87.5)
* Other Fiscal	6,764,504	7,010,300	7,010,600	7,870,100	859,800	12.3
** Total	21,771,570	23,828,600	23,492,900	24,653,200	824,600	3.5

Summary of Revenues Details - CAO

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4202 Area Rate Commercial	(3,803,510)	(3,820,200)	(3,820,200)	(4,497,600)	(677,400)	17.7
* Area Rate Revenue	(3,803,510)	(3,820,200)	(3,820,200)	(4,497,600)	(677,400)	17.7
4601 Grant in Lieu-Fed	-	(30,300)	(30,300)	-	30,300	(100.0)
4602 Grant in Lieu-Prov.	-	(131,400)	(131,400)	-	131,400	(100.0)
4605 Grant Lieu-Hflx Port	-	(5,800)	(5,800)	-	5,800	(100.0)
4607 Grant Lieu -Via Rail	-	(7,100)	(7,100)	-	7,100	(100.0)
* Payments in Lieu of taxes	-	(174,600)	(174,600)	-	174,600	(100.0)
4704 Conditnl Grnts Other	(2,297)	-	-	-	-	-
* Transfers from other Gov'ts	(2,297)	-	-	-	-	-
5508 Recov External Parti	(563,093)	(225,000)	(418,800)	(281,500)	(56,500)	25.1
5600 Miscellaneous Revenue	(38,396)	(50,300)	(50,300)	(50,300)	-	-
* Other Revenue	(601,488)	(275,300)	(469,100)	(331,800)	(56,500)	20.5
** Total	(4,407,295)	(4,270,100)	(4,463,900)	(4,829,400)	(559,300)	13.1
**** Net Total	17,364,275	19,558,500	19,029,000	19,823,800	265,300	1.4

HALIFAX

FINANCE AND ASSET MANAGEMENT

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

FINANCE & ASSET MANAGEMENT

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

We provide financial and strategic leadership through advice, governance, customer-focused services and policy.

OVERVIEW

Finance & Asset Management (FAM) supports Council priorities through strong financial stewardship, strategic planning, business planning, progress tracking and performance reporting and efficient service delivery to increase public trust and confidence in the municipality. The business unit oversees the operating and reserve budgets, annual financial statements, multi-year capital budget, asset management, revenues, procurement, service reviews and continuous improvement. In delivering key resident-focused services, accountability, customer service and fiscal sustainability is strengthened across the municipality.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units.

Service Area	Services Offered
Chief Financial Officer / CFO Office	✓ Oversight and Administration of Finance & Asset Management Business Unit ✓ Tax and Fiscal Policy Development
311 Customer Contact Centre	✓ 311 After-Hours Dispatch Services ✓ 311 Customer Contact Centre Services ✓ In-Person Customer Service Centres
Asset Management Office	✓ Asset Management Governance Support ✓ Asset Management Process, Tools and Training

Service Area	Services Offered
	✓ Asset Management Systems Configuration and Support ✓ Asset Portfolio and Capital Budget Coordination ✓ Performance Reporting and Continuous Improvement Support
Corporate Planning & Performance	✓ Accountability and Performance Reporting ✓ Business Planning ✓ Continuous Improvement Project Support ✓ Corporate Performance Excellence Program Oversight ✓ Corporate Planning and Performance Change Management ✓ Resident Engagement ✓ Strategic Planning
Financial Management & Operations	✓ Accounting ✓ Accounts Payable Payment Processing ✓ Budget Coordination ✓ Financial Services Delivery ✓ Financial Reporting and Analysis ✓ Financial Reserve Management ✓ Financial Strategy and Leadership ✓ Payroll Services ✓ Regional Council Financial Report Review and Support
Procurement	✓ Fuel Management and Distribution ✓ Inventory Management ✓ Procurement Services ✓ Purchasing ✓ Salt Management ✓ Surplus Asset Disposal ✓ Warranty Management
Revenue	✓ Cash Management ✓ Collections ✓ General Revenue Processing ✓ Grants and Contributions Program Support ✓ Taxation Services ✓ Treasury Services

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		239.2
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Business Analyst	Maintain Current Service	2.0
Customer Account Analyst	Vacant Position/Position Removed	(2.0)
Treasury Analyst	Vacant Position/Position Removed	(1.0)
1st Class Receiver	Vacant Position/Position Removed	(1.6)
Collection Specialist	Vacant Position/Position Removed	(1.0)
Administrative Assistant	Vacant Position/Position Removed	(2.0)
Portfolio Manager, Procurement	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Senior Performance Analyst	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Tax Analyst	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Vacant Position	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Transferred Positions		
Net Transfer Positions		
Total Changes		(9.6)
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		229.6

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Customer Contact Centres	\$ 2,968,286	\$ 3,154,100	\$ 2,990,400	\$ 3,144,200	\$ (9,900)	(0.3)
Admin - Finance	737,263	889,000	915,000	860,200	(28,800)	(3.2)
Revenue	(1,611,630)	(1,059,500)	(2,119,200)	(3,236,200)	(2,176,700)	205.4
Corporate Planning	1,183,263	1,369,500	1,358,900	1,251,500	(118,000)	(8.6)
Accounting & Financial Reporting	6,193,526	6,504,500	6,411,800	6,586,000	81,500	1.3
Procurement	5,470,820	5,715,500	5,869,300	5,833,000	117,500	2.1
Asset Management	1,196,025	1,398,500	1,554,300	1,283,300	(115,200)	(8.2)
Net Total	\$ 16,137,554	\$ 17,971,600	\$ 16,980,500	\$ 15,722,000	\$ (2,249,600)	(12.5)

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 20,157,861	\$ 21,622,000	\$ 21,034,500	\$ 21,175,200	\$ (446,800)	(2.1)
Office	212,437	227,500	182,100	169,700	(57,800)	(25.4)
External Services	1,174,325	555,800	1,209,100	523,000	(32,800)	(5.9)
Supplies	8,340	22,800	12,300	21,200	(1,600)	(7.0)
Materials	8,410	-	-	-	-	-
Building Costs	1,426	-	5,600	-	-	-
Equipment & Communications	26,843	62,300	32,700	8,100	(54,200)	(87.0)
Vehicle Expense	(143)	-	-	-	-	-
Other Goods & Services	99,426	250,800	509,500	225,500	(25,300)	(10.1)
Interdepartmental	16,697	20,700	37,900	21,700	1,000	4.8
Other Fiscal	(403,413)	-	(478,500)	-	-	-
Total Expenditures	21,302,209	22,761,900	22,545,200	22,144,400	(617,500)	(2.7)

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Fee Revenues	\$ (4,093,720)	\$ (3,768,000)	\$ (4,343,500)	\$ (4,889,100)	\$ (1,121,100)	29.8
Other Revenue	(1,070,936)	(1,022,300)	(1,221,200)	(1,533,300)	(511,000)	50.0
Total Revenues	(5,164,656)	(4,790,300)	(5,564,700)	(6,422,400)	(1,632,100)	34.1
Net Total	\$ 16,137,554	\$ 17,971,600	\$ 16,980,500	\$ 15,722,000	\$ (2,249,600)	(12.5)

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 17,971,600
Inflation/Service Pressures	
External Services increase	27,200
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	206,700
Revenue Changes	
False Alarm Revenue increase	(270,000)
Marketing Levy Revenue increase	(71,000)
Tax Certification Revenue increase	(100,000)
Tax Sale Admin increase	(110,000)
By-Law Revenue decrease	454,000
Tax Info Revenue decrease	80,000
Other Miscellaneous Revenue	(350,000)
Other/Transfers	
Transfer to IT for Microsoft Copilot	(11,000)
Discretionary Reductions	(46,300)
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact "Green" Reductions	(390,600)
Low Service Impact Reductions in response to flat tax motion	(138,500)
Increase Fees	(965,100)
FTE Reductions - Vacancy	(565,000)
Total Changes	\$ (2,249,600)
2026/27 Budget	\$ 15,722,000

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Asset Management Office	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected	2026 Planned
Number of capital projects managed for budgeting and accounting	214	337	309	320
\$ of capital projects managed for budgeting and accounting	\$230M	\$391M	\$497M	\$500M
Number of requests for change processed for Enterprise Asset Management (EAM) systems users	445	480	500	500
Analysis: - The capital program is seeing growth in larger, more complex projects. Demand continues to increase for both infrastructure renewal and expansion to support municipal services. - The volume of Enterprise Asset Management systems requests for change have increased due to changing municipal service needs and system upgrade changes.				
Corporate Planning & Performance	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected	2026 Planned
Number of Performance Excellence and Lean training participants ¹	205	83	120	100
Number of corporate improvement projects completed ²	8	6	6	5
Corporate annual savings identified	\$1,000,000	\$637,000	\$406,000	\$1,000,000
Number of Continuous Improvement (CI) projects reported	9	18	30	20
¹ The number of people trained reflects the number of registrations to Performance Excellence courses and Lean certifications. ² Corporate improvement projects are those projects supported by CPP. Analysis: - The number of employees trained in Performance Excellence or Lean decreased in 2024 due to fewer requests for Lean/Performance Excellence training for targeted municipal divisions. However, the number of sessions and capacity remained the same. For 2025/26 it is expected that the number of participants will increase due to more special requests made for training in addition to regular offerings. - In 2024/25, six corporate continuous improvement projects completed including: Payroll Process Improvement Recommendations, Councillor's Support Office Process Improvements report, Facilities Design & Construction Process Improvement report, P-Card Purchases Improvements, HR Hiring Process Improvements, AG Recommendations Tracking Improvements				

- In 2024/25, the Corporate Performance team in collaboration with Human Resources identified approximately \$637,000 in cost avoidance in future years. This project focused on identifying opportunities to reduce non-value-added work and increase efficiency. In 2025/26, approximately \$406,000 in annual savings were identified in collaboration with Facilities, Maintenance & Operations. However, these savings may be realized slowly over future years by reducing outsourced work and overtime.
- There were 18 total completed continuous improvement projects reported across the municipality in 2024/25 and 25 completed in 2025/26 year to date. Therefore, it is projected that a total of 30 projects will be completed by municipal business units. While generally the number of projects reported are increasing, it is possible these are underreported. The Corporate Planning & Performance team continues to promote lean training, awareness and support to increase continuous improvement activities.

311 Customer Contact Centre	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected ¹	2026 Planned
Contact Centre quality	88%	83%	82%	83%
Call volume	374,000	353,000	350,000	350,000
Email volume	55,000	57,000	62,000	65,000
Abandon rate	7.8%	5.02%	5.5%	6.0%
Number of counter service transactions	67,000	60,000	61,000	60,000
Customer Service Centre revenue processed	\$224M	\$206M	\$224M	\$220M

¹ 2025/26 projection can be impacted based on weather. The projection is based on current trending.

Analysis:

- The 2024/25 year-end quality results continue to demonstrate strong performance in customer service delivery. The 311 Customer Service Centres achieved an 83 per cent quality score, surpassing the established target of 80 per cent. This outcome reflects a sustained commitment to providing high-quality service and ongoing improvements in customer experience.
- Email routing to the telephony system remains a significant asset to the organization. This integration has led to ongoing enhancements in service standards, as well as more efficient routing and tracking of both internal and external customer emails. The continued growth in email volume is evident, with over 57,000 emails processed in 2024/25, building on the year-over-year upward trend.
- Up-front messaging and information mailboxes played a pivotal role in managing customer interactions, successfully deflecting approximately 30 per cent of the 353,000 customer telephone contacts recorded during the 2024/25 fiscal year. For the period ending November 20, 2025, customers reached out to the 311 Contact Centres 243,000 times via telephone and sent over 39,000 emails. These requests primarily related to municipal services including transit, garbage

and recycling, tax, road operations, animal licensing, parking enforcement and civic events. Consistently, about 30 per cent of telephone contacts were handled through information mailboxes and up-front messaging. Given current trends, the call and email volumes for the 2025/26 fiscal year are projected to be similar to those observed in the prior fiscal year.

- The 311 Customer Service Centres are tasked with supporting and assisting Halifax Regional Municipality customers regarding a variety of municipal services. In the previous fiscal year, Customer Service Representatives processed 60,000 financial transactions and collected \$206 million in revenue. This represents a 10 per cent decrease in transactions compared to the prior year, a change attributed to the increasing availability and use of digital and online services by residents. For the period ending November 30, 2025, in-person transaction volumes at the 311 Customer Service Centres have remained consistent with the previous fiscal year. It is anticipated that in-person transactions will continue at a similar level through fiscal 2025/26.
- In November 2025, 311, in collaboration with IT, introduced the American Sign Language (ASL) Video Relay Service (VRS) as a new service channel. This initiative enables residents who are Deaf or hard of hearing to access municipal services more effectively and supports the municipality's commitment to equitable, accessible and inclusive public service. Looking ahead, the organization is working with IT to introduce further enhancements to the telephony system in 2025/26, with the goal of providing innovative and improved solutions for continuous customer service improvement.

Procurement	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected	2026 Planned
Per cent of inventory on contract	49%	60%	65%	70%
Average number of bids per publicly posted solicitations per year	3.2	3.5	4.5	4
Number of competitive solicitations per year	-	429	342	400
Value of non-competitive solicitations per year	-	\$35,426,761	\$41,222,006	\$30,000,000
Average time from source to contract	-	38.5	33.3	30
Inventory Turnover	-	3.18	2.65	4

Analysis:

- Percent of inventory on contract has increased year over year, providing cost consistency and securing the dependability of our supply chain.
- Since adopting e-sourcing, more bids per solicitation have been received, we expect stabilization in 2026/27

- The number of competitive solicitations has decreased. This is a result of larger and more complex procurements and more focus on creating standing offers to address repetitive purchases and streamline departmental purchases.
- Although the value of non-competitive purchases has increased, we expect a decline in 2026/27 through better internal education, more thorough procurement project planning and market research.
- Inventory Turnover is low in comparison with standard benchmarks for distribution warehouses. Closer monitoring and disposing of dead stock should allow for the stocking of more in-demand inventory and a decrease in average inventory costs. This should increase inventory turnover and decrease delivery times on key inventory, therefore lowering the carrying costs of inventory.

Revenue	2023 Actual	2024 Actual	2025 Projected	2026 Planned
All Revenue ¹				
Percentage of resident inquiries completed within two business days	93%	97%	99.6%	98%
Taxation				
Per cent of prior year's tax arrears not collected in the current year as a percent of the current year levy	1.85%	1.50%	1.75%	1.75%
Current year's tax arrears as a percent of current year levy	1.70%	2.00%	2.25%	2.00%
General Revenue				
Per cent of billings outstanding over 90 days at year end ²	1.00%	0.88%	1.00%	1.00%
Bad debts written off as a percent of billed revenue	0.02%	0.02%	0.02%	0.02%

¹ All Revenue includes Taxation, General Revenue and Treasury.

² Excludes Halifax Water Commission.

Analysis:

- The performance measures for taxation indicate the effectiveness of collecting property tax revenue. General Revenue performance measures similarly indicate the effectiveness of collecting non-tax revenue as well as the efficiency of answering resident inquiries across the Revenue group within the service level goal of two business days.

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
RA-01 Preserve and strengthen the municipality's financial position to meet current and future needs and obligations.	
Formalize and Implement a New Corporate Financial Governance Structure <i>Service Area: Chief Financial Officer / Executive Director's Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-01-A1</i> Establish a financial governance framework and executive committee to strengthen accountability, improve cross-departmental coordination, decision making and ensure transparent oversight of budget (operating & capital) and financial policy.	31-Mar-27
Implementation of the Corporate User Fee Policy and Strategy <i>Service Area: Chief Financial Officer / Executive Director's Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-01-A3</i> In collaboration with business units, Finance and Asset Management will lead the development of a unified corporate user fee policy and strategy. This work will identify and implement new user fee opportunities that align the cost of services with the primary users that are benefitting from these services.	31-Mar-28
RA-02 Monitor, maintain, and replace municipal assets to establish and ensure service levels.	
Improve Corporate Asset Inventory Data Quality <i>Service Area: Asset Management Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-02-A2</i> Collect, review, assess, validate and maintain the municipality's asset data inventory in the Enterprise Asset Registry, to improve cost-effective long-term capital planning and municipal service delivery.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
RA-04 Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency, and cost effectiveness, while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.	
Corporate Continuous Improvement Strategy <i>Service Area: Corporate Planning & Performance</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04-A1</i> Complete a jurisdictional scan of continuous improvement programs and review the Performance Excellence Program to develop a new Corporate Continuous Improvement Strategy.	31-Mar-27
Continuous Improvement Project Support <i>Service Area: Corporate Planning & Performance</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04-A1</i> To encourage continuous improvement and operational efficiency, Corporate Performance will lead up to five corporate continuous improvement projects while providing support to business unit led projects in 2026/27.	31-Mar-27
Complete Municipal Service Review <i>Service Area: Corporate Planning & Performance</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04-A3</i> Corporate Performance will undertake a Municipal Service Review in collaboration with Finance and municipal business units to assess services and identify opportunities for efficiencies and cost savings. Results of the Review will inform 2027/28 budget and business planning and implementation of findings or subsequent Secondary Reviews.	31-Mar-27
2026-2030 Strategic Plan Accountability and Performance Reporting <i>Service Area: Corporate Planning & Performance</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04; no Action alignment</i> Corporate Planning & Performance will establish the accountability and performance reporting for the 2026-2030 Strategic Plan, including the Baseline Performance Report (fall 2026) and progress on Actions (June 2027), as well as updating the Strategic Dashboard, Corporate Dashboard and Accountability Reporting Tracker to reflect the new Strategic Plan structure.	30-Sep-27
RA-05 Deliver meaningful and accessible public engagement and education on key municipal issues.	
2027 Resident Survey <i>Service Area: Corporate Planning & Performance</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-05-A1</i> Corporate Planning will engage the organization to plan for the completion of a Resident Survey in early 2027/28 to support planning and decision-making and inform the mid-	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
cycle review of the 2026-2030 Strategic Plan. Included in this process will be the collection of national benchmarking data on survey results.	

Summary of Net Expenditures - Finance & Asset Mgmt

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
C740 Lkd Visitor S. Staff	-	-	-	-	-	-
C750 Visitor Info. Centres	-	-	-	-	-	-
C799 Visitor Serv-Clearin	-	-	-	-	-	-
* Visitor Services	-	-	-	-	-	-
A661 Lkd Admin. & Storefr	-	-	-	-	-	-
A663 Alderney Gate	215,819	212,700	203,800	205,300	(7,400)	(3.5)
A664 Bayers Road	206,834	213,100	212,900	214,200	1,100	0.5
A665 LOCKED Scotia Square	-	-	-	-	-	-
A666 Cole Harbour Place	-	-	-	-	-	-
A667 LOCKED Acadia Centre	-	-	-	-	-	-
A668 Musquodoboit Harbour	20,001	20,000	20,000	20,000	-	-
** Customer Service Centres	442,654	445,800	436,700	439,500	(6,300)	(1.4)
A625 311 Contact Centre	2,525,632	2,708,300	2,553,700	2,704,700	(3,600)	(0.1)
*** Customer Contact Centres	2,968,286	3,154,100	2,990,400	3,144,200	(9,900)	(0.3)
A301 Administration - Finance	606,936	616,700	650,400	583,400	(33,300)	(5.4)
A810 Fiscal & Tax Policy	130,327	272,300	264,600	276,800	4,500	1.7
*** Admin - Finance	737,263	889,000	915,000	860,200	(28,800)	(3.2)
A811 Community Grants	302,658	342,300	234,800	237,100	(105,200)	(30.7)
A311 Revenue - Administration	365,285	407,000	401,300	331,300	(75,700)	(18.6)
A312 Coin Room	244,072	169,000	121,200	-	(169,000)	(100.0)
A313 Cash Management	386,537	377,100	407,700	432,800	55,700	14.8
A314 General Revenue	(1,340,520)	(894,200)	(1,306,500)	(1,598,600)	(704,400)	78.8
A316 Taxation	(1,616,484)	(1,643,500)	(1,938,400)	(2,027,300)	(383,800)	23.4
A325 Collections	43,855	180,000	(39,300)	(611,500)	(791,500)	(439.7)
A360 Parking Meters	2,968	2,800	-	-	(2,800)	(100.0)
*** Revenue	(1,611,630)	(1,059,500)	(2,119,200)	(3,236,200)	(2,176,700)	205.4
A302 Corporate Planning	246,421	308,700	299,700	282,100	(26,600)	(8.6)
A307 Director CPPO	272,187	285,800	285,600	295,500	9,700	3.4
I102 Org PerformanceExcel	664,655	775,000	773,600	673,900	(101,100)	(13.0)
*** Corporate Planning	1,183,263	1,369,500	1,358,900	1,251,500	(118,000)	(8.6)
A321 Accounting Admin	1,015,167	840,300	812,300	781,800	(58,500)	(7.0)
A322 Payment Processing	760,526	737,100	694,300	751,300	14,200	1.9
A323 Accounting Operations	630,942	683,800	715,300	690,800	7,000	1.0
A324 Accounting Svce Del	1,610,913	1,638,700	1,627,700	1,628,000	(10,700)	(0.7)
A327 Accounting Capital	167,992	445,700	436,400	527,300	81,600	18.3
** Accounting	4,185,540	4,345,600	4,286,000	4,379,200	33,600	0.8
A615 Payroll Ctrlrs & Rptg	191,156	193,100	197,100	205,000	11,900	6.2
A616 Payroll Service Delivery	1,262,770	1,339,800	1,307,400	1,356,500	16,700	1.2
A617 Payroll Processing	265,688	271,100	270,700	272,200	1,100	0.4
** Payroll	1,719,614	1,804,000	1,775,200	1,833,700	29,700	1.6
A326 Planning and Reserves	288,371	354,900	350,600	373,100	18,200	5.1
*** Accounting & Financial Reporti	6,193,526	6,504,500	6,411,800	6,586,000	81,500	1.3
A331 General Purchasing	2,025,710	2,242,120	2,228,000	2,103,400	(138,720)	(6.2)
A332 Inventory Management	(52,816)	(66,100)	58,000	(117,100)	(51,000)	77.2
A333 BTC Inventory	719,091	685,500	706,800	825,700	140,200	20.5
A334 Corp Fleet & Gen Inv	695,699	787,720	752,100	799,500	11,780	1.5
A335 Procurement PSRs	728,289	697,900	807,400	693,900	(4,000)	(0.6)
A336 LockedProcurement Staff	-	-	-	-	-	-
A337 Disp.of Surplus Equi	5,900	-	(9,300)	-	-	-
A338 RLT Inventory	654,608	568,260	583,300	710,200	141,940	25.0
A339 Inventory Administration	694,339	800,100	743,000	817,400	17,300	2.2
*** Procurement	5,470,820	5,715,500	5,869,300	5,833,000	117,500	2.1
W701 Asset Management	1,196,025	1,398,500	1,554,300	1,283,300	(115,200)	(8.2)
*** Asset Management	1,196,025	1,398,500	1,554,300	1,283,300	(115,200)	(8.2)
**** Net Total	16,137,554	17,971,600	16,980,500	15,722,000	(2,249,600)	(12.5)

Summary of Expenditures Details - Finance & Asset Mgmt

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	16,057,637	17,452,300	16,834,600	17,805,300	353,000	2.0
6002 Salaries - Overtime	340,533	202,700	243,100	189,700	(13,000)	(6.4)
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(321,668)	-	(283,000)	-	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6051 Shift Agreements	4,595	5,200	5,900	5,200	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	32,147	10,000	40,700	10,000	-	-
6099 Other Allowances	80	-	-	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	3,528,619	3,750,500	3,586,300	3,933,200	182,700	4.9
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(507,500)	1,100	(507,500)	-	-
6152 Retirement Incentives	96,604	119,100	120,000	121,300	2,200	1.8
6154 Workers' Compensation	535,516	680,700	683,600	656,100	(24,600)	(3.6)
6155 Overtime Meals	(111)	2,900	2,900	2,900	-	-
6156 Clothing Allowance	2,250	4,100	3,800	3,600	(500)	(12.2)
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	(106,141)	(98,000)	(204,500)	(1,044,600)	(946,600)	965.9
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	(12,200)	-	-	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	20,157,861	21,622,000	21,034,500	21,175,200	(446,800)	(2.1)
6201 Telephone/Cable	21,577	9,300	13,500	9,300	-	-
6202 Courier/Postage	58,333	43,300	42,900	43,300	-	-
6203 Office Furn/Equip	19,784	23,800	19,200	21,500	(2,300)	(9.7)
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	72,222	67,700	78,100	61,200	(6,500)	(9.6)
6205 Printing & Reprod	96	51,900	1,100	2,900	(49,000)	(94.4)
6207 Office Supplies	38,821	30,500	26,600	30,500	-	-
6299 Other Office Expenses	1,604	1,000	700	1,000	-	-
* Office	212,437	227,500	182,100	169,700	(57,800)	(25.4)
6301 Professional Fees	213,284	275,000	199,800	243,700	(31,300)	(11.4)
6302 Legal Fees	-	-	101,700	-	-	-
6303 Consulting Fees	417,947	100,000	246,000	45,000	(55,000)	(55.0)
6304 Janitorial Services	3,751	-	300	-	-	-
6306 Property Survey	37,282	-	31,800	-	-	-
6310 Outside Personnel	253,425	-	-	-	-	-
6312 Refuse Collection	1,069	2,000	1,500	2,000	-	-
6316 Real Property Disb	2,042	10,000	6,000	10,000	-	-
6399 Contract Services	245,525	168,800	622,000	222,300	53,500	31.7
* External Services	1,174,325	555,800	1,209,100	523,000	(32,800)	(5.9)
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	2,905	12,800	5,700	11,300	(1,500)	(11.7)
6402 Med & First Aid Supp	110	500	1,200	400	(100)	(20.0)
6407 Clean/Sani Supplies	2,286	7,600	3,400	7,600	-	-
6409 Personal Protect Equ	2,610	1,900	2,000	1,900	-	-
6499 Other Supplies	428	-	-	-	-	-
* Supplies	8,340	22,800	12,300	21,200	(1,600)	(7.0)
6505 Lubricants	3	-	-	-	-	-
6507 Propane	3,662	-	-	-	-	-
6511 Salt	4,548	-	-	-	-	-
6517 Paint	33	-	-	-	-	-
6599 Other Materials	165	-	-	-	-	-
* Materials	8,410	-	-	-	-	-
6608 Water	604	-	-	-	-	-
6610 Building - Exterior	-	-	5,600	-	-	-
6611 Building - Interior	822	-	-	-	-	-
* Building Costs	1,426	-	5,600	-	-	-
6701 Equipment Purchase	14,824	2,500	6,500	2,500	-	-
6702 Small Tools	1,300	1,300	1,200	1,300	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	700	-	600	-	-	-
6704 Equipment Rental	1,267	54,200	20,000	-	(54,200)	(100.0)
6705 Equip - R&M	7,414	2,000	2,100	2,000	-	-
6706 Computer R&M	-	100	100	100	-	-
6711 Communication System	1,337	2,200	2,200	2,200	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	26,843	62,300	32,700	8,100	(54,200)	(87.0)
6802 Vehicle R&M	(198)	-	-	-	-	-
6811 Shop Supplies	56	-	-	-	-	-
* Vehicle Expense	(143)	-	-	-	-	-
6901 Membership Dues	50,001	48,100	39,700	41,300	(6,800)	(14.1)
6902 Conferences/Workshop	17,752	4,000	23,700	4,000	-	-
6903 Travel - Local	17,885	15,100	13,500	13,600	(1,500)	(9.9)
6904 Travel - Out of Town	2,025	9,300	3,400	7,500	(1,800)	(19.4)
6905 Training & Education	87,349	90,300	85,500	83,100	(7,200)	(8.0)
6906 Licenses & Agreements	2,444	300	2,600	300	-	-
6907 Commission Fees	382	-	-	-	-	-
6908 Medical Examinations	12	-	-	-	-	-
6910 Signage	-	500	-	500	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6912 Advertising/Promotio	29,462	41,500	31,300	32,000	(9,500)	(22.9)
6913 Awards	112	2,600	2,300	2,600	-	-
6914 Recruiting	-	-	800	-	-	-
6915 Research Data Acquis	-	100	-	100	-	-
6917 Books and Periodicals	2,102	1,300	1,100	800	(500)	(38.5)
6918 Meals/Catering	8,110	4,300	8,400	4,300	-	-
6919 Special Projects	1,131	5,000	5,000	5,000	-	-
6920 Land Purchase	368	-	-	-	-	-
6936 Staff Relations	1,002	-	-	-	-	-
6938 Rewarding Excellence	10,204	5,800	13,500	7,800	2,000	34.5
6954 Cash over/under	(28)	-	200	-	-	-
6999 Other Goods/Services	(130,887)	22,600	278,500	22,600	-	-
* Other Goods & Services	99,426	250,800	509,500	225,500	(25,300)	(10.1)
7009 Internal Trfr Other	35	20,300	32,700	20,300	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	16,662	400	5,200	1,400	1,000	250.0
* Interdepartmental	16,697	20,700	37,900	21,700	1,000	4.8
8030 Tfr Fr Resvs to Oper	(403,413)	-	(478,500)	-	-	-
* Other Fiscal	(403,413)	-	(478,500)	-	-	-
** Total	21,302,209	22,761,900	22,545,200	22,144,400	(617,500)	(2.7)

Summary of Revenues Details - Finance & Asset Mgmt

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4909 False Alarm Recovery	(1,379,500)	(1,030,000)	(1,300,000)	(1,530,000)	(500,000)	48.5
4951 By-Law F300 Revenue	(1,216,350)	(1,254,000)	(1,254,000)	(1,220,000)	34,000	(2.7)
5204 Administration Fees	-	(14,000)	(14,500)	(97,100)	(83,100)	593.6
5205 Tax Certificates	(1,182,690)	(1,100,000)	(1,300,000)	(1,525,000)	(425,000)	38.6
5229 Tax Sale Admin Fees	(223,695)	(190,000)	(375,000)	(415,000)	(225,000)	118.4
5241 Tax Info Revenue	(91,485)	(180,000)	(100,000)	(102,000)	78,000	(43.3)
* Fee Revenues	(4,093,720)	(3,768,000)	(4,343,500)	(4,889,100)	(1,121,100)	29.8
5508 Recov External Parti	(986,402)	(922,300)	(1,146,200)	(1,393,300)	(471,000)	51.1
5600 Miscellaneous Revenue	(84,534)	(100,000)	(75,000)	(140,000)	(40,000)	40.0
* Other Revenue	(1,070,936)	(1,022,300)	(1,221,200)	(1,533,300)	(511,000)	50.0
** Total	(5,164,656)	(4,790,300)	(5,564,700)	(6,422,400)	(1,632,100)	34.1
**** Net Total	16,137,554	17,971,600	16,980,500	15,722,000	(2,249,600)	(12.5)

HALIFAX

LEGAL, RISK AND INSURANCE SERVICES

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

LEGAL, RISK & INSURANCE SERVICES

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

To provide high quality professional services to the Halifax Regional Municipality in keeping with the municipality's core values and Council Priorities.

OVERVIEW

Legal, Risk & Insurance Services supports Council and Administrative Priorities by providing professional support to Halifax Regional Municipality through the provision of legal, risk and insurance services. The business unit ensures strong governance and oversight by supporting compliance with legal, regulatory and policy requirements across the organization.

The team provides legal advice and support to Regional Council, its agencies, boards, commissions, committees and the municipal business units. It also delivers risk management, manages claims involving the municipality and manages financing of municipal risk through insurance and reserves. The business unit identifies, analyzes and mitigates loss exposure while managing the municipal insurance portfolio for Halifax Regional Municipality, Halifax Water, the Library Commission and other agencies, boards and commissions.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Chief Governance Officer & Executive Director's Office	✓ Oversight and Administration of Legal, Risk & Insurance Services Business Unit
Legal Services	✓ Corporate Governance ✓ Litigation Services ✓ Prosecution Services ✓ Solicitor Services
Risk & Insurance Services	✓ Claims Management ✓ Contractual Risk Management ✓ Insurance Placement ✓ Operational Risk Management

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		85.6
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Telephone Claims Officer	Maintain Current Service	1.0
Transferred Positions		
Transfer to CAO	Municipal Clerks Office Transferred from Legal, Risk & Insurance	(17.1)
Transfer to CAO	Access & Privacy Transferred from Legal, Risk and Insurance	(9.0)
Transfer to CAO	Information Management Transferred from Legal, Risk & Insurance	(9.0)
Transfer to CAO	Board Of Police Commissioners Transferred from Legal, Risk & Insurance	(1.0)
Total Changes		(35.1)
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		50.5

* The Telephone Claims Officer position approved in 2025/26 is fully funded by Halifax Water.

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Legal Services	\$ 5,394,425	\$ 5,597,000	\$ 5,852,400	\$ 6,111,800	\$ 514,800	9.2
Director's Office	514,263	522,500	521,800	545,100	22,600	4.3
Risk & Insurance Services	857,873	1,087,800	898,400	988,300	(99,500)	(9.1)
Net Total	\$ 6,766,560	\$ 7,207,300	\$ 7,272,600	\$ 7,645,200	\$ 437,900	6.1

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 6,666,888	\$ 6,815,100	\$ 6,984,500	\$ 7,273,000	\$ 457,900	6.7
Office	104,285	109,000	120,400	136,500	27,500	25.2
External Services	195,931	274,000	202,500	258,800	(15,200)	(5.5)
Supplies	100	800	1,100	800	-	-
Building Costs	23	-	700	-	-	-
Equipment & Communications	2,250	-	700	-	-	-
Other Goods & Services	269,815	321,400	326,100	329,100	7,700	2.4
Interdepartmental	5,383	5,200	5,200	5,200	-	-
Other Fiscal	-	(8,000)	(3,000)	(8,000)	-	-
Total Expenditures	7,244,675	7,517,500	7,638,200	7,995,400	477,900	6.4

Revenues	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Fee Revenues	\$ (215,373)	\$ (230,200)	\$ (230,200)	\$ (230,200)	\$ -	-
Other Revenue	(262,743)	(80,000)	(135,400)	(120,000)	(40,000)	50.0
Total Revenues	(478,115)	(310,200)	(365,600)	(350,200)	(40,000)	12.9
Net Total	\$ 6,766,560	\$ 7,207,300	\$ 7,272,600	\$ 7,645,200	\$ 437,900	6.1

* Budgets have been restated due to changes in organizational structure.

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 7,207,300
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Other inflationary and service pressures	20,000
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	651,700
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Deferral of Enterprise Risk Management processes.	(193,800)
Increase Revenue	(40,000)
Total Changes	\$ 437,900
2026/27 Budget	\$ 7,645,200

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Legal Services	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Number of legal files opened	717	724	707	710
Number of prosecution files opened	162	163	138	140
Number of reports reviewed	379	442	486	485
In-house legal operating cost per \$1,000 municipal operating & capital expenditures	-	0.3%	0.3%	0.3%
In-house legal operating cost per in-house lawyer hour	-	\$177	\$192	\$209
Analysis Data reflects quantity of files; quantity can be impacted by file complexity. Number of prosecution files opened is projected to decrease by 15% based on the number of open files as of December 1, 2025				
Risk & Insurance Services	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Claims received by fiscal year	2,199 ¹	1,875	1,209	1,500
¹ Significant weather events in 2023/24 contributed to the high number of claims.				
Analysis The projected claims is based on the actual number of claims so far this fiscal year (to Q3) and adding 25 per cent. It does not account for upcoming weather-related activities which could significantly impact the frequency of claims received.				

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
RA-04 Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency, and cost effectiveness, while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.	
Governance Framework Service Area: Legal Services Action Plan Reference: RA-04-A7 Create a Governance Framework policy/guideline document to assist Business Units with the Framework to ensure municipal by-laws, administrative orders and policies are systematically reviewed.	31-Mar-27

Summary of Net Expenditures - Legal, Risk & Insurance Services

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
A110 Legal Services	5,394,425	5,597,000	5,852,400	6,111,800	514,800	9.2
* Legal Services	5,394,425	5,597,000	5,852,400	6,111,800	514,800	9.2
A101 Director's Office-Admin	514,263	522,500	521,800	545,100	22,600	4.3
* Director's Office	514,263	522,500	521,800	545,100	22,600	4.3
A303 Risk & Insurance Services	857,873	1,087,800	898,400	988,300	(99,500)	(9.1)
** Net Total	6,766,560	7,207,300	7,272,600	7,645,200	437,900	6.1

Summary of Expenditures Details - Legal, Risk & Insurance Services

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	5,575,362	5,767,400	5,957,000	5,887,100	119,700	2.1
6002 Salaries - Overtime	(686)	2,000	2,000	2,000	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(222,225)	40,000	(205,200)	40,000	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	11,634	-	12,200	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	992,320	1,020,200	1,039,100	1,064,100	43,900	4.3
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(197,300)	-	(197,300)	-	-
6152 Retirement Incentives	29,891	35,700	35,000	35,200	(500)	(1.4)
6153 Severance	165,740	-	-	-	-	-
6154 Workers' Compensation	114,664	147,100	144,400	144,900	(2,200)	(1.5)
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	-	-	-	297,000	297,000	-
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	188	-	-	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	6,666,888	6,815,100	6,984,500	7,273,000	457,900	6.7
6201 Telephone/Cable	3,320	4,500	9,100	9,000	4,500	100.0
6202 Courier/Postage	8,162	9,300	9,300	12,300	3,000	32.3
6203 Office Furn/Equip	379	12,000	10,500	12,000	-	-
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	78,778	72,000	80,000	92,000	20,000	27.8
6205 Printing & Reprod	-	400	300	400	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	13,562	10,800	10,800	10,800	-	-
6299 Other Office Expenses	84	-	400	-	-	-
* Office	104,285	109,000	120,400	136,500	27,500	25.2
6301 Professional Fees	-	1,000	-	1,000	-	-
6302 Legal Fees	70,287	150,000	75,000	135,000	(15,000)	(10.0)
6309 Litigation Disburse	10,851	7,500	6,000	7,300	(200)	(2.7)
6314 Prosecution Services	109,984	102,000	110,000	102,000	-	-
6316 Real Property Disb	3,869	8,000	3,000	8,000	-	-
6399 Contract Services	938	5,500	8,500	5,500	-	-
* External Services	195,931	274,000	202,500	258,800	(15,200)	(5.5)
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	-	-	300	-	-	-
6499 Other Supplies	100	800	800	800	-	-
* Supplies	100	800	1,100	800	-	-
6602 Electrical	-	-	700	-	-	-
6608 Water	23	-	-	-	-	-
* Building Costs	23	-	700	-	-	-
6701 Equipment Purchase	1,506	-	-	-	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	744	-	700	-	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	2,250	-	700	-	-	-
6901 Membership Dues	128,674	158,800	164,600	158,800	-	-
6902 Conferences/Workshop	-	7,500	7,600	7,500	-	-
6903 Travel - Local	8,925	5,200	7,700	5,200	-	-
6904 Travel - Out of Town	7,906	10,000	8,600	15,000	5,000	50.0
6905 Training & Education	16,074	30,000	25,000	30,000	-	-
6912 Advertising/Promotio	-	-	200	-	-	-
6914 Recruiting	728	-	-	-	-	-
6917 Books and Periodicals	100,456	107,000	107,800	107,000	-	-
6918 Meals/Catering	728	600	600	600	-	-
6938 Rewarding Excellence	6,307	2,300	3,900	5,000	2,700	117.4
6999 Other Goods/Services	17	-	100	-	-	-
* Other Goods & Services	269,815	321,400	326,100	329,100	7,700	2.4
7009 Internal Trfr Other	5,154	5,000	5,000	5,000	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	229	200	200	200	-	-
* Interdepartmental	5,383	5,200	5,200	5,200	-	-
8030 Tfr Fr Resvs to Oper	-	(8,000)	(3,000)	(8,000)	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
* Other Fiscal	-	(8,000)	(3,000)	(8,000)	-	-
** Total	7,244,675	7,517,500	7,638,200	7,995,400	477,900	6.4

Summary of Revenues Details - Legal, Risk & Insurance Services

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
5250 Sales of Svcs-Other	(215,373)	(230,200)	(230,200)	(230,200)	-	-
* Fee Revenues	(215,373)	(230,200)	(230,200)	(230,200)	-	-
5508 Recov External Parti	(262,743)	(80,000)	(135,400)	(120,000)	(40,000)	50.0
* Other Revenue	(262,743)	(80,000)	(135,400)	(120,000)	(40,000)	50.0
** Total	(478,115)	(310,200)	(365,600)	(350,200)	(40,000)	12.9
** Net Total	6,766,560	7,207,300	7,272,600	7,645,200	437,900	6.1

HALIFAX

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

To deliver technology and solutions that enable the Halifax Regional Municipality to become an organization that governs with transparency and evidence-based decision making, while providing secure customer-centric digital services that align with Council and Administrative Priorities.

OVERVIEW

Information Technology (IT) supports Regional Council and Administrative priorities by aligning the corporate vision with technology architecture and driving the municipality's growth as a modern digital service delivery organization. The business unit delivers performance excellence through secure and reliable infrastructure, resilient business systems, strengthened cybersecurity, advanced analytics and responsive customer service. Its core priorities focus on protecting business continuity, enabling data-driven decision-making, supporting enterprise resource systems and providing efficient frontline technology services.

IT enhances operational effectiveness by ensuring reliable access to devices and applications, refining foundational systems and embedding cybersecurity best practices. The team invests in advanced data analytics, geographic information systems and digital services to empower informed decision-making and foster innovation across the municipality.

Through strategic planning, service management and collaborative delivery leveraging technology solutions, including the use of AI, IT builds strong partnerships with business units and ensures technology investments generate measurable value. These efforts sustain daily operations while enabling long-term transformation, strengthening organizational resilience and enhancing services for the municipality and its residents.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Executive Director's Office	✓ Oversight and Administration of Information Technology Business Unit
Architecture & Infrastructure	✓ IT Architecture Management ✓ IT Infrastructure Management
Cybersecurity	✓ Information Security Program Management ✓ Security Monitoring and Compliance Oversight ✓ Security Policy Development and Maintenance
Data Analytics & Visualization	✓ Evidence Based Decision Support ✓ Data Management and Analytics ✓ Web Solutions and User Centric Design
ERP Delivery Management & Operations	✓ Enhance ERP Tools and Capabilities ✓ ERP Operations Management
Service Management & Operations	✓ Business Applications Management ✓ Field Support and Asset Management ✓ Service Desk ✓ Service Management and Process Optimization
Strategic Planning & Delivery	✓ Business Relationship Management ✓ Portfolio and Project Management Office

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		165.0
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Field Support Analyst	Service Enhancement	1.0
Audiovisual Technology Analyst	Budget Committee Direction	(2.0)
Transferred Positions		
Net Transfer Positions		
Total Changes		(1.0)
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		164.0

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Data Analytics & Visualization	\$ 3,665,586	\$ 4,264,000	\$ 4,241,900	\$ 4,383,300	\$ 119,300	2.8
Architecture & Infrastructure	9,010,471	10,398,250	10,406,550	11,024,150	625,900	6.0
Chief Information Office	7,170,246	7,776,200	7,756,150	8,117,600	341,400	4.4
Strategic Planning & Delivery	2,992,269	3,028,050	3,524,450	3,196,950	168,900	5.6
Service Management & Operations	14,238,642	16,984,650	16,751,450	17,880,250	895,600	5.3
Cybersecurity	1,195,179	2,287,050	2,241,100	2,455,750	168,700	7.4
Net Total	\$ 38,272,393	\$ 44,738,200	\$ 44,921,600	\$ 47,058,000	\$ 2,319,800	5.2

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 16,670,559	\$ 18,747,350	\$ 19,388,000	\$ 19,165,400	\$ 418,050	2.2
Office	10,178,510	12,450,550	12,024,000	13,114,300	663,750	5.3
External Services	8,520,241	9,994,950	10,190,900	10,720,900	725,950	7.3
Supplies	-	-	100	-	-	-
Building Costs	32,138	29,200	41,800	30,200	1,000	3.4
Equipment & Communications	3,324,939	3,434,400	3,220,600	3,823,700	389,300	11.3
Other Goods & Services	186,998	212,050	215,800	212,100	50	-
Interdepartmental	(599,303)	(121,700)	(132,900)	-	121,700	(100.0)
Total Expenditures	38,314,082	44,746,800	44,948,300	47,066,600	2,319,800	5.2

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Other Revenue	\$ (41,688)	\$ (8,600)	\$ (26,700)	\$ (8,600)	\$ -	-
Total Revenues	(41,688)	(8,600)	(26,700)	(8,600)	-	
Net Total	\$ 38,272,393	\$ 44,738,200	\$ 44,921,600	\$ 47,058,000	\$ 2,319,800	5.2

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 44,738,200
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Increased overtime requirements	50,000
Increase for software and licensing costs	546,900
Increase for computer equipment requirements	391,700
Annual contract increases	451,600
End of maintenance support agreements	(123,900)
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	711,300
Digital Evidence Management System / Body Worn Cameras	1,539,000
IT contract renewals	277,200
Decrease to telephone and mobility contracts	(68,100)
Other/Transfers	
Public Wi-Fi Service Reduction	(450,000)
Increase related to operating costs of capital	393,400
Transfer from HRP for IT Services (Software, Maintenance, Licenses, Hardware, Peripherals)	409,500
Transfer of WAN/Internet Services from other BU's to consolidate billing	176,700
Transfer of HAF funding to compensation	121,700
Transfer from Finance for Microsoft Copilot	11,000
Miscellaneous adjustments	6,800
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact "Green" Reductions	(117,400)
Low Service Impact Reductions in response to flat tax motion	(1,781,800)
Eliminate Audiovisual Technology Analyst position	(225,800)
Total Changes	\$ 2,319,800
2026/27 Budget	\$ 47,058,000

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Architecture & Infrastructure	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Core network availability (excludes scheduled outages)	99.97%	99.95%	99.99%	99.99%
Analysis: - Core network availability (excluding scheduled outages for maintenance/upgrades). These values represent the uptime of the municipality's core network services in our Data Centers. Downtime because of scheduled maintenance/changes is not represented in this value. For example, if there were unexpected interruptions in our core network services during the fiscal year which resulted in downtime/instability for 8h41m, the resulting uptime would be 99.99% of the year. 2023/24 Actual missed due to a two-hour unexpected outage on April 14, 2023. 2024/25 Actual adjusted due to a four-hour outage on April 25, 2024 and 30-minute outage on July 3, 2024. 2025/26 Projected is expected to be 99.99%; there has been one 15-minute unplanned outage to date. 2026/27 Planned is expected to be 99.99%.				
Cybersecurity	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Cybersecurity awareness training completion rate	2,387 (80%)	70%	80%	80%
Analysis: 2026/27 Planned is expected to remain at 80% and is an aligned industry standard. - Projected completion rate for 2025/26 is on target as expected and is deemed an acceptable level for the organization. - Cybersecurity awareness training equips municipal employees to recognize and respond to cyber threats, such as phishing and ransomware. - Training helps reduce the risk of breaches that could disrupt services, compromise citizen trust and cause financial losses. - A well-trained workforce is vital for maintaining compliance, protecting confidential data and ensuring the resilience of municipal systems. - Annual refresher training will continue to be assigned to staff, additionally, identified high risk users will be assigned additional training.				

Data Analytics & Visualization	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Number of Open Data sets ¹	241	255	283	308
Website visits (sessions) ²	7,398,366	7,056,046	6,898,312	6,750,000
Website average session duration (mm:ss) ³	3:02	3:09	3:25	3:00
¹ Expectation is to continue to release new data sets every two months. Data sets have various refresh cycles depending on business need, ranges from daily, weekly, monthly to annually. ² The number of times a user visited the website, consisting of one or more pageviews. ³ The average length of time a visitor is spending on the website per visit.				
Service Management & Operations	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Total asset/device count	5,800	6,800	8,000	8,400
Total IT ticket volume	35,000	38,500	39,500	42,000
Analysis: - Total Asset count increases in 2025/26 were due to ongoing increased reliance on technology and a shift to leverage online productivity tools and mobility to perform work. Examples include increased adoption of tablet technology for digitized field work, inclusion of HRP vehicle computers, maturity of classroom environments now including computing assets, growth of the municipality's Full Time Equivalents (FTEs), or provisioning of mobile phones for roles previously without such as summer/term/students now requiring assets. This increase is expected to continue into 2026/27. - A corresponding increase in total ticket volume in 2026/27 is predicted due to the growth in assets supported, inclusion of business devices which are operated through software and planned projects to onboard net new technology systems and applications in the upcoming fiscal year. - Total Asset/Device count increases in 2024/25 were due to a general increased reliance on technology or business decisions to provide assets to a broader group of employees. Examples include provisioning of mobile phones for all sworn HRP officers, summer/term/students now requiring assets, or general growth of the municipality's Full Time Equivalents (FTEs). Growth is projected to continue into 2025/26 due to adoption of tablet technology for digitized field work, anticipated net new positions requiring technology, inclusion of HRP vehicle computers Mobile Data Terminals and a general business shift in providing classroom cadet/trainees or summer term employees with assets. - A corresponding increase in total ticket volume in 2025/26 is predicted due to the inclusion of HRP technical support, large growth in assets supported and planned projects to onboard net new technology in the upcoming fiscal year.				

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
RA-04 Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency, and cost effectiveness, while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.	
Information Technology Strategic Plan <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> Action Plan Reference: RA-04-05 The municipality will continue to execute the multi-year strategy developed in 2022/23 through review and enhancement of key Information Technology processes, continued engagement with business units to identify opportunities to leverage technology, and updates to the Information Technology Strategic Plan to ensure activities in future years align with the needs of all business units in providing services to residents. All areas of the Information Technology business unit will be governed by the overarching Information Technology Strategic Plan.	31-Mar-28
Artificial Intelligence Strategy and Governance <i>Service Area: Architecture & Infrastructure</i> Action Plan Reference: RA-04-A6 Architecture & Infrastructure will continue to: • Evaluate AI-related use cases submitted by business units. • Assess requests for the implementation or adoption of AI solutions. • Conduct pilot projects for personal assistant tools based on identified business use cases. • Advance and maintain required AI governance deliverables.	31-Mar-27
Strategic Cybersecurity Initiative <i>Service Area: Cybersecurity</i> Action Plan Reference: RA-04-A10 Advance the cybersecurity program into its next phase by performing security control assessments based on the National Institute of Standards and Technology Cybersecurity Framework (NIST CSF). This initiative will use the organizational profile to score current maturity, track improvements and demonstrate measurable progress toward strategic security objectives.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
Geographic Information Systems (GIS) Strategy Refresh and Year 1 Implementation <i>Service Area: Data Analytics & Visualization</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04, no Action alignment Refresh the HRM GIS Strategy for the next three-year cycle to meet HRM's strategic business goals, focusing on increasing efficiencies and productivity through the implementation of AI and automation tools, developing the Linear Referencing System (LRS) roadmap and the implementation of the HRP GIS roadmap.	31-Mar-27
Business Intelligence (BI) Strategy Refresh Year 3 Implementation <i>Service Area: Data Analytics & Visualization</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04, no Action alignment Execute the third year of the Business Intelligence (BI) Strategy by enhancing municipal services through the cloud migration of BI tools, expanding self-service analytics, developing a business case for improved metadata management and data governance tools and exploring the benefits of AI on data service delivery.	31-Mar-27
Portfolio Management <i>Service Area: Strategic Planning & Delivery</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04, no Action alignment The IT Investment Committee will ensure projects being funded and delivered are the priority of the overall organization and fulfill strategic and corporate mandates. The Committee will continue to: • The Portfolio team will develop the Benefits Realization Framework to capture proposed measurable benefits in terms of Business Unit cost savings, FTE reductions or service improvements related to the requested IT system or solution. • The expected benefits will be included in a new rating system to be used by the IT Investment Committee to score all IT Business Cases going forward. • These changes will further support a more formal decision-making framework. • The IT Investment Committee will continue to review and approve all new IT Business Cases. They will also review and prioritize the Project Portfolio to ensure the projects being funded and delivered are the priority of the overall organization.	31-Mar-27
IT Asset Audit Automation <i>Service Area: Service Management & Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04, no Action alignment Design and implement automation to compare the IT asset repository with real-time scanned network data to identify discrepancies and automatically generate tickets for staff action. Efficient asset auditing helps ensure assets are accurately tracked, optimally utilized and safeguarded against theft, loss, or misuse.	31-Mar-27

Deliverable	Completion
IT Process Automation <i>Service Area: Service Management & Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04, no Action alignment Automating common customer requests and routine IT Service Desk tasks by integrating ServiceNow ITSM workflows with Active Directory enables seamless execution of actions such as granting system access and deploying desktop software without manual intervention. This approach enhances operational efficiency, accelerates service delivery and minimizes human errors; freeing IT staff to focus on higher-value initiatives and onboarding new technologies in business unit roadmaps.	31-Mar-27
Corporate Scheduling – Time and Attendance <i>Service Area: ERP Delivery Management & Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04, no Action alignment Continuing activities for the implementation of the UKG software product to provide enhanced Time & Attendance capabilities across Halifax Regional Municipality business units including advanced scheduling functionality for emergency services. The Corporate Scheduling Time and Attendance solution will streamline the employee payroll process while reducing manual activities, duplication of work and the number of errors. The solution will improve management reporting and enforce adherence to collective agreement terms. Deliverables will include build and configuration of the Time, Attendance and Scheduling solution and the commencement of deploying the new solution across the organization.	30-Sep-26
HR Project – Phase 2 (Implementation) <i>Service Area: ERP Delivery Management & Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04, no Action alignment Following the successful roll out of the SAP SuccessFactors Employee Central module, the HR Project will focus on the planning of the enterprise Learning Management Systems (LMS), Recruiting and Onboarding modules. Deliverables will include finalization of a contract for technical implementation services, detailed planning, build and deployment of the LMS module and the commencement of detailed planning for the Recruiting and Onboarding modules.	31-Dec-27
Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) Roadmap <i>Service Area: ERP Delivery Management & Operations</i> Action Plan Reference: Goal RA-04, no Action alignment The municipality's ERP system is the source of truth for the municipality's financial and human resource information. The ERP system provides capabilities the municipality can leverage to support future service expansions designed to keep pace with strategic direction, expectations and the needs of its clients and citizens. The ERP roadmap will provide a clear path to benefits realization and categorize and prioritize ERP initiatives while identifying resources, timelines and investment. Deliverables will include updates to the current Roadmap and implementation planning.	30-Sep-26

Summary of Net Expenditures - Information Technology

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
A410 Digital Services	683,986	770,600	786,700	891,300	120,700	15.7
A411 BI & Data Initiatives	846,182	854,000	901,200	755,500	(98,500)	(11.5)
A728 Director Data A & V	170,548	178,700	178,800	184,000	5,300	3.0
A746 IT GIS	1,964,870	2,460,700	2,375,200	2,552,500	91,800	3.7
* Data Analytics & Visualization	3,665,586	4,264,000	4,241,900	4,383,300	119,300	2.8
A724 Enterprise Architect	778,089	786,550	808,850	818,550	32,000	4.1
A727 Director Infra Admin	174,032	187,200	187,200	191,900	4,700	2.5
A742 Technology Infrastructure	6,705,880	7,950,850	7,963,150	8,510,150	559,300	7.0
A745 Tech Systems Admin	1,352,470	1,473,650	1,447,350	1,503,550	29,900	2.0
* Architecture & Infrastructure	9,010,471	10,398,250	10,406,550	11,024,150	625,900	6.0
A751 ERP Delivery Mgt/Ops	6,353,913	6,687,700	6,676,000	6,970,500	282,800	4.2
A721 Chief Info Office	816,333	1,088,500	1,080,150	1,147,100	58,600	5.4
* Chief Information Office	7,170,246	7,776,200	7,756,150	8,117,600	341,400	4.4
A645 Strategic Plan/Deliv	523,676	425,600	572,850	469,550	43,950	10.3
A734 IT Proj Mgmt Office	1,957,728	2,137,200	2,437,400	2,240,000	102,800	4.8
A747 IT Strategy & Portfolio	510,865	465,250	514,200	487,350	22,100	4.8
* Strategic Planning & Delivery	2,992,269	3,028,050	3,524,450	3,196,900	168,850	5.6
A737 Public Safety Apps	208,435	738,200	1,147,400	1,399,600	661,400	89.6
A729 IT Contract Management	415,869	408,200	433,200	416,800	8,600	2.1
A732 Business App Mgt	4,172,027	4,709,800	4,707,800	5,509,450	799,650	17.0
A741 Svc Mgt & Ops Admin	517,821	519,250	541,550	537,850	18,600	3.6
A743 IT Client Service	6,199,942	7,475,950	6,932,950	7,495,850	19,900	0.3
A744 IT Corporate Solutions	1,769,202	1,988,600	1,852,500	1,330,600	(658,000)	(33.1)
A749 IT Service Support	955,345	1,144,650	1,136,050	1,190,150	45,500	4.0
* Service Management & Operations	14,238,642	16,984,650	16,751,450	17,880,300	895,650	5.3
A726 IT Cybersecurity	1,195,179	2,287,050	2,241,100	2,455,750	168,700	7.4
* Cybersecurity	1,195,179	2,287,050	2,241,100	2,455,750	168,700	7.4
** Net Total	38,272,393	44,738,200	44,921,600	47,058,000	2,319,800	5.2

Summary of Expenditures Details - Information Technology

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	13,724,160	15,853,200	15,675,700	16,153,500	300,300	1.9
6002 Salaries - Overtime	371,250	301,900	361,900	351,900	50,000	16.6
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(209,129)	-	(239,700)	-	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	35,814	-	40,500	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	2,897,041	3,291,700	3,244,200	3,466,200	174,500	5.3
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(1,407,550)	-	(1,254,100)	153,450	(10.9)
6152 Retirement Incentives	81,797	110,100	107,800	112,500	2,400	2.2
6153 Severance	10,000	-	136,100	-	-	-
6154 Workers' Compensation	373,791	497,300	490,300	484,100	(13,200)	(2.7)
6158 WCB Recov Earnings	(3,403)	-	-	-	-	-
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	(123,562)	100,700	(54,600)	(148,700)	(249,400)	(247.7)
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	(486,959)	-	(374,200)	-	-	-
9210 HR CATS OT Wage/Ben	(242)	-	-	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	16,670,559	18,747,350	19,388,000	19,165,400	418,050	2.2
6201 Telephone/Cable	1,738,735	1,889,350	1,708,550	1,720,150	(169,200)	(9.0)
6202 Courier/Postage	24,402	30,000	11,300	32,000	2,000	6.7
6203 Office Furn/Equip	10,563	15,850	14,850	15,850	-	-
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	7,698,814	9,826,350	9,745,500	10,652,800	826,450	8.4
6205 Printing & Reprod	702,534	685,000	608,800	689,500	4,500	0.7
6207 Office Supplies	3,352	4,000	3,500	4,000	-	-
6290 Office OCC Transfer	-	-	(68,500)	-	-	-
6299 Other Office Expenses	109	-	-	-	-	-
* Office	10,178,510	12,450,550	12,024,000	13,114,300	663,750	5.3
6301 Professional Fees	2,120	6,200	4,000	6,200	-	-
6302 Legal Fees	2,730	-	2,700	-	-	-
6303 Consulting Fees	37,957	152,300	321,000	182,300	30,000	19.7
6390 Extnl Svcs OCC Trsf	(76,000)	-	(164,800)	-	-	-
6399 Contract Services	8,553,433	9,836,450	10,028,000	10,532,400	695,950	7.1
* External Services	8,520,241	9,994,950	10,190,900	10,720,900	725,950	7.3
6409 Personal Protect Equ	-	-	100	-	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
* Supplies	-	-	100	-	-	-
6607 Electricity	32,138	29,200	41,000	29,200	-	-
6612 Safety Systems	-	-	800	1,000	1,000	-
* Building Costs	32,138	29,200	41,800	30,200	1,000	3.4
6701 Equipment Purchase	2,226	2,000	2,000	2,000	-	-
6702 Small Tools	2,197	2,000	4,000	2,000	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	2,438,210	2,098,900	2,099,300	2,509,000	410,100	19.5
6705 Equip - R&M	2,430	-	-	16,000	16,000	-
6706 Computer R&M	410,322	802,700	595,800	626,000	(176,700)	(22.0)
6711 Communication System	<u>469,555</u>	<u>528,800</u>	<u>519,500</u>	<u>668,700</u>	<u>139,900</u>	<u>26.5</u>
* Equipment & Communications	3,324,939	3,434,400	3,220,600	3,823,700	389,300	11.3
6901 Membership Dues	3,738	4,200	5,800	4,200	-	-
6902 Conferences/Workshop	15,634	25,200	22,600	25,600	400	1.6
6903 Travel - Local	39,749	44,850	45,550	48,450	3,600	8.0
6904 Travel - Out of Town	24,708	31,300	31,300	31,300	-	-
6905 Training & Education	30,363	37,500	37,500	37,500	-	-
6911 Facilities Rental	55,584	50,700	49,800	46,700	(4,000)	(7.9)
6912 Advertising/Promotio	(364)	-	100	-	-	-
6914 Recruiting	5,520	4,000	4,000	4,000	-	-
6917 Books and Periodicals	-	-	300	-	-	-
6918 Meals/Catering	5,108	6,450	11,000	6,450	-	-
6938 Rewarding Excellence	<u>6,958</u>	<u>7,850</u>	<u>7,850</u>	<u>7,900</u>	<u>50</u>	<u>0.6</u>
* Other Goods & Services	186,998	212,050	215,800	212,100	50	0.0
7008 ItnTrsf IT & Commun	(1,445)	-	-	-	-	-
7009 Internal Trfr Other	-	(121,700)	(132,900)	-	121,700	(100.0)
7010 IntTrfr Insur Funds	(597,910)	-	-	-	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	<u>51</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>
* Interdepartmental	(599,303)	(121,700)	(132,900)	-	121,700	(100.0)
** Total	38,314,082	44,746,800	44,948,300	47,066,600	2,319,800	5.2

Summary of Revenues Details - Information Technology

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
5508 Recov External Parti	(41,688)	(8,600)	(26,700)	(8,600)	-	-
* Other Revenue	(41,688)	(8,600)	(26,700)	(8,600)	-	-
** Total	(41,688)	(8,600)	(26,700)	(8,600)	-	-
** Net Total	38,272,393	44,738,200	44,921,600	47,058,000	2,319,800	5.2

HALIFAX

HUMAN RESOURCES

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

HUMAN RESOURCES

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

Committed to providing innovative, practical strategies and solutions that address business needs and promote service excellence.

OVERVIEW

Human Resources (HR) provides strategic leadership and services to ensure a respectful, safe and supportive workplace where employees are engaged, valued and aligned to advance Council and Administrative Priorities. The business unit delivers expertise in employee relations, wellbeing, talent management and total rewards to support a positive workplace culture, promote health and safety, attract and develop talent, and administer compensation, benefits and HR systems. Together, these services enhance organizational effectiveness and ensure the municipality is equipped with a skilled, resilient workforce to deliver high-quality public services.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Executive Director's Office	✓ Oversight and Administration of Human Resources Business Unit
	✓ Business Continuity
	✓ CAO Review Committee Liaison
	✓ Monitoring and Managing Operational Risk
Employee Relations	✓ Collective Bargaining
	✓ Conflict Resolution
	✓ Duty to Accommodate Support
	✓ Grievance Management

Service Area	Services Offered
	✓ Labour Relations Expertise ✓ Leadership Support for Employee Absenteeism and Health ✓ Leadership Support for Job Design ✓ Performance Management ✓ Policy Development and Review ✓ Succession Planning
Employee Wellbeing	✓ Corporate Health and Wellness ✓ Corporate Safety ✓ Employee Engagement
Talent Management	✓ Corporate Learning and Development ✓ Employee Development ✓ Employee Immigration Support ✓ Recruitment and Talent Acquisition Support
Total Rewards	✓ Benefits Administration ✓ Employee Recognition ✓ HR Reporting ✓ MyHR Service ✓ Organizational and Employee Data Management ✓ Pension Plan Employer Administration ✓ Retirement Benefit Administration ✓ Salary Administration ✓ Total Compensation Design

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		92.0
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Safety Coordinator	Budget Committee Direction	(1.0)
Transferred Positions		
Net Transfer Positions		
Total Changes		(1.0)
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		91.0

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	Budget	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections		Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
HR Administration	\$ 616,554	\$ 202,300	\$ 531,500	\$ 233,800	\$ 31,500	15.6
Employee Wellbeing	1,648,401	2,215,200	2,013,230	2,206,800	(8,400)	(0.4)
Talent Management	3,349,483	4,247,000	3,303,166	3,448,500	(798,500)	(18.8)
Employee Relations	2,553,105	2,812,600	2,759,109	2,897,600	85,000	3.0
Total Rewards	2,056,882	2,278,000	2,183,019	2,393,300	115,300	5.1
Net Total	\$ 10,224,424	\$ 11,755,100	\$ 10,790,025	\$ 11,180,000	\$ (575,100)	(4.9)

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	Budget	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections		Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 9,599,978	\$ 11,049,300	\$ 10,281,115	\$ 10,438,100	\$ (611,200)	(5.5)
Office	32,251	28,900	24,770	28,100	(800)	(2.8)
External Services	252,957	216,300	215,500	246,300	30,000	13.9
Supplies	355	200	200	1,000	800	400.0
Equipment & Communications	993	-	100	-	-	-
Other Goods & Services	409,763	540,400	447,340	543,000	2,600	0.5
Interdepartmental	8,128	-	(99,000)	3,500	3,500	-
Total Expenditures	10,304,424	11,835,100	10,870,025	11,260,000	(575,100)	(4.9)

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	Budget	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections		Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Other Revenue	\$ (80,000)	\$ (80,000)	\$ (80,000)	\$ (80,000)	\$ -	-
Total Revenues	(80,000)	(80,000)	(80,000)	(80,000)	-	
Net Total	\$ 10,224,424	\$ 11,755,100	\$ 10,790,025	\$ 11,180,000	\$ (575,100)	(4.9)

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 11,755,100
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Miscellaneous adjustments	6,100
Employee Engagement Survey	30,000
Compensation adjustments	258,800
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Low Service Impact Reductions in response to flat tax motion	(870,000)
Total Changes	\$ (575,100)
2026/27 Budget	\$ 11,180,000

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Employee Relations	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned ¹
Number of Respectful Workplace complaints filed	27	26	35	N/A
Number of grievances filed	109	133	184	N/A
Number of grievances resolved	89	120	120	N/A
¹ 2026/27 data is N/A; these performance indicators are lagging indicators that are not forecasted but are reported after the reporting period closes. Analysis: Grievance activity is trending upward across the organization, and this will continue into 26/27 based on grievance activity up to the end of Q2 2025/26. In 2024/25, 106 grievances were resolved between the parties in the grievance process, with an additional 14 resolved with the assistance of a third party (Arbitrator, Mediator), which indicates that the parties are working together to resolve issues.				
Employee Wellbeing	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Number of new health referrals received	653	652	697	715
Number of Workplace Safety Assessments completed	30	25	25	25
Total Accident frequency ¹	7	8	8	8
Lost Time Accident frequency ²	4	4	4	4

¹ Total accident frequency. Indicates the average number of recordable work-related injuries and illnesses, for every 100 full-time employees over a year.

² Lost time accident frequency. Indicates the average number of work-related injuries that result in time away from work, for every 100 full-time employees over a year.

Analysis:

- *Number of new health referrals received.* New health referrals are trending slightly higher in 2025/26 and are expected to increase in 2026/27. This is primarily due to an increase in health files with an associated mental health overlay and proactive requests for ergonomic assessments.

Talent Management	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Number of jobs filled	1,326	1,490	1,400	1,450
Internal Fill Rate ¹	44.3%	48.1%	45.0%	44.0%
Internal Promotion Rate ²	4.7%	3.8%	4.0%	3.9%
Voluntary Employee Turnover ³	4.6%	4.5%	4.4%	4.6%
Number of training attendees	7,030	11,432	6,500 ⁴	7,100
Time-to-fill	91.4	88.4	85.7	95.0

¹ Internal Fill Rate is calculated as follows: Internal Movements / (Internal Movements + Hires + Rehires).

² Internal Promotion Rate is calculated as follows: (Total number of promotions / Total number of employees) x 100.

³ Percentage of active permanent employees who resign from the organization.

⁴ Implementation of the new Learning Management System may cause numbers to decrease temporarily.

Analysis:

- **Planned 2026/27** – Based on the number of current resources supporting the historical increase in volume of recruitment activities for the organization, the time to fill is likely to increase based on the team's inability to meet the increase in demand without increasing FTEs. The implementation of a new applicant tracking system and the unknown impacts to our current and future processes may also impact this metric.

Total Rewards	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Pre-Retirement Leave processing time (days)	5	3	3	3
MyHR Service Request response times (days) ¹	2	3	3	3

Number of service requests to MyHR	8,470	20,000	22,500	23,500
Employee Actions Processed by HR Data Control	14,552	16,571	22,000	27,000
¹ Average resolution time is measured in calendar days. Resolution is defined as closed, and inquiry/issue resolved. Analysis: <i>Number of service requests to MyHR.</i> The number of service requests to MyHR were estimated in 2023/24 as there was no mechanism in place to track this data. The team now manually tracks the number of inquiries for a two-week period which equate to approximately 22,500. - Total Rewards will continue to conduct this same tracking in future years or until such time that an automated intake tracking system is in place.				

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
RA-04 Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency, and cost effectiveness, while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.	
Management of Hiring Practices Audit Response <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04-A10</i> Implement the action plan in response to the 14 recommendations in the Auditor General's Management of Hiring Practices audit report.	31-May-26
OP-01 Foster a workplace that is equitable, diverse, inclusive, and accessible.	
Corporate Training Support – Dismantling Hate & Racism Strategy <i>Service Area: Talent Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-01-A1</i> In collaboration with the Office of Diversity & Inclusion/ ANSAIO, support the creation and delivery of corporate training as per the Dismantling Hate and Racism Strategy.	31-Mar-27

Corporate Training Support – Accessibility Strategy 2025-2028 <i>Service Area: Talent Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-01-A2</i> In collaboration with the Office of Diversity & Inclusion/ ANSAIO, support the creation of corporate training as per the approved recommendations in the Accessibility Strategy 2025-2028 and as per the Province of Nova Scotia's <i>Accessibility Act</i>.	31-Mar-28
OP-02: Strengthen the attraction and retention of people with the skills and behaviours needed to deliver municipal services.	
Total Rewards Strategy <i>Service Area: Total Rewards</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-02-A1</i> Continue to refresh the Total Rewards Strategy to ensure that Halifax Regional Municipality's employee value proposition is sustainable and flexible to the evolving labour market. This will include market reviews and analysis, participation in applicable benchmarking surveys, implementation of new benefit plan design and development of a communication plan to educate employees on the Total Value Proposition project.	31-Mar-27
Workforce Planning <i>Service Area: Talent Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-02-A2</i> Implement Phase 1 of the succession planning framework with the support of senior leadership, business units and in collaboration with the employee relations team and Total Rewards.	31-Mar-27
Success Factors – Recruitment and Onboarding Modules <i>Service Area: Talent Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-02-A4</i> In collaboration with IT, act as the subject matter expert and work with the system integrator and business units to configure business requirements and complete system testing in support of the new Recruitment Management System.	31-Mar-27
OP-03: Increase employee access to learning and development opportunities.	
Employee Development Programs <i>Service Area: Talent Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-03-A1</i> Review the results of the Mentorship Program pilot program, consider the feedback received and create resources and training to support both the roles of the mentee and mentor. Create the New Leaders Program framework and psychological safety training for employees and leaders.	31-Mar-27
Success Factors – Learning Management System <i>Service Area: Talent Management</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-03-A3</i>	31-Mar-27

In collaboration with IT, act as the subject matter expert and work with the system integrator and business units to configure business requirements and complete system testing in support of the new Learning Management System.	
OP-04: Foster a safety-first culture where employees' mental, emotional, and physical well-being are protected.	
Employee Wellbeing Strategy <i>Service Area: Employee Wellbeing</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-04-A1</i> Continue to advance the corporate Employee Wellbeing Strategy with the goal of enhancing proactive prevention programming and reducing physical and psychological illness and injury. Continue to guide business units and support employees maintaining connection to the workplace following occupational and non-occupational illness or injury.	31-Mar-27
Fire Fighter Cancer Screening – Phase 2 – Implementation and Monitoring <i>Service Area: Employee Wellbeing</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-04-A1</i> Monitor and evaluate implementation of the Fire Fighter Cancer Screening Program as screening activities begin.	31-Mar-27
Assess Current Safety Support Model <i>Service Area: Employee Wellbeing</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal OP-04-A2</i> Assess current safety support model and requirements.	31-Mar-27

Summary of Net Expenditures - Human Resources

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
A250 Corporate Safety	391,138	735,800	587,280	654,500	(81,300)	(11.0)
A255 HSW Admin	223,455	321,800	325,950	374,100	52,300	16.3
F182 Health & Wellness	1,033,808	1,157,600	1,100,000	1,178,200	20,600	1.8
* Health/Safety/Wellness/EE Engag	1,648,401	2,215,200	2,013,230	2,206,800	(8,400)	(0.4)
A260 Talent Management Admin	282,960	461,400	452,950	398,900	(62,500)	(13.5)
A210 Talent Development	910,330	960,600	812,822	951,300	(9,300)	(1.0)
A233 Talent Acquisition	2,156,194	2,825,000	2,037,394	2,098,300	(726,700)	(25.7)
* Talent Management	3,349,483	4,247,000	3,303,166	3,448,500	(798,500)	(18.8)
A220 Client Services	1,177,926	1,416,700	1,387,700	1,465,700	49,000	3.5
A240 Labour Relations	1,154,179	893,800	870,095	919,000	25,200	2.8
A245 ER Admin	221,000	502,100	501,315	512,900	10,800	2.2
* Employee Relations	2,553,105	2,812,600	2,759,109	2,897,600	85,000	3.0
A230 Total Rewards Admin	694,543	821,100	768,178	869,900	48,800	5.9
A235 Benefits & EE Svcs	673,485	702,000	660,042	750,100	48,100	6.9
A237 HR Systems & Reporti	688,853	754,900	754,800	773,300	18,400	2.4
* Total Rewards	2,056,882	2,278,000	2,183,020	2,393,300	115,300	5.1
A205 HR Administration	616,554	202,300	531,500	233,800	31,500	15.6
A221 Locked WCB	-	-	-	-	-	-
** Human Resources	10,224,424	11,755,100	10,790,025	11,180,000	(575,100)	(4.9)
*** Net Total	10,224,424	11,755,100	10,790,025	11,180,000	(575,100)	(4.9)

Summary of Expenditures Details - Human Resources

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	7,494,479	7,884,100	8,166,500	8,716,500	832,400	10.6
6002 Salaries - Overtime	10,342	-	4,549	-	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(259,071)	-	(267,800)	-	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	12,058	-	4,602	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	1,549,698	1,556,900	1,592,700	1,775,800	218,900	14.1
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(329,600)	-	(329,600)	-	-
6150 Honorariums	-	12,000	12,000	12,000	-	-
6152 Retirement Incentives	43,902	50,500	50,800	57,700	7,200	14.3
6154 Workers' Compensation	208,674	256,200	254,900	271,500	15,300	6.0
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	539,799	1,619,200	462,865	(65,800)	(1,685,000)	(104.1)
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	96	-	-	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	9,599,978	11,049,300	10,281,115	10,438,100	(611,200)	(5.5)
6201 Telephone/Cable	10,016	15,100	14,720	14,300	(800)	(5.3)
6202 Courier/Postage	1,465	2,500	2,000	2,500	-	-
6203 Office Furn/Equip	10,131	4,000	1,750	4,000	-	-
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	433	500	-	500	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	5,667	5,800	5,800	5,800	-	-
6299 Other Office Expenses	4,538	1,000	500	1,000	-	-
* Office	32,251	28,900	24,770	28,100	(800)	(2.8)
6301 Professional Fees	161,591	162,800	160,800	162,800	-	-
6303 Consulting Fees	33,692	25,000	26,000	55,000	30,000	120.0
6399 Contract Services	57,675	28,500	28,700	28,500	-	-
* External Services	252,957	216,300	215,500	246,300	30,000	13.9
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	116	200	200	1,000	800	400.0
6409 Personal Protect Equ	239	-	-	-	-	-
* Supplies	355	200	200	1,000	800	400.0
6701 Equipment Purchase	102	-	-	-	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	891	-	100	-	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	993	-	100	-	-	-
6901 Membership Dues	44,107	58,100	57,200	60,600	2,500	4.3
6902 Conferences/Workshop	25,797	21,900	26,700	24,000	2,100	9.6
6903 Travel - Local	3,459	10,600	11,060	10,800	200	1.9
6904 Travel - Out of Town	7,570	8,800	11,300	8,800	-	-
6905 Training & Education	82,698	107,500	106,200	83,800	(23,700)	(22.0)
6912 Advertising/Promotio	63,484	10,000	10,230	10,000	-	-
6914 Recruiting	20,977	91,000	81,700	101,000	10,000	11.0
6916 Public Education	650	-	-	-	-	-
6917 Books and Periodicals	5,804	4,900	5,400	4,900	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6918 Meals/Catering	3,892	4,100	4,300	4,100	-	-
6919 Special Projects	30,321	102,800	30,000	112,800	10,000	9.7
6937 Corporate Training	80,200	100,000	80,000	100,000	-	-
6938 Rewarding Excellence	30,343	7,200	23,250	8,700	1,500	20.8
6999 Other Goods/Services	10,460	13,500	-	13,500	-	-
* Other Goods & Services	409,763	540,400	447,340	543,000	2,600	0.5
7009 Internal Trfr Other	2,655	-	(100,000)	-	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	5,473	-	1,000	3,500	3,500	-
* Interdepartmental	8,128	-	(99,000)	3,500	3,500	-
** Total	10,304,424	11,835,100	10,870,025	11,260,000	(575,100)	(4.9)

Summary of Revenues Details - Human Resources

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
5508 Recov External Parti	(80,000)	(80,000)	(80,000)	(80,000)	-	-
* Other Revenue	(80,000)	(80,000)	(80,000)	(80,000)	-	-
** Total	(80,000)	(80,000)	(80,000)	(80,000)	-	-
*** Net Total	10,224,424	11,755,100	10,790,025	11,180,000	(575,100)	(4.9)

HALIFAX

FISCAL SERVICES

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

FISCAL SERVICES

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

FISCAL SERVICES OVERVIEW

Fiscal Services is not a business unit and has no services or initiatives per se. Rather it includes HRM's financial responsibilities and obligations that are not directly related to any specific business unit as well as organization-wide costs and revenues not fully allocated to business units. Fiscal Services includes:

- Property and Other Taxes
- Deed Transfer Tax
- Non-departmental Revenues
- Private Roads and Other Area Rates
- Debt Charges
- Elections costs
- Capital from Operating
- Reserves
- Provincial Mandatory costs
- Supplementary Education
- Transfers such as Fire Protection, Stormwater and the Halifax Convention Centre
- Contingencies
- Other Compensation Costs
- Grants and Tax Relief
- Valuation Allowance
- Summary Office Ticket Revenues

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Debt Servicing	\$ 49,556,470	\$ 42,264,900	\$ 42,124,000	\$ 42,059,300	\$ (205,600)	(0.5)
Transfer to Outside Agencies	7,540,000	7,564,000	7,564,000	7,786,400	222,400	2.9
Other Fiscal Services	45,412,055	45,613,900	37,008,200	59,890,500	14,276,600	31.3
Transfer to/fr Other Funds	86,212,446	101,175,900	100,803,900	146,924,900	45,749,000	45.2
Non-Departmental Revenue	(841,721,860)	(885,966,300)	(881,739,700)	(964,969,800)	(79,003,500)	8.9
Net Total	\$ (653,000,889)	\$ (689,347,600)	\$ (694,239,600)	\$ (708,308,700)	\$ (18,961,100)	2.8

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ (689,347,600)
Service Enhancements	
Cancer Screening Program	600,000
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Inflationary pressures on Insurance costs	420,700
Contractual Increases	
Transfer of RCMP contract increase	(2,783,500)
Compensation provision adjustments	14,203,500
Debt services	(205,600)
Revenue Changes	
Increase in tax revenues (including Grants in Lieu)	(80,204,200)
SOT, Marketing Levy Fees and NSF Cheque Fees Revenue	(1,008,000)
Investment Income decline expected due to lower interest rates	3,900,000
Interest revenue increase	(700,000)
Other/Transfers	
Transfer of Heritage Grants from P&D	200,000
Halifax Central Library Reserve one-time funding for 25/26 reversal	10,000,000
Capital Renewal	10,890,000
Updated Reserve funding based on Council Approved Strategy	18,000,000
Net change in other Reserve funding/withdraws	212,400
Increase in tax-relief for non-profits	446,000
Other contingencies	2,098,000
Budget Committee Adjustments	
2% Reduction in pension contributions	(6,000,000)
Reduce Contribution to Elections Reserve	(200,000)
District Capital Account reduced by 10% - Capital Renewal	(150,400)
Accelerate the implementation of Halifax Transit's Core Service Plan - Capital Renewal	13,000,000
Corporate Accomodations CB190011 - Capital Renewal	(1,000,000)
Expedite Road Safety Program - Capital Renewal	820,000
Wage Contingency Reduction	(1,500,000)
Total Changes	\$ (18,961,100)
2026/27 Budget	\$ (708,308,700)

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE & REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 16,221,254	\$ 28,232,900	\$ 26,878,700	\$ 36,086,400	\$ 7,853,500	27.8
Office	1,190,513	8,600	8,600	8,600	-	-
External Services	6,196,384	8,926,200	3,411,200	7,282,500	(1,643,700)	(18.4)
Supplies	17,804	1,600	1,600	1,600	-	-
Materials	102,600	-	-	-	-	-
Building Costs	472,973	268,500	268,500	286,500	18,000	6.7
Equipment & Communications	143,378	900	900	8,000	7,100	788.9
Vehicle Expense	29,249	10,000	500,000	10,200	200	2.0
Other Goods & Services	788,821	3,812,000	1,668,200	4,596,400	784,400	20.6
Interdepartmental	994,396	502,400	2,400	510,000	7,600	1.5
Debt Service	57,247,450	43,523,300	43,523,300	44,543,800	1,020,500	2.3
Other Fiscal	363,768,573	376,455,600	375,311,400	437,093,800	60,638,200	16.1
Total Expenditures	447,173,395	461,742,000	451,574,800	530,427,800	68,685,800	14.9

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Tax Revenue	\$ (749,378,670)	\$ (799,852,700)	\$ (795,622,900)	\$ (875,921,300)	\$ (76,068,600)	9.5
Area Rate Revenue	(232,660,250)	(254,676,000)	(254,676,000)	(264,310,700)	(9,634,700)	3.8
Tax Agreements	(14,437,555)	(15,175,800)	(15,102,700)	(15,178,200)	(2,400)	-
Payments in Lieu of taxes	(50,856,223)	(51,555,000)	(51,555,000)	(55,679,500)	(4,124,500)	8.0
Transfers from other Govts	(7,618,948)	(3,600,000)	(3,393,300)	(3,600,000)	-	-
Interest Revenue	(21,712,861)	(16,378,000)	(13,578,000)	(13,176,700)	3,201,300	(19.5)
Fee Revenues	(2,933,822)	(1,872,500)	(2,872,500)	(2,877,500)	(1,005,000)	53.7
Other Revenue	(20,575,956)	(7,979,600)	(9,014,000)	(7,992,600)	(13,000)	0.2
Total Revenues	(1,100,174,284)	(1,151,089,600)	(1,145,814,400)	(1,238,736,500)	(87,646,900)	7.6
Net Total	\$ (653,000,889)	\$ (689,347,600)	\$ (694,239,600)	\$ (708,308,700)	\$ (18,961,100)	2.8

FISCAL SERVICES PLAN (2026/27)

Debt Servicing

Debt charges in the operating budget consist of payments made on outstanding debentures (principal) and the interest costs associated with those debentures. Also included in the debt charges are bank charges, debenture discount and interest payments to Agencies, Boards & Commissions. For management purposes, debt charges can be classified as to how the funds are repaid:

- **Tax Supported Debt** – repaid through the general and transit tax rates;
- **Other Municipal Debt** – repaid through Local Improvement Charges (LICs), Area Rates and Development Charges;
- **Halifax Water Debt** – funds borrowed on behalf of Halifax Water Commission, and which are repaid through their rate base; and
- **Repayable Debt** – debt borrowed for and repaid by outside organizations.

Provincial Area Rates

Like all municipalities, HRM is legally required by the Province of Nova Scotia to provide funding for education costs, and for other services that are the responsibility of the Province of Nova Scotia. The funding source for the transfers is a separate Provincial Area Rate on the tax bill. Any increase in that budget amount has zero net impact to the overall HRM budget.

Provincial Area Rates	2025/26 Budget	2026/27 Budget	Δ 25/26	Δ %
Mandatory Education	210,699,500	226,863,000	16,163,500	7.7%
Property Valuation Services	7,587,000	7,797,000	210,000	2.8%
Total	\$ 218,286,500	\$ 234,660,000	\$ 16,373,500	7.5%

- **Mandatory Education**

This mandatory education contribution is set by the Province of Nova Scotia at the value of the Provincial Education Rate times the Uniform Assessment.

- **Assessment**

Property Valuation Services Corporation (PVSC) is mandated under the Nova Scotia Assessment Act to assess every property in Nova Scotia. HRM is required to pay a share of the cost of operating this provincial assessment system.

Other Transfers

- **Halifax Convention Centre (HCC)**

HRM has an agreement with the Province of Nova Scotia to fund the Halifax Convention Centre (HCC). This includes its share of the Provincial lease and the annual operating costs, which are paid to Events East. The HCC costs are to be paid from a reserve which is funded from the property tax revenues

collected from the new Nova Centre plus those funds which would have been paid to the former World Trade and Convention center (WTCC). The Nova Centre is a private development that includes not only the HCC but also offices, a hotel, retail and parking.

- **Supplementary Education**

Under the Halifax Charter, HRM provides funding for local schools, including a payment to the province-wide Acadian school board, Conseil scolaire acadien provincial (CSAP). The Halifax Charter requires that the municipality provides a guaranteed amount for supplementary education, although it may reduce the guaranteed amount by 10% of the amount spent in 1995/96. In addition to the legal requirements of the Charter, this payment is governed by a Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) with the Halifax Regional Centre for Education (HRCE), which expires March 31, 2026. A new MOU will be negotiated in 2026.

- **Fire Protection Services (Hydrants)**

The Nova Scotia Utilities and Review Board (NSUARB) has established a formula that requires HRM to contribute to the Halifax Water Commission (HW) for the hydrant costs incurred by the Commission. These hydrant charges are recovered by HRM via a special Fire Protection Area Rate that HRM levies on all properties within 1,200 feet of a hydrant that is designed and operated for public fire protection purposes.

- **Stormwater Right-of-Way (Halifax Water Commission)**

The Nova Scotia Utilities and Review Board (NSUARB) requires HRM to pay Halifax Water the cost of the stormwater drainage in the right-of-way of HRM streets and roads.

Grants and Tax Relief

HRM operates several Grant programs. Fiscal services includes the Community Grants Program (\$500,000) and the Community Museums Grant Program (\$220,000), the District Activity Fund (\$72,000). Other grant programs are administered by individual business units. HRM also provides a number of tax relief programs including for low income homeowners (\$1.8 million) and for non-profits (\$10 million).

Valuation Allowance

The Valuation Allowance is an account required by provincial rules as a contingency against uncollectible tax and other revenues. In 2026/27 it is budgeted at \$2.0 million.

Reserves

Reserves are utilized to ensure sustainability and improve the process of planning for HRM's future needs. Reserve Funds are provided for under the Financial Reserves Administrative Order Number 2014-015-ADM and are intended to serve three specific purposes:

- Contingency Funds for Opportunities;
- Contingency Funds for Risk;
- Savings Funds for Obligations.

Reserves deposits and withdrawals are budgeted for in both Fiscal Services and in individual business units.

Capital Renewal

Capital Renewal is used to fund the capital budget and helps reduce reliance on debt and other funding. The proposed budget for Capital Renewal is \$89.2 for 2026/27, which is an increase of \$23.2 against 2025/26.

Non-Departmental Revenue and Area Rates

This includes the municipality's revenues from Property Tax, Tax Agreements, Grants-in-Lieu payments, Deed Transfer Tax as well as income from investments.

Also included are the costs and revenues for community area rates, private organizations and private roads.

Summary of Net Expenditures - FISCAL SERVICES

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
M110 Debt & Interest Chg	41,703,939	42,324,900	34,433,200	34,370,600	(7,954,300)	(18.8)
M111 P&I Pmt Fnd by RESF	-	-	-	-	-	-
M113 Int.Pmt-Gen Govt	1,403,403	-	1,346,300	1,068,400	1,068,400	-
M114 Int.Pmt-Protect.Serv	517,430	-	522,300	1,111,100	1,111,100	-
M115 Int.Pmt-Transp.Serv.	5,036,638	-	4,983,900	4,606,800	4,606,800	-
M118 Int.Pmt - Plan & Dev.	-	-	-	-	-	-
M119 Int.Pmt - Rec & Cult	954,025	-	898,300	962,400	962,400	-
M122 HRWC Debt Charges	-	-	-	-	-	-
M530 Local Improvement Charges	-	-	-	-	-	-
M531 LIC Solar City Project	-	-	-	-	-	-
M532 LIC Solar City Ph II	-	-	-	-	-	-
M533 LIC Water Supply	(3,280)	-	-	-	-	-
M534 LIC Fall River Water	(55,685)	(60,000)	(60,000)	(60,000)	-	-
M535 Deep Energy Retrofit	-	-	-	-	-	-
** Debt Servicing Net of Recoverie	49,556,470	42,264,900	42,124,000	42,059,300	(205,600)	(0.5)
M230 LKD Corrections Svcs	-	-	-	-	-	-
M240 LKD Met.HousingAut	-	-	-	-	-	-
M280 Mandatory Education	-	-	-	-	-	-
M318 Prop Valuation Serv	-	-	-	-	-	-
* Provincially Mandated Services	-	-	-	-	-	-
M250 Halifax Convention Centre	7,540,000	7,564,000	7,564,000	7,786,400	222,400	2.9
M288 Suppl Educ HRM-wide	-	-	-	-	-	-
M291 Fire Protection	-	-	-	-	-	-
M293 Stormwater ROW	-	-	-	-	-	-
* Other Outside Agencies	7,540,000	7,564,000	7,564,000	7,786,400	222,400	2.9
** Transfers To Outside Agencies	7,540,000	7,564,000	7,564,000	7,786,400	222,400	2.9
M351 Managers Contingency	68,595	-	-	-	-	-
A125 Elections	(39,336)	-	-	-	-	-
M270 Compensation PPP	881,907	3,380,000	3,180,000	3,180,000	(200,000)	(5.9)
M310 Other Fiscal Serv.	29,011,796	26,716,900	19,924,300	40,747,500	14,030,600	52.5
M311 Grants & Tax Concessions	9,646,326	11,929,000	10,831,900	12,375,000	446,000	3.7
M317 Oper Cost NewCap	729,700	1,516,000	1,000,000	1,516,000	-	-
M341 Surplus/Deficit	3,474,015	-	-	-	-	-
M361 District Activity Fund	65,301	72,000	72,000	72,000	-	-
M382 Rapid Housing Initiative	(14)	-	-	-	-	-
M451 Valuation Allowance	1,573,766	2,000,000	2,000,000	2,000,000	-	-
** Other Fiscal Services	45,412,055	45,613,900	37,008,200	59,890,500	14,276,600	31.3
M316 Strategic Growth Fund	1,000,000	1,000,000	1,000,000	1,000,000	-	-
M320 Insurance Claims	4,362,446	6,882,900	6,510,900	7,303,600	420,700	6.1
M322 New Cap Replace Res	-	-	-	-	-	-
M324 Capital Surplus Reserve	-	-	-	-	-	-
M411 Oper Stabiliz Resrv	25,000,000	25,000,000	25,000,000	25,000,000	-	-
M433 Waste Resource Cap R	3,000,000	-	-	-	-	-
M461 Capital Fr Operating	50,700,000	66,033,000	66,033,000	89,237,600	23,204,600	35.1
M471 Other Transfers	2,150,000	2,260,000	2,260,000	24,383,700	22,123,700	978.9
** Transfers to/fr Other Funds	86,212,446	101,175,900	100,803,900	146,924,900	45,749,000	45.2
M510 Property Tax	(695,642,308)	(742,848,800)	(741,628,900)	(820,919,800)	(78,071,000)	10.5
M520 Deed Transfer	(68,256,024)	(70,000,000)	(70,000,000)	(70,000,000)	-	-
M540 Grants in Lieu	(50,856,223)	(51,555,000)	(51,555,000)	(55,679,500)	(4,124,500)	8.0
M550 Own Source Revenue	(23,625,356)	(16,962,500)	(15,162,500)	(14,770,500)	2,192,000	(12.9)
M560 Unconditional Trans.	(3,341,949)	(4,600,000)	(3,393,300)	(3,600,000)	1,000,000	(21.7)
** Non-Departmental Revenue	(841,721,860)	(885,966,300)	(881,739,700)	(964,969,800)	(79,003,500)	8.9
R856 East Preston Greenway	-	-	-	-	-	-
* Rural Sidewalk Area Rates	-	-	-	-	-	-
C101 Frame Subdivision	-	-	-	-	-	-
C105 Sackville Hts El Sch	-	-	-	-	-	-
C107 GlenArb Hme Owners	-	-	-	-	-	-
C108 White Hill Res Assoc	-	-	-	-	-	-
C111 Lost Creek Comm Asso	-	-	-	-	-	-
C112 Waterstone Neighbour	-	-	-	-	-	-
C114 Ketch Hbr Resi. Asso	-	-	-	-	-	-
C115 Mineville Community	-	-	-	-	-	-
C117 Three Brks Homeowner	-	-	-	-	-	-
C120 Haliburton Hills	-	-	-	-	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
C130 Highland Park	-	-	-	-	-	-
C135 Kingswood Ratepayers	-	-	-	-	-	-
C140 Prospect	-	-	-	-	-	-
C145 Westwood H Res Assoc	-	-	-	-	-	-
C160 Musquodoboit Harbour	-	-	-	-	-	-
C170 Hammonds Plns Com.RT	-	-	-	-	-	-
C180 Grand Lake Com. Ctr	-	-	-	-	-	-
C185 LKD District 3 Fund	-	-	-	-	-	-
C190 Maplewood Subdivisio	-	-	-	-	-	-
C196 Silverside Res.Assoc	-	-	-	-	-	-
C198 St. Margaret's/Fox Hollow	-	-	-	-	-	-
C200 Waverley Comm Assoc.	-	-	-	-	-	-
C210 LWF Recreation Ctr	-	-	-	-	-	-
W944 SH Streetscape Prog	-	-	-	-	-	-
* Community and Private Organizati	-	-	-	-	-	-
R756 Petpeswick Drive	-	-	-	-	-	-
R757 Three Brooks Home Ow	-	-	-	-	-	-
R758 Shag End Lot Owner	-	-	-	-	-	-
R759 SW Grand Lake Prop	-	-	-	-	-	-
R769 River Bend HOA	-	-	-	-	-	-
R786 Bald Rock Road Maint	-	-	-	-	-	-
R787 SMCA Road Maint	-	-	-	-	-	-
R788 Rutter Court Road	-	-	-	-	-	-
R789 Range rd Priv Rd Fee	-	-	-	-	-	-
R790 Blacks Sudb. Rd Main	-	-	-	-	-	-
R791 Redoubt Head Rd Main	-	-	-	-	-	-
R792 MARA Road Maintenance Fee	-	-	-	-	-	-
R793 St Marg Bay Heights	-	-	-	-	-	-
R794 Shiloh & Karla Drive	-	-	-	-	-	-
R795 Kelly Point Assoc	-	-	-	-	-	-
R796 Jenna Lane HOA	-	-	-	-	-	-
R797 Bayview Homeowners	-	-	-	-	-	-
R798 Cambrian's Cove HOA	-	-	-	-	-	-
R799 Gill Cove Rd MTN HOA	-	-	-	-	-	-
* Private Roads	-	-	-	-	-	-
** Transfers to Outside Organizati	-	-	-	-	-	-
*** Net Total	(653,000,889)	(689,347,600)	(694,239,600)	(708,308,700)	(18,961,100)	2.8

Summary of Expenditures Details - FISCAL SERVICES

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	4,799,937	24,482,900	15,087,500	37,686,400	13,203,500	53.9
6002 Salaries - Overtime	61,785	-	-	-	-	-
6003 Wages - Regular	105,901	-	-	-	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	9,848,078	-	8,391,200	-	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	3,793	-	-	-	-	-
6099 Other Allowances	6,200	-	-	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	1,579,433	1,100,000	1,400,000	(3,600,000)	(4,700,000)	(427.3)
6101 Benefits - Wages	70	-	-	-	-	-
6152 Retirement Incentives	(396,229)	2,500,000	2,000,000	2,000,000	(500,000)	(20.0)
6154 Workers' Compensation	30,105	-	-	-	-	-
6190 Compensation OCC trf	70,000	-	-	-	-	-
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	124,822	150,000	-	-	(150,000)	(100.0)
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	(12,641)	-	-	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	16,221,254	28,232,900	26,878,700	36,086,400	7,853,500	27.8
6201 Telephone/Cable	12,205	2,400	2,400	2,400	-	-
6202 Courier/Postage	347,345	-	-	-	-	-
6203 Office Furn/Equip	-	-	-	-	-	-
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	710,627	-	-	-	-	-
6205 Printing & Reprod	62,170	-	-	-	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	14,838	-	-	-	-	-
6290 Office OCC Transfer	34,500	-	-	-	-	-
6299 Other Office Expenses	8,828	6,200	6,200	6,200	-	-
* Office	1,190,513	8,600	8,600	8,600	-	-

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6301 Professional Fees	4,098	43,700	43,700	44,600	900	2.1
6302 Legal Fees	2,762,226	125,000	1,225,000	127,500	2,500	2.0
6303 Consulting Fees	(11,761)	120,000	275,000	120,400	400	0.3
6308 Snow Removal	16,425	7,000	7,000	7,000	-	-
6309 Litigation Disburse	(8,757)	-	-	-	-	-
6310 Outside Personnel	260,567	-	-	-	-	-
6311 Security	14,854	-	-	8,000	8,000	-
6312 Refuse Collection	4,499	2,700	2,700	4,000	1,300	48.1
6390 Extnl Svcs OCC Trsf	219,500	-	-	-	-	-
6399 Contract Services	2,934,733	8,627,800	1,857,800	6,971,000	(1,656,800)	(19.2)
* External Services	6,196,384	8,926,200	3,411,200	7,282,500	(1,643,700)	(18.4)
6402 Med & First Aid Supp	2,376	-	-	-	-	-
6406 Bridge Tolls	-	-	-	-	-	-
6407 Clean/Sani Supplies	1,857	1,600	1,600	1,600	-	-
6490 Supplies OCC Transfer	10,000	-	-	-	-	-
6499 Other Supplies	3,571	-	-	-	-	-
* Supplies	17,804	1,600	1,600	1,600	-	-
6590 Materials OCC Trsf	102,600	-	-	-	-	-
* Materials	102,600	-	-	-	-	-
6606 Heating Fuel	26,465	23,000	23,000	23,000	-	-
6607 Electricity	1,798	700	700	2,400	1,700	242.9
6608 Water	239,835	218,600	218,600	218,600	-	-
6610 Building - Exterior	9,381	9,000	9,000	25,000	16,000	177.8
6611 Building - Interior	94,524	15,800	15,800	17,000	1,200	7.6
6612 Safety Systems	28,269	1,400	1,400	500	(900)	(64.3)
6690 Building OCC Transfer	72,700	-	-	-	-	-
6699 Other Building Cost	-	-	-	-	-	-
* Building Costs	472,973	268,500	268,500	286,500	18,000	6.7
6701 Equipment Purchase	64,936	900	900	6,000	5,100	566.7
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	25,832	-	-	-	-	-
6704 Equipment Rental	2,610	-	-	-	-	-
6705 Equip - R&M	-	-	-	-	-	-
6707 Plumbing & Heating	-	-	-	200	200	-
6708 Mechanical Equipment	-	-	-	1,800	1,800	-
6790 Equipment OCC Trsf	50,000	-	-	-	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	143,378	900	900	8,000	7,100	788.9
6802 Vehicle R&M	9,840	10,000	500,000	10,200	200	2.0
6806 Vehicle Rentals	-	-	-	-	-	-
6807 Vehicle Leases	19,409	-	-	-	-	-
* Vehicle Expense	29,249	10,000	500,000	10,200	200	2.0
6901 Membership Dues	343,441	390,000	396,700	390,000	-	-
6902 Conferences/Workshop	412	-	-	-	-	-
6903 Travel - Local	10,340	-	-	-	-	-
6904 Travel - Out of Town	562	-	-	10,000	10,000	-
6905 Training & Education	100,634	-	10,000	-	-	-
6908 Medical Examinations	200,844	180,000	250,000	183,600	3,600	2.0
6910 Signage	300	-	-	-	-	-
6911 Facilities Rental	147,028	-	-	-	-	-
6912 Advertising/Promotio	53,705	-	-	-	-	-
6917 Books and Periodicals	-	-	-	-	-	-
6918 Meals/Catering	7,325	-	-	-	-	-
6933 Community Events	81	-	-	-	-	-
6938 Rewarding Excellence	41,602	-	11,500	-	-	-
6954 Cash over/under	(80)	-	-	-	-	-
6990 Gds & Svcs OCC Trsf	170,400	-	-	-	-	-
6999 Other Goods/Services	(287,774)	3,242,000	1,000,000	4,012,800	770,800	23.8
* Other Goods & Services	788,821	3,812,000	1,668,200	4,596,400	784,400	20.6
7005 Interdept EXP	-	-	-	-	-	-
7007 ltnTrsf Paper Recyc	-	-	-	-	-	-
7009 Internal Trfr Other	245,290	2,400	2,400	-	(2,400)	(100.0)
7010 IntTrfr Insur Funds	621,100	500,000	-	510,000	10,000	2.0
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	128,007	-	-	-	-	-
* Interdepartmental	994,396	502,400	2,400	510,000	7,600	1.5
8011 Interest on Debentur	8,210,465	7,825,200	7,825,200	9,868,300	2,043,100	26.1
8012 Principal on Debentu	49,036,985	35,698,100	35,698,100	34,675,500	(1,022,600)	(2.9)
* Debt Service	57,247,450	43,523,300	43,523,300	44,543,800	1,020,500	2.3

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
8001 Transf Outside Agenc	224,754,884	240,878,200	240,941,200	255,454,300	14,576,100	6.1
8002 Insurance Claims	1,999,929	700,000	700,000	714,000	14,000	2.0
8003 Insurance Pol/Prem	4,353,063	5,660,000	5,660,000	6,059,700	399,700	7.1
8004 Grants	5,556,403	792,000	792,000	992,000	200,000	25.3
8005 Tax Exemptions	1,476,955	1,875,000	1,875,000	1,875,000	-	-
8006 Tax Concess Non Prof	7,677,867	9,554,000	8,456,900	10,000,000	446,000	4.7
8007 Tax Concess Commerci	3,995,471	3,844,900	3,838,700	3,844,900	-	-
8009 Fire Protection	8,083,080	11,798,800	11,798,800	13,971,900	2,173,100	18.4
8014 Capital from Operati	54,800,000	66,033,000	66,033,000	89,237,600	23,204,600	35.1
8015 Debenture Discount	293,677	242,700	219,300	926,200	683,500	281.6
8016 Provision for Allow	1,573,766	2,000,000	2,000,000	2,000,000	-	-
8017 Bank Charges	852,643	875,000	875,000	875,000	-	-
8022 Transf to/fr Trust	(234,488)	(40,000)	(40,000)	(40,000)	-	-
8024 Transf to/fr Capital	533,601	207,700	207,700	399,000	191,300	92.1
8026 Property Damage	55,093	94,200	194,200	96,100	1,900	2.0
8030 Tfr Fr Resvs to Oper	(13,814,171)	(18,747,900)	(18,865,400)	(11,028,600)	7,719,300	(41.2)
8031 Tfr To Resvs Fr Oper	56,385,815	42,302,700	42,302,700	60,211,500	17,908,800	42.3
8046 Stormwater ROW Chg	5,316,000	5,867,600	5,867,600	6,780,010	912,410	15.6
9000 Prior Yr. Sur/Def	(5,223,841)	4,800	(5,429,700)	(5,541,300)	(5,546,100)	(115,543.8)
9001 Current Yr. Sur/Def	5,332,827	2,512,900	7,884,400	266,490	(2,246,410)	(89.4)
* Other Fiscal	363,768,573	376,455,600	375,311,400	437,093,800	60,638,200	16.1
** Total	447,173,395	461,742,000	451,574,800	530,427,800	68,685,800	14.9

Summary of Revenues Details - FISCAL SERVICES

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4001 Res. Property Taxes	(372,427,792)	(404,099,800)	(403,970,000)	(452,108,400)	(48,008,600)	11.9
4002 Comm. Property Taxes	(285,235,559)	(300,084,200)	(299,834,200)	(329,734,600)	(29,650,400)	9.9
4005 Resrc Property Taxes	(1,887,718)	(2,054,700)	(2,054,700)	(2,194,400)	(139,700)	6.8
4006 Rec. Non Profit	(26,568)	(17,000)	(17,000)	(17,000)	-	-
4007 Resource Forest Taxes	(39,375)	(42,000)	(42,000)	(42,000)	-	-
4008 Comm. Forest Taxes	(72,067)	(89,000)	(89,000)	(89,000)	-	-
4014 Climate Action Tax	(18,400,672)	(17,952,300)	(17,952,300)	(18,222,200)	(269,900)	1.5
4100 Deed Transfer Taxes	(68,256,024)	(70,000,000)	(70,000,000)	(70,000,000)	-	-
4101 Capital Charges	(3,032,896)	(5,513,700)	(1,663,700)	(3,513,700)	2,000,000	(36.3)
* Tax Revenue	(749,378,670)	(799,852,700)	(795,622,900)	(875,921,300)	(76,068,600)	9.5
4201 Area Rate Residential	(193,675,817)	(212,052,300)	(212,052,300)	(224,338,700)	(12,286,400)	5.8
4202 Area Rate Commercial	(38,014,304)	(41,589,000)	(41,589,000)	(38,915,600)	2,673,400	(6.4)
4206 Area Rate Resource	(970,128)	(1,034,700)	(1,034,700)	(1,056,400)	(21,700)	2.1
* Area Rate Revenue	(232,660,250)	(254,676,000)	(254,676,000)	(264,310,700)	(9,634,700)	3.8
4501 Tax Agreement - NSLC	(930,370)	(948,600)	(933,600)	(948,600)	-	-
4502 Tax Agreement - NSPI	(6,181,938)	(6,463,600)	(6,463,600)	(6,567,000)	(103,400)	1.6
4503 Tax Agreement - Bell	(1,496,469)	(1,419,200)	(1,484,900)	(1,319,200)	100,000	(7.0)
4507 Tax Agreement - Heri	(1,810,771)	(1,950,200)	(1,988,500)	(1,950,200)	-	-
4508 Tax Agreement - HIAA	(1,970,780)	(2,373,700)	(2,191,400)	(2,600,000)	(226,300)	9.5
4509 Tax Agrmnt - Irving	(1,719,222)	(1,711,200)	(1,784,800)	(1,483,900)	227,300	(13.3)
4550 Tax Agreement - Other	(328,005)	(309,300)	(255,900)	(309,300)	-	-
* Tax Agreements	(14,437,555)	(15,175,800)	(15,102,700)	(15,178,200)	(2,400)	0.0
4601 Grant in Lieu-Fed	(30,186,967)	(29,421,100)	(29,421,100)	(31,774,800)	(2,353,700)	8.0
4602 Grant in Lieu-Prov.	(14,992,920)	(16,486,000)	(16,486,000)	(17,804,900)	(1,318,900)	8.0
4603 Grant in Lieu-CPC	(771,505)	(859,800)	(859,800)	(928,600)	(68,800)	8.0
4605 Grant Lieu-Hflx Port	(2,439,358)	(2,101,900)	(2,101,900)	(2,270,100)	(168,200)	8.0
4606 Grant in Lieu - CBC	(40,171)	(42,800)	(42,800)	(46,200)	(3,400)	7.9
4607 Grant Lieu -Via Rail	(163,085)	(203,700)	(203,700)	(220,000)	(16,300)	8.0
4608 Grant in Lieu - WCB	(139,780)	(152,300)	(152,300)	(164,500)	(12,200)	8.0
4609 Grant in Lieu- Citad	(2,032,711)	(2,202,300)	(2,202,300)	(2,378,500)	(176,200)	8.0
4610 Grant in Lieu-NRC	(72,499)	(66,400)	(66,400)	(71,700)	(5,300)	8.0
4650 Grant in Lieu - Other	(17,227)	(18,700)	(18,700)	(20,200)	(1,500)	8.0
* Payments in Lieu of taxes	(50,856,223)	(51,555,000)	(51,555,000)	(55,679,500)	(4,124,500)	8.0
4704 Conditnl Grnts Other	(4,276,998)	-	-	-	-	-
4706 Uncond.Grant NS(oth)	(3,341,949)	(3,600,000)	(3,393,300)	(3,600,000)	-	-
* Transfers from other Gov'ts	(7,618,948)	(3,600,000)	(3,393,300)	(3,600,000)	-	-
4801 Int. Rev. - Tax	(5,348,999)	(4,300,000)	(5,200,000)	(5,000,000)	(700,000)	16.3
4803 Int. Rev. - Cap.Chrg	(509,507)	(493,000)	(493,000)	(491,700)	1,300	(0.3)

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4850 Int. Rev. - Other	(224,821)	(85,000)	(85,000)	(85,000)	-	-
4860 Investment Income	(15,629,534)	(11,500,000)	(7,800,000)	(7,600,000)	3,900,000	(33.9)
* Interest Revenue	(21,712,861)	(16,378,000)	(13,578,000)	(13,176,700)	3,201,300	(19.5)
4923 Marketing Levy Penalty	(141,489)	-	-	(5,000)	(5,000)	-
5151 Lease Revenue	(2,130)	-	-	-	-	-
5255 Engineering Fees	(19,815)	-	-	-	-	-
5256 SOT Revenue	(2,770,387)	(1,872,500)	(2,872,500)	(2,872,500)	(1,000,000)	53.4
* Fee Revenues	(2,933,822)	(1,872,500)	(2,872,500)	(2,877,500)	(1,005,000)	53.7
5502 HRWC Dividend	(6,815,659)	(7,024,600)	(6,122,000)	(7,024,600)	-	-
5508 Recov External Parti	(13,508,261)	(650,000)	(2,587,000)	(660,000)	(10,000)	1.5
5509 NSF Chq Fee	-	-	-	(3,000)	(3,000)	-
5600 Miscellaneous Revenue	(252,036)	(305,000)	(305,000)	(305,000)	-	-
* Other Revenue	(20,575,956)	(7,979,600)	(9,014,000)	(7,992,600)	(13,000)	0.2
** Total	(1,100,174,284)	(1,151,089,600)	(1,145,814,400)	(1,238,736,500)	(87,646,900)	7.6
*** Net Total	(653,000,889)	(689,347,600)	(694,239,600)	(708,308,700)	(18,961,100)	2.8

HALIFAX

MAYOR'S OFFICE

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MAYOR'S OFFICE

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

OVERVIEW

The Office of the Mayor supports the Mayor in fulfilling their mandate as Chair of Regional Council, spokesperson for the Municipality and host of visiting dignitaries. This is done by delivering service excellence in administration, operations, community outreach, council relations, intergovernmental and interjurisdictional affairs, issues management and policy. This includes supporting the fulfilment of the Mayor's duties as listed in the *Halifax Regional Municipality Charter* (see Appendix).

The Office provides strategic leadership, fosters inclusive engagement and ensures the Office of the Mayor serves as a trusted bridge between Regional Council, residents and external partners – in alignment with Regional Council's priorities.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Office of the Mayor	✓ Council, Intergovernmental and External Relations ✓ Communications Support ✓ Policy Support ✓ Community Outreach ✓ Administrative Support ✓ Operational Support

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		6.0
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Communications & Digital Coordinator	Service Enhancement	1.0
Transferred Positions		
Net Transfer Positions		
Total Changes		1.0
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		7.0

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	Budget	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections		Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Mayor's Office	\$ 872,385	\$ 972,300	\$ 1,009,300	\$ 1,095,300	\$ 123,000	12.7
Net Total	\$ 872,385	\$ 972,300	\$ 1,009,300	\$ 1,095,300	\$ 123,000	12.7

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	Budget	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections		Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 808,990	\$ 787,000	\$ 824,000	\$ 1,010,000	\$ 223,000	28.3
Office	9,326	8,500	14,100	7,500	(1,000)	(11.8)
External Services	160	3,500	7,100	3,500	-	-
Building Costs	167	-	-	-	-	-
Other Goods & Services	68,671	173,300	175,800	74,300	(99,000)	(57.1)
Interdepartmental	171	-	600	-	-	-
Total Expenditures	887,484	972,300	1,021,800	1,095,300	123,000	12.7

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	Budget	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections		Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Other Revenue	\$ (15,100)	\$ -	\$ (12,500)	\$ -	\$ -	-
Total Revenues	(15,100)	-	(12,500)	-	-	-
Net Total	\$ 872,385	\$ 972,300	\$ 1,009,300	\$ 1,095,300	\$ 123,000	12.7

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 972,300
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Position conversions and new position	192,800
Compensation adjustments	63,200
Other/Transfers	
Removal of one time special project funding	(100,000)
Budget Committee Adjustments	
Compensation Savings	(33,000)
Total Changes	\$ 123,000
2026/27 Budget	\$ 1,095,300

APPENDIX – DUTIES OF THE MAYOR

The Mayor's Duties are articulated in the Halifax Regional Municipality Charter and Administrative Order 1.

HALIFAX REGIONAL MUNICIPALITY CHARTER SECTION 12 — MAYOR PRESIDES

12(3) The Mayor may

- (a) monitor the administration and government of the Municipality; and
- (b) communicate such information and recommend such measures to the Council as will improve the finances, administration, and government of the Municipality. (2008, c. 39, s. 12)

ADMINISTRATIVE ORDER 1 COMMITTEES AND SUBCOMMITTEES

Section 128 — Mayor as Ex Officio Member

- **128(1)** Unless otherwise provided for in a by-law or an Administrative Order, the Mayor shall be an ex officio member of all committees of the Council, and shall have all the powers and privileges of a member of the committee, including the right to vote.

Schedule 2 – Audit and Finance Standing Committee

- Audit and Finance Subcommittee (Auditor General Oversight)
 - **13(1)** The Audit and Finance Standing Committee shall appoint a subcommittee to oversee the contract of the Auditor General.
 - **13(2)** The subcommittee shall be comprised of the Mayor, the Chair and the Vice-Chair of the Audit and Finance Standing Committee.
 - **13(3)** The subcommittee shall report, as required, to the Audit and Finance Standing Committee who, in turn, shall report to the Council.

Schedule 4 — Standing Committee of the Whole on Budget

- **4** The Chair of the Audit and Finance Standing Committee shall be the Chair of the Standing Committee of the Whole on Budget and the Vice Chair shall be the Mayor.

Schedule 6 — Executive Standing Committee

- **2(2)** The Mayor and Deputy Mayor shall be Members of the Executive Standing Committee and the other Members shall be appointed by each Standing Committee.

Summary of Net Expenditures - Mayor's Office						
	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
E300 Mayor's office	872,385	972,300	1,009,300	1,095,300	123,000	12.7
* Net Total	872,385	972,300	1,009,300	1,095,300	123,000	12.7
Summary of Expenditures Details - Mayor's Office						
	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	682,304	666,800	708,700	877,100	210,300	31.5
6002 Salaries - Overtime	-	-	1,100	-	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(20,674)	-	(13,900)	-	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	7,655	-	3,000	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	123,189	100,200	95,900	141,000	40,800	40.7
6152 Retirement Incentives	3,348	2,800	2,800	4,100	1,300	46.4
6153 Severence	-	-	9,200	-	-	-
6154 Workers' Compensation	13,167	17,200	17,200	20,800	3,600	20.9
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	-	-	-	(33,000)	(33,000)	-
* Compensation and Benefits	808,990	787,000	824,000	1,010,000	223,000	28.3
6201 Telephone/Cable	6,628	3,500	7,100	2,500	(1,000)	(28.6)
6202 Courier/Postage	718	1,000	1,800	1,000	-	-
6205 Printing & Reprod	-	1,000	800	1,000	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	1,082	3,000	2,400	3,000	-	-
6299 Other Office Expenses	898	-	2,000	-	-	-
* Office	9,326	8,500	14,100	7,500	(1,000)	(11.8)
6301 Professional Fees	-	-	5,700	-	-	-
6399 Contract Services	160	3,500	1,400	3,500	-	-
* External Services	160	3,500	7,100	3,500	-	-
6699 Other Building Cost	167	-	-	-	-	-
* Building Costs	167	-	-	-	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	-	-	200	-	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	-	-	200	-	-	-
6901 Membership Dues	-	1,500	300	1,500	-	-
6902 Conferences/Workshop	1,336	2,000	1,400	2,000	-	-
6903 Travel - Local	3,356	4,000	2,300	4,000	-	-
6904 Travel - Out of Town	13,793	18,500	7,100	18,500	-	-
6905 Training & Education	-	2,000	-	2,000	-	-
6906 Licenses & Agreements	12	-	-	-	-	-
6912 Advertising/Promotio	2,830	8,500	6,200	8,500	-	-
6913 Awards	-	1,500	900	1,500	-	-
6917 Books and Periodicals	1,128	2,500	2,000	1,500	(1,000)	(40.0)
6918 Meals/Catering	3,195	2,800	3,900	2,800	-	-
6919 Special Projects	-	100,000	108,500	2,000	(98,000)	(98.0)
6933 Community Events	43,019	30,000	42,900	30,000	-	-
6999 Other Goods/Services	-	-	300	-	-	-
* Other Goods & Services	68,671	173,300	175,800	74,300	(99,000)	(57.1)
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	171	-	600	-	-	-
* Interdepartmental	171	-	600	-	-	-
** Total	887,484	972,300	1,021,800	1,095,300	123,000	12.7
Summary of Revenues Details - Mayor's Office						
	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
5508 Recov External Parti	(15,100)	-	(12,500)	-	-	-
* Other Revenue	(15,100)	-	(12,500)	-	-	-
** Total	(15,100)	-	(12,500)	-	-	-
* Net Total	872,385	972,300	1,009,300	1,095,300	123,000	12.7

HALIFAX

**OFFICER OF THE AUDITOR
GENERAL**

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

OFFICE OF THE AUDITOR GENERAL

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

To deliver independent audits that strengthen accountability and encourage improved efficiency and effectiveness of programs.

OVERVIEW

The Office of the Auditor General is responsible for auditing Halifax Regional Municipality's programs and accounts, including all municipal bodies. The Office assists Halifax Regional Council in holding itself, and administration, accountable for the use of public funds and for achieving value-for-money in the Municipality's operations.

The Office of the Auditor General independently prepares and publishes its work plan and reports. Details can be found at: <https://hrmauditorgeneral.ca/annual-reports>.

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		9.6
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Transferred Positions		
Net Transfer Positions		
Total Changes		-
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		9.6

Includes full, part-time, and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Office of the Auditor General	\$ 1,129,257	\$ 1,342,200	\$ 1,261,100	\$ 1,339,400	\$ (2,800)	(0.2)
Net Total	\$ 1,129,257	\$ 1,342,200	\$ 1,261,100	\$ 1,339,400	\$ (2,800)	(0.2)

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 1,052,702	\$ 1,195,600	\$ 1,094,600	\$ 1,202,600	\$ 7,000	0.6
Office	36,851	47,300	75,300	49,300	2,000	4.2
External Services	1,356	32,000	35,400	32,000	-	-
Equipment & Communications	26	1,000	1,000	1,000	-	-
Other Goods & Services	38,321	66,300	54,800	54,500	(11,800)	(17.8)
Total Expenditures	1,129,257	1,342,200	1,261,100	1,339,400	(2,800)	(0.2)

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Total Revenues	-	-	-	-	-	
Net Total	\$ 1,129,257	\$ 1,342,200	\$ 1,261,100	\$ 1,339,400	\$ (2,800)	(0.2)

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 1,342,200
Inflation/Service Pressures	
Compensation adjustments	7,000
Office	2,000
Other Goods and Services	(11,800)
Total Changes	\$ (2,800)
2026/27 Budget	\$ 1,339,400

Summary of Net Expenditures - Auditor General's Office

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
A317 Bus Process & QA	-	-	-	-	-	-
G100 Off of the Aud Gen	1,129,257	1,342,200	1,261,100	1,339,400	(2,800)	(0.2)
* Net Total	1,129,257	1,342,200	1,261,100	1,339,400	(2,800)	(0.2)

Summary of Expenditures Details - Auditor General's Office

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	870,995	955,100	908,300	963,000	7,900	0.8
6002 Salaries - Overtime	146	-	-	-	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(27,760)	-	(27,800)	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	182,647	205,700	180,600	202,000	(3,700)	(1.8)
6152 Retirement Incentives	5,409	6,500	5,200	7,300	800	12.3
6154 Workers' Compensation	21,266	28,300	28,300	30,300	2,000	7.1
* Compensation and Benefits	1,052,702	1,195,600	1,094,600	1,202,600	7,000	0.6
6201 Telephone/Cable	-	1,100	1,100	1,100	-	-
6202 Courier/Postage	-	200	200	200	-	-
6203 Office Furn/Equip	110	2,500	32,500	2,500	-	-
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	36,221	42,000	40,000	44,000	2,000	4.8
6207 Office Supplies	521	1,500	1,500	1,500	-	-
* Office	36,851	47,300	75,300	49,300	2,000	4.2
6301 Professional Fees	-	25,000	28,400	25,000	-	-
6302 Legal Fees	-	5,000	5,000	5,000	-	-
6399 Contract Services	1,356	2,000	2,000	2,000	-	-
* External Services	1,356	32,000	35,400	32,000	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	26	1,000	1,000	1,000	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	26	1,000	1,000	1,000	-	-
6901 Membership Dues	14,805	14,000	14,300	14,800	800	5.7
6902 Conferences/Workshop	4,305	4,000	2,000	4,000	-	-
6903 Travel - Local	143	1,500	1,500	1,500	-	-
6904 Travel - Out of Town	1,738	3,000	1,500	3,000	-	-
6905 Training & Education	14,574	38,300	30,000	25,700	(12,600)	(32.9)
6912 Advertising/Promotio	-	1,000	1,000	1,000	-	-
6914 Recruiting	-	1,000	1,000	1,000	-	-
6917 Books and Periodicals	1,227	1,500	1,500	1,500	-	-
6918 Meals/Catering	19	-	-	-	-	-
6937 Corporate Training	25	-	-	-	-	-
6938 Rewarding Excellence	1,486	2,000	2,000	2,000	-	-
* Other Goods & Services	38,321	66,300	54,800	54,500	(11,800)	(17.8)
** Total	1,129,257	1,342,200	1,261,100	1,339,400	(2,800)	(0.2)
* Net Total	1,129,257	1,342,200	1,261,100	1,339,400	(2,800)	(0.2)

HALIFAX

HALIFAX PUBLIC LIBRARIES

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

HALIFAX PUBLIC LIBRARIES

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

MISSION

Reflecting our community, we are a resource for everyone and a launch point for growth.

OVERVIEW

Halifax Public Libraries (the Library) engages and connects communities by providing equitable access to learning, resources and opportunities across the municipality. Through its 14 branches, two community offices, digital platforms and outreach programs, the Library fosters connection, inclusion and growth. Guided by the Halifax Regional Library Board and aligned with the municipality's Strategic Plan, the Library advances community growth, strengthens community well-being and contributes to the region's social and economic development.

SERVICE AREAS

Refer to the municipality's [Service Catalogue](#) for details on service areas and services offered across all business units and offices.

Service Area	Services Offered
Office of the Chief Librarian and Chief Executive Officer	✓ Oversight and Administration of the Halifax Public Libraries ✓ Governance, Policy and Risk
Access Services	✓ Collection Management ✓ Information Technology
Administrative Services	✓ Facilities and Capital Projects ✓ Finance ✓ Fund Development and Partnerships ✓ Human Resources ✓ Marketing and Communications ✓ Strategic Planning
Public Services	✓ Branch Services

Service Area

Services Offered

✓ Community Engagement

FULL TIME EQUIVALENT COUNTS

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) Change Details		
Approved 2025/26 FTEs:		337.0
Net Positions:		
Position	Rationale	Count
Transferred Positions		
Net Transfer Positions		
Total Changes		-
Total Budgeted 2026/27 FTEs		337.0

Includes full, part-time and permanent positions.

Some opening balances have been restated to be consistent with how an FTE is counted.

BUDGET

SERVICE AREA BUDGET OVERVIEW

Service Area	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Administrative Services	\$ (2,588,133)	\$ (4,130,100)	\$ (3,595,300)	\$ (3,825,400)	\$ 304,700	(7.4)
Information Technology/Collection	7,429,386	8,612,800	8,712,800	10,241,500	1,628,700	18.9
Branches/Public Services	20,414,781	23,789,700	24,039,700	24,487,800	698,100	2.9
Eng. Lang. Learning/Literacy	(62,563)	182,300	182,300	265,800	83,500	45.8
Library Restricted Funds	(25,419)	-	-	-	-	-
Capital Transactions	95,065	-	-	-	-	-
Net Total	\$ 25,263,116	\$ 28,454,700	\$ 29,339,500	\$ 31,169,700	\$ 2,715,000	9.5

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE AND REVENUE

Expenditures	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Compensation and Benefits	\$ 21,594,610	\$ 24,584,600	\$ 25,584,600	\$ 26,250,000	\$ 1,665,400	6.8
Office	759,122	790,700	790,700	868,700	78,000	9.9
External Services	1,523,969	1,468,000	1,529,000	1,560,000	92,000	6.3
Supplies	95,761	88,600	88,600	88,600	-	-
Building Costs	1,833,012	1,526,600	1,576,600	1,727,900	201,300	13.2
Equipment & Communications	282,418	511,500	791,500	511,500	-	-
Other Goods & Services	5,504,177	5,660,200	5,410,200	6,443,500	783,300	13.8
Interdepartmental	16,399	33,200	33,200	33,200	-	-
Other Fiscal	707,229	(2,400)	(2,400)	(2,400)	-	-
Total Expenditures	32,316,697	34,661,000	35,802,000	37,481,000	2,820,000	8.1

Revenues	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27		
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
Transfers from other Govts	\$ (5,530,500)	\$ (5,530,500)	\$ (5,786,700)	\$ (5,530,500)	\$ -	-
Fee Revenues	(363,275)	(405,300)	(405,300)	(450,300)	(45,000)	11.1
Other Revenue	(1,159,805)	(270,500)	(270,500)	(330,500)	(60,000)	22.2
Total Revenues	(7,053,581)	(6,206,300)	(6,462,500)	(6,311,300)	(105,000)	1.7
Net Total	\$ 25,263,116	\$ 28,454,700	\$ 29,339,500	\$ 31,169,700	\$ 2,715,000	9.5

OPERATING – SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Change Description / Service Impact	Amount
Approved 2025/26 Budget	\$ 28,454,700
Inflation/Service Pressures	
External contracts including janitorial	170,000
Facility Rentals (rental increases & new leased space)	693,800
Library collections investment	290,800
Contractual Increases	
Collective agreement & compensation changes	1,665,400
Revenue Changes	
Fees and other revenues increases	(105,000)
Total Changes	\$ 2,715,000
2026/27 Budget	\$ 31,169,700

PERFORMANCE MEASURES

Access Services	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Total annual wireless connections	6,459,720	5,677,196	5,446,827	5,446,827
Public use computer bookings	401,004	399,759	423,264	423,264

Annual non-electronic circulation ¹	2,789,859	2,597,147	2,765,686	2,765,686
Annual non-electronic circulation per capita	5.62	5.16	5.38 ³	5.3
Annual electronic circulation ²	1,950,400	2,195,964	2,682,236	2,682,236
Annual electronic circulation per capita	3.93	4.36	5.22 ³	5.1
Annual dollar amount spent on electronic library materials per capita	\$3.74	\$3.49	\$3.93	\$3.80
Materials expenditures per capita	\$6.29	\$6.22	\$6.73	\$6.60

¹ Non-electronic circulation includes all print books, magazines, CDs, and DVDs.

² Electronic circulation includes e-books and e-magazines. It does not include streaming services.

³ Value for 2025/26 is based on projected population provided by the municipality (513,816) and will be updated once Statistics Canada population estimate data is available.

Analysis:

This year the Library continues to see shifts in how residents are accessing library services, with electronic use continuing to grow and in-person use of the Library recovering after reduced services at Keshen Goodman Public Library last year. *Public use computer bookings* remain stable and grows slightly in the projections, indicating continued demand for Library-provided technology, particularly among community members who rely on public access for workforce, education, and social needs. *Annual non-electronic circulation* shows a dip in 2024/25 followed by a rebound in 2025/26, while *Annual non-electronic per-capita* rates remain relatively strong. The dip in 2024/25 is attributed to the extended reduced service at Keshen Goodman Public Library and a three-week system wide closure in September 2024 due to a labour disruption. This pattern suggests that the physical collection remains an important part of library use, even as borrowing patterns fluctuate.

Annual electronic circulation continues its strong upward trend, rising from 1.95 million in 2023/24 to a projected 2.68 million, with *Annual electronic circulation per-capita* borrowing increasing from 3.93 to 5.22 before stabilizing slightly. This growth reflects ongoing community member preference for digital convenience and the Library's investment in a robust electronic collection. *Annual dollar amount spent on electronic library materials per capita* remains consistent – with only slight year-to-year variation – due to the additional investment in library collections over the last three years. Similarly, *Materials expenditure per capita* remains stable overall, with modest growth that aligns with inflationary pressures.

The data highlights the continued shift to electronic resources, while access and use of physical collections remain strong. Balancing both physical and electronic resources is required to meet community demand.

Administrative Services	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
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Library square feet per capita ¹	0.65	0.65	0.62 ²	0.60
Library website visits	4,159,529	4,490,027	4,462,304	4,462,304
Active Library card holders	194,270	212,149	214,270	214,270

¹ Target Library size range is 0.6 - 1.2 ft² per person.

² Value for 2025/26 is based on projected population provided by the municipality (513,816) and will be updated once Statistics Canada population estimate data is available.

Analysis:

To serve the municipality effectively, the Library's target is to have been 0.60 - 1.2 ft² of library space per capita. This ensures that there is sufficient physical space to house the Library collection, offer programming to the community and have the space needed for community members' use. Currently the Library is at the lowest end of the range of required number of square feet to adequately serve the community. This means that in some locations services are restricted; libraries can be crowded, and community members may not be able to access the technology or the space they require. Halifax Regional Council has approved an additional library lease to support moving delivery, process and IT services to the Burnside Industrial area which is planned for the end of the 2026/27 fiscal year. This will help to mitigate some of the space shortfall.

The Library is experiencing growing demand amid gradually tightening physical space. Despite this constraint, digital engagement remains strong: *Library website visits* increased significantly from 4.16 million to 4.49 million and remain high in future projections, demonstrating sustained reliance on online services, resources, and information seeking. At the same time, *Active Library card holders* grew from 194,270 to over 214,000, suggesting that more residents are formally engaging with the Library and accessing services. Together, these indicators show that the Library is attracting more users and digital activity even as the per-capita space declines, underscoring the importance of continued investment in both physical infrastructure and digital service delivery.

Public Services	2023/24 Actual	2024/25 Actual ¹	2025/26 Projected	2026/27 Planned
Annual Library uses ¹	19,759,970	19,770,222	20,066,775	20,367,776
Annual Library uses per capita	39.8	39.3	39.1 ²	40.5
Annual Library visits	2,654,108	2,824,502	2,954,713	2,954,713
Annual Library visits per capita	5.34	5.62	5.75 ²	5.70
Meeting room bookings	14,893	15,449	19,994	19,994
Program attendance (in person)	211,872	227,862	234,727	234,727

Volunteer hours	31,312	32,535	36,806	36,806
Hours of in person Library service ³	42,017	34,720	36,890	36,890

- ¹ Library uses include in-person visits, circulation (both electronic and digital), online activity, Wi-Fi connections, program attendance, and technology use. Calculated using the Canadian Urban Library Council definition of Library use.
- ² Value for 2025/26 is based on projected population provided by the municipality (513,816) and will be updated once Statistics Canada population estimate data is available.
- ³ Total hours of open hours to the public across all branches.

Analysis:

The data show steady and sustained growth in overall Library use, reflecting strong community engagement and a broad reliance on Library services. *Annual Library uses* rose from 19.76 million in 2023/24 to a projected 20.07 million in 2025/26, with *Annual Library uses per-capita* remaining consistently high. This overall upward trend underscores the continued relevance of the Library as an essential community service that supports information access, technology use, programs and community spaces.

In-person engagement indicators also demonstrate healthy growth. *Annual Library visits* increased from 2.65 million to nearly 3 million, and *Annual Library per capita visits* rose from 5.34 to 5.87. These increases point to strong interest in physical library spaces, whether for browsing, studying, attending programs, or accessing technology. *Meeting room bookings* grew from just under 15,000 to nearly 20,000 highlighting the critical role of library facilities as accessible, community-orientated gathering spaces. Likewise, *Program attendance (in-person)* continued to climb, with projections of more than 230,000 participants, reflecting a continued demand for learning, cultural events and social connection facilitated by Library programming.

Hours of in person Library service has declined slightly over the last several years due to a combination of service disruptions attributed to staffing and facility closures. Facility closures are generally attributed to unexpected maintenance or operations. For example, Dartmouth North Public Library has had an extended closure awaiting repairs following flooding in March 2025.

2026/27 DELIVERABLES

Council Priorities

EP	Enabling Prosperity
SC	Strengthening Communities
MB	Moving Better

Administrative Priorities

RA	Responsible Administration
OP	Our People

Deliverable	Completion
EP-02 Expedite the delivery of housing supply and support the development of complete communities with a mix of housing options and convenient access to goods, services, and facilities.	
Library Infrastructure <i>Service Area: Administrative Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A9</i> With major population growth and new neighborhood development within the municipality, the Library will identify locations for expansion of service.	31-Mar-27
Sheet Harbour Library <i>Service Area: Administrative Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A9</i> The Library will work collaboratively with the municipality, Parks & Recreation and Halifax Regional Fire & Emergency to build a new public library in Sheet Harbour that meets the community's needs.	31-Mar-27
Halifax Central Library Improvements <i>Service Area: Administrative Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: EP-02-A10</i> Enhance the Halifax Central Library's functionality and visitor experience through targeted facilities improvements, including elevator updates, new flooring, refreshed signage, and updates to the children's area.	31-Mar-28
SC-02 Improve municipal emergency response and recovery efforts to keep residents safe, protect property, and restore essential services and infrastructure following an emergency event.	
Sustainable and Resilient Communities <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-02-A5</i> The Library will work with community and partners to provide timely and important emergency preparation information to residents.	31-Mar-27
SC-03 Improve the well-being of community members at risk of or experiencing homelessness by enhancing supports and resources.	
Community Navigation <i>Service Area: Public Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-03-A2</i> The Library will partner with community organizations to build services, programs and staff capacity to help address the needs of community members at risk.	31-Mar-28

SC-04 Plan and invest in social infrastructure and opportunities for connection to increase residents' well-being and sense of belonging in their communities.	
Restoring Service to Dartmouth North Public Library <i>Service Area: Public Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A11</i> The Library will restore full library service to the Dartmouth North Public Library community by reopening the facility and re-establishing access to programs, collections and spaces disrupted by the closure.	31-Oct-27
Information Literacy <i>Service Area: Public Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A11</i> The Library will work to empower the community to recognize and navigate information and misinformation by offering programs and resources that build critical thinking and information evaluation skills.	31-Mar-28
Service to the North End Halifax Community <i>Service Area: Public Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A11</i> The Library will identify and implement alternative service locations and delivery approaches for Halifax North to ensure continued access to library programs, collections and supports during the renovation period.	31-Mar-28
Library Accessibility <i>Service Area: Public Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A11</i> The Library will work to identify and remove barriers to service in alignment with the Library Accessibility Plan.	31-Mar-28
Public Safety <i>Service Area: Public Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A11</i> The Library will demonstrate and champion approaches to public safety that prioritize accessible public spaces and social inclusion, reduce isolation, build community and respond to emergencies.	31-Mar-27
Social Isolation <i>Service Area: Public Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A11</i> Understanding the negative health impacts of social isolation, the Library will build services and programs that engage community members with one another and reduce social isolation.	31-Mar-27

Community Leadership <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A11</i> The Library will model excellence in community engagement, leveraging community partnership for public good.	31-Mar-27
Building Literacy <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: SC-04-A11</i> The Library will undertake initiatives to improve language literacy with a focus on youth and newcomers.	31-Mar-27
SC-05 Improve equitable access to municipal programs, services, indoor and outdoor spaces, and events for all residents.	
Digital Inclusion <i>Service Area: Executive Director's Office</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: Goal SC-05; no Action alignment</i> The Library will work to build digital inclusion and ensure that the public has access to the tools, resources and information they need.	31-Mar-27
RA-04 Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency, and cost effectiveness, while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.	
Improving Information Technology and Technical Services Infrastructure <i>Service Area: Administrative Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04-A11</i> The Library will centralize and strengthen collection services, delivery operations, information technology and home services to improve efficiency and its ability to respond to population growth.	31-Mar-28
Artificial Intelligence <i>Service Area: Administrative Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: RA-04-A11</i> The role of artificial intelligence in Library services will be assessed by evaluating potential applications, risks and benefits to inform approaches to uses.	31-Mar-28
OP-02: Strengthen the attraction and retention of people with the skills and behaviours needed to deliver municipal services.	
Employee Growth and Development <i>Service Area: Administrative Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-02-A2</i> The Library will develop and implement a performance management program that supports staff growth, accountability and organizational excellence.	31-Mar-27

Leadership Development <i>Service Area: Administrative Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-02-A2</i> The Library will develop a leadership development plan to build future leaders of the organization.	31-Mar-27
Internal Communications <i>Service Area: Administrative Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-02-A3</i> The Library will develop and enhance internal communication channels to support employee engagement, information sharing and connection.	31-Mar-27
OP-03: Increase employee access to learning and development opportunities.	
Employee Learning <i>Service Area: Administrative Services</i> <i>Action Plan Reference: OP-03-A1</i> The Library will develop a foundational training program that equips staff with the core knowledge and skills needed to deliver consistent, high-quality library service.	31-Mar-27

Summary of Net Expenditures - Halifax Public Libraries

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26		2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
B012 Collection Managemen	5,573,633	6,461,000	6,461,000	8,015,800	1,554,800	24.1
B015 IT Department	1,855,753	2,151,800	2,251,800	2,225,700	73,900	3.4
* Information Technology/Collecti	7,429,386	8,612,800	8,712,800	10,241,500	1,628,700	18.9
B011 Administrative Services	(2,588,133)	(4,130,100)	(3,595,300)	(3,825,400)	304,700	(7.4)
* Administrative Services	(2,588,133)	(4,130,100)	(3,595,300)	(3,825,400)	304,700	(7.4)
B013 Communications & Mkt	986,077	1,159,700	1,159,700	1,236,900	77,200	6.7
B014 Information Services	-	-	-	-	-	-
B021 Alderney Gate Library	1,567,914	2,016,900	2,016,900	2,041,100	24,200	1.2
B022 Alderney Gate Youth	-	-	-	-	-	-
B031 LKD Spr.Garden Gen	-	-	-	-	-	-
B032 LKDSpr. Gard Library	-	-	-	-	-	-
B033 Spring Garden Youth	-	-	-	-	-	-
B034 Central Library	5,332,627	6,195,100	6,245,100	6,444,400	249,300	4.0
B035 Central, Parkg/Plaza	-	-	-	-	-	-
B041 Branch Library Services	841,112	1,280,500	1,430,500	1,404,100	123,600	9.7
B042 Cole Harbour Library	1,103,399	1,220,300	1,220,300	1,240,000	19,700	1.6
B043 Dartmouth North Library	450,920	533,300	563,300	532,500	(800)	(0.2)
B044 Sackville Library	840,243	958,300	958,300	997,500	39,200	4.1
B045 Woodlawn Library	2,012,801	2,382,400	2,382,400	2,385,000	2,600	0.1
B046 Bedford Library	758,595	857,800	857,800	906,200	48,400	5.6
B047 Cpt Wil.Spry Library	749,317	836,900	836,900	913,500	76,600	9.2
B048 Halifax North Library	1,202,357	1,259,800	1,259,800	1,306,400	46,600	3.7
B049 Keshen Goodman Library	2,386,522	2,791,400	2,791,400	2,693,300	(98,100)	(3.5)
B050 Locked Outreach Services	-	-	-	-	-	-
B051 Musq. Harb. Library	452,509	471,300	471,300	496,200	24,900	5.3
B052 Shatford Memorial Library	427,449	428,600	448,600	460,400	31,800	7.4
B053 Sheet Harbour Library	375,975	389,200	389,200	413,800	24,600	6.3
B054 Tantallon Library	899,903	970,300	970,300	977,900	7,600	0.8
B055 Merchandise Sales	(3,472)	1,000	1,000	1,000	-	-
B056 East Preston Service	30,533	36,900	36,900	37,600	700	1.9
* Branches/Public Services	20,414,781	23,789,700	24,039,700	24,487,800	698,100	2.9
B064 English Language Learning	(56,958)	182,300	182,300	265,800	83,500	45.8
B065 Literacy	(5,605)	-	-	-	-	-
B074 ELL Ops	-	-	-	-	-	-
B075 Literacy Operations	-	-	-	-	-	-
* Eng. Lang. Learning/Literacy	(62,563)	182,300	182,300	265,800	83,500	45.8
** Library General Rate	25,193,471	28,454,700	29,339,500	31,169,700	2,715,000	9.5
B061 Restricted Grants	(47,414)	-	-	-	-	-
B062 Subsidized Salaries	0	-	-	-	-	-
B063 Restricted Donations	(14,857)	-	-	-	-	-
B066 Restricted - Lou Duggan	30,931	-	-	-	-	-
B067 Restricted Sun Life	5,921	-	-	-	-	-
* Restricted Funds	(25,419)	-	-	-	-	-
** Library Restricted Funds	(25,419)	-	-	-	-	-
B071 Capital Transactions	95,065	-	-	-	-	-
** Capital Transactions	95,065	-	-	-	-	-
*** Net Total	25,263,116	28,454,700	29,339,500	31,169,700	2,715,000	9.5

Summary of Expenditures Details - Halifax Public Libraries

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	19,567,750	21,562,000	21,562,000	22,599,000	1,037,000	4.8
6002 Salaries - Overtime	57,938	-	-	-	-	-
6003 Wages - Regular	6,205	-	-	-	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	(2,267,871)	-	-	-	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	15,329	-	-	-	-	-
6099 Other Allowances	2,450	-	-	-	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	4,051,580	4,617,000	4,617,000	4,859,000	242,000	5.2
6101 Benefits - Wages	742	-	-	-	-	-
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(1,977,400)	(977,400)	(1,592,000)	385,400	(19.5)
6152 Retirement Incentives	117,190	215,000	215,000	194,000	(21,000)	(9.8)
6154 Workers' Compensation	142,490	168,000	168,000	190,000	22,000	13.1

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6155 Overtime Meals	180	-	-	-	-	-
6158 WCB Recov Earnings	(796)	-	-	-	-	-
6194 Sick Bank allowance	(166,412)	-	-	-	-	-
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	57,504	-	-	-	-	-
9210 HR CATS OT Wage/Ben	10,330	-	-	-	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	21,594,610	24,584,600	25,584,600	26,250,000	1,665,400	6.8
6201 Telephone/Cable	76,213	125,000	125,000	139,700	14,700	11.8
6202 Courier/Postage	25,591	27,000	27,000	30,000	3,000	11.1
6203 Office Furn/Equip	226,061	222,300	222,300	229,000	6,700	3.0
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	246,335	260,000	260,000	290,000	30,000	11.5
6205 Printing & Reprod	28,389	37,000	37,000	37,000	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	67,454	44,400	44,400	58,000	13,600	30.6
6208 Binding	6,433	10,000	10,000	10,000	-	-
6299 Other Office Expenses	82,645	65,000	65,000	75,000	10,000	15.4
* Office	759,122	790,700	790,700	868,700	78,000	9.9
6301 Professional Fees	31,666	25,000	25,000	30,000	5,000	20.0
6302 Legal Fees	33,891	20,000	20,000	20,000	-	-
6303 Consulting Fees	46,623	-	41,000	-	-	-
6304 Janitorial Services	757,518	796,500	796,500	813,000	16,500	2.1
6308 Snow Removal	85,637	86,000	86,000	89,000	3,000	3.5
6311 Security	67,618	36,000	56,000	43,000	7,000	19.4
6312 Refuse Collection	34,969	42,000	42,000	47,000	5,000	11.9
6399 Contract Services	466,047	462,500	462,500	518,000	55,500	12.0
* External Services	1,523,969	1,468,000	1,529,000	1,560,000	92,000	6.3
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	1,915	1,200	1,200	1,200	-	-
6406 Bridge Tolls	1,757	2,400	2,400	2,400	-	-
6407 Clean/Sani Supplies	20,342	10,000	10,000	10,000	-	-
6499 Other Supplies	71,746	75,000	75,000	75,000	-	-
* Supplies	95,761	88,600	88,600	88,600	-	-
6602 Electrical	30,089	-	-	-	-	-
6603 Grnds & Landscaping	5,805	33,500	33,500	31,000	(2,500)	(7.5)
6605 Municipal Taxes	238,316	237,000	237,000	353,200	116,200	49.0
6607 Electricity	506,596	488,000	488,000	575,600	87,600	18.0
6608 Water	44,321	42,000	42,000	42,000	-	-
6609 Elevator & Escalator	20,718	27,500	27,500	27,500	-	-
6610 Building - Exterior	2,167	-	-	-	-	-
6611 Building - Interior	2,650	-	-	-	-	-
6612 Safety Systems	6,673	6,000	6,000	6,000	-	-
6616 Natural Gas-Buildings	203,708	172,600	172,600	172,600	-	-
6617 Pest Management	5,887	-	-	-	-	-
6699 Other Building Cost	766,083	520,000	570,000	520,000	-	-
* Building Costs	1,833,012	1,526,600	1,576,600	1,727,900	201,300	13.2
6701 Equipment Purchase	173,291	430,500	680,500	430,500	-	-
6702 Small Tools	887	5,000	5,000	5,000	-	-
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	1,698	-	-	-	-	-
6705 Equip - R&M	2,946	-	-	-	-	-
6706 Computer R&M	50,971	50,000	50,000	50,000	-	-
6707 Plumbing & Heating	9,394	-	-	-	-	-
6708 Mechanical Equipment	43,231	26,000	56,000	26,000	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	282,418	511,500	791,500	511,500	-	-
6901 Membership Dues	29,475	25,000	25,000	25,000	-	-
6903 Travel - Local	42,846	50,000	50,000	50,000	-	-
6904 Travel - Out of Town	71,962	70,000	70,000	60,000	(10,000)	(14.3)
6905 Training & Education	141,555	120,000	120,000	110,000	(10,000)	(8.3)
6911 Facilities Rental	1,253,151	1,679,600	1,429,600	2,172,100	492,500	29.3
6912 Advertising/Promotio	45,369	56,000	56,000	56,000	-	-
6913 Awards	-	8,200	8,200	13,200	5,000	61.0
6917 Books and Periodicals	3,124,637	3,387,300	3,387,300	3,678,100	290,800	8.6
6918 Meals/Catering	126,616	3,000	3,000	13,000	10,000	333.3
6928 Committee Expenses	2,226	7,000	7,000	7,000	-	-
6936 Staff Relations	-	12,100	12,100	17,100	5,000	41.3
6938 Rewarding Excellence	36,609	-	-	-	-	-
6950 Region.Serv.Program	619,547	231,000	231,000	231,000	-	-
6954 Cash over/under	(67)	-	-	-	-	-
6999 Other Goods/Services	10,253	11,000	11,000	11,000	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
* Other Goods & Services	5,504,177	5,660,200	5,410,200	6,443,500	783,300	13.8
7009 Internal Trfr Other	10,268	9,200	9,200	9,200	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	6,131	24,000	24,000	24,000	-	-
* Interdepartmental	16,399	33,200	33,200	33,200	-	-
8016 Provision for Allow	61,756	-	-	-	-	-
8022 Transf to/fr Trust	(2,863)	(2,400)	(2,400)	(2,400)	-	-
8045 Amortization Expense	648,337	-	-	-	-	-
* Other Fiscal	707,229	(2,400)	(2,400)	(2,400)	-	-
** Total	32,316,697	34,661,000	35,802,000	37,481,000	2,820,000	8.1

Summary of Revenues Details - Halifax Public Libraries

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4703 Cond. Grant NS(Other)	(5,530,500)	(5,530,500)	(5,786,700)	(5,530,500)	-	-
* Transfers from other Gov'ts	(5,530,500)	(5,530,500)	(5,786,700)	(5,530,500)	-	-
4902 Fines Fees	(8,355)	(6,500)	(6,500)	(6,500)	-	-
5101 Parking Rentals	(204,475)	(224,000)	(224,000)	(234,000)	(10,000)	4.5
5102 Facilities Rentals	(63,755)	(90,000)	(90,000)	(100,000)	(10,000)	11.1
5227 Photocopier Revenue	(86,691)	(84,800)	(84,800)	(109,800)	(25,000)	29.5
* Fee Revenues	(363,275)	(405,300)	(405,300)	(450,300)	(45,000)	11.1
5520 Donations	(166,929)	(20,000)	(20,000)	(30,000)	(10,000)	50.0
5600 Miscellaneous Revenue	(992,876)	(250,500)	(250,500)	(300,500)	(50,000)	20.0
* Other Revenue	(1,159,805)	(270,500)	(270,500)	(330,500)	(60,000)	22.2
** Total	(7,053,581)	(6,206,300)	(6,462,500)	(6,311,300)	(105,000)	1.7
*** Net Total	25,263,116	28,454,700	29,339,500	31,169,700	2,715,000	9.5

HALIFAX

RESERVES

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

RESERVES

2026/27 BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

RESERVES OVERVIEW

Reserves are established following the guidelines outlined in the Provincial Financial Reporting and Accounting Manual, Section 3.15 and Section 3.16. Also, the Halifax Regional Municipality Charter, section 120 (1) states that “the Municipality shall maintain a capital reserve fund.” Section 120(3) states “The capital reserve fund includes:

- a) funds received from the sale of property;
- b) the proceeds of insurance resulting from loss or damage of property that is not used for replacement, repair or reconstruction of the property;
- c) any surplus remaining from the sale of debentures that is not used for the purpose for which the debentures were issued;
- d) the surplus remaining in a sinking fund when the debentures for which it was established are repaid;
- e) any capital grant not expended in the year in which it was paid;
- f) proceeds received from the winding up of a municipal enterprise as defined in the Municipal Finance Corporation Act;
- g) the current fiscal year’s accrual for landfill closure and post closure costs; and
- h) amounts transferred to the fund by the Council.”

Section 120(4) states “A withdrawal from the capital reserve fund shall be authorized by the Council, by resolution, and may only be used for:

- a) capital expenditures for which the Municipality may borrow;
- b) repayment of the principal portion of capital debt; and
- c) landfill closure and post closure costs.”

Section 120(6) states that “the Municipality may maintain other reserve funds for such purposes as the Council may determine”.

In addition, On October 15, 2014, Council approved the Financial Reserves Administrative Order Number 2014-015 ADM which implemented the following strategies:

- a) assist in planning for the long-term financial health and stability of the Municipality;
- b) assist in removing unstable and unpredictable tax rates;
- c) integrate the reserve business cases into the business planning and long-term operating and capital budgets;
- d) ensure the Municipality has the ability to fund projects and events:
 - a. that produce long-term efficiency gains,
 - b. that are strategic or require significant cost sharing between the Municipality and another person or level of government,
 - c. between budget approvals where there is sudden or unexpected business opportunity,
 - d. where future obligations can be reasonable foreseen, and
 - e. where substantial risk to the Municipality may occur.
- e) reduce the current and future financial impacts to the taxpayer by minimizing significant budget fluctuations and reliance on debt financing by balancing the need for sufficient funds for unforeseen opportunities or

obligations with the inefficient use of resources that could otherwise be used for current financial obligations or needs.

- f) has a provision for funding emergencies which include the procedure and processes for the transfer of funds between reserves other than as prescribed by the business case in the case of a funding emergency.

Other aspects of the Administrative Order include the payment of interest to the reserves, the segregating of each reserve in the accounting records, and ensuring that reserves will not be in a deficit position.

In general, reserve funds are intended to serve three specific themes:

Contingency funds for risk recognize that:

- a) the financial risk of unforeseen events involving substantial costs, such as emergencies or economic events; and that a reserve can mitigate this risk by providing funding for sufficient public safety or preventing service interruptions.

Savings funds for future - obligations recognizes that:

- a) an obligation may be associated with recapitalization of a specific asset where the estimated lifecycle cost of an asset can be reasonably estimated;
- b) an obligation associated with a strategic plan where the asset or project may not yet be specified, such as the purchase of land; and
- c) a future expenditure may be managed through the long-term operating or capital budget, depending on the magnitude or situation of the obligation.

Contingency funds for opportunities recognize that:

- a) not all expenditures are planned or anticipated, and
- b) an opportunity may arise to develop services or achieve efficiencies and that the Municipality must react rapidly or lose that opportunity, such as a sudden change in the economy or the introduction of cost shared programs from other levels of government or the private sector.

The Reserves that fit into each of these themes are below:

RISK RESERVE

Q416 RISK & RISILIENCY RESERVE:

PURPOSE

The intent of the Risk and Resiliency Reserve is to accumulate funds to deal with the risk of unforeseen events involving substantial costs, so that HRM can mitigate, adapt and recover from such an event. Risk events covered include economic, financial, environmental, service related, health and safety, and legal and compliance risks.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Regional Council; and,
- b) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Funds are allocated for:

- a) funding of claims and settlements as appropriate;
- b) covering the costs of risk events over and above any amounts budgeted;
- c) the payment of principle, as it relates to a risk event;
- d) the payment of interest, as it relates to a risk event, if the underlying funds are not raised by the sale of asset; and,
- e) other operating and capital costs as related to a risk event, as appropriate.

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

The reserve, combined with the Options reserve, will have a minimum balance of 5% of adjusted operating expenditures and a target balance of 2 months of adjusted operating expenditures.

OBLIGATION RESERVES

Q506 LANDFILL CLOSURE AND POST CLOSURE COSTS RESERVE:

PURPOSE

To provide funding for the closure and post closure of landfills, as required by the Public Sector Accounting Board (PSAB). Currently, three landfill sites exist: Sackville, Otter Lake and Mengoni. Specific closure and post closure activities including environmental monitoring programs may be outlined in regulatory approvals for each site (issued by NS Environment).

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) transfers from the Solid Waste Resources operating budget;
- b) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Council; and,
- c) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Funds are allocated for costs related to closure and post-closure care and include, but are not limited to:

- a) purchase of equipment and site assets.
- b) development, construction, and removal of infrastructure.
- c) maintenance and upgrades for all site assets.
- d) landfill cover (capping)
- e) environmental monitoring; and,
- f) leachate and gas management.

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

A maximum/minimum balance has not been set for this reserve.

Q511 MUNICIPAL ELECTION RESERVE:

PURPOSE

To provide funding to conduct regular and special Municipal elections.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) an annual allocation of 25% of the estimated cost of the next municipal election and any anticipated by-elections;
- b) an annual allocation for the estimated costs of the District Boundary Review;
- c) any plebiscite or any other election for which HRM has responsibility;
- d) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Council; and,
- e) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Funds are allocated for:

- a) conducting special and regular municipal elections pursuant to legislation;
- b) legal and other costs for any required District Boundary Review; and,
- c) routine maintenance of election data, systems and election initiatives deemed necessary to ensure critical information is current and in place for special and regular elections.

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

The reserve has been established to provide funds for the municipal election. The balance is expected to reach the cost to run a municipal election plus any byelections during the term of Regional Council.

Q521 CONVENTION CENTRE RESERVE:

PURPOSE

To provide funding to reimburse the Province for HRM's share of the Halifax Convention Centre (HCC) costs including the capital costs for its construction (through an annual base rent payment), the operating costs and any operating deficit, as per a Memorandum of Understanding Agreement ("MOU") between the Province and HRM.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) total revenues from all commercial property taxes levied on the Nova Centre property, including all municipal and provincial area rates and fire protection charges, and any Deed Transfer Tax associated with the property. Contributions to reserve excludes:
 - i) amounts for area improvement and promotion, Business Improvement Districts, (BID's),
 - ii) amounts collected for stormwater charges under By-law C-900, the Charges for Stormwater from Municipal Streets By law, and,
 - iii) any portion of the commercial general rated property tax revenues levied on the Halifax Convention Centre that are not considered a shareable annual cost under Section 4 of the MOU;
- b) funds for the former World Trade and Convention Centre;
- c) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Council; and,

- d) interest accumulated in accordance with the Corporate Guidelines respecting Reserves.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

As per the terms and conditions of the MOU, funds are allocated for:

- a) rent payments to cover HRM's share of the capital costs amortized over 25-year lease; and,
- b) HRM's share of annual operating costs of the Halifax Convention Centre (Nova Centre).

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

A maximum/minimum balance has not been set for this reserve.

Q546 MULTI-DISTRICT FACILITIES RESERVE:

PURPOSE

The intent of the Multi-District Facilities Recapitalization Reserve is to accumulate funds to upgrade, renovate and replace the various multi-district facilities including the Scotiabank Centre. By doing so the reserve enables the municipality to plan for the replacement and upgrade of significant community facilities while maintaining a stable, predictable property tax level.

The Multi-District facilities include event, and some indoor sport facilities as designated by Council. Currently, the Multi-District facilities include the following HRM owned assets: Alderney Landing, Halifax 4 Pad, Canada Games Centre, Cole Harbour Place, Zatsman Sportsplex, Halifax Forum, Sackville Sports Stadium, Scotiabank Centre and St. Margaret's Centre. Council may adjust the Multi-District Facilities listing to include other facilities.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) amounts transferred to the fund from Multi-District Facilities including as per operating agreements and naming rights;
- b) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Regional Council; and,
- c) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Funds are allocated for:

- a) construction, design and build of Multi-District facilities;
- b) renovation of Multi-District facilities;
- c) the payment of principle; and,
- d) the payment of interest, if the underlying funds are not raised by the sale of assets.

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

A maximum/minimum balance has not been set for this reserve.

Q556 SOLID WASTE FACILITIES RESERVE:

PURPOSE

The intent of the Solid Waste Recapitalization Reserve is to accumulate funds to upgrade and replace solid waste facilities. By doing so the reserve enables the municipality to plan for the replacement and upgrade of solid waste facilities while maintaining a stable, predictable property tax level.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Regional Council;
- b) the Capital Cost Charge (CCC's) for Solid Waste Facilities as incorporated into Bylaws C-600, respecting Regional Capital Cost Charges and C-800, respecting Regional Capital Cost Charges for Solid Waste; and,
- c) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Funds are allocated for:

- a) construction, design and build of solid waste facilities;
- b) the payment of principle; and,
- c) the payment of interest, if the underlying funds are not raised by the sale of assets.

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

A maximum/minimum balance has not been set for this reserve.

Q566 MASTER PLAN RESERVE:

RESERVE DELETION

As part of the municipality's review of reserves, this reserve will be collapsed in 2026/27.

PURPOSE

The intent of the Master Plan Reserve is to accumulate funds that are levied as part of the Master Plan process, including Regional and specific Master Plan Area charges.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Regional Council;
- b) any amount levied as part of a capital cost contribution or development charge, other than solid waste levies under by-law C-600, which are contributed to the Solid Waste Reserve, and funds collected on behalf of Halifax Water; and,

- c) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Funds are allocated for the purposes allowed under legislation and any by-law that establishes a master plan levy. This may include:

- a) land purchases;
- b) growth-related capital projects;
- c) studies relating to the establishment of a specific capital charge or to a growth-related capital project; and,
- d) the payment of principal and interest related to a) and b) above.

Q621 COMMUNITY AND EVENTS RESERVE:

PURPOSE

To provide funding to attract and host exceptional large-scale sporting and tourism events that create economic benefit, promote Halifax as major event destination, and improve tourism flows to HRM.

To provide funding to community non-profit and public institutions in support of major capital initiatives by facilitating the development of significant community infrastructure to realize tangible cultural, sectoral, and economic impacts on a national, provincial, regional, or sectoral scale.

To provide funding to support the principles and objectives of the Cultural Plan and the HRM Public Art Policy.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) a transfer of 40% of the Provincial Hotel Sales Tax (Marketing Levy);
- b) a transfer from Fiscal Services operating budget;
- c) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Council; and
- d) interest accumulated in accordance with the Corporate Guidelines respecting Reserves.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Funds are allocated for:

- a) support to events that support tourism and economic development through the Marketing Levy grant program;
- b) Cultural/Heritage projects;
- e) significant community infrastructure (non-profit and public institutions); and,
- f) Public Art.

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

A maximum/minimum balance has not been set for this reserve.

OPPORTUNITY RESERVES

Q421 OPTIONS RESERVE:

PURPOSE

To provide resources for changes or additions to services or for grants to outside agencies.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Regional Council,
- b) any municipal surplus, other than any amount otherwise designated by Regional Council for a different reserve; and,
- c) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

- a) operating costs, including grants; and,
- b) funding of capital projects;

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

The reserve, combined with the Options reserve, will have a minimum balance of 5% of adjusted operating expenditures and a target balance of 2 months of adjusted operating expenditures.

Q666 STRATEGIC INITIATIVE CAPITAL RESERVE:

PURPOSE

To provide funding for large capital projects that are part of the Strategic Initiatives outlined by council.

The intent of the Strategic Initiatives Reserve is to accumulate funds to pay for the principal and interest costs associated with Strategic Initiatives. By doing so the reserve enables the municipality to achieve its Strategic Initiatives through leveraging debt while maintaining a stable, predictable property tax level.

“Strategic Initiatives” were identified in Regional Council’s Fiscal Sustainability Strategy (December 15, 2020) and the Strategic Initiative Funding Plan (January 20, 2021). They are defined as “those whose implementation would require a discernible increase to the tax rate in order to move forward.”

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Regional Council;
- b) annual transfer from Fiscal Services operating budget;
- c) funds raised by the Strategic Infrastructure and Climate Fund tax rate; and,
- d) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Funds are allocated for:

- a) to fund principal and interest costs incurred related to debentures on Strategic Initiative projects, as identified by Regional Council;
- b) projects must be eligible for debentures and be capital in nature; and,
- c) as per the Halifax Charter, any funds transferred to the reserve from the sale of an asset may be used for the payment of principle, but not the payment of interest.

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

The expected balance of the reserve is based on contributions estimated to cover anticipated principal and interest costs using assumed debenture dates for Strategic Initiatives. Maintaining this balance ensures funds are available to offset debt payments, allowing the municipality to support higher debt levels while keeping tax rates stable and predictable. As the expected balance is driven by the timing and value of future debentures, no maximum balance has been established.

Q667 STRATEGIC INITIATIVE OPERATING RESERVE:

RESERVE DELETION

As part of the municipality's review of reserves, this reserve will be collapsed in 2026/27.

PURPOSE

To provide funding for the operating costs associated with large capital projects that are part of the Strategic Initiative Projects outlined by council.

The intent of the Strategic Initiatives Reserve-Operating is to accumulate funds to pay for the operating costs associated with Strategic Initiative Projects. By doing so the reserve enables the municipality to achieve its Strategic Initiatives while maintaining a stable, predictable property tax level.

This reserve is governed by the Halifax Regional Municipality Charter Section 120(1), (3) and (4).

"Strategic Initiatives" were identified in Regional Council's Fiscal Sustainability Strategy (December 15, 2020)) and the Strategic Initiative Funding Plan (January 20, 2021). They are defined as "those whose implementation would require a discernible increase to the tax rate in order to move forward."

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Regional Council; and,
- b) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Funds are allocated for:

- a) to fund costs incurred related to completion of Strategic Initiative projects, as identified by Regional Council; and,
- b) funding is for project costs but exclude any ongoing operating costs.

Q611 PARKLAND DEVELOPMENT RESERVE:

PURPOSE

The intent of the Parkland Development Reserve is to accumulate funds from the parkland dedication fees (cash-in-lieu) received through the development and subdivision process and for the acquisition of, and capital improvements to, parks, playgrounds and similar public purposes.

The Reserve is governed by Halifax Regional Municipality Charter Section 283.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) funds received under Halifax Regional Municipality Charter Section 283(1) and the Regional Subdivision By-law;
- b) funds received from sale of property no longer needed for parks, playgrounds or similar public purposes, pursuant to Halifax Regional Municipality Charter Section 283(14);
- c) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Regional Council; and,
- d) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Per the Halifax Regional Municipality Charter Section 283(5): Funds are allocated for the acquisition of, and capital improvements to parks, playgrounds, and similar public purposes.

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

The reserve has been established both to fulfill the legal requirements of Section 283 of the Halifax Charter. Funds received as Parkland Dedication Fees and any sale of assets are generally unplanned and subject to development trends. As such, a targeted reserve level cannot be easily estimated and a maximum balance has not been set for this reserve.

Q616 BUSINESS/INDUSTRIAL PARKS EXPANSION RESERVE:

PURPOSE

The intent is to ensure HRM has flexibility to purchase and improve infrastructure for select strategic land to ensure improved functioning of the local land market. Funding to come through sale of land in HRM business and industrial parks.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) net revenues from the sale of land in HRM business and industrial parks;
- b) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Council; and
- c) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Funds are allocated for: business and industrial park land acquisition;

- a) Business and industrial park land acquisition;
- b) Infrastructure expenditures necessary to ensure lands are marketable; and,

- c) principal and interest costs incurred related to debentures for business park projects, as identified by Regional Council.

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

A maximum/minimum balance has not been set for this reserve.

Q626 - CANADA COMMUNITY BUILDING RESERVE

PURPOSE

The intent of the Canada Community Building Reserve is to accumulate funds from the Canada Community Building Fund, more commonly known as the Gas Tax. These funds will supplement available capital funding from capital from operating and debt.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) amounts transferred to the fund from the Canada Building Community Fund;
- b) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Regional Council; and,
- c) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Funds are allocated for projects that meet the eligibility criteria of the Canada Community Building Fund, including:

- a) capital projects;
- b) land purchases;
- c) the payment of principle;
- d) the payment of interest, if the underlying funds are not raised by the sale of assets; and,
- e) landfill closure and post-closure costs.

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

A maximum/minimum balance has not been set for this reserve.

Q640 DENSITY BONUS RESERVE

PURPOSE

The reserve facilitates the implementation of the incentive or bonus zoning policies as contained in applicable municipal planning strategies and land use by-laws.

An effective reserve will improve transparency and simplify (bonus zoning) funding for affordable housing, heritage properties, public art, municipal parks, and community or cultural space, in addition to other Municipal funding sources and reserves.

Funds may only be expended in accordance with the *HRM Charter*, applicable land use by-laws, and used for the purpose for which the money was accepted.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Sources of funds will include:

- a) incentive or bonus zoning money-in-lieu payments as required by the applicable land use by-laws.
- b) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Council; and,
- c) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

- a) As per the Halifax Regional Municipality Charter Subsection 245A (6), the Municipality shall use any money accepted in-lieu of a contribution for the purpose for which the money was accepted;
- b) Funding allocation for the public benefits will be in accordance with the applicable land use by-laws; and
- c) Fund expenditures will be in accordance with any Administrative Orders approved by Council.

Q526 CAPITAL FUND RESERVE:

PURPOSE

The intent of the Capital Fund Reserve is to accumulate funds from the operating surplus and the sale of municipal assets, as well as other funds for the renewal and expansion of its asset base. These funds will supplement available capital funding from capital from operating and debt.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Regional Council;
- b) sale of all municipal assets, other than the sale of Business/Industrial Parks land, the sale of land conveyed to HRM for parks, playgrounds or other similar public purposes under section 282 of the Halifax Regional Municipality Charter and any amount otherwise designated by Regional Council for a different reserve;
- c) all funds designated for the Capital Reserve Fund, as per Section 120 of the *Halifax Charter*, other than the current fiscal year's accrual for landfill closure and post closure costs and any amount otherwise designated by Regional Council for a different reserve; and,
- d) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Funds are allocated for:

- a) capital projects, including cost overruns and changes in scope,
- b) land purchases,
- c) the payment of principle,
- d) the payment of interest, if the underlying funds are not raised by the sale of assets, and,

- e) landfill closure and post-closure costs.

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

The reserve has been established both to fulfill the legal requirements of Section 120 of the Halifax Charter and to provide funds for capital projects that are supplementary to any capital from operating funding or anticipated debt funding. The reserve minimum balance is set at 10% of the average annual asset consumption and a target balance 50% of average annual asset consumption.

Q601 EXTRAORDINARY INVESTIGATION RESERVE

PURPOSE

The purpose of the Police Extraordinary Investigation Reserve is to provide a dedicated funding source to address unanticipated and extraordinary police investigative costs that fall outside routine policing activities and exceed the approved annual police operating budget.

The Reserve is intended to ensure Halifax Regional Police can respond promptly and effectively to investigations that are exceptional in scale, complexity, urgency, sensitivity, or public safety impact, while maintaining transparency, accountability, and compliance with legislative requirements.

SOURCE OF FUNDS

Funding arises from:

- a) amounts transferred to the fund as approved by Regional Council; and,
- b) accumulated interest.

APPLICATION OF FUNDS

Funds from the Police Extraordinary Investigation Reserve may be allocated only for costs directly attributable to extraordinary investigations, including but not limited to:

- a) major criminal investigations requiring extended duration or specialized expertise;
- b) critical incidents such as officer-involved shootings or deaths in custody;
- c) multi-jurisdictional or inter-agency investigations;
- d) investigations involving significant threats to public safety or national security;
- e) highly sensitive or confidential matters; and
- f) investigations mandated by external legal or regulatory authorities; and
- g) post investigation reporting regarding the use of the reserve must be completed.

The following conditions must be met prior to accessing the Reserve:

- a) the investigation meets the definition of an extraordinary investigation;
- b) costs are unanticipated, unbudgeted, and exceed the approved operating budget;
- c) costs are operationally necessary and directly related to the investigation;
- d) written notice is provided by the Chief of Police to the CAO and CFO identifying the estimated amount; and
- e) all expenditures comply with applicable legislation and municipal policy.
- f) reserve funds shall not be used for routine police operations.

Definition of Extraordinary Investigations

Extraordinary investigations are defined as investigations that fall outside the scope of routine policing due to their complexity, scale, sensitivity, or urgency, and which require significant, unanticipated resources beyond the approved operating budget. These may include, but are not limited to:

- Major criminal investigations involving organized crime, homicides, or other serious offences requiring

extended duration or specialized expertise.

- Critical incidents such as officer-involved shootings, deaths in custody, or other events that may trigger oversight by external bodies.
- Multi-jurisdictional or inter-agency investigations requiring coordination with provincial, federal, or international partners.
- Investigations involving significant threats to public safety or national security.
- Highly sensitive or confidential matters, including those involving public officials or systemic misconduct.
- Investigations mandated by external legal or regulatory authorities that exceed the scope of normal operations.

ANTICIPATED BALANCES

The reserve should maintain a minimum balance of \$2 million. If funds are used from the reserve they should be replenished in the subsequent fiscal year

RESERVE FUNDS BUDGET

Projected Net Available Balances

	2025/26 (as of Dec 31/25)	2026/27	2027/28	2028/29
Risk Reserve				
Q416 Operating Stabilization Reserve	\$ 19,014,962	\$ 22,154,472	\$ 25,902,164	\$ 29,761,252
Total	\$ 19,014,962	\$ 22,154,472	\$ 25,902,164	\$ 29,761,252
Obligation Reserve				
Q506 Landfill Closure Costs	\$ 23,163,130	\$ 26,475,162	\$ 28,050,878	\$ 29,673,431
Q511 Municipal Election Reserve	2,239,653	3,171,192	4,140,718	5,139,062
Q521 Convention Centre Reserve	9,584,274	10,788,185	12,024,278	13,297,112
Q536 Library Recapitalization Reserve	(0)	(0)	(0)	(0)
Q546 Multi District Facilities Reserve	5,358,167	3,992,292	5,322,111	6,711,829
Q556 Solid Waste Facilities Reserve	12,473,139	10,022,447	9,208,252	5,980,897
Q566 Master Plan Reserve	2,336,236	-	-	-
Q616 Business/Industrial Parks Expansion	42,267,872	86,780,960	101,091,053	136,100,735
Q621 Community and Events Reserve	8,210,922	6,397,595	7,735,899	9,113,983
Total	\$ 105,633,392	\$ 147,627,832	\$ 167,573,188	\$ 206,017,049
Opportunity Reserve				
Q666 SI Capital	\$ 165,665,158	\$ 203,439,335	\$ 226,827,330	\$ 245,571,905
Q667 SI Operating	7,028,814	-	-	-
Q611 Parkland Development Reserve	11,033,962	12,134,229	13,267,200	14,433,847
Q626 Gas Tax Reserve	7,279,045	8,858,062	8,541,225	8,693,792
Q640 Density Bonus	2,831,904	2,401,218	1,957,729	1,501,059
Q421 Options Reserve	13,614,208	17,709,547	18,697,159	19,714,127
Q526 Capital Fund Reserve	21,155,418	21,549,788	17,378,433	17,546,943
Q601 Investigation Reserve	-	2,059,448	2,120,663	2,183,698
Total	\$ 228,608,509	\$ 268,151,626	\$ 288,789,739	\$ 309,645,371
Total Reserve Projected Balances	\$ 353,256,862	\$ 437,933,931	\$ 482,265,092	\$ 545,423,672

GLOSSARY

Accrual Basis	Accounting for expenses and revenues as they are incurred, not when funds are disbursed or received (see Cash Basis).
Area-Rates	Similar to Property Tax Rates, except that the tax is applied only to real property in a specified area for the purpose of funding a specific service that benefits that area only (Compare Regional Area Rate).
Assessment Roll	The assessed value of all properties within the municipality as provided by PVSC.
Assets	An asset is a resource with economic value that an individual, corporation or government owns or controls with the expectation that it will provide a future benefit.
Balance Sheet	Summary of assets, liabilities, and equity. The total value of assets must equal the sum of the total liabilities and equity.
Base Budget/Base Case	The budget amounts required to provide the same level of service as was provided in the prior year.
Base General Tax Rate	The general property tax rate applicable to all taxable properties within HRM.
Budget Envelopes	Sum of funding allocated to a business unit within which to develop a budget. Operating budget envelopes are net of (after) business unit revenues. Capital budget envelopes are net of reserves, area rates, LICs, CCC, and external cost sharing.
Business Plans	Include program objectives, outcomes desired, resources required and performance measures used to determine whether outcomes have been achieved.
Business Units	High-level corporate divisions based on major services.
CAO	Chief Administration Officer
Capital Asset	An asset is a resource with economic value that an individual, corporation or government owns or controls with the expectation that it will provide a future benefit.
Capital Charges	Another name for Local Improvement Charges (LICs).
Capital Plan	Refers to the capital projects under consideration for the next three years. While the capital plan has the same level of detail, costing and funding as the capital budget, Council can only approve the second and third years “in principle”.
Capital Cost Contribution (CCC)	Funding provided by developers which is used to offset the costs stemming from new or expanded municipal infrastructure required as the result of new development. Sometimes called Development Charges.
Capital Budget	The Council-approved expenditures and defined funding sources for projects supporting significant rehabilitative maintenance,

	construction, purchase or demolition of municipal infrastructure or equipment. Capital activities are differentiated from routine operational repairs and maintenance and exclude purchase of small equipment and inventory that occur in the regular course of business.
Capital District	The regional centre for government, finance, culture, entertainment and business. It encompasses downtown Halifax, downtown Dartmouth, and the Spring Garden Road, Quinpool Road and Gottingen Street areas.
Capital from Operating	Refers to capital projects which are funded directly from operating funds. For that reason, it is often referred to as “pay-as-you-go” capital funding.
Capital Reserve Pool (Crespool)	Budget remaining, following completion of a capital project, which was approved to be funded from debt. These funds may be used to provide additional debt funding for capital projects which are over-budget or may be used in future budgets. It cannot be used for new projects or to expand the scope of existing projects.
Capitalize	The amortization of capital costs over a period of years, usually equal to or less than the anticipated life of the resulting capital asset or improvements to it.
Cash Basis or received	Accounting for expenses and revenues as the funds are disbursed.
CCC	See Capital Cost Contribution.
Citizen	A person who resides in HRM.
Collective Agreement	Legal agreement between an employer and a union representing a group of employees which details the terms and conditions of employment such as wages and benefits.
Commercial Assessment	The market value of real property (land and buildings) used for commercial purposes as assessed by the PVSC.
Commercial General Tax Rates	The general rate of taxation applied to the market value of real property used for commercial purposes, expressed per \$100 of assessed value. Council levies Urban, Suburban and Rural General Tax Rates.
Commercial Multiplier	A factor that was formerly used to calculate commercial tax rates as a function of residential rates.
Committee of the Whole (COW)	When all members of Regional Council meet as a committee, not in a session of Council. Council cannot pass resolutions when meeting as a Committee of the Whole. Council uses a special Budget COW to debate the Budget.
Consumer Price Index (CPI)	An indicator of changes in consumer prices. It is obtained by comparing through time, the cost of a fixed basket of commodities purchased by consumers as determined by Statistics Canada.

Cost Drivers	Cost pressures which may present challenges to business units in terms of developing more cost-effective ways of providing service within budget.
Debenture	A written promise to pay a specified sum of money called the face value or principal amount at a specified date or dates in future, called maturity dates, together with periodic interest at a specified rate. In Nova Scotia, municipal debentures are provided by the Nova Scotia Department of Finance and Treasury Board to finance capital projects.
Debenture Discount	When the market interest rate exceeds the stated debenture rate, the debenture sells at a discount. When the opposite is true, the debenture sells at a premium. On fixed term securities such as debentures, it is appropriate to amortize any discount or premium arising on purchase of the security over the period to maturity.
Debt	The outstanding principal repayable on loans provided by the Municipal Finance Corporation.
Debt Servicing Policy	The policy which places limits on the debt which may be issued during a fiscal year.
Deed Transfer Tax	Tax levied on the arms-length transfer of real property (land and buildings), which is payable at the time of conveyance of the title, and is based on the purchase price. The rate has been set by Council as 1.5% of the purchase price.
Deficit	At the end of the fiscal year, the amount by which the municipality's operating expenditures exceeds its operating revenues.
Director	The most senior management position within a Business Unit.
Education Rate	Part of the formula used by the Province of Nova Scotia to determine how much each Municipality pays to the Province for Education. The Education Rate is the rate per \$100 of assessed value which is applied to the previous year's Uniform Assessment to determine the Mandatory Education contribution required from each municipal government within Nova Scotia.
EMO	Emergency Measures Organization
Fee Revenue	User fees such as parking meter revenue, rentals, etc.
Fire Protection Rate	A tax levied on assessable property in an area served by a water system to recover that part of the cost of the water system which is directly attributable to fire protection.
Fiscal Framework	A financial projection showing revenues, expenditures, debt and other information using a consistent set of assumptions. It is used for budgeting purposes and for longer-term projections.

Fiscal Year	April 1 to March 31.
Fiscal Services	Section of the Operating Budget which includes non-departmental expenditures such as mandatory payments to the Province of Nova Scotia, most debt charges (except those related to Transit Services, Wastewater and Solid Waste), payments to reserves, Capital from Operating, Capital and Operating Grants, the surplus or deficit from the prior fiscal year, etc.
FTE	Full Time Equivalent. A unit of labour equivalent to the normal hours worked by one full time employee in a year. It is used to standardize and aggregate the work of regular, part-time and seasonal workers.
GDP	Gross Domestic Product, as defined by Statistics Canada, is the total value of goods and services produced.
General Property Tax Rate	The property tax rate, expressed per \$100 of taxable assessed value, which is charged to all property owners in HRM, and which includes all services except for those funded from area-rates.
Generally Accepted Accounting Principles (GAAP)	A set of standardized accounting principles defined by the Canadian Institute of Chartered Accountants.
Grants in Lieu	The Federal and Provincial Governments, as well as their Crown Corporations, pay grants in lieu of property taxes.
Gross Expenditures	Total expenditures before deducting revenue.
GST (Goods and Services Tax)	The Federal sales tax.
HaliFACT	HalifACT is one of the most ambitious climate action movements in Canada. It's our community response to the climate crisis that will build a more resilient and healthy future in Atlantic Canada while preparing for current and future climate impacts.
HRM	Halifax Regional Municipality
HRP	Halifax Regional Police Service
Indicator	A statistic or parameter that provides information on trends in the condition of a phenomenon and has significance extending beyond that associated with the properties of the statistic itself.

Interest Revenue	Includes interest earned by investing excess cash balances, interest accrued on overdue taxes, capital charges, local improvement charges, etc.
Key Metrics	Indicators that provide information (either qualitative or quantitative) on efficiency and/or effectiveness.
Local Improvement Charges (LIC)	Council may make by-laws imposing charges on individual properties for municipal infrastructure such as streets, curbs, gutters, sidewalks, etc.
Long Term Capital Plan	The 10-year Capital Plan consisting of a 3-year detailed plan which includes all project costs and funding sources, and a 7-year capital outlook. The first year is approved by Regional Council as the Project Budget. The second and third year are approved as a detailed planning tool.
Mandatory Education	Provincial statute requires that each municipality contribute to education. The contribution for each municipality is calculated by multiplying the Education Rate by each municipality's portion of the previous year's Uniform Assessment. The Education Rate is set each year by the N.S. provincial government.
Mandatory Provincial Costs	Costs which HRM is required to fund by provincial statute. They include Mandatory Education, Correctional Services, the Metropolitan Regional Housing Authority, and the cost of the Provincial Assessment system.
Metropolitan Regional Housing Authority	Administers and manages public non-profit housing for seniors and families on low incomes within HRM. It is one of seven housing authorities administered by the Province.
Multi-Year Financial Strategy	A study undertaken for Regional Council that involved modeling the future financial situation of HRM and implementing a strategy in response. It included Principles of Financial Management, a Reserve Policy, Capital Spending Policy, a Capital Debt Policy, and a business planning process.
Net Expenditures	Total expenditures less off-setting revenues.
Non-Tax Revenues	Revenues other than tax revenue. Examples are user fees paid for services provided (such as recreation programs and transit fares) and fines.
Nova Scotia Department of Finance and Treasury Board Nova Scotia Regulatory and Appeals Board	The Department of Finance and Treasury Board is responsible for provincial government's spending and revenue. An independent quasi-judicial body which has both regulatory and adjudicative jurisdiction flowing from the Energy and Regulatory Boards Act.
Operating Budget	The budget which includes the everyday operating expenditures of the municipality, including debt charges, capital from operating, and reserve payments, and the main sources of financing available such as taxation revenue, grants, interest earned on

investments, service charges, licenses and permits, etc. The total budgeted expenditures must equal the total budgeted revenue.

Outcome	The benefit or change that occurs because of a program or service.
Police Commission	Provides civilian governance for strategic policy planning and policy driven budget planning for police service delivery within the communities serviced by the Halifax Regional Police and provides an advisory role in respect of police matters within the communities serviced by the Provincial Police Service. The Commission also carries out other roles and responsibilities in accordance with the Provincial Police Act and HRM Bylaws.
Principal	Portion of loan repayments which directly pays down the total amount owing.
Projections	Estimate of total expenditures and revenues at the end of the fiscal year.
Property Assessment	The value of real property as determined by the PVSC. PVSC determines both a "Market" value and a "Capped" value (see Property Assessment Cap). Taxes are based on the "Taxable" value which is either the Capped Value (if eligible) or the Market value (if ineligible for the Cap).
Property Assessment Appeals	The Province of Nova Scotia permits property owners to appeal the assessment figures provided in their annual Notice of Assessment.
Property Assessment Cap	The percentage that a property assessment can rise, for taxation purposes, in any given year. Under provincial law the percentage is set at the Consumer Price Index for the previous twelve months (October to October). Some properties, such as apartments, are ineligible.
Property Assessment Lift	The total increase in the assessment base from one year to the next; includes Assessment Cap.
Property Assessment Roll	The assessed value of all properties within the municipality as provided by PVSC.
Property Taxes	Tax levied based on the market value of real property (land and buildings) as assessed by PVSC. Expressed as a rate per \$100 of assessed value. Residential and commercial properties may be taxed at different rates. Property tax payments are usually due twice per year.
Property Tax Rate	The rate of taxation on the capped value of real property, expressed per\$100 of assessed value.
Property Valuation Services Corporation (PVSC)	Independent, not-for-profit organization that is responsible for assessing all property in Nova Scotia as mandated under the Nova Scotia Assessment Act.
Province	Government of the Province of Nova Scotia.

PVSC	See Property Valuation Services Corporation.
Royal Canadian Mounted Police (RCMP)	Federal policing agency.
RDP-Real Domestic Product	The Gross Domestic Product adjusted for inflation.
Recapitalization	The use of funds to develop and improve existing assets which have deteriorated through the passage of time and/or a lack of maintenance.
Recreational Non-Profit Taxes	The owner of land used solely for non-profit recreational purposes pays taxes based on a rate of \$5.00 per acre increased by 5% per year from 1977.
Regional Area Rate	A tax rate applied to all areas of HRM, in both the residential and commercial sectors, to raise the funds required to cover set costs such as the Mandatory Provincial Costs.
Regional Council	The governing and legislative body for the municipality, Regional Council consists of the Mayor and 16 Councilors representing the 16 Districts. Regional council is elected once every four years.
Reserves	Accounts in which funds are accumulated to provide the following: - Risk Reserve: Funds for unforeseen events involving substantial costs. - Obligations Reserve: Funds for the timely replacement of municipal infrastructure. - Opportunities Reserve: Funds for opportunities that may arise to develop services or achieve efficiencies and that the Municipality must react rapidly or lose that opportunity.
Residential General Tax Rates	The general rate of taxation applied to the capped value of real property used as a residence, expressed per \$100 of assessed value.
Residential Assessment	The Taxable value of real property (land and buildings) used for residential purposes as assessed by the PVSC.
Resource Assessment	The assessed value of farm property, aquaculture property, forest property of less than 50,000 acres, land of a municipal water utility, or community fisherman's service buildings and the land it occupies.
Resource Property Taxes	Taxes levied against resource assessment.
Revenues	External sources of funds provided to the municipality to pay for the cost of providing services. For HRM, the main source of revenue is provided by property taxation. There are many other sources including grants, interest earned on investments, service charges, licenses and permits, etc.
Rural General Tax Rate	See Base General Tax Rate.

Service Drivers	Factors which increase demand for a service. Examples include population growth, new construction, new trends, etc.
Stakeholder	A person with an interest or concern in the HRM budget.
SICF	See Strategic Infrastructure & Climate Fund
Strategic Infrastructure & Climate Fund	A Strategic Infrastructure & Climate Fund was established to implement and finance Strategic Initiatives as well as those of HalifACT.
Strategic Initiatives	Large scale initiatives which are corporate-wide in scope and represent a major shift in the type and manner that services are provided.
Suburban General Tax Rate	The general tax rate applicable to all taxable properties within the suburban zone of HRM.
Supplementary Education	Funding amounts provided to the Halifax Regional Centre for Education and the province-wide Conseil Scolaire Acadien Provincial (CSAP) that are in addition to Mandatory Education. The Halifax Charter requires that the Municipality provide a guaranteed amount for supplementary education, although it may reduce the amount by 10% of the amount spent in 1995-96. Halifax and HRSB have negotiated a Memorandum of Understanding as to the amounts and provisions as to funding.
Surplus	A the close of the fiscal year, the amount by which operating revenues exceed operating expenditures.
Tabled Budget	The proposed or draft budget which is presented by staff to Regional Council for review and approval.
Tax Agreements	Agreements made with corporations and utilities that operate under unique circumstances, which, require special arrangements for how they pay taxes.
Taxpayer	Citizens and businesses of HRM who pay taxes.
Taxable Assessed Value	The "Taxable" Assessed value is either the Capped Value (if eligible) or the Market value (if ineligible for the Cap).
Temporary Debt	Financing provided through the Nova Scotia Department of Finance and Treasury Board, short-term loan program for completed capital projects between debenture issues. The expectation is that the long-term financing will be acquired through the next Nova Scotia Department of Finance and Treasury Board debenture issue.
Uniform Assessment	The total of the taxable property assessment plus the value of grants a municipality receives from special property tax arrangements.
WCB	Workers Compensation Board

APPENDIX

Appendix A – HRM Total Outstanding Debt Repayment Schedule

HRM Total Outstanding Debt Repayment Schedule

Debenture Name	Fiscal Year										
	2025	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031	2032	2033	2034	2035
GMIF-10309	229,984	225,984	221,976	217,995	213,984	209,984	205,982	201,989	-	-	-
2012 - A	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2012 - B	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2013 - A	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2013 - B	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2014 - A	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2014 - B	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2015 - A	2,737,611	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
GMIF-12028	258,585	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2015 - B	1,042,548	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2016 - A	2,034,328	1,978,519	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2017 - A	876,624	856,400	835,064	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2017 - B	1,210,490	1,178,360	1,145,141	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2018 - A	2,177,607	2,116,166	2,053,141	1,988,981	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2018 - B	1,296,833	1,259,997	1,222,417	1,184,218	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2019 - B	3,193,910	3,127,277	3,058,654	2,988,324	2,916,743	-	-	-	-	-	-
2021 - A	8,917,172	8,815,904	8,694,829	8,555,775	8,401,050	8,231,967	8,049,514	-	-	-	-
2022 - A	5,243,743	5,112,215	4,977,213	4,838,448	4,694,899	4,546,194	4,393,496	4,237,654	-	-	-
2023 - B	11,725,235	11,300,733	10,890,880	10,489,076	10,094,919	9,695,127	9,289,460	8,878,963	8,464,682	-	-
2024 - B	2,578,719	2,519,247	2,460,881	2,402,177	2,342,413	2,281,205	2,217,875	2,152,441	2,084,717	2,015,395	1,288,745
2025 - B	-	4,555,676	4,481,734	4,405,143	4,324,340	4,239,445	4,149,926	4,055,578	3,956,842	3,852,806	3,743,647
Total	43,523,388	43,046,477	40,041,930	37,070,137	32,988,348	29,203,921	28,306,253	19,526,625	14,506,242	5,868,202	5,032,392

Appendix B

READING THE BUDGET AND BUSINESS PLAN

Budget and Business Plans are informed by and developed in alignment with the [2026-2030 Strategic Plan](#) and its associated Action Plan to ensure the successful implementation of the Strategic Plan's goals.

Council and Administrative Priorities

Council Priorities – **Enabling Prosperity**, **Strengthening Communities** and **Moving Better** – are established by Regional Council and reflect the municipality's most pressing needs and biggest opportunities. Administrative Priorities – **Responsible Administration** and **Our People** – are established by the Chief Administrative Officer in collaboration with municipal leadership and employees and outline the roadmap for the organization to deliver programs and services to advance Council Priorities. Priorities align with the Vision, Mission and Values and provide strategic direction for the term of the Strategic Plan. Priorities are represented in the plan using the legend below.



Strategic Lenses

The business planning process is guided by the Vision, Mission and Values and uses the municipality's Strategic Lenses – **Equity, Diversity, Inclusion and Accessibility**, **Environment and Climate Action** and **Service Excellence** – to ensure different points of view are considered in operational planning and decision-making.

Strategic Lenses are not special strategic or temporary initiatives – they are how the municipality conducts day to day business on an on-going basis to enable the municipality to consider a problem, decision, or action from different points of view. In doing so, the municipality ensures the resident experience is reflected in its work.

Strategic Lenses will be reported on annually using aligned Performance Indicators. Definitions for the Strategic Lenses are found below.

Equity, Diversity, Inclusion and Accessibility (EDIA) – The municipality values, understands and draws upon the diverse views, ideas, lived experiences, skills and knowledge of its residents and employees. In its decision-making, the municipality applies the EDIA lens to build more inclusive communities, programs and services and to actively remove systemic barriers. This approach ensures that all voices across the region are considered in shaping the future, promoting fairness and access for everyone.

Environment and Climate Action (ENV) – The municipality integrates environment and climate action in all corporate and community planning, policies, infrastructure, investments and services to achieve success in addressing the climate crisis and protecting the environment. Achieving net-zero emissions, safeguarding communities and infrastructure and protecting ecosystems are paramount in the municipality’s decision-making.

Service Excellence (SE) – The municipality applies evidence-based decision-making, effective risk management, quality management and resident-centric planning. By applying a Service Excellence lens, the municipality manages risks and opportunities while focusing on continuous improvement, modernization and service quality. This approach ensures the organization remains adaptable, resilient and committed to enhancing overall performance and the resident experience.

Budget and Business Plan Deliverables

Budget and Business Plan Deliverables identify the Council and Administrative Priorities Goal and reference the Action Plan number, as applicable, to highlight the linkage to the *Strategic Plan* and *Action Plan*.

Deliverable	Completion
2026-2030 Strategic Plan Goal	
Deliverable Title <i>Service Area</i> <i>Action Plan Reference Number</i> Deliverable action and what it will accomplish.	Date

Municipal Services

Budget and Business Plans list services provided by the municipality. The [Halifax Regional Municipality’s Service Catalogue](#) is an information source that details the services delivered, including any public facing service standards, where applicable. Service standards are subject to change based on Regional Council direction or by the administration and may be impacted by resource availability or other factors.

2026–2030 Strategic Plan Summary

HALIFAX

Vision

The Halifax Regional Municipality's vision for the future is to enhance our quality of life by fostering the growth of healthy and vibrant communities, a strong and diverse economy, and a sustainable environment.

Mission

We take pride in providing high-quality public service to benefit residents.
We make a difference.

Values

Respect • Collaboration • Integrity • Accountability • Sustainability
• Diversity and Inclusion

Lenses

Equity, Diversity, Inclusion and Accessibility • Environment and Climate Action
• Service Excellence

Council priorities

Enabling Prosperity

Strengthening Communities

Moving Better

Administrative priorities

Responsible Administration

Our People



Enabling Prosperity

The municipality prioritizes sustainable, inclusive growth that strengthens the economy, builds resilient infrastructure and expands housing options.

EP-01: Increase regional growth in strategic areas that are well-served by existing or planned services, utilities and infrastructure.

EP-02: Expedite the delivery of housing supply and support the development of complete communities with a mix of housing options and convenient access to goods, services and facilities.

EP-03: Maintain and improve infrastructure resilience to mitigate and adapt to the impacts of climate change.

EP-04: Ensure residents and businesses can contribute to and benefit from the municipality's growing economy.

EP-05: Attract, retain and grow domestic and international business and talent.

Strengthening Communities

The municipality prioritizes safe and inclusive places and activities that enhance the quality of life for residents.

SC-01: Improve municipal preparedness planning to mitigate the potential impacts emergency situations and climate-related events.

SC-02: Improve municipal emergency response and recovery efforts to keep residents safe, protect property and restore essential services and infrastructure following an emergency event.

SC-03: Improve the well-being of community members at risk of or experiencing homelessness by enhancing supports and resources.

SC-04: Plan and invest in social infrastructure and opportunities for connection to increase residents' well-being and sense of belonging in their communities.

SC-05: Improve equitable access to municipal programs, services, indoor and outdoor spaces and events for all residents.

SC-06: Invest to enable community efforts to reduce carbon emissions by 75 per cent (of 2016 levels) by 2030 and net-zero by 2050.

SC-07: Invest in the enhancement, protection and expansion of natural assets, green spaces and urban agriculture to support community and ecological health and resilient ecosystem services.

Moving Better

The municipality ensures a safe, accessible, efficient and connected public transit and regional transportation network that promotes environmentally sustainable options and offers residents travel choices that meet their needs.

MB-01: Manage traffic congestion and improve the efficiency of the transportation network.

MB-02: Improve the reliability of public transit.

MB-03: Improve access to sustainable transportation modes.

MB-04: Improve safety of transportation modes.

MB-05: Public transit resources and service standards align and grow with the municipality.

MB-06: Improve connectivity between and within communities.

MB-07: Develop and enhance the transportation network and infrastructure assets to meet defined service levels.

Responsible Administration

The organization prioritizes accountability and leverages tools and processes to efficiently deliver services, engage with the community and support sustainable growth.

RA-01: Preserve and strengthen the municipality's financial position to meet current and future needs and obligations.

RA-02: Monitor, maintain and replace municipal assets to establish and ensure service levels.

RA-03: Reach net-zero municipal operations by 2030.

RA-04: Continuously improve municipal services and programs for quality, efficiency and cost effectiveness while supporting an accessible and user-friendly experience.

RA-05: Deliver meaningful and accessible public engagement and education on key municipal issues.

RA-06: Foster collaborative relationships with other levels of government and partners.

RA-07: Enhance the organization's ability to anticipate and manage risks and opportunities effectively.

Our People

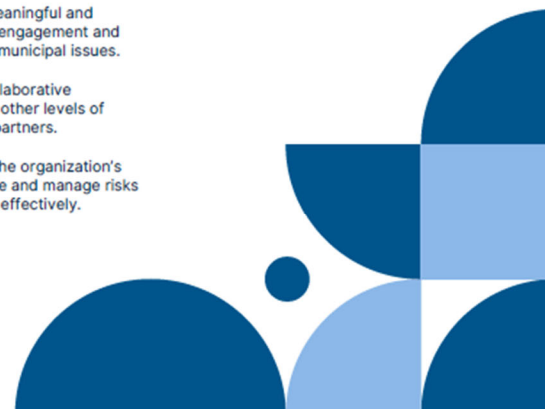
The organization is committed to equity, diversity, inclusion, accessibility and employee well-being, health and safety to attract and retain a talented and engaged workforce.

OP-01: Foster a workplace that is equitable, diverse, inclusive and accessible.

OP-02: Strengthen the attraction and retention of people with the skills and behaviours needed to deliver municipal services.

OP-03: Increase employee access to learning and development opportunities.

OP-04: Foster a safety-first culture where employees' mental, emotional and physical well-being are protected.



Summary of Expenditures Details - HRM Total

	2024/25	2025/26	2025/26	2026/27	2026/27	
	Actual	Budget	Projections	Budget	Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
6001 Salaries - Regular	384,894,497	432,376,900	400,313,400	462,691,800	30,314,900	7.0
6002 Salaries - Overtime	30,309,530	19,515,400	30,413,949	19,482,500	(32,900)	(0.2)
6003 Wages - Regular	11,936,839	11,031,695	11,684,800	11,516,200	484,505	4.4
6004 Wages - Overtime	33,232	-	17,500	-	-	-
6005 PDP & Union Con Incr	4,155	40,000	225,900	40,000	-	-
6050 Court Time	2,246,078	1,647,800	2,576,400	1,686,200	38,400	2.3
6051 Shift Agreements	279,575	288,900	290,200	294,600	5,700	2.0
6052 Shift Differentials	250,861	419,600	419,600	419,600	-	-
6053 Extra Duty	1,751,601	1,988,400	1,988,400	1,988,400	-	-
6054 Vacation payout	943,330	35,000	448,302	35,000	-	-
6099 Other Allowances	174,431	19,500	19,500	19,500	-	-
6100 Benefits - Salaries	84,430,054	85,818,000	85,117,900	86,750,000	932,000	1.1
6101 Benefits - Wages	702,076	591,700	751,000	601,600	9,900	1.7
6110 Vacancy Management	-	(24,020,550)	(976,300)	(22,247,700)	1,772,850	(7.4)
6120 Comp OCC Budget Yr 1	-	587,900	587,900	1,071,300	483,400	82.2
6150 Honorariums	3,802,839	4,380,800	4,384,200	4,380,800	-	-
6151 Vehicle Allowance	11,116	-	11,800	-	-	-
6152 Retirement Incentives	2,432,014	6,134,200	5,284,000	5,706,200	(428,000)	(7.0)
6153 Severence	177,068	-	180,300	-	-	-
6154 Workers' Compensation	14,869,171	16,363,300	16,676,200	17,558,500	1,195,200	7.3
6155 Overtime Meals	16,714	19,700	20,700	20,100	400	2.0
6156 Clothing Allowance	662,736	760,000	775,400	759,200	(800)	(0.1)
6157 stipends	532,570	510,000	672,000	510,000	-	-
6158 WCB Recov Earnings	(239,096)	(18,300)	(19,600)	(18,300)	-	-
6164 On the Job injuries	142,794	179,400	103,400	179,400	-	-
6170 ext Fund Positions	-	62,200	-	27,200	(35,000)	(56.3)
6194 Sick Bank allowance	934,141	-	-	-	-	-
6199 Comp & Ben InterDept	(515,623)	7,416,100	4,503,165	1,576,100	(5,840,000)	(78.7)
9200 HR CATS Wage/Ben	(746,256)	109,600	(1,027,000)	118,100	8,500	7.8
9210 HR CATS OT Wage/Ben	(122,195)	(45,900)	(328,000)	(45,900)	-	-
* Compensation and Benefits	539,914,250	566,211,345	565,115,015	595,120,400	28,909,055	5.1
6201 Telephone/Cable	2,579,968	2,830,850	2,652,270	2,504,150	(326,700)	(11.5)
6202 Courier/Postage	1,615,835	914,400	1,179,800	947,900	33,500	3.7
6203 Office Furn/Equip	651,431	612,600	710,200	586,550	(26,050)	(4.3)
6204 Computer S/W & Lic	10,041,870	11,628,850	11,519,000	12,291,300	662,450	5.7
6205 Printing & Reprod	1,477,457	1,268,400	1,365,100	1,128,800	(139,600)	(11.0)
6206 Microfilms	-	-	100	-	-	-
6207 Office Supplies	773,323	615,800	766,400	631,300	15,500	2.5
6208 Binding	6,433	10,000	10,000	10,000	-	-
6290 Office OCC Transfer	34,500	19,900	(48,600)	19,900	-	-
6299 Other Office Expenses	256,509	286,800	237,100	266,600	(20,200)	(7.0)
* Office	17,437,326	18,187,600	18,391,370	18,386,500	198,900	1.1
6301 Professional Fees	762,269	873,500	800,800	900,400	26,900	3.1
6302 Legal Fees	3,296,778	587,600	1,975,900	469,100	(118,500)	(20.2)
6303 Consulting Fees	4,415,227	5,901,400	5,000,900	4,144,700	(1,756,700)	(29.8)
6304 Janitorial Services	5,859,774	6,162,700	6,155,900	6,650,200	487,500	7.9
6305 Property Appraisal	20,557	44,300	33,400	33,600	(10,700)	(24.2)
6306 Property Survey	70,671	25,000	114,200	20,000	(5,000)	(20.0)
6308 Snow Removal	3,497,108	2,740,900	2,787,800	2,971,400	230,500	8.4
6309 Litigation Disburse	2,111	7,500	6,200	7,300	(200)	(2.7)
6310 Outside Personnel	2,125,229	1,501,000	1,481,000	1,526,000	25,000	1.7
6311 Security	3,652,821	3,203,300	3,165,800	3,387,000	183,700	5.7
6312 Refuse Collection	1,325,353	670,200	1,162,500	918,500	248,300	37.0
6314 Prosecution Services	111,399	102,000	111,000	102,000	-	-
6315 Outside Policing	38,650,825	40,681,200	42,391,300	45,130,000	4,448,800	10.9
6316 Real Property Disb	5,911	18,000	9,000	18,000	-	-
6390 Extnl Svcs OCC Trsf	(34,500)	-	(382,600)	-	-	-
6399 Contract Services	122,269,007	122,086,550	120,703,370	126,820,700	4,734,150	3.9
* External Services	186,030,542	184,605,150	185,516,470	193,098,900	8,493,750	4.6
6401 Uniforms & Clothing	1,648,032	2,216,000	2,226,300	2,245,500	29,500	1.3
6402 Med & First Aid Supp	207,750	104,000	132,750	105,750	1,750	1.7
6403 Patrol Equip Supplies	580,052	692,100	732,000	677,800	(14,300)	(2.1)
6404 Rec Prog Supplies	487,410	414,200	493,900	453,700	39,500	9.5

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget Δ %	
6405 Photo Supp & Equip	28,344	45,000	45,000	45,000	-	-
6406 Bridge Tolls	445,618	14,000	3,400	3,600	(10,400)	(74.3)
6407 Clean/Sani Supplies	670,384	546,400	677,700	531,100	(15,300)	(2.8)
6409 Personal Protect Equ	712,552	907,550	1,183,465	611,100	(296,450)	(32.7)
6490 Supplies OCC Transfer	-	58,800	58,800	58,800	-	-
6499 Other Supplies	692,404	321,300	844,200	370,650	49,350	15.4
* Supplies	5,472,546	5,319,350	6,397,515	5,103,000	(216,350)	(4.1)
6501 Asphalt	296,268	235,500	235,500	235,000	(500)	(0.2)
6502 Chemicals	67,084	124,100	142,900	135,000	10,900	8.8
6503 Fertilizer	54,167	46,000	44,000	44,500	(1,500)	(3.3)
6504 Hardware	271,029	239,800	226,000	239,200	(600)	(0.3)
6505 Lubricants	406,944	461,200	468,600	466,400	5,200	1.1
6506 Lumber	72,620	97,700	77,800	96,400	(1,300)	(1.3)
6507 Propane	209,915	160,800	183,400	160,600	(200)	(0.1)
6508 Ready Mix Concrete	81,253	167,000	166,500	167,000	-	-
6510 Road Oils	2,006	6,700	3,100	6,700	-	-
6511 Salt	2,454,309	2,185,100	2,188,200	2,185,100	-	-
6512 Sand	19,330	28,500	28,700	34,500	6,000	21.1
6513 Seeds & Plants	119,294	89,500	125,600	93,500	4,000	4.5
6514 Sod	2,305	11,700	7,800	11,700	-	-
6515 Stone and Gravel	86,375	93,900	95,400	93,900	-	-
6516 Topsoil	118,206	108,900	86,100	108,900	-	-
6517 Paint	354,308	386,900	406,285	426,500	39,600	10.2
6518 Metal	77,844	70,300	70,700	70,300	-	-
6519 Welding Supplies	9,392	12,600	12,900	13,100	500	4.0
6522 Greenhouse Materials	-	-	-	1,500	1,500	-
6599 Other Materials	178,803	79,600	140,300	129,400	49,800	62.6
* Materials	4,881,451	4,605,800	4,709,785	4,719,200	113,400	2.5
6602 Electrical	1,230,945	1,389,500	1,640,300	1,431,500	42,000	3.0
6603 Grnds & Landscaping	52,702	170,000	143,000	153,500	(16,500)	(9.7)
6604 Bus Gates/Shltr-R&M	8,138	35,000	35,000	35,000	-	-
6605 Municipal Taxes	1,230,888	1,244,000	1,207,500	1,475,200	231,200	18.6
6606 Heating Fuel	918,318	1,251,000	1,133,000	1,251,000	-	-
6607 Electricity	10,409,096	10,683,600	10,567,800	10,887,000	203,400	1.9
6608 Water	1,413,810	1,233,000	1,419,300	1,233,000	-	-
6609 Elevator & Escalator	171,535	170,300	170,300	477,200	306,900	180.2
6610 Building - Exterior	1,188,213	975,000	971,300	778,000	(197,000)	(20.2)
6611 Building - Interior	1,551,950	1,299,100	1,301,600	1,157,500	(141,600)	(10.9)
6612 Safety Systems	924,829	935,900	938,700	936,000	100	0.0
6613 Overhead Doors	311,519	252,800	292,800	272,800	20,000	7.9
6614 Envir Assess/Cleanup	250,226	578,500	210,200	148,700	(429,800)	(74.3)
6615 Vandalism Clean-up	-	10,000	10,100	10,000	-	-
6616 Natural Gas-Buildings	2,104,463	1,931,700	2,031,700	2,076,700	145,000	7.5
6617 Pest Management	134,072	169,900	78,700	169,900	-	-
6699 Other Building Cost	2,308,214	1,537,200	1,928,000	1,537,200	-	-
* Building Costs	24,208,918	23,866,500	24,079,300	24,030,200	163,700	0.7
6701 Equipment Purchase	1,956,774	2,505,200	2,822,800	2,172,200	(333,000)	(13.3)
6702 Small Tools	445,954	417,800	442,400	400,700	(17,100)	(4.1)
6703 Computer Equip/Rent	2,643,871	2,236,600	2,270,750	2,643,700	407,100	18.2
6704 Equipment Rental	475,658	278,200	790,650	239,000	(39,200)	(14.1)
6705 Equip - R&M	1,264,930	1,307,700	1,790,500	1,358,700	51,000	3.9
6706 Computer R&M	461,490	866,000	655,100	689,300	(176,700)	(20.4)
6707 Plumbing & Heating	1,710,293	909,300	1,269,800	1,100,000	190,700	21.0
6708 Mechanical Equipment	2,255,367	1,893,100	2,333,600	2,037,900	144,800	7.6
6711 Communication System	1,906,569	1,855,000	1,802,400	1,847,200	(7,800)	(0.4)
6731 Airtime	189,761	258,700	258,700	258,700	-	-
6732 Mobile Data	174,667	184,400	184,400	184,400	-	-
* Equipment & Communications	13,485,335	12,712,000	14,621,100	12,931,800	219,800	1.7
6802 Vehicle R&M	11,196,385	13,732,100	14,280,200	13,637,100	(95,000)	(0.7)
6803 Vehicle Fuel - Diesel	18,872,214	19,885,800	16,045,200	18,509,755	(1,376,045)	(6.9)
6804 Vehicle Fuel - Gas	3,561,835	3,340,500	2,959,800	4,255,745	915,245	27.4
6805 Tires and Tubes	1,787,287	1,777,000	1,882,000	1,787,000	10,000	0.6
6806 Vehicle Rentals	308,204	327,700	261,700	232,500	(95,200)	(29.1)
6807 Vehicle Leases	55,367	-	43,400	10,000	10,000	-
6809 Electricity-Vehicles	7,066	-	300	-	-	-

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget Δ %	
6810 Comm Vehicle R&M	5,838,233	3,859,000	4,950,500	3,559,000	(300,000)	(7.8)
6811 Shop Supplies	104,599	115,000	121,200	112,000	(3,000)	(2.6)
6890 Vehicle OCC Transfer	-	269,600	269,600	269,600	-	-
6899 Other Vehicle Expense	1,362,248	528,200	590,500	1,218,600	690,400	130.7
* Vehicle Expense	43,093,440	43,834,900	41,404,400	43,591,300	(243,600)	(0.6)
6901 Membership Dues	943,557	1,081,600	1,083,600	1,109,700	28,100	2.6
6902 Conferences/Workshop	316,540	308,600	342,200	313,000	4,400	1.4
6903 Travel - Local	760,247	829,850	835,010	838,450	8,600	1.0
6904 Travel - Out of Town	916,328	870,900	859,000	833,300	(37,600)	(4.3)
6905 Training & Education	1,716,146	2,722,700	2,830,900	2,819,300	96,600	3.5
6906 Licenses & Agreements	1,122,005	892,500	942,400	974,900	82,400	9.2
6907 Commission Fees	217,961	350,000	350,400	350,000	-	-
6908 Medical Examinations	295,332	342,400	411,300	346,000	3,600	1.1
6909 Cost of Sales	554,289	881,300	1,967,000	3,281,300	2,400,000	272.3
6910 Signage	171,968	281,700	313,100	281,700	-	-
6911 Facilities Rental	8,701,596	9,525,600	8,945,900	9,917,500	391,900	4.1
6912 Advertising/Promotio	1,033,002	1,246,600	1,048,930	1,477,000	230,400	18.5
6913 Awards	182,624	136,100	136,800	141,100	5,000	3.7
6914 Recruiting	520,905	348,100	434,000	358,200	10,100	2.9
6915 Research Data Acquis	50,209	115,100	82,100	115,100	-	-
6916 Public Education	146,374	185,100	192,100	268,600	83,500	45.1
6917 Books and Periodicals	3,290,709	3,570,100	3,643,050	3,860,400	290,300	8.1
6918 Meals/Catering	392,055	223,650	290,120	197,150	(26,500)	(11.8)
6919 Special Projects	3,587,146	5,033,700	4,952,100	3,097,200	(1,936,500)	(38.5)
6920 Land Purchase	428,363	-	-	-	-	-
6928 Committee Expenses	2,526	10,900	10,500	10,700	(200)	(1.8)
6929 Procurement Card Clg	11,626	200	900	200	-	-
6932 Youth Pr Services	30,382	140,000	39,900	99,200	(40,800)	(29.1)
6933 Community Events	1,169,322	1,235,100	1,172,100	1,207,400	(27,700)	(2.2)
6936 Staff Relations	60,661	82,000	81,300	82,900	900	1.1
6937 Corporate Training	80,225	102,500	81,500	100,000	(2,500)	(2.4)
6938 Rewarding Excellence	209,179	137,050	180,330	132,000	(5,050)	(3.7)
6940 Fencing	1,634,728	293,800	276,400	288,800	(5,000)	(1.7)
6941 Playground Equipment	37,806	53,400	89,300	62,300	8,900	16.7
6942 Management Fees	745,351	807,500	1,534,300	764,600	(42,900)	(5.3)
6943 Health and Wellness	109,217	110,600	103,600	110,500	(100)	(0.1)
6950 Region.Serv.Program	619,547	231,000	231,000	231,000	-	-
6954 Cash over/under	(119)	-	600	-	-	-
6990 Gds & Svcs OCC Trsf	-	-	-	-	-	-
6999 Other Goods/Services	566,219	3,438,700	1,873,950	4,391,700	953,000	27.7
* Other Goods & Services	30,624,026	35,588,350	35,335,690	38,061,200	2,472,850	6.9
7005 Interdept EXP	-	-	-	-	-	-
7007 ltnTrsf Paper Recyc	-	-	-	-	-	-
7008 ltnTrsf IT & Commn	(1,445)	-	-	-	-	-
7009 Internal Trfr Other	22,104	(53,800)	(163,800)	(768,100)	(714,300)	1,327.7
7010 IntTrfr Insur Funds	-	365,000	(135,000)	375,000	10,000	2.7
7011 Int Trf Record Check	-	4,200	4,200	4,200	-	-
7012 Int Trf Print/Reprod	(8,864)	(42,700)	(193,750)	(41,700)	1,000	(2.3)
7013 Int Trf Extra Duty	(442)	(216,100)	(32,900)	(86,500)	129,600	(60.0)
7015 Int Trf FacilityRent	-	-	-	19,000	19,000	-
7099 Interdept Chargeback	(23,780)	-	(3,900)	-	-	-
9900 Rev/Exp.Vehicle Rent	-	0	0	0	-	-
* Interdepartmental	(12,426)	56,600	(525,150)	(498,100)	(554,700)	(980.0)
8011 Interest on Debentur	8,210,465	7,825,200	7,825,200	9,868,300	2,043,100	26.1
8012 Principal on Debenbu	49,036,985	35,698,100	35,698,100	34,675,500	(1,022,600)	(2.9)
* Debt Service	57,247,450	43,523,300	43,523,300	44,543,800	1,020,500	2.3
8001 Transf Outside Agenc	244,613,785	255,804,575	257,796,800	273,200,270	17,395,695	6.8
8002 Insurance Claims	1,999,929	700,000	700,000	714,000	14,000	2.0
8003 Insurance Pol/Prem	4,439,782	5,747,100	5,747,100	6,146,800	399,700	7.0
8004 Grants	11,485,221	7,856,100	14,674,800	17,921,200	10,065,100	128.1
8005 Tax Exemptions	1,476,955	1,875,000	1,875,000	1,875,000	-	-
8006 Tax Concess Non Prof	7,677,867	9,554,000	8,456,900	10,000,000	446,000	4.7
8007 Tax Concess Commerci	3,995,471	3,844,900	3,838,700	3,844,900	-	-
8009 Fire Protection	8,083,080	11,798,800	11,798,800	13,971,900	2,173,100	18.4
8014 Capital from Operati	41,392,909	66,033,000	66,033,000	89,237,600	23,204,600	35.1

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
8015 Debenture Discount	293,677	242,700	219,300	926,200	683,500	281.6
8016 Provision for Allow	1,635,521	2,000,000	2,000,000	2,000,000	-	-
8017 Bank Charges	852,643	875,000	875,000	875,000	-	-
8022 Transf to/fr Trust	(413,639)	(42,400)	(177,400)	(42,400)	-	-
8024 Transf to/fr Capital	533,601	207,700	207,700	399,000	191,300	92.1
8026 Property Damage	55,093	94,200	194,200	96,100	1,900	2.0
8030 Tfr Fr Resvs to Oper	(17,383,224)	(22,734,500)	(24,977,900)	(17,335,700)	5,398,800	(23.7)
8031 Tfr To Resvs Fr Oper	56,962,515	42,819,430	42,879,400	61,448,230	18,628,800	43.5
8045 Amortization Expense	648,337	-	-	-	-	-
8046 Stormwater ROW Chg	5,316,000	5,867,600	5,867,600	6,780,010	912,410	15.6
9000 Prior Yr. Sur/Def	(5,223,841)	25,100	(5,409,400)	(5,528,700)	(5,553,800)	(22,126.7)
9001 Current Yr. Sur/Def	<u>5,332,827</u>	<u>2,528,900</u>	<u>7,900,400</u>	<u>268,490</u>	<u>(2,260,410)</u>	<u>(89.4)</u>
* Other Fiscal	373,774,509	395,097,205	400,500,000	466,797,900	71,700,695	18.1
** Total	1,296,157,365	1,333,608,100	1,339,068,795	1,445,886,100	112,278,000	8.4

Summary of Revenues Details - HRM Total						
	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget	Δ %
4001 Res. Property Taxes	(372,427,792)	(404,099,800)	(403,970,000)	(452,108,400)	(48,008,600)	11.9
4002 Comm. Property Taxes	(285,235,559)	(300,084,200)	(299,834,200)	(329,734,600)	(29,650,400)	9.9
4005 Resrc Property Taxes	(1,887,718)	(2,054,700)	(2,054,700)	(2,194,400)	(139,700)	6.8
4006 Rec. Non Profit	(26,568)	(17,000)	(17,000)	(17,000)	-	-
4007 Resource Forest Taxes	(39,375)	(42,000)	(42,000)	(42,000)	-	-
4008 Comm. Forest Taxes	(72,067)	(89,000)	(89,000)	(89,000)	-	-
4014 Climate Action Tax	(18,400,672)	(17,952,300)	(17,952,300)	(18,222,200)	(269,900)	1.5
4100 Deed Transfer Taxes	(68,256,024)	(70,000,000)	(70,000,000)	(70,000,000)	-	-
4101 Capital Charges	(395,412)	(5,513,700)	(1,663,700)	(3,513,700)	2,000,000	(36.3)
* Tax Revenue	(746,741,186)	(799,852,700)	(795,622,900)	(875,921,300)	(76,068,600)	9.5
4201 Area Rate Residential	(193,675,817)	(212,052,300)	(212,052,300)	(224,338,700)	(12,286,400)	5.8
4202 Area Rate Commercial	(41,817,814)	(45,409,200)	(45,409,200)	(43,413,200)	1,996,000	(4.4)
4204 Area Rate Loc Transi	(40,426,656)	(43,551,600)	(43,551,600)	(48,536,900)	(4,985,300)	11.4
4206 Area Rate Resource	(970,128)	(1,034,700)	(1,034,700)	(1,056,400)	(21,700)	2.1
* Area Rate Revenue	(276,890,416)	(302,047,800)	(302,047,800)	(317,345,200)	(15,297,400)	5.1
4501 Tax Agreement - NSLC	(930,370)	(948,600)	(933,600)	(948,600)	-	-
4502 Tax Agreement - NSPI	(6,181,938)	(6,463,600)	(6,463,600)	(6,567,000)	(103,400)	1.6
4503 Tax Agreement - Bell	(1,496,469)	(1,419,200)	(1,484,900)	(1,319,200)	100,000	(7.0)
4507 Tax Agreement - Heri	(1,810,771)	(1,950,200)	(1,988,500)	(1,950,200)	-	-
4508 Tax Agreement - HIAA	(1,970,780)	(2,373,700)	(2,191,400)	(2,600,000)	(226,300)	9.5
4509 Tax Agrmnt - Irving	(1,719,222)	(1,711,200)	(1,784,800)	(1,483,900)	227,300	(13.3)
4550 Tax Agreement - Other	(328,005)	(309,300)	(255,900)	(309,300)	-	-
* Tax Agreements	(14,437,555)	(15,175,800)	(15,102,700)	(15,178,200)	(2,400)	0.0
4601 Grant in Lieu-Fed	(30,186,967)	(29,451,400)	(29,451,400)	(31,774,800)	(2,323,400)	7.9
4602 Grant in Lieu-Prov.	(14,992,920)	(16,617,400)	(16,617,400)	(17,804,900)	(1,187,500)	7.1
4603 Grant in Lieu-CPC	(771,505)	(859,800)	(859,800)	(928,600)	(68,800)	8.0
4605 Grant Lieu-Hflx Port	(2,439,358)	(2,107,700)	(2,107,700)	(2,270,100)	(162,400)	7.7
4606 Grant in Lieu - CBC	(40,171)	(42,800)	(42,800)	(46,200)	(3,400)	7.9
4607 Grant Lieu -Via Rail	(163,085)	(210,800)	(210,800)	(220,000)	(9,200)	4.4
4608 Grant in Lieu - WCB	(139,780)	(152,300)	(152,300)	(164,500)	(12,200)	8.0
4609 Grant in Lieu- Citad	(2,032,711)	(2,202,300)	(2,202,300)	(2,378,500)	(176,200)	8.0
4610 Grant in Lieu-NRC	(72,499)	(66,400)	(66,400)	(71,700)	(5,300)	8.0
4650 Grant in Lieu - Other	(17,227)	(18,700)	(18,700)	(20,200)	(1,500)	8.0
* Payments in Lieu of taxes	(50,856,223)	(51,729,600)	(51,729,600)	(55,679,500)	(3,949,900)	7.6
4703 Cond.Grant NS(Other)	(10,847,650)	(9,330,500)	(10,384,400)	(9,330,500)	-	-
4704 Conditnl Grnts Other	(6,985,816)	(5,079,900)	(8,170,200)	(13,253,700)	(8,173,800)	160.9
4706 Uncond.Grant NS(oth)	(3,341,949)	(3,600,000)	(3,393,300)	(3,600,000)	-	-
4750 Other Grants	(3,820,137)	(4,542,000)	(4,861,500)	(4,371,500)	170,500	(3.8)
* Transfers from other Gov'ts	(24,995,553)	(22,552,400)	(26,809,400)	(30,555,700)	(8,003,300)	35.5
4801 Int. Rev. - Tax	(5,348,999)	(4,300,000)	(5,200,000)	(5,000,000)	(700,000)	16.3
4803 Int. Rev. - Cap.Chrg	(509,507)	(493,000)	(493,000)	(491,700)	1,300	(0.3)
4850 Int. Rev. - Other	(224,821)	(85,000)	(85,000)	(85,000)	-	-
4860 Investment Income	(15,629,534)	(11,500,000)	(7,800,000)	(7,600,000)	3,900,000	(33.9)
* Interest Revenue	(21,712,861)	(16,378,000)	(13,578,000)	(13,176,700)	3,201,300	(19.5)
4901 Parking Station Rev	(4,811,138)	(4,700,000)	(5,000,000)	(6,161,600)	(1,461,600)	31.1

	2024/25 Actual	2025/26 Budget	2025/26 Projections	2026/27 Budget	2026/27 Δ 25/26 Budget Δ %	
4902 Fines Fees	(824,104)	(6,500)	(6,500)	(6,500)	-	-
4903 Building Permits	(13,923,476)	(13,300,000)	(10,300,000)	(13,699,000)	(399,000)	3.0
4904 Plumbing Permits	(238,956)	(150,000)	(176,000)	(154,500)	(4,500)	3.0
4905 St. Opening Permits	(1,087,571)	(685,000)	(988,200)	(698,500)	(13,500)	2.0
4906 Subdivision Applic.	(234,560)	(250,000)	(237,000)	(257,500)	(7,500)	3.0
4907 Taxi Licenses	(112,925)	(140,000)	(175,000)	(140,000)	-	-
4908 Animal Licenses	(128,242)	(140,000)	(108,000)	(140,000)	-	-
4909 False Alarm Recovery	(1,379,500)	(1,030,000)	(1,300,000)	(1,530,000)	(500,000)	48.5
4911 Zoning Fees	(243,950)	(120,000)	(193,600)	(123,600)	(3,600)	3.0
4912 Signs & Encroachments	(1,797,237)	(913,400)	(1,734,400)	(985,900)	(72,500)	7.9
4914 Grade Alterations	(226,650)	(200,000)	(248,400)	(206,000)	(6,000)	3.0
4915 Minor Variance	(32,790)	(30,000)	(44,800)	(30,900)	(900)	3.0
4916 Vending Licenses	(36,162)	(25,000)	(24,000)	(25,000)	-	-
4920 Development Permits	(1,029,274)	(750,000)	(1,000,300)	(772,500)	(22,500)	3.0
4921 Parking Permit Rev	(821,063)	(950,000)	(950,000)	(1,099,400)	(149,400)	15.7
4922 Parking Ticket Rev	(3,716,681)	(4,600,000)	(4,600,000)	(5,030,900)	(430,900)	9.4
4923 Marketing Levy Penalty	(141,489)	-	-	(5,000)	(5,000)	-
4950 Other Lic. & Permits	(354,391)	(345,000)	(342,200)	(358,300)	(13,300)	3.9
4951 By-Law F300 Revenue	(1,216,350)	(1,254,000)	(1,254,000)	(1,220,000)	34,000	(2.7)
5101 Parking Rentals	(2,797,585)	(2,809,100)	(2,809,100)	(3,114,000)	(304,900)	10.9
5102 Facilities Rentals	(3,666,443)	(3,034,400)	(3,339,000)	(3,202,700)	(168,300)	5.5
5107 Rental Ball Fields	(298,088)	(300,000)	(350,000)	(345,000)	(45,000)	15.0
5108 Rental Sportsfields	(252,439)	(250,000)	(220,000)	(250,000)	-	-
5109 Rental Parks	(20,517)	(22,800)	(26,000)	(23,500)	(700)	3.1
5110 Rental Sports Courts	(18,245)	(20,800)	(37,000)	(30,000)	(9,200)	44.2
5111 RTAL Weather Fields	(503,363)	(510,000)	(540,000)	(510,000)	-	-
5150 Other Rental Revenue	(121,455)	-	(140,300)	-	-	-
5151 Lease Revenue	(1,219,082)	(1,080,500)	(1,248,700)	(1,713,800)	(633,300)	58.6
5201 Fare Revenue	(36,816,740)	(39,350,200)	(39,663,700)	(41,291,300)	(1,941,100)	4.9
5204 Administration Fees	(100,000)	(227,200)	(139,500)	(197,100)	30,100	(13.2)
5205 Tax Certificates	(1,182,690)	(1,100,000)	(1,300,000)	(1,525,000)	(425,000)	38.6
5209 Comm. Events Rev.	(352,442)	(464,500)	(364,500)	(350,500)	114,000	(24.5)
5210 Sport & Fitness Rev.	(1,291,952)	(1,197,500)	(1,181,600)	(1,284,300)	(86,800)	7.2
5212 Leisure Skills Rev.	(107,231)	(125,500)	(110,800)	(125,500)	-	-
5213 Play. & Camp Rev.	(1,115,466)	(1,133,000)	(1,931,300)	(2,146,200)	(1,013,200)	89.4
5215 Aquat.Rev.-Instuct.	(1,287,506)	(1,194,400)	(1,354,300)	(1,418,400)	(224,000)	18.8
5216 Aquat.Rev.-Recreat.	(123,796)	(228,300)	(138,600)	(229,300)	(1,000)	0.4
5219 Ice Rentals	(5,386,280)	(5,182,200)	(5,439,400)	(5,481,200)	(299,000)	5.8
5225 Tipping Fees-Waste R	(1,899,698)	(1,877,000)	(1,877,000)	(2,052,300)	(175,300)	9.3
5227 Photocopier Revenue	(86,691)	(84,800)	(84,800)	(109,800)	(25,000)	29.5
5228 Membership Revenue	(887,325)	(767,800)	(811,400)	(868,200)	(100,400)	13.1
5229 Tax Sale Admin Fees	(223,695)	(190,000)	(375,000)	(415,000)	(225,000)	118.4
5235 Contract Serv Rev	-	-	(931,900)	(107,300)	(107,300)	-
5239 Cultural Programs	(325,014)	(293,700)	(348,200)	(432,400)	(138,700)	47.2
5241 Tax Info Revenue	(91,485)	(180,000)	(100,000)	(102,000)	78,000	(43.3)
5250 Sales of Svcs-Other	(1,296,306)	(1,940,000)	(1,518,900)	(1,812,400)	127,600	(6.6)
5253 Subdiv Insp Fees	(5,701)	(10,000)	(12,000)	(10,300)	(300)	3.0
5255 Engineering Fees	(19,815)	-	-	-	-	-
5256 SOT Revenue	(2,771,927)	(1,872,500)	(2,872,500)	(2,872,500)	(1,000,000)	53.4
5403 Sale-Other Recycle	(1,424,758)	(1,315,200)	(800,000)	-	1,315,200	(100.0)
5404 Canteen Revenue	(50,914)	(29,800)	(130,000)	(123,900)	(94,100)	315.8
5450 Other Sales Revenue	(74,982)	(44,500)	(235,100)	(153,800)	(109,300)	245.6
* Fee Revenues	(98,176,142)	(96,424,600)	(99,113,000)	(104,942,800)	(8,518,200)	8.8
5502 HRWC Dividend	(6,815,659)	(7,024,600)	(6,122,000)	(7,024,600)	-	-
5503 Advertising Revenue	(719,691)	(1,011,700)	(1,126,100)	(917,700)	94,000	(9.3)
5508 Recov External Parti	(48,438,932)	(17,283,700)	(23,746,900)	(21,109,900)	(3,826,200)	22.1
5509 NSF Chq Fee	-	-	-	(3,000)	(3,000)	-
5520 Donations	(166,929)	(20,000)	(20,000)	(30,000)	(10,000)	50.0
5600 Miscellaneous Revenue	(5,486,798)	(4,107,200)	(4,077,200)	(4,001,500)	105,700	(2.6)
* Other Revenue	(61,628,009)	(29,447,200)	(35,092,200)	(33,086,700)	(3,639,500)	12.4
** Total	(1,295,437,945)	(1,333,608,100)	(1,339,095,600)	(1,445,886,100)	(112,278,000)	8.4
*** Net Total	719,420	0	(26,805)	0	(0)	-

HALIFAX